Keith Ka-fu Chan
Life as Spirit

Tillich Research

Tillich-Forschungen
Recherches sur Tillich

Edited by
Christian Danz, Marc Dumas, Werner Schüßler,
Mary Ann Stenger and Erdmann Sturm

Volume 17

Keith Ka-fu Chan

Life as Spirit

A Study of Paul Tillich's Ecological Pneumatology

DE GRUYTER

ISBN 978-3-11-061167-0
e-ISBN (PDF) 978-3-11-061275-2
e-ISBN (EPUB) 978-3-11-061181-6
ISSN 2192-1938

Library of Congress Cataloging-in-Publication Data
Names: Chen, Jiafu, author.
Title: Life as spirit : a study of Paul Tillich's ecological pneumatology / Keith Ka-fu Chan.
Description: Berlin ; Boston : De Gruyter, [2018] | Series: Tillich research, ISSN 2192-1938 ; volume 17 | Includes bibliographical references and index.
Identifiers: LCCN 2018024036 (print) | LCCN 2018031514 (ebook) | ISBN 9783110612752 (electronic Portable Document Format (pdf) | ISBN 9783110611670 (print : alk. paper) | ISBN 9783110611816 (e-book epub) | ISBN 9783110612752 (e-book pdf)
Subjects: LCSH: Tillich, Paul, 1886-1965. | Ecotheology. | Nature--Religious aspects--Christianity. | Holy Spirit.
Classification: LCC BX4827.T53 (ebook) | LCC BX4827.T53 C44 2018 (print) | DDC 230.092--dc23
LC record available at https://lccn.loc.gov/2018024036

Bibliographic information published by the Deutsche Nationalbibliothek
The Deutsche Nationalbibliothek lists this publication in the Deutsche Nationalbibliografie; detailed bibliographic data are available in the Internet at http://dnb.dnb.de.

© 2018 Walter de Gruyter GmbH, Berlin/Boston
Printing and binding: CPI books GmbH, Leck
♾ Printed on acid-free paper
Printed in Germany

www.degruyter.com

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Preface

The earliest form of the present book came from my doctoral dissertation, submitted to The Chinese University of Hong Kong in 2002. Almost 16 years later, the thesis has been radically changed, substantially expanded, and revised in form and content, though some fundamental assumptions and ideas remain unchanged. One considerable departure from my dissertation is to locate the argumentative burden heavily on Tillich's pneumatology, contained in volume three of *Systematic Theology*, which can be argued to be both the climax and provocative matrix of his theological system. This departure is a considered risk but one of which I am almost certain. However, neither did the scholarship of Tillich studies in particular, nor the research on Christian pneumatology in general, pay sufficient attention to Tillich's doctrine of the Holy Spirit.[1] The reason for the importance of volume three is not merely that it appears as the *magnum opus* of Tillich's systematic construction of theology, but also for the following three points: First, Tillich's doctrine of the Holy Spirit (and its correlational concept of life) was not well established until the publication of volume three of *Systematic Theology* in 1963. During his lifetime, mainly in Germany, two systematic doctrinal attempts were the so-called "1913 *Systematische theologie*" (1913) and *Vorlesung on Dogmatik* in Marburg University (1925), which were fragmentary in content and unfinished, respectively. This means that the disclosure of Tillich's overall *gestalt* of theology was clearly manifest after the completion of his volume three. Second, it seems that Tillich intended to rethink his early theonomous vision of the theology of culture, the social-political dimension of theology of history, and even his later theology of correlation, in the light of his pneumatology and eschatology. Therefore, volume three of *Systematic Theology* should not be treated as one of the steps of Tillich's systematic construction, but instead as an almost rewritten project of his whole theological enterprise in the light of his pneumatological-eschatological perspective. Last, Tillich's dissatisfaction with the writing of volume three was not secret.[2] Until the publica-

1 The exception was found in the recent collection co-edited by Nimi Wariboko and Amos Young entitled *Paul Tillich and Pentecostal Theology* (2015).

2 It should be noted that the German version of volume three of Tillich's *Systematic Theology* was published in 1963, before Tillich's death. Even though the German version was translated and edited by Renate Albrecht, Tillich himself did participate in the whole translation and editoral process. It is important that Tillich amended several parts and added numerous passages in the German version. It is difficult if not impossible to compare the English and German versions. But, at least, it is obvious that Tillich attempted to revise his *magnum opus* until his death.

https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110612752-001

tion of volume two (1956), Tillich still believed that the third part of the system, containing the discussion of the concept of existence and the Christ, remained the "largest" one (in a qualitative not quantitative sense). However, between the publication of volume two and three, the most influential factor affecting Tillich's theological development could be properly described as his authentic experience of Christian-Buddhist dialogue in the early 1960s, especially his trip to Japan in 1960. Professor Pan-chiu LAI has argued, and I am indebted to his view, that these inter-religious dialogues experiences forced Tillich to reconsider his attitude towards non-Christian religions and his own theological project. Most probably, Tillich's volume three, published after those Christian-Buddhist dialogues and Japan trip, was a mixture of his original thoughts and the "*Nachdenken*" of his inter-religious dialogues. Therefore, the importance of Tillich's pneumatology and eschatology contained in volume three was not merely that it was the final largest part of his system, but also it revealed, in a certain sense, Tillich's final statement of his understanding of numerous theological topics.

This book is not intended to argue either that volume three of Tillich's *Systematic Theology* should be regarded as the replacement of all his previous writings, or that it should be singled out as the representative statement of Tillich's theology as a whole. For it is impossible and unjustified to single one particular doctrine out of the *gestalt* nature of Tillich's theology. However, I would like to highlight that, Life and the Spirit, History and the Kingdom of God, of volume three should not be understood as one or two basic doctrines among other doctrines of Tillich rather that almost all other doctrines find their renewal in the light of this volume. For Tillich, pneumatology is not merely closely related to the different loci of traditional Christian doctrines; its distinctive functionality lies in the correlational apparatus of human spiritual creations and the interpenetration between infinite and finite reality through the metaphor of multi-dimensionality. In this book, using a wealth of resources to tackle the problem of scientific-technological rationality, this ontological understanding of pneumatology is argued as the most promising solution for resolving the demarcation between eco-centrism and anthropocentricism, and situating environmental ethics in the context of religious dialogue.

Even though there have been some academic investigations in the past devoted to Tillich's ecological theology,[3] the correlation between Tillich's pneuma-

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John Clayton had mentioned several significant differencs between both versions, see (Clayton 1980).

3 Michael Drummy's *Being and Earth* (2000) should be mentioned. My critical comment on it would be found in 1.3.

tology and ecology was never noticed by scholars. This book will demonstrate that this negligence is not justified, because the theology of nature presented as the multi-dimensional unity of life is strictly correlated with Tillich's idea of the Spirit. Thus, Tillich's ecological theology lies in the fact that the concept of life in general, and humanity in particular, is immediately pneumatological. As H. P. Santmire pointed out, even though he did not notice the pneumatological significance of Tillich's green theology, the ecological potentiality of Tillich's theology perfectly fits into his "ecological motif" which reasserts the tri-unity of God, human beings and nature. The present book argues, not in contrast with but going beyond H.P. Santmire, that Tillich's ecological thinking tries to integrate both the horizontal and the vertical dimensions of God, nature and human beings within a dynamic ontology under a pneumatological-eschatological perspective. Tillich is exceptional among other German and American theologians in that his distinctive and abundant understanding of the concept of life has the potential to engage with other disciplines, such as biology, psychology, cosmology and social science; and that his ontological understanding of "life" which is so crucial in the ecological consideration, is so complex and subtle that we cannot position Tillich's thought as either eco-centricism or anthropocentricism. This enables powerful and critical inter-religious dialogue in environmental ethics. All these discussions will be explored in this full-length book in a roundabout way, especially as Tillich himself did not address any so-called "green theology" during his life; and the emergence of ecological awareness within Christian scholarship had only a preliminary framework by the end of Tillich's life. The basic assumption of my thesis is the assertion that, despite the fact that Tillich did not engage in ecological and environmental theology *directly*, his abundant personal experience of nature-mysticism and intellectual understanding of the idea of nature rooted in his Lutheran and German idealist heritages and, more importantly, his ontological-pneumatological holistic and multi-dimensional conception of unifying and differentiated reality, perfectly and organically coupled with the theonomous vision of theology of culture, nature and morality is profoundly ecologically oriented.

Many thanks to the late Professor Langdon Gilkey for his encouragement and advice during the process of finishing my doctoral thesis on Tillich's ecological theology in the spring semester of 2002 when he was in Hong Kong at the invitation of the Chung Chi Divinity School at The Chinese University of Hong Kong. My gratitude is also expressed to my former colleagues in the Department of Religion and Philosophy, Hong Kong Baptist University, for providing academic and personal supports. A special word of acknowledgment must be made to those colleagues, Professor KWAN Kai-man, Professor Stephen Palmquist, Professor CHAN Shun-hing, Dr William NG Yau-nang, Dr KWOK Wai-luen, Dr. LEE

Siu-fan, Dr CHAN Sze-chi and Dr TAM Yik-fai. Also, my gratitude is especially expressed to Professor Lauren Pfister, the former director of the Center of Sino-Christian Studies, Hong Kong Baptist University, who provided his support for the organization of the international conference "Ultimate Concern: Tillich, Buddhism, Confucianism" in July 2015. My friend, Professor YANG Junjie (Beijing Normal University), deserves to be mentioned. His brilliant translation and interpretation of early Tillich on Schelling removed numerous obstacles to my writing. Also, I would like to thank Prof. Werner Schüßler, Prof. Christian Danz and Prof. Mary Ann Stenger's valuable comments and suggestions on my draft. I am honored to have my work included in the Tillich Research series of Walter de Gruyter. Finally, my thanks must go to Professor Pan-chiu LAI (The Chinese University of Hong Kong). He was my *Doktorvater* for the doctoral thesis on Tillich's ecological theology; his excellent study on Tillich's Trinitarian theology of religions in particular, and intellectual studies on environmental ethics (theology) between different religions in general, inspired me and shaped my perspectives in a fundamental way. His kindly support and criticism during and after my doctoral study undoubtedly provided the greatest motivation for me to move forward. He read the drafts of this book and provided me numerous valuable suggestions. This book is dedicated to him but all the errors are mine.

Chapter two on Tillich's pneumatological theology in this book is the expanded version of my article, "Paul Tillich's Understanding of Theology: A Pneumatological-Christological Perspective", in *Sino-Christian Studies*, no.2 (2015), pp. 33 – 86. Chapter six is the expanded version of my work "Pneumatological Sacramentality and Cosmic Humanity: Tillich, Orthodox Theology and Confucianism", in *Paul Tillich and Asian Religions*. Eds. Keith CHAN Ka-fu & William NG Yau-nang. Berlin. de Gruyter, 2017, pp. 221 – 238.

Keith CHAN

1 Introduction

"Life as spirit" was a phrase employed by Paul Tillich to describe the divine dynamic ontology and the innermost part of human life and reality in his volume one of *Systematic Theology*. "The statement that God is Spirit means that life as spirit is the inclusive symbol for the divine life ... Life as spirit can be found by man only in man, for only in him is the structure of being completely realized" (Tillich 1951: 250).[1] For Tillich, this phrase was not welcome for the two reasons. The word life is both highly ambiguous and vague. It is always correlated with the polarity of life and death in the realm of living beings. However, Tillich intended to re-articulate its embracing power and extend its meaning to cover the whole reality, entitled "multi-dimensional unity of life" in his volume three of *Systematic Theology*, and the reality of God as Living and as Spirit in his volume one of *Systematic Theology*. Also, the word spirit has almost lost its genuine meaning under the modern empiricist separation between the human mind, intellect, emotion and will. However, for Tillich, the "spirit" functions not as a separated sphere alongside other functions of the human mind; it denotes fulfillment in life as an integrated whole in which all elements of the structure of being participate (Ibid.). In referring to the whole universe, "life as spirit" expresses the multi- and trans-dimensionality of all beings functioning under holistic and dynamic interrelationality. In describing the being of God, divine life as spirit expresses the dialectical movement within the process of God, whose identity (being) and separation (non-being) are overcome in the unity of the Spirit. "Life as spirit" articulates the analogical dialectical structure of "union-separation-reunion" shared by God's life as Spirit manifesting his Trinitarian dialectical overcoming of non-being within the being-itself and life in the process of actualization of potentiality in the multi-dimensional whole of the universe. This book aims to elaborate Tillich's above assertion, and to explore its ecological significance in dialogue with orthodox theology and Confucianism.

In this introduction, the symbol of "life" and "spirit" within Tillich's system are mapped in order to argue that, in a formal architecture, these two symbols play embracing and crucial roles in grasping Tillich's overall structure (1.1.). Likewise, Tillich's theology, anthropology and cosmology are deeply and existentially grounded in his experience of nature-mysticism and, simultaneously, his appropriation of the mutual participation of the infinite and the finite which, inspired by his German intellectual heritage and the Lutheran tradition, empow-

1 All quotes with gender specificity are historically situated and intended to refer to humanity in an inclusive sense.

https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110612752-002

ered Tillich to reject the idea of the separation of human beings and nature (1.2.). Furthermore, the scholarship on Tillich's ecological theology is reviewed, and the shortcomings of the scholarship of Tillich's theological contribution to environmental issues assessed (1.3.). Some recent distinctive pneumatological attempts, including: Pannenberg's "Spirit-field", Moltmann's cosmic Spirit, the eco-feminist idea of the Spirit, and Mark Wallace's wounded Spirit and Pentecostal ecological theology, are reviewed (1.4.). Lastly, I sketch some distinctive approaches of Tillich's ecological pneumatology (1.5.).

1.1 Mapping the "Life-spirit" Symbol in Tillich's System

Without question, the categories of "life" and "spirit" function as the regulating formal principle and substantial material concept contained in the thought of Paul Tillich. Although Tillich located the correlation of the term "life" and "spirit" primarily as the doctrine of God in his volume one of *Systematic Theology*, both terms receive their comprehensive meanings in the lengthiest part of his volume three of *Systematic Theology* under the method of correlation. The theoretical significance and practical implication of both concepts should not be understood merely as one of the doctrines among others in Tillich's systematic theology. However, the thesis of this book is an argument that both concepts are the heartbeat and backbone of his entire system in which all other fundamental ideas, concepts and doctrines are closely interconnected. Both concepts are rich and complex for us in articulating a Tillichian ecological pneumatology, even though it seems that Tillich himself did not directly engage in the environmental issues during his lifetime.[2]

2 It seems that there is no documentary evidence to argue for the thesis that Tillich had encountered certain environmental philosophy or ethics in general, and ecological theology in particular, during his life. Of course, undoubtedly, Tillich had rather rich and abundant thinking on the idea of the nature, philosophically and theologically. Especially, in 1963, Tillich noticed that his idea of life is similar to de Chardin's thought, which can be regarded as one of the Catholic theological-scientific interpretations of nature. Therefore, it is quite difficult to decide whether Tillich's ecological theology (if any) was inspired by any particular person's thinking or by which traditions. However, it is certain that, by the 1960s, some Christian theologians had started to express their concerns about the ecological crisis and tried to articulate some theological treatments about the environmental problems. Joseph Sittler was a good example and his essay "A Theology for Earth" was published in 1954 (Sittler 2000). So, the Christian response to Lynn White Jr's essay, "The Historical Roots of Our Ecological Crisis" (1967), should not be commonly regarded as the first attempt of Christianity to respond to environmental challenges.

In both Semitic and Indo-Germanic employment, the word "spirit" originally denoted the breath of life which keeps life alive. Therefore, the word "spirit" does not carry the meaning of immaterial substance, but is profoundly and fully embodied with the power of life which is not external but is the power of animation itself (Tillich 1963: 21). However, through the western dichotomy of spiritual-transcendent and material-immanent worlds, the meaning of "spirit" has been reduced into the idea of "mind" and "intellect" in which only the cognitive and psychological meanings remain (Ibid.: 22). For Tillich, losing the meaning of "spirit" inevitably leads to the breakdown of the meaning of other related terms, such as "soul", "mind" and "reason". Under the predominance of empirical philosophy, the human psyche is the immortal "substance" which is outside the boundary of human knowledge. Therefore, the logos of psyche (psychology) can be easily misunderstood as the science of human behavior instead of the human internal psyche. The words "mind" and "reason" are correlated and face the same fate that, without being in companion with the "spirit", "reason" is understood as the scientific-technological functionality of "reasoning", instead of expressing the logos-structure of all beings. For Tillich, spirit without "*logos*" is blind; "*logos*" without spirit is empty (Ibid.: 24).

For Tillich, losing the meaning of the term "spirit" denotes the breakdown and division of human beings. Pneumatology no longer belongs to anthropology; that means human being deprived of spirit. Anthropology without pneumatology is not only incomplete but also inadequate because both the unity of each human being is in danger and also the creativity of human beings would become inexplicable. Tillich emphasized the meaning of "spirit" as the unity of power and meaning. If the element of spirit is eliminated, the functionality of the human mind is internalized as the emotional element and is disconnected with the intellect. Therefore, the unity of the human person would be fragmented.

Inspired by Hegelian philosophy of the whole vision of reality, Tillich reserved the term "spirit" (with a small "s") for a human being, which constitutes the relative and finite spirit, and is correlated with God as absolute and infinite Spirit (Tillich 1967a: 416). Firstly, the Hegelian God as Spirit is the creative power united with meaning. "This creative power in union with meaning produces in men personal self-consciousness and creates through men culture, language, the arts, the state, philosophy and religion" (Ibid.). Without the understanding of the human spirit, all creative production of the human being as person is problematic. Secondly, Tillich is aligned with Hegel in integrating the concept of spirit and life process into a dynamic whole. The human spirit itself and its various manifestations are the self-manifestation of the divine Spirit, which concretely and profoundly appears in the life process in nature and history. "All life

processes are the manifestation of the divine life, only they appear in time and space, whereas in God, they are in their essential nature" (Ibid.: 417). God's being is nothing but is essential and potential, given his historical and natural manifestations. God's Spirit reveals Himself in and through the human spirit. Therefore, for Hegel, "everything in its essential nature is the self-expression of the divine life" (Ibid.). God's Spirit returns to Himself through the world process, and finally through human spiritual manifestations. For Tillich, from an essential perspective, Hegel established a comprehensive vision for restoring the synthesis of divine Spirit and the human spirit through the manifestation of the divine life in the life of all beings.[3]

Furthermore, the term, life, also suffers the problems of ambiguity and vagueness. Generally speaking, the polarity of life and death denotes the experience of the special group of "living beings" which merely dominate the organic dimension. It is obvious that the other dimension will be excluded in this limited employment of this term. Therefore, Tillich tried to expand the realm of life, from the polarity of life and death, to the universal concept of life in which the word, life, can be elevated to a basic and radical term to cover the multi-dimensional unity of all beings. Also, due to the above limitation only covering the biological understanding of life, the ontological and universal status of life is designed and packaged as a philosophical concept, which is inspired by Aristotle's classical distinction between *dynamis* and *energeia* (Tillich 1963: 12). Life is the actuality of potentiality. This pair of Aristotelian concepts plays an important role in two directions. Firstly, this ontological-philosophical matrix of potentiality and actuality enriches the meaning of life from materiality to spirituality in which life does not merely mean living beings, but also covers the various processes of different life forms in which the ontological self-integration, self-creation and self-transcendence are articulated. Secondly, echoing Tillich's own philosophical-theological articulation of essential and existential framework, life is understood as a twofold perspective: the unity and diversity in its essential

3 It is not my intention to argue that Hegel's philosophy largely influenced the pneumatology of Tillich. The complex relationship between Hegel and Tillich could be well-constructed in another project. Following from Re Manning's comment (Re Manning 2005: 96 – 103), I agree that, even though Tillich had a negative perception of Hegel by his exposure to Kierkegaard's existential critique of Hegelian's idealism, Hegel's influence is significant. I would like to complement this with Tillich's idea of love as the union of the separated as being clearly Hegelian. Also, it seems that Tillich's negative attitude towards Hegel's idealism can be explained and influenced by his religious socialist perspective towards the danger of Hegel's historical dialectical theory. However, it is clear that Tillich asserted, "Hegel's concept of spirit unites meaning with power" (Tillich 1963: 22), which is the basic assertion of Tillich's pneumatology.

and potential stage, and the manifold ambiguities in its existential and actual stages (Ibid.). Based on this articulation of life as existential actuality of essential potentiality, the various forms of life would be enveloped into a pneumatological quest for an unambiguous stage of redemption.

Besides, the philosophical-theological system itself and life share the same destiny. Tillich conceived all parts of his *Systematic Theology* as being constituted as an organic system with a circular character, like a *gestalt* whole (Tillich 1957:5); this is despite the fact that the writing process for his three volumes of *Systematic Theology* took almost twelve years (1951–1963)! Tillich's enthusiasm for systematic construction is well known; it started from his first published, but less noticed monograph, *The System of the Sciences* (1923), to the *magnum opus*, *Systematic Theology* (1951–1963). In his work he always integrated diverse, multifaceted, even rival, perspectives into a coherent and unified system which is not static and closed, but is a dynamic unity even if it were full of unsolved tensions. In his final phase of life, Tillich still insisted on defending his systematic character of thinking. For him, from Origen to Schleiermacher, Christian theology is always systematic in character. However, Tillich was never lost in establishing the system for the sake of the system. He always reminded us of the danger of Hegelian systematic-metaphysical hubris and we should bear in mind that the finite, fragmentary and fragile nature of the system is convincingly challenged by existentialism (Tillich 1957: 51).

It is dramatically ironical that, in his final volume of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich honestly confessed, "his system is not even complete" (Tillich 1963: 5). For Tillich, the completeness of his system is neither his theological goal nor the destiny of every system; rather he tends to accept the symbolic function of the system pointing beyond itself to the ultimate.[4] The concepts of God, human beings, theological engagement, etc., are by no means static and fixed. For Tillich, static implies a death identity. Tension, polarity and dynamism symbolize authentic and concrete embodiment in reality. Therefore, systematic construction of theologizing is implicitly analogous with life processing, involving and sharing the same destiny that is fragile and fragmentary; but positively speaking, they are a *gestalt* whole in which those regulating principles and dynamic interrelations unite different dimensions (Tillich 1951: 58; 1963: 3). Tillich always resisted the deductive-mathematical character of a theological system in

4 Tillich said, "It [The system] should be like a station at which preliminary truth is crystallized on the endless road towards truth" (Tillich 1963: v).

which the human existential experience is excluded and ignored.[5] For the fragility of life and the fragmentation of the system, Tillich said,

> It is the function of the systematic form to guarantee the consistency of cognitive assertions in all realms of methodological knowledge. In this sense some of the most passionate foes of the system are most systematic in the totality of their utterances. And it often happens that those who attack the systematic form are very impatient when they discover an inconsistency in someone else' s thought. On the other hand, it is easy to discover gap in the most balanced system, because life continuously breaks through the systematic shell. One could say that in each system an experienced fragment of life and vision is drawn out constructively even to cover areas where life and vision are missing. And, conversely, one could say that in each fragment a system is implied which is not yet explicated. Hegel's imposing system was built on his early fragmentary paragraphs on the dialectics of life, including the dialectics of religion and the state. The "blood" of his system, as well as its immense historical consequences, were rooted in this fragmentary vision of existence ... Nietzsche's many fragments seem to be permanently contradictory. But in all of them a system is implicit, the demonic strength of which has become manifest in the twentieth century. *A fragment is an implicit system; a system is an explicit fragment*" (Tillich 1951: 58. Emphasis mine).

No system should be a closed entity as life is always open and unstable. A fragmentary character is not a weakness of a system; rather it is like different pieces of stationary entities searching for another stage.[6]

Even if Tillich himself was disappointed with the incompleteness of his system, his blueprint for systematic theology was clearly framed into three main parts. First, the "essential" element expresses the structure of the finitude of beings and the ontological questions implied. Following the doctrine of God provides the Christian answer under the consideration of the method of correlation. Second, the "existential" element analyses the estranged alienation of the beings and all realms of human activities, which points to the quest for the Christolog-

5 It is disappointing that Kenneth Hamilton is unable to recognize the correlation between human life and theological systematic construction and, I think, his complaint with the "systematic" character of Tillich's work is not valid. See (Hamilton 1963).

6 For the question of the inconsistency of Tillich's systematic theology, there are numerous literature references to review. A good summary is (Halme 2003: 25 – 34). Generally speaking, many scholars tend to draw the conclusion that it is unquestionable that, in Tillich's systematic theology, inconsistency and tension are found in different areas; this includes Halme himself. I engage with this question in chapter two through the analysis of the tension of "particularity-universality" of the theological circle. My own thesis is basically that, due to the reason for Tillich's volume three of *Systematic Theology* carrying a polemic burden to "rethink" all the theological questions that emerged in the volume one and two, it is too "heavy" for Tillich's pneumatology to play this role.

ical answer. Last, as Tillich said, the third part is based on a premise that "the essential as well as the existential characteristics are abstractions and that in reality they appear in the complex and dynamic unity which is called 'life'" (Tillich 1951: 67). Thus, the discussion of the essential and existential beings, contained in volume one and two of *Systematic Theology* remain as *abstractions*, until the mixture of both comes into the actualization in the symbol of "life" under which the doctrine of the Spirit is designed to tackle the ambiguity of life expressed in this last part. Simply speaking, the "essential" and "existential" parts are prepared for the concept of "life" which embraces and integrates the former two abstract ideas. Also, correspondingly, pneumatology is proposed as the main doctrine to correlate the ambiguity founded in the mixture of essential and existential beings. Therefore, in the very beginning of writing his theology, Tillich anticipated the climax of his theology in the correlational apparatus of life and spirit.

Likewise, in his volume one of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich had already anticipated the last part, life and spirit, which would be extended into the consideration of "historical life" and the problems created in history in general. Correspondingly, the doctrine of the Holy Spirit would also extend into the doctrines of "eternal life" and the "kingdom of God" as the Christian answers. For Tillich, these three symbols, the Holy Spirit, eternal life and the kingdom of God, are not independent. Conversely, in the final part of his volume three of *Systematic Theology*, history and the kingdom of God, should be considered as the extended dimension of the part, life and spirit. That means, the historical dimension of the Spirit and the horizontal dimension of the multi-dimensional unity of life are articulated. Therefore, in volume three of *Systematic Theology*, the comprehensive vision of the vertical and horizontal dimensions, coupled with multi- and polyfaceted levels of beings and the divine, is clearly completed. As Tillich emphasized the doctrine of Spiritual Presence, the Eternal Life and the Kingdom of God are all three-in-one symbols manifesting the distinctive modality of God's revelation in answering different dimensions of the ambiguity of life in general and the historical life in particular. "The three symbols [Spiritual Presence, Eternal Life and the Kingdom of God] use different symbolic material and, in doing so, express different directions of meaning *within the same idea of unambiguous life*"(Tillich 1963:108. Emphasis mine). For the sake of systematic construction, it is reasonable to assert that volume three of *Systematic Theology*, containing the last two parts, life and the Spirit, history and the Kingdom of God, is Tillich's

final consideration in his lifelong theological career.[7] This is not to assert that volume three should be exclusively interpreted as an isolated text; rather this book argues that all other texts published in the U.S., and even other writings in his German period, are rightly to be reinterpreted in the light of this final volume. Therefore, this is exactly the reason why Tillich himself expected too much of this volume and, furthermore, after the publication of the former two volumes of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich highlighted that the whole polemic burden, heavily relying on the doctrine of the Spirit, may be another reason for creating some internal difficulties and external problems.[8] Whether Tillich convincingly argued his numerous theses in volume three, one thing is certain: the neglect of the ideas of life and the spirit would become unacceptable. It is clear that the whole theological construction is basically Trinitarian in framework (Being/ God – Existence/ Christ – Life/ Spirit) and, as Tillich mentioned, based on the reasons of expediency, the integrated whole body of doctrine is divided and functions separately, corresponding to different existential questions. For the circular and the *gestalt* character of theology, all religious symbols are intrinsically interrelated. "The end of the system leads back to its beginning" (Tillich 1963: 299).[9] Therefore, Tillich's idea of God as being-itself and Christ as New being would not be understood if the concept of the Spirit is neglected, as the whole concept of being in essence and existence would be missed if, finally, the idea of life is forgotten.

Furthermore, apart from the correlation method functioning to correlate the symbol of the Trinitarian God with different existential questions, Tillich's system is Trinitarian in principle in another aspect: the ontological interdependence between God and the world is also threefold. The whole system indicates a Trinitarian rhythm of the Divine Life and of the life universal. "One could refer to this rhythm as the way from essence through existential estrangement to essentialization" (Tillich 1963: 421). This Trinitarian dialectical matrix of "essence-existence-essentialization" constitutes the backbone of Tillich's thought. Also, "it

7 Some commentators assert that Tillich had some slightly "new" perspectives in his last public lecture on the history of religions in 1965. I deal with this problem in (2.6.).

8 Tillich said, "I did not feel that I should deal with them [critical questions] in terms of direct answers, since that would overload this volume with polemical material and I believe that the volume itself, *especially the section on the doctrine of the Spirit*, implicitly answers many of the arguments of the former volumes" (Tillich 1963: 5. Emphasis mine). In Pan-chiu LAI's study, the method of correlation is in danger when Tillich developed his pneumatology and the concept of life because both are *not* in a relation of correlation but in interrelation.

9 It should be noted that Tillich had decided to publish his "*dogmatik*" in 1930 under the title as "*Die Gestalt der religiosen Erkenntnis*"; see (Schüssler 2009:8). For the importance of the "*gestalt*" in Tillich's theology, see (Jahr 1989).

is the way from the merely potential through actual separation and reunion to fulfillment beyond the separation of potentiality and actuality" (Tillich 1963: 299). This matrix is philosophical and theological in nature. In his final consideration, all living beings in general and human beings in particular, are examined through this Trinitarian structure: created goodness (essence), fall (estranged existence) and salvation (essentialization). Tillich's systematic and comprehensive vision is "Trinitarian theocentric" in terms of embracing the whole world process (the multi-dimensional unity of life and history) into the very being of God. From the above analysis, the final consummation of the world (essentialization) comes into fulfillment within the interplay between pneumatology and eschatology, which are intensively and completely constituted in volume three of *Systematic Theology*.

Back to the theme of life and the spirit, the most remarkable conception of Tillich's perspective is, first, that the fundamental formulation of the idea of God is understood within the Trinitarian principle that denotes God as *living* and as *Spirit*. Therefore, the symbol of life and spirit are, primarily but not exclusively, denoted to the being of God as being-itself. Although Tillich devoted much effort to develop his ontological-universal structure of God as the ground and the power of being in volume one of *Systematic Theology*, this being-theology of God can be misunderstood if it is external to Tillich's *pneumatic*-theology of God in and through which the dynamic and dialectical conception of the divine are clearly manifested.[10] As Wolfgang Vondey rightly asserted: "Tillich can be described as a theologian of being only insofar as this title takes account of Tillich's theology of spirit" (Vondey 2015: 36).[11] For Tillich, the being-language and *pneumatic*-language are not contradictory but are complementary to each other, because, in his defense of employing the concept of "being", Tillich highlighted that the reason he employed the conception of being was to show "the expression of the experience of being over against non-being" (Tillich 1957: 11). The reason for the employment of the notion of 'being" is its dynamic character of the

10 Tillich defended why he employed ontological language in the conception of God even though his pneumatology had not been fully expressed before 1963. Therefore, the charge that Tillich committed fully into the philosophical-ontological substance in replacing the Christian-religious idea of God is not justified in the work of R.A. Killen. For details, see (Killen 1956).
11 Wolfgang Vondey is convincing in tracing Tillich's pneumatology back to German idealist philosophy and theology (Schelling and Schleiermacher). However, Vondey was disappointed with Tillich being "less concerned with a philosophy of nature" (Vondey 2015: 35). This study argues that, in contrast to Vondey's careless judgment, Tillich was not merely concerned with the identity of nature and spirit, but also constructed the multi-dimensionality of life through which a more comprehensive idea of cosmology can be articulated.

polarity of being and non-being. The dialectical polarity of being and non-being within God himself is correctly understood as God as living. Following Schelling's philosophy, the Godhead of God is never a dead pure identity, but the identity and separation are always posited and united (Tillich 1951: 242). Also, life as the actualization of the ontological structural elements in their union and tension is fully expressed by Tillich's presentation of the *telos* of life and the fulfillment as spirit (Ibid.: 249). Precisely, the complex understanding of life and of spirit implied in the doctrine of God is clearly expressed in Tillich's words that "God as living is God fulfilled in himself and therefore spirit" (Ibid.). For Tillich, the symbol of "spirit" is the most fruitful and promising one in describing God himself because "it is the most embracing, direct and unrestricted symbol for the divine life ... it includes all the ontological elements" (Ibid.). Therefore, my reading strategy has been to package all the ideas of the being and act of God under the perspective of pneumatology. If Tillich's idea of the living God as Spirit is the comprehensive conception of the Being-itself, the divine revelation in volume one, and the redemptive manifestation in the life of Jesus Christ as New Being in volume two, are interpreted anew under the Spiritual Presence in volume three of *Systematic Theology*. This study aims to articulate Tillich's theology from a pneumatological perspective and argues that it would be out of focus if Tillich's entire system cannot be understood in an organic way in general, or without considering seriously the prominent role that pneumatology plays in his system. I think this articulation is perfectly in tune with the intention of Tillich. As Frank Macchia mentioned: "Tillich's system implies the development of the First Article of the Creed from the vantage point of God as the universal spirit. Tillich could very well have started with the universal Spirit and then *worked from there* to God's decisive and ultimate manifestation in the Christ and then to a dynamic understanding of the Ground of Being, Articles 1 and 2 understood from the vantage point of Article 3" (Macchia 2015: 86. Emphasis mine).[12]

Apart from the doctrine of God, Tillich covered his ideas of creation, anthropology, church, morality, culture and religion, under the categories of life and spirit. For the understanding of life, Tillich anticipated this concept as not only the full meaning of the ontological elements and their unity (Tillich 1951: 249), but also "passion as much as truth, libido as much as surrender, will to power as much as justice" (Ibid.: 250). "Life" integrates different human faculties – rationality, morality and aesthetics – into a unity with differentiated func-

12 In Macchia's article, he mentioned an interesting exchange between Tillich and Nels F.S. Ferre where Ferre asked Tillich whether it is possible to rework the entire *Systematic Theology* with Spirit language. Tillich's answer was "that this could and should be done" (Macchia 2015: 86).

tions in which the ontological-ethical entities, such as love, justice and power, are also structurally combined. Therefore, neither a dualistic conceptuality nor a monistic complex without any differentiation is preferable. In contrast, the phrase "Life as spirit" denotes the integrated, multi-faceted and unifying reality instead of referring to an isolated or a special independent function of the human being and the cosmos. In his volume three of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich extended both concepts, life and spirit, universally in the macro and micro levels in order to cover from materiality to spirituality on the one hand, and then located them specifically in the human spiritual functions (morality, culture and religion) on the other under the embracing concept, multi-dimensional unity of life, through which the essential trans- and multi-dimensions of all life forms are located, and the modalities of human and other life-forms – self-integration, self-growth and self-transcendence – are integrated within the fabric of the Unconditioned.

In summary, Tillich re-established his whole theonomous vision of human activities and life in general in his pneumatology and eschatology in volume three of *Systematic Theology*. This theological project was first thematically sketched in his early Berlin address, "On the Idea of a Theology of Culture" (1919); in this last attempt in his volume three of *Systematic Theology*, he extended this theological vision to cover not merely the relationship between religion and culture which was his earlier focus, but he also articulated the theonomous understanding of different forms of life in the whole universe and its historical dimension under the dynamic understanding of both concepts. Therefore, in his last attempt, Tillich integrated the theology of culture, theology of nature, theological cosmology, Christian anthropology under the scheme of pneumatology and eschatology.

1.2 Tillich's Mystical Experience of Nature and his Intellectual Heritage[13]

1.2.1 Nature Mysticism

Among the Protestant theologians in the twentieth century, Tillich was regarded as the one who was most highly connected with nature. In the mid-twentieth

13 In this part, I only try to sketch some basic important figures, e. g. Schelling, Martin Kähler and Nicolaus Cusanus, in exploring the identity principle in philosophical and theological traditions through which Tillich was deeply inspired. For other more important and substantial aspects of intellectual traditions (which I call "Spirit-movements and Theologies of experience")

century, Tillich mentioned that almost all his early writings in Germany were highly related to historical problems. However, for Tillich, nature and history are closely related. Tillich remarked that during his childhood, he enjoyed being in the living environment, which was full of medieval architectures and Gothic-style of churches (Tillich 1967: 24). Furthermore, Tillich's appreciation of nature was based on his personal mystical-romantic participation with nature. That is the reason why Tillich always used an aesthetic instead of a scientific-technical attitude towards nature (Ibid: 26; Tillich 1956a: 4). Apart from his personal mystical experience of nature, Tillich was inspired by German poetry from Goethe, Hölderlin, Nietzsche, Novalis and Rilke, through which he experienced nature mysticism (Ibid.: 26; Tillich 1956a: 5).

Also, Tillich's mystical participation in nature was grounded in *finitum capax infiniti* under the *Infra Lutheranum*, which provided a Christological justification for asserting the presence of the infinite in the finite, even though this theological inheritance was easily misunderstood as the pagan pantheism by some Calvinist theologians (Tillich 1967: 26). His appreciation of F.W.J. Schelling's philosophy of nature and positive philosophy framed Tillich's construction of the idea of nature's participation in the fall and salvation. The above-mentioned Lutheran and German idealist traditions powerfully supported Tillich in rejecting a position of an infinite gap between person and nature, which was commonly expressed in post-Kantian theology in general and Ritschlian theology in particular (Tillich 1967: 25; 1956a: 4). Tillich noted that this Kantian theological conceptuality restricted the mystical participation of human beings in nature, and reduced nature to a dominant object of human morality and scientific technology. The danger of this theological reductionism frames nature as something external to infinite divinity and as the mere object of the scientific rationality (Ibid.).[14]

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and which influence deeply and profoundly Tillich's doctrine of the Holy Spirit in particular and panentheistic understanding of God in general, I locate them in chapter 3 in order to make it more relevant to the exploration of Tillich's pneumatology. In that part, medieval and German mystics (Augustine, Bonaventura, Bernard of Clairvaux, Joachim of Floris and Meister Eckhart), radical reformers and Schleiermacher are regarded as the essential resources of Tillich's theology of the Holy Spirit.

14 Nature, for Tillich, is always full of mystical spirits and divine-demonic powers. Langdon Gilkey had mentioned that, in his recollections with Tillich, in May 1950, Gilkey drove with Tillich beyond the suburban development south of Nashville about ten miles into the country; and then they turned off onto a forest road that wound another two miles or so into the hills. This was a place full of tall grass which sloped down into the woods about a hundred yards away. The wood was aflame with flowering trees and stubs. When Gilkey pulled up the car and came around to open the front door for Tillich, he noticed that Tillich was a bit flustered and nervous. He asks, "Are zere *zerpents* here, Langdon?" Interestingly, Gilkey noticed that Tillich did not say snakes,

Nature was not merely the place in which Tillich could contemplate, but also provided lots of inspiration and wonderful experiences in his intellectual life. Tillich mentioned that the experience of the ocean was analogous with "the experience of the infinite bordering on the finite". This metaphor inspired by the ocean-boundary was the source of Tillich's imagination of the human boundary situation. Furthermore, "the dynamic assault on the serene firmness of the land and the ecstasy of its gales and waves" is so rich that Tillich developed his idea of "dynamic mass". As Tillich said, "the sea ... supplied the imaginative element necessary for the doctrines of the Absolute as both ground and abyss of dynamic truth, and of the substance of religion as the thrust on the eternal into the finitude" (Tillich 1966: 18).

Tillich's early two theses on Schelling's philosophy (Tillich 1910; 1912) described in detail the dynamic participation of the divine in the world in the idealist perspective, and the way mystical identity and separation facilitated between God and the world. These early frameworks contributed to Tillich's lifelong theological career (Tillich 1966: 17). Precisely, the early Schelling's "*Identitätsprinzip* of nature and spirit" constituted the interrelationships between God, human beings and the world. Under this principle, the mixing of nature and spirit, objectivity and subjectivity, *Realität* and *Idealität* are posited in their unity (Schüssler 1997: 27). Also, in Tillich's *Habilitationsschrift*, he devoted his energy to the complex relationship of naturalism and supernaturalism before Schleiermacher's theological tradition. It manifested his early criticism about dualistic theological supernaturalism in which the dichotomy between God and the world was constituted (Tillich 1915).

Tillich believed that the finite is capable of symbolizing the infinite; this was inspired not merely by the German idealism, but also through the powerful assertion of "justification by grace through faith" taught by his admirable teacher, Martin Kähler (1835 – 1912). This Lutheran doctrine of salvation provides the radical equality of all beings before God's grace, and God's acceptance being extended to the intellectual doubters. The consequent breakdown of hierarchical levels of all beings inspired Tillich to use "dimension" instead of "level" to interpret multi-faceted reality. Furthermore, Nicolaus Cusanus's idea of "*coincidentia oppositorum*" also reinforced Tillich's belief in the interrelationship between the infinite and the finite. The finite is able to participate in the infinite. The "principle of immediacy" for the inwardness of the divine in the innermost

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but zerpents, which implies that Tillich was fully occupied with a much more formidable and mysterious sort of creature, a creature transparent to the unconditional power of life and of death in nature; see (Gilkey 1990: 201).

human mind inspired by the Platonic-Augustinian-Franciscan tradition constituted the idea of "participation" in which Tillich's entire theological system was grounded (Dourley 1975; Wettstein 1968; Tillich 1964).

1.2.2 Dialectic Attitudes towards Mysticism

However, Tillich did not embrace mysticism without reservation. In his discussion of medieval mysticism, Tillich warned us: "do not make the mistake of identifying this (*concrete*) type of mysticism with the absolute or abstract mysticism in which the individual disappears in the abyss of the divine" (Tillich 1967a:136). Actually, this kind of warning occurred in his early thesis on Schelling, when Tillich tried to find out the synthesis between the principle of identity and the guilt-consciousness separation between God and human beings, "the principle of mysticism triumphs, but *not in the form of mysticism*, *not as immediate identity*, but rather as personal communion that overcomes contradiction: it is 'the religion of the Spirit and of freedom'" (Tillich 1912: 125. Emphasis mine). In volume two of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich reminded us that the problem of mysticism "neither is their solitude or communion, because the centered self of the individual has been dissolved" (Tillich 1957:72). Moreover, it is dangerous for mysticism, for Tillich, to neglect the existential and historical condition of beings without the eschatological criticism (Horne 1978; Dreisbach 2000).

It is clear that Tillich rejected the so-called absolute or abstract mysticism and held a dialectical perspective towards mysticism; however, in his article "Paul Tillich and the Classical Christian Tradition", Carl Braaten rightly wrote that "all the labels that have been applied to Tillich's theology, none of them come close to fitting unless they bring out the *mystical ontology* which undergirds his whole way of thinking" (Braaten 1967: xxv. Emphasis mine). Then, how did Tillich avoid the danger of abstract mysticism when he established his whole theology in the fashion of mysticism? Or, what kinds of mysticism did Tillich prefer in order to fit into his own theology of participation?

The immediate awareness of the Unconditioned constituted the essential element of Tillich's idea of religious experience. In his reflection on his philosophical background, Tillich asserted that the union of infinite and finite was the grounding principle of his doctrine of religious experience, and that was the reason why he appreciated Eastern mysticism (Tillich 1960: 414). Firstly, Tillich articulated the term "mysticism" as a divine immediate presence or manifestation category which is a focus shared by all religions. This means that seeking mystical union between infinite and finite is universally valid in every religion. The dichotomy between subject and object is transcended under a transcendent

union (Tillich 1963: 257–258). As a religious category, mysticism embodies the element of religious *a priori* in which the ultimate identity is presupposed in the epistemological and ontological senses (Tillich 1951: 9). Secondly, it is well known that Tillich distinguished three types of religion: sacramental, prophetic and mystical. The danger of the first is mixing the finite with the infinite and thus identifying the medium of revelation as the revelation itself (Tillich 1957: 60). In order to avoid the danger of demonic tendency, mystical and prophetic criticism complement each other; they "criticized the demonically distorted sacramental-priestly substance by devaluing every medium of revelation and by trying to unite the soul directly with the ground of being, to make it enter the mystery of existence without the help of a finite medium" (Tillich 1951: 140).

However, in seeking the immediate awareness of the Unconditioned, the way of mysticism is to liberate human beings from a concrete existential situation, thus making the situation irrelevant to the actual human situation. Tillich has reservations about the "ultimate negation" in mysticism and the self-dissolving aspect of the mystic union. For an understanding of ontological polarity of individualization and participation, either an epistemological process or an ontological experience is both expressed in a dialectical process of "union-separation-reunion". That means, for Tillich, a pure and absolute sense of mystical union is impossible and undesirable. This comment was fully articulated in his comment distinguishing two types of mysticism in his lecture on Bernard of Clairvaux the history of Christian thought:

> concrete mysticism, which is mysticism of love and participating in the Savior-God, and abstract mysticism, or transcending mysticism, which goes beyond everything finite to the ultimate ground of everything that is (Tillich 1967a: 174).

The ultimate goal of Christian mysticism neither neglects the finite and concrete situation, nor seeks to dissolve oneself into the divine mystery. Rather, it should be a kind of concrete love dynamic relationship between God and each human being. Mystical knowing should be regarded as a participation epistemology in which knowing self and knowing God are communicated under the *eros-agape* relationship. The "I-Thou" relationship is reserved in the mystical union, as Martin Buber emphasized (Tillich 1959b: 194). Love as a dynamic driving power is essential in understanding Tillich's mystical ontology of participation. The union is regarded as the final goal of love in which separation and distance are assumed (Tillich 1954: 25). Being is being-in-communion in Tillich's articulation of Christian mysticism in which individual centeredness should not be dissolved though entering into the abyss of the divine.

However, it seems that the above personal and relational character of mysticism does not perfectly fit into Tillich's ontological theology in which God is regarded as a non-personal ontology of being-itself.[15] How can Tillich maintain the harmonious correlation between divine-human personal mystical experience and God as the ground and the abyss of the being? It is not the intention of this discussion to solve the tension between God as being itself and God as personal. However, when a human being faces a situation of radical doubts and both concrete and abstract approaches of mysticism cannot overcome the doubt, then, in what sense can Tillich still maintain his mystical ontological theology? And, in what sense does the idea "God above God" as the solution of radical doubt overcome the difficulty of mysticism? Finally, despite Tillich's preference that there is no special content of "God above God," his Trinitarian symbolism of God would be a perfect symbol to understand the content (Chan 2015).[16]

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15 It should be noted that, in Tillich's mind, the religious (God as personal) and philosophical languages (God as being-itself) are not in contradiction. However, it is not the scope of this book to deal with this problem. See (Tillich 1955d).

16 The discussion of the relationship between Tillich's "God above God" and the Trinitarian symbol is beyond the scope of this chapter. Briefly speaking, Tillich never identified the God above God as a Triune God. However, I have argued that his understanding of Trinitarian symbolism is the perfect metaphor to grasp the meaning of the God above God. Firstly, traditional theism is dysfunctional under the threat of radical doubt, not because of its error but because it is one-sided. That means we do not need to abandon this concept but to transcend it. Also, the God of mysticism and the God above God is not contradictory. Therefore, the idea of God above God implies an embracing of the impersonal character of mystical union and personalism of the divine-human encounter into itself. Secondly, though Tillich is not much interested in the doctrine of Trinity, this does not imply that God as tri-unity plays no role in his entire theology. Rather, Tillich's whole theological construction is entirely Trinitarian. Trinitarian dialectical process within the life of God as being-itself expresses the dynamic power of over-coming non-being within the being of God. Trinitarian symbolism is the perfect symbol in answering the human existential question and in expressing the divine self-manifestation. The most important point is that, according to Tillich, the two basic and fundamental aspects of ultimate human concern are seeking for both concreteness and absoluteness. These two dialectical demands correspond to the polytheist and monotheistic modes of theism, which is perfectly combined into a Trinitarian structure of being-itself. Therefore, even though the human Trinitarian structure of ultimate concern does not prove the validity of the Christian triune God, the inner tension within this religious experience will perfectly correspond to the tension within the Godhead. Mysticism seeks for a kind of universal and ultimate character of ultimate concern; personalist religion seeks for a kind of concrete and particular character of ultimate concern. Tillich emphasized that, one of the functions of the Trinitarian symbol is to answer the "ultimate and concrete question within the living God" (Tillich 1951: 228). It seems that these two dimensions, ultimate and concrete, of human ultimate concern correspond to the mystical union of ultimate with the concrete personal

1.3 Tillich's Ecological Theology: A Review

Although Tillich's biographical details convincingly demonstrate the richness of Tillich's personal experience of nature-mysticism, it is surprising that, according to Richard Crossmann's research, there was no monograph, academic article and doctoral thesis devoted to Tillich's idea of nature until 1983 (Crossman 1983). In the 1970s, there were only two substantial monographs, Kenneth Schedler's *Natur und Gnade: Das sakramentale Denken in der frühen Theologie Paul Tillichs* (1919 – 1935) and Ulrich Reetz's *Das Sakramentale in der Theologie Paul Tillichs*, which slightly touched on Tillich's concept of nature; however, both of them focused on the sacramentality of nature and not mainly on tackling the problematic of ecological concerns (Schedler 1970; Reetz 1974).

Gordon Kaufman was perhaps the first to be aware of the relationship between Paul Tillich and ecological theology. In his 1972 essay, "A Problem for Theology: The Concept of Nature", Kaufmann condemned the bankruptcy of the concept of nature in the Christian dominant discourses in which the vertical dimension between God and human beings is over-emphasized at the cost of neglect of nature. Based on the analogical construction on the similarity of morality and personality between God and human beings, nature is far away from God and should be controlled and managed by human rationality. Kaufman emphasized that this ecological bankruptcy cannot be solved by highlighting the human being as part of nature because, fundamentally and ontologically, a human being is not merely a kind of historical-natural being but also a being who transcends the environment in order to build a cultural world which is ultimately harmful to nature (Kaufman 1972). Based on an evolutionary interpretation, Kaufman's thesis is that all historical existence should be understood as grounded in the matrix of nature; the concept of "nature" should not be regarded as external to the human evolution-historical-cultural apparatus. In one of his footnotes following this point, Kaufman mentioned that when we access or try to develop the vision of the unity of nature and history, the significance of Tillich's volume three of *Systematic Theology* is significantly downgraded and neglected in the scholarship (Ibid.). Besides this appreciation, in his essay entitled "Reconceiving God and Humanity in Light of Today's Evolutionary-Ecological Consciousness", Tillich's theological vision was surprisingly reduced and criticized by Kaufmann with the charge of anthropocentricism and personalism, even

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relationship of divine-human. In Tillich's theology, God as being-itself is not a dead identity but his dynamic life is a creatively living experience expressed through the Trinitarian principle inherited in the Godhead.

though Kaufman mentioned the concept of "life" as promising and fruitful in Tillich's system (Kaufman 2001).[17]

In contrast, in his book, *The Travail of Nature: The Ambiguous Ecological Promise of Christian Theology*, H. P. Santmire highly appreciated Tillich's eco-theology, which was positively classified into the category of "ecological motif" in which the tri-relationship between God, nature and human being is regarded as ecologically oriented. This motif produces a substantial ecological empowerment for us in tackling the environmental problem (Santmire 1985: 9–10). Furthermore, Santmire asserted that Tillich's articulation of the concept of God as the ground of being provides the criticism towards the impassibility of a post-Kantian conception of God who is personal in character but is external to the cosmos. Tillich's doctrine of God as "hyper-personalism", as Santmire called it, which regards God as the ground of all personal, is helpful in resolving the tension between the personal God and the impersonal nature of classical theism (Santmire 2000: 64–65). Following this line, James Carpenter devoted one chapter in his *Nature and Grace*, published in 1988, to the idea of Tillich's "multi-dimensional unity of life" in order to explore nature as the entity participating in God's economic saving power (Carpenter 1988: 37–56).

In Langdon Gilkey's monograph on the thoughts of Tillich, *Gilkey on Tillich*, published in 1990, we find a more direct attempt to relate Tillich's theology to environmental problems. For Gilkey, Tillich provided numerous religious and ontological languages for us to image the direct correlation between human beings and nature. Also, Gilkey asserted that, in Tillich's theology, the *logos* within the human and nature is united and shares the same ultimate *Logos*. This "unity-in-difference" character of *Logos* connects all *logos* with the ground of beings (Gilkey 1990: 184). Furthermore, under Tillich's existential analysis of the alienation between human beings and nature, the concept of *concupiscence* expressed in technical rationality and capitalist consumerism, is particularly important in considering the economic-social implication in ecology (Ibid.: 182–184, Gilkey 2001).

In the late twentieth century, Tillich's theology of nature in general and his ecological implication in particular were dramatically explored in the German-speaking world and by English academics as well. In 1992, several articles focused on Tillich's cosmology and the chaos theory (Wettstein 1992); the subjectivity of nature (Kucera 1992); the relationship between culture and nature (Vahanian 1992); and spirit and nature (Jahr 1992). Among the studies on the ecological considerations of Tillich's theology, Pan-chiu LAI's pioneer essay,

17 Kaufman's criticism of Tillich was challenged by Michael F. Drummy; see (Drummy 2001).

"Paul Tillich and Ecological Theology", published in 1999, was insightful in demonstrating that, firstly, Tillich has a clear understanding of the participation of nature in the fall and salvation. Secondly, in responding to the contemporary problem of environmental ethics, Lai asserted that Christian theology should pay more attention to the horizontal-ethical dimension of human beings and nature instead of the vertical dimension between God and the world. Thirdly, Tillich's theology can arguably provide existential roots, instead of Lynn White, Jr's historical roots, for western environmental problems. Lastly, through dialogue with Buddhist ideas on nature, Tillich's theology is promising in engaging with inter-religious dialogue on ecological understanding (Lai 1999).

Michael Drummy's *Being and Earth*, published in 2000, was highly significant in the study of the ecological theology of Paul Tillich. Drummy emphasized that Tillich's theology has rich resources that covered the realm of inorganic beings in the whole dynamic unity of reality and, more importantly, the environmental ethics of *bio-agape* through which the eco-egalitarianism and non-anthropocentricism in Tillich's thought are disclosed (Drummy 2000: 142–144). Furthermore, Tillich's "ecology of being", emphasizing the interconnection of all created order, is a benefit for ecological thinking. Drummy rightly pointed out that, in Tillich's criticism on modern "forwardism", modern enlightenment should take responsibility for the western environmental crisis. Also, Drummy followed the line of deep ecology, asserting that Tillich's idea of "creative stewardship" is non-anthropocentric and eco-centric in the character in which the kinship of all beings is highlighted (Ibid: 129–143).

Drummy employed profound environmental language to package Tillich's ecological thinking and convincingly located Tillich's theology into the debate about environmental ethics. However, several weaknesses are found in his interpretation. Firstly, there is no detailed analysis to support the claim that Tillich's environmental thinking is a type of bio-centrism in general and a deep ecological consideration in particular. Secondly, this book argues that, ontologically speaking, in contrast with bio-centrism, Tillich's environmental anthropology and his idea of nature should be framed as *neither anthropocentricism nor eco-centrism*. As this study argues that the complex relationship between humanity and nature, framed as a multi-dimensional unity of life, should be re-examined as an idea comparable with a hierarchical-level metaphor. Also, it seems that Tillich's decisive notion, human as microcosm, is unnoticed in Drummy's work and this study shows that this negligence results in an unfair treatment of Tillich's anthropology and cosmology. Furthermore, it is quite clear that, from an axiological point of views it is hard to assert that Tillich is committed to bio-egalitarianism because Tillich said clearly that the valuation of all dimensions of life functions according to their different degrees of power.

In contrast with Drummy's thesis, this book argues that, first, even Tillich himself rejected a hierarchical metaphor; Tillich's "multi-dimensional unity of life" still maintained a certain "weak hierarchical" matrix that differentiated the ontological and axiological level of beings. That is the rationale about how to distinguish the highest and the most perfect being, Tillich claimed. This book further argues that Tillich's so-called "weak hierarchical" model is more fruitful in the discussion of environmental ethics. Second, based on Tillich's idea of the human being as a microcosm, it is hard for us to assert that Tillich's thought is completely bio-centric in nature. This book argues that the ecological vision of Tillich's idea is correctly regarded as "theanthropocosmic" which goes beyond the dichotomy between anthropocentricism and bio-centrism. Lastly, this book points out that, in Tillich's analysis of the origin of the modernity, the modern scientific-technological matrix is not originally based on the Enlightenment project, as Drummy's claimed, but ultimately is well grounded in medieval nominalist theology. Thus, the secular-rational domination apparatus manifesting in the technological machine is ontologically linked with a spiritual and religious landscape. Also, Tillich's pneumatological-eschatological doctrine is articulated as the answer for the question of the technology, which was not Drummy's concern.[18]

1.4 Pneumatology and Ecology

In the modern period, we can find several theological attempts to correlate pneumatology to the concept of nature in general and the ecological crisis in particular. These theological projects believe the ecological potential of Christian pneumatology in dialogue with natural science (Pannenberg), Jewish mystical theology (Moltmann), eco-feminist critique (Sallie McFague and Elizabeth A. Johnson), postmodern ecological thought (Mark Wallace) and Pentecostalism (A.J. Swoboda). Also, Tillich's theology is also mentioned and related to different

18 For a book review on Drummy's book, see (Walker 2003). The concept of "technonature" is essential to articulating the integration between the materiality of nature and the spirituality of technology in a contemporary context. Studies on Tillich's concept of technology in the past are insufficient to link the findings with ecological discussion. For the discussion about Tillich's attitudes towards technology, scholars' conclusions are diverse. Newman claims that Tillich is an anti-technologist (Newman 1997:154). Others claim that Tillich adopted a romanist-aesthetic perspective to response to the problem of technology; see (Hopper 1991: 107). The much more substantial analyses are found in (Thomas 1987: 177–228; Wettstein 1984: 113–134; Bulman 1978: 213–234; Cruz 1996).

degree in these theological attempts. This section provides the intellectual background to locate Tillich's ecological pneumatology in this modern and postmodern period.

1.4.1 Spirit and Field

Wolfhart Pannenberg (1928 – 2014) is widely known as the last systematic thinker in the construction of theology in our post-modern era. Pannenberg's theological thinking started to revise the Barthian and Bultmannian understandings of God's revelation as self-revelation as the word of God and human historicity, respectively. God's revelation, for Pannenberg, is always mediated and indirectly located in historical events. He reopened the discussion of Christology in *Jesus-God and Man*, published in 1964, and anthropology, *Anthropology in Theological Perspective*, published in 1983. Both projects manifest Pannenberg's interdisciplinary capacity for integrating Christian doctrines with other natural scientific findings and humanistic perspectives. It is interesting that, in struggling with the construction of different doctrines in Christian theology and in constructing his *magnum opus*, three-volume *Systematic Theology* (1988 – 1993), Pannenberg devoted his energy to the dialogue between the scientific character of theology in general and engaging in the dialogue with natural science in particular. According to Niles Henrik Gregersen (Gregersen 2008), during the 1960s, Pannenebrg had already become deeply engaged in the theology-science dialogue in Germany, in which he developed the regularity view of the laws of nature, and regarded the regularities observed in a post-hoc manner. In summary, the individual occurrences, in all their endless varieties, are prior to the causal connections that arise out of the interplay between individuals (Ibid: ix; Pannenberg 1970). Likewise, his lengthy book, *Theology and the Philosophy of Science* (1973), shows a methodological consideration in building the self-identity of Christian theology and expresses the coherence of theological thinking with the methodology of nature- and human-sciences. Apart from the above formal encounter of theology and other *wissenschaften*, Pannenberg engaged with natural scientists in discussing numerous topics that are beneficial to theology-science dialogue. This part focuses on his understanding of Christian pneumatology and the scientific idea of the field, and tries to tackle some problematic issues noted by Pannenberg in his critique of Tillich.

In his essay, "The Doctrine of the Spirit and the Task of a Theology of Nature", Pannenberg complained that the bankruptcy of Christian pneumatology in the west is largely explained by the subjectivist explanation started in the late Reformation and reinforced by the spiritualistic movement of the sixteenth

and seventeenth centuries, which originally developed from medieval mysticism (Pannenberg 1972: 127). Spirit is becoming a factor in subjective experience rather than a cosmic principle in explanations of nature. Following Cartesian dualism, spirit is regarded as the immaterial mind, which shapes the way of the identification of spirit and mind in the idealist tradition. John Locke was trying to identify the spirit in terms of a substance acting in the operations of the mind; and David Hume eliminated the idea of substance, and then he abolished the concept of spirit altogether (Ibid.). Pannenberg further analysed that, when Christian theology argues against the identification of the divine spirit and the human spirit, it results in separating both and, then, the theological talk of the divine spirit has lost its empirical and material base and becomes meaningless. Finally, for Pannenberg, modern Christian theology, to a large extent, is the peak of that subjectivism, which becomes the object of irrational decision of faith (Ibid.:127–128).

Therefore, for Pannenberg, pneumatology should correctly embrace a cosmic vision and involve the dimension of life originally developed in the Hebrew Scriptures, and extended in scope and depth through the Pauline letter to the Patristic theology. According to the Old Testament, the divine spirit is closely related to breath, wind and storm. The Spirit of God is breathed into the bones after they had taken on flesh and brings them to life again. It seems that the life given by the divine spirit is not bound into the life of faith as Paul and John in the New Testaments mentioned, but also refers to the origin of all life. According to Pannenberg, the notion of the life-giving spirit is dominant in biblical traditions (Ibid.:123–125). Further, in the Greek Patristic theology of the Holy Spirit, it is of fundamental importance to emphasize the participation of spirit in the act of creation as the solid ground for the significance of the spirit's soteriological presence in the church and in Christian experience (Ibid.:126).

Furthermore, the field-force concept in physics is a dominant metaphor in the theology-sciences dialogue in which Pannenberg was actively engaged. The scientist Michael Faraday and his successors such as Albert Einstein, were particularly interested in it. This field concept "reverses the previous view that forces are solely the immediate result of bodies in motion, that action-at-a-distance is precluded". Faraday asserted that the "force field is an independent reality prior to the body. Body and mass become secondary phenomena, concentrations of dynamic force at particular places and points in the field" (Peters: 1993).

God is Spirit, according to John 4:24. In his essay, "A Dialogue: God as Spirit – and Natural Science", Pannenberg regarded this notion as a creative field operative over and between creatures, which contrasted with the Platonic understanding of thought or mind (*nus*, in Greek). It is remarkable that Pannenberg's

understanding can be traced to Stoic monistic philosophy instead of Greek dualistic opposition between spirit and matter. Both the biblical *pneuma* and the Stoic *pneuma* denotes air in movement, full of force. The difference is that the latter is a cosmic principle, pervading the cosmos and keeping all its parts together by its tension; the former represents the transcending of the world of the spirit and works through it creatively (Pannenberg 2001: 65). Pannenberg argued that spirit as the field-force designates the operative presence of the spirit in the world of matter. It does not mean that the spirit is the field, but that the spirit works in and beyond the force of nature without being exhaustively expressed by it (Pannenberg 2000: 37). Also, the applicability of this metaphor is related to space and time. "The interpretation of the pneumatic essence of God's divinity as a field can be applied to the undivided unity of space and time that preceded all geometric description" (Ibid.). Pannenberg's innovation is fruitful in the theology-science dialogue in that, on one hand, the spirit is regarded as a dynamic force field within the Trinitarian divine life in which the Holy Spirit is the love that generates the Son, and binds with the Father in love, creates the cosmos, precipitates redemption, and unifies all. On the other hand, the spirit as field-force, is the creative and unifying power effective in matter and the cosmos. This theological language establishes a consonance with the scientific discovery of perceiving the world (Pannenberg 2000: 28).[19]

In 1972, Pannenberg's essay, "The Doctrine of the Spirit and the Task of a Theology of Nature", clearly mentioned that, in contrasting with the subjectivistic understanding of the Holy Spirit, two modern attempts are worth mentioning. One is Pierre Teihard de Chardin's holistic interpretation of life (Pannenberg 1971). Another is Paul Tillich's idea of life and spirit (Pannenberg 1972: 128). Pannenberg highly appreciated Tillich's notion of the spirit as one of the dimensions of life, and which is potentially present in all dimensions. Pannenberg emphasized that the most important point in Tillich's idea of self-transcendence of life is the correlation between the human spirit and the divine spirit. However, Pannenberg asserted, in comparison with Teilhard's unifying concept of the spirit, the contrast between the divine spirit and the human spirit in Tillich's theology still exists. It seems that, Pannenberg pointed out, "the ecstatic element is attributed specifically to the 'spiritual presence' of God in faith, hope and love". However, Pannenberg asked, why is this understanding "not universal to all spiritual experience as exemplifying the self-transcendence of life?" (Pannenberg 1972: 129). Tillich's theology disappointed Pannenberg in that the self-

19 Pannenberg himself pointed out the similarity between his idea and Pierre Teilhard de Chardin's theological-scientific notion of "radial energy" (Pannenberg 1971).

transcendence of life is merely limited to the human spirit functioning in morality, culture and religion, but not universally applied to the whole universe. Pannenberg complained: "Tillich accepted a separation of his idea of spiritual presence from the continuously self-transcending process of life, because he conceived of self-transcendence only in terms of an activity of the organism" (Pannenberg 1972: 135). However, this criticism is not fair to Tillich because, on one hand, Tillich did mention that the model of spiritual presence is directly related to the human spirit and *indirectly correlated with other dimensions of different life forms*. On the other hand, under the sacramental thinking of nature, Tillich did emphasize the ecstatic condition of the whole universe under the spiritual presence. "Ecstasy as a state of mind is the *exact correlate* to self-transcendence as the state of reality" (Tillich 1957: 8. Emphasis mine).[20] This means, for Tillich, that it is theologically correct to express that the whole reality is experienced within the mystery of divine revelation and presence, and that the structure of the whole reality is the divine expression of the divine.

Actually, it seems that the similarity between Pannenberg and Tillich is more than Pannenberg expected. First, Pannenberg and Tillich both complained about the subjectivist and transcendental understanding of the spirit. The misconception of the former, for Pannenberg, was a lack of the material content for conceiving the universal sphere of the spirit. Likewise, for Tillich, it would be impossible to conceive the idea of the divine spirit, if the immanent-material content of the symbol of the spirit is lacking. Second, Pannenberg mentioned that we should adopt a broad concept of life, and that all living beings do not merely live in the environment. They are open systems in which the awareness of, and dynamic interaction with, the external world exist. Life is always self-transcending (Pannenberg 1982:157). This is exactly what Tillich's articulation of the concept, *gestalt*, means. For Tillich, all organisms are *gestalt* wholes in which the parts and the whole are correlated, and they are closely living and acting in the surrounding realms. Tillich even extended this idea to the inorganic realm. In Pannenberg's appropriation with Teilhard, Pannenberg agreed that if "Teilhard had conceived of energy in terms of a field, this would have been in perfect concordance with his idea of a transcendent spirit whose creative power dominates the entire process of evolution" (Pannenberg 1972: 131). Although Tillich never understood the spirit as field, he found no difficulty in regarding the spirit as the unity of power and meaning despite having strong reservations about Teilhard's overly-optimistic eschatological-teleological evolutionary understanding of the cosmos. For Tillich, the eschatological orientation of the Spiritual Presence

20 I fully discuss Tillich's idea of ecstatic naturalism in 3.3.2.

manifests the *telos* of the creature, which is always ambiguous; it is the reason Tillich preferred the actualization of life instead of the "process" image uncovered in Teilhard's process thought.

1.4.2 The Creator Spirit

Jürgen Moltmann (1926-) was invited to give his Gifford lectures in 1984 – 85, and further revised them in a book-form, entitled *God in Creation*, published in 1985. In one sense, this book is one of the contributions in Moltmann's "systematic contributions to Messianic Theology" following his first volume, *The Trinity and the Kingdom of God* (1980), in which the doctrine of Trinity and its political implication was worked out. Second, in facing the challenge of the ecological crisis, Moltmann reinterpreted the doctrine of God and the doctrine of creation as the Christian answer for environmental misery. As Moltmann asserted, in *God in Creation*, his focus is God the Holy Spirit who is the lover of life (Moltmann 1985: xii). The main thesis argued for the ecological model of the divine with special reference to the doctrine of the Holy Spirit who created the world and also dwells within the world. As Moltmann said, "the inner secret of creation is this indwelling of God, just as the inner secret of the Sabbath of creation is God's rest" (Ibid.). Therefore, God's indwelling, *Shekinah*, is the divine secret of the doctrine of creation in which the whole creation becomes the house of God.

For Moltmann, the divine act of creation must be interpreted in a Trinitarian sense instead of a monotheistic and deistic way. God the Father created the world through the Son in the Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit is understood as the Creator through which all divine activity is pneumatic in its efficacy. "Everything that is, exists and lives in the unceasing inflow of the energies and potentialities of the Spirit; the Creator is himself present in his creation" (Moltmann 1985: 9). In the Nicene Creed, the third article expresses the Holy Spirit as "the giver of life". Moltmann emphasized that the very existence of all creation is grounded in the being and the power of the Holy Spirit and in the creative sustaining work of the Holy Spirit. For the ecological implication, Moltmann considered that the paradigm shift of conceiving the doctrine of God and creation is needed. The monarchical and subjectivist understanding of God, on one hand, and the mechanistic domination of the world, on the other, is no longer desirable. In contrast, the interpenetration between God and the world is manifested through emphasizing that the presence of God in the world and the presence of the world in God. For Moltmann, the emphasis on the immanence of God in the world is

neither at the expense of the transcendence of God nor the re-enchantment of the world.

God creates the world and, at the same time, enters into it. He calls it into the existence, and, at the same time, manifests himself through its being. It lives from his creative power, and yet he lives in it. So if God as Creator stands over his creation, he also stands over Himself. If the creation stands over its Creator, God again stands over Himself. The God who is transcendent in relation to the world, and the God who is immanent in that world is one and the same God. So in God's creation of the world we can perceive a self-differentiation and a self-identification on God's part. God is in himself, and yet he is at the same time outside himself. He is outside himself in his creation, and is yet at the same time with himself, in his Sabbath (Moltmann 1985: 15).

For Moltmann, the divine creative work of the Holy Spirit is multi-dimensional. God gives new life to the believers in the power of the Holy Spirit, and she breaks the boundary of different groups, communities and races in order to from a solid and universal community. The most important aspect of ecological pneumatology is that the cosmic spirit operates and correlates within the dynamic structure of nature: "the Spirit is the principle of evolution" (Moltmann 1985: 100); "the Spirit is the common spirit of creation" (Ibid.); "the Spirit is the principle of the individuation" (Ibid.); and, finally, "all creations in the Spirit are in intention open" (Ibid.). For the co-suffering of the wounded world in the ecological crisis, Moltmann asserted that Christian theology is permitted to talk about a kenosis Spirit and the suffering Spirit in emphasizing the dynamic and wounded presence of the Holy Spirit in healing life and participating in the wounds and suffering of the world. As Moltmann said, "the idea of the Shekinah points towards the kenosis of the Spirit. In his *Shekinah*, God renounces his impassibility and becomes able to suffer because he is willing to love" (Moltmann 1992: 51). Therefore, love and suffering are closely connected in the presence and indwelling of the Holy Spirit in the world.

Pneumatology in Moltmann's theology is both transcendence and immanence, personal and impersonal, individualist and communitarian, and micro-level and macro-level. Creation and redemption are not separated as two distinctive acts of the Holy Spirit. Moltmann emphasized that the redemptive Spirit is understood as closely linked with the redemptive work of Christ, but the life-renewing Spirit concerning the cosmic redemption of the creation must be related to the creative act of the Father eschatologically. Apart from the universal cosmic breadth of the Holy Spirit, Moltmann, in conservation with Liberation theology, pointed out that the Spirit must be the liberating Spirit (Moltmann 1992: 114). Liberating love constitutes the communicative sociality among human beings and the whole universe (Moltmann 1992: 120 – 121).

When Moltmann discussed the doctrine of creation, he mentioned two traditional and rival approaches; one is the doctrine of decrees with the assumption that God creates the world by his will; the other is the doctrine of emanation with the gnostic and Neoplatonic assumption that the world is the overflow of the divine essence (Moltmann 1985:83). Moltmann pointed out his own way of combining both rival traditions as "the unity of will and nature in God can be appropriately grasped through the concept of love" (Moltmann 1985:85). The whole theological reconstruction of the doctrine of creation relies on the doctrine of *zimsum* (self-limitation). Moltmann drew on the kabbalistic doctrine of *zimsum* that God's creating act is originally a withdrawing act in which the self-restricting love of God is determined at the very beginning in God Himself when God elects Himself as a creating God and a self-limiting God.

Moltmann had criticized Tillich's doctrine of creation in terms of the doctrine of emanation (Moltmann 1985: 83). For Moltmann, Tillich's understanding of creation is the identification of God's divine life and God's creativity. Therefore, the creative act is not external to God's being but is his creative nature. For Tillich, the divine act is identical with the divine being. Therefore, creation is always in a timeless situation. Symbolically speaking, God has created the world, creates the world and will fulfill the world. However, for God, they are not regarded as three different and distinct modes of temporality but only one. That means, for Tillich, God's nature is essentially creative, and his creation is essentially eternal as well. For Moltmann, there are two questions: one, how can Tillich conceive of God's "rest"? Two, how can Tillich distinguish between the Creator and the creature if God is conceived as divine creating? (Moltmann 1985:84).

For the first question, Moltmann seemed to assume a dichotomy between creative activity and creative rest. The notion of "rest" does not mean a dead end but, in Moltmann's own understanding, pointed to the celebrating and rejoining in the Sabbath. More importantly, the Sabbath denotes that the goal of the creation is fulfilled. If the fulfillment of the creation is the ultimate meaning of the "rest" in Moltmann's theological concern, it is not difficult for Tillich to agree with the doctrine of "God will be all in all" in the Eternal life in which the *telos* of all beings finds its fulfillment, even if Tillich did not employ the concept of "rest". For the second question, Moltmann is correct in pointing out that, in Tillich's theological understanding, the existential concern is dominant in a sense that the temporality of the present has the ontological priority over the past and the future. However, as Moltmann complained, it is difficult if not impossible to pick up the language to distinguish between the creator and the creature in Tillich's doctrine of the creation. However, this does not imply that Tillich's entire theological system is committed to the charge of pantheism. Actually, Tillich did remind his readers that what Spinoza highlighted as *deus*

sive natura, God is identical with the creative nature instead of the assemblies of natural beings (Tillich 1957: 6). Also, in his system, Tillich never identified the being of God with the totality of all beings. Therefore, Tillich is very clear in distancing himself from any forms of pantheism. Furthermore, Moltmann is indeed following the line of Tillich in asserting both the transcendence and the immanence of God and the world, despite Tillich being not willing to employ this polarity of "transcendence-immanence" in his system due to the charge of the spatial imagery of these two concepts. Tillich's idea of God as being-itself and the power of being should be correctly interpreted as the embodiment and empowerment of God in the world. God and the world are always under the matrix of "difference but not separation".

1.4.3 Feminine Spirit

The movement of eco-feminist theology, which became prominent in the 1970s, shares the basic conviction of eco-feminism in that the domination of women and the natural world is interlaced in a complex synthesis of hierarchical dualisms embedded in patriarchal worldviews and social structures.[21] Therefore, the liberation of women and nature is also closely linked and grounded in the breakdown of those oppressive ideologies and power structures. The main target of eco-feminist theology is to unveil the determining roots of misogyny and the domination of the earth in Christianity, and to rediscover and reinterpret the ecological potential recourses within the Christian traditions through diverse methodological innovations, such as, dialogue with earth sciences, creative dialogue with other religious and spiritual traditions, and cooperation with social-political analysis.[22]

The hierarchical dualism deeply rooted in Euro-western cultures constitutes the opposites or polarities of their conceptual entities, and also artificially establishes a situation of imbalance among those pairs. This dualistic framework con-

21 For a basic and useful analysis of eco-feminist theology, see (Eaton 2005).

22 According to Heather Eaton, there are seven common awarenesses in the methodological concerns in ecofeminist thinkers: an in-depth awareness of the logic of domination, a recognition of the multi-and inter-disciplinary character, critical appraisals of the destructive and liberating elements within religious traditions, an appreciation of the exchange between science and religion, a rigorous understanding of the extent of the ecological crisis, openness to the insight of the myriad religious traditions, and commitment to politically relevant and engaged work in tandem with an awareness of the strained material realities of the women of the South. See (Eaton 2001: 76).

tributes to patriarchal social structures, which assumes male supremacy (androcentrism). An asymmetry between men and women that is symbolically, socially, sexually and materially codified with male dominance is the recurrent pattern of development. To read Christian history and writings through an eco-feminist lens reveals that Christianity should be responsible for the source (or at least one of the sources) of the domination of women and of the natural world. In the following, I explain the ideas of "feminine spirit" through the exploration of two eco-feminist theologians, Sallie McFague and Elizabeth A. Johnson, to illustrate why Christian traditions can result in the bankruptcy of ecological thinking and practices, and to what extent Christian doctrines, especially the doctrine of the Holy Spirit, are potentially reformulated in tackling ecological challenges under their two distinctive approaches.

As a feminist theologian, Sallie McFague tried to examine and criticize the androcentric, hierarchical and dualistic models of God in western Christian traditions. Based on the interlocking character of oppression of women and nature, McFague pointed out that ecological and feminist concerns of Christian theology are closely linked together. McFague's distinctive contribution in eco-feminist theological construction is to reinterpret the model of "body" in which all life forms in the planet and the model of God are profoundly grounded. The concept of the body covers the range from materiality to spirituality, from non-living to living, from the most intimate to the most universal (McFague 1993:17–18). In order to recapture the advanced ecological model of God and the world, McFague conceived the world as the body of God in which the transcendence and immanence of God of the world can be in a complementary condition.

In her *The Body of God* (1993), McFague examined several models of God and the world. The deistic model banishes God from the world and "encourages an irresponsible, idolatrous attitude in the scientific community, allowing it to claim for itself sole rights both to interpret and to dispose of the world" (Ibid.: 138). The dialogue model creates an interrelationship between human beings and God at the expense of indifference to the natural and social worlds. The monarchical model corrects the weakness of the above two paradigms: impersonalism in deism and individualism in the dialogical model. However, the image of kingship and lordship of the monarchical model is still indifferent to the natural world (Ibid.:139). The agential model has the advantage of internalizing divine action within cosmic processes. "God is related to the world and realizing the divine intentions and purposes in the world, in a way similar to how we use our bodies to carry out our purpose" (Ibid.). The last one, the organic model, is more adequate in suggesting the world as God's body. For McFague, this organic model insists on the agency or subjectivity of all entities and provides a basis for the intrinsic value of every created being. The dynamic view of God and the evo-

lutionary life-process is independent and interdependent at the same time. What McFague tried to investigate is how to articulate an adequate ecological model for Christian theology in which the transcendence and immanence of God and the world are in balance. "If the model were that God is related to the world as spirit is to body, perhaps the values of both the agential and organic models could be preserved" (Ibid.:141).

For McFague, "spirit is a wide-ranging, multi-dimensional term with many meanings built upon its physical base as the breath of life" (Ibid.: 143). In contrast with the dualistic and hierarchical system of spirit over matter/ body, "spirit" denotes the breath of life of all life forms and their concrete embodiment. First, the pneumatological matrix provides a strong criticism about anthropocentricism and promotes cosmocentricism (Ibid.: 144). "God is not primarily the orderer and controller of the universe but its sources and empowerment, the breath that enlivens and energizes it" (Ibid.). Secondly, the correlation of spirit that gives life to every creature with the Holy Spirit that renews all creation suggests a close connection between Christian theology, and biological and biocultural evolution (Ibid.: 147). The presence of the Holy Spirit is not to direct and control the process of human evolution, but rather to empower and enrich the process through the participation in human activities. This pneumatological panentheist model tries to join the agential and organic models in order to express the asymmetrical and profoundly interrelational character of God and the world.

Furthermore, in order to replace the hierarchical and dualistic models, McFague suggested that we should revise our model: God as mother, lover and friend. In contrast with the fashionable employment in locating a non-personal metaphor of God in ecological thinking, McFague insisted, "the current understanding of personal agency allows personal metaphors to reflect a view of God's activity in the world as radically relational, immanent, interdependent, and noninterventionist" (McFague 1987: 83). Employing a personal metaphor does not imply speaking of an individual being that is related externally to the world, rather to image God as the personal presence in the universe who epitomizes personhood who has intrinsic relations with all beings (Ibid.). In discussing God as mother, McFague was insightful in mentioning that Tillich's idea of God as the ground of being is profoundly feminine in character and also highly related to the life-giving metaphor of the Holy Spirit. For Tillich, McFague insisted, "the symbolic dimension of the 'ground of being' points to the mother-quality of giving birth, carrying, and embracing, and, at the same time, of calling back, resisting independence of the created, and swallowing it" (Ibid.: 101). Also, Tillich emphasized that God, as maternal love, is a kind of moving power of life; all elements of need, desire, and mutuality are evident in all forms of life (Ibid.: 102). With inspiration from Tillich, McFague argued that

the love dimension expressed in God as mother is essential as a basis for an interpretation of Christian faith as a destabilizing, inclusive, nonhierarchical fulfillment for all. "The depth of divine love can be characterized as agape, for the distinctive features of this love is its impartiality, its willing of existence and fulfillment for all beings" (Ibid.: 103).[23]

Elizabeth A. Johnson, in her *Women, Earth and Creator Spirit* (1993), proposed the thesis that the exploitation of the earth, which has reached crisis proportions in our day, is intimately linked to the marginalization of women, and that both of these predicaments are intrinsically related to forgetting the Creator Spirit who pervades the world in the dance of life. Johnson is on the same wavelength as Sallie McFague in condemning the hierarchical dualism which "delivers a two-tiered vision of reality that privileges the elite half of a pair and subordinates the other, which is thought to have little or no intrinsic value of its own but exits only to be of use to the higher" (Johnson 1993:11). Within a sexist system the true identity of both women and the earth are skewed. Both are commonly excluded from the sphere of the sacred; both are routinely taken for granted and ignored, used and discarded, even battered and "raped"; but, nevertheless they do not cease to give birth and sustain life. Both women and the earth, furthermore, have a symbolic and literal affinity with the Creator Spirit, giver of life, who is similarly ignored in western religious consciousness as a result of restricting the sacred to a transcendent, monarchical deity outside of nature (Johnson 1993: 2–3). The typical example of this dualistic framework is constructed by Greek philosophy in which spirit and matter are regarded as two separated levels of existence. "Spirit is a transcendent principle that brings into play activity, autonomy, reason, the mind, the intellectual, the soul, the permanent, the infinite. Matter ... is the principle signifying immanence which shows itself in passivity, dependence, emotions, the body, the physical, nature, the transitory, the finite" (Ibid.:11).

However, for Johnson, following the Nicene Creed, the Holy Spirit is the "Giver of Life" which should be emphasized at the cosmological level with a kinship model. For Johnson, all living creatures are "a manifestation of the Spirit's creative energy" (Ibid.: 31). The most significant is that Spirit is the creative origin of all life in which the Spirit is the unceasing, dynamic flow of divine power that sustains the universe bringing forth life. Therefore, there is no sacred/ secular split in reality. Like Moltmann, Johnson emphasized that the community of cre-

23 In fact, Tillich never emphasized the female character of the Holy Spirit. It is because, when faced with the problem of male-determined symbolism in Christianity, Tillich was not trying to search for a counter-balance feminine symbol but rather to articulate the symbol which can transcend the alternative of male and female symbolism; see (Tillich 1963: 294).

ation is also the fellowship of the Holy Spirit; this means that "the religious kinship attitude cherishes and seeks intelligently to preserve biodiversity, for when a species goes extinct we have lost a manifestation of the goodness of God" (Ibid.: 39).

In contrast to certain forms of panentheism which deny divine sovereignty over creation, Johnson proposed a Trinitarian framework for panentheism where it is particularly the Holy Spirit who is regarded as immanent in the natural world. First, the concept of panentheism indicates the continuous creative origin of life, the Creator Spirit, which is immanent in the historical world (Ibid.: 42). "The Spirit's encircling indwelling weaves a genuine solidarity among all creatures and between God and the world" (Ibid.: 43). Second, the life-giving Spirit also cherishes what has been made and renews it in myriad ways. Third, the Spirit moves in the continuous changing of historical life in which Spirit empowers, lures, dances on ahead (Ibid.:44). In supporting her thesis of Trinitarian panentheism; Johnson suggested several "cosmic symbols" which illustrate the intimate connection between the Holy Spirit and nature; Spirit as the wind blowing through the valley of dry bones bringing life in Ezek. 47.1–14; Spirit as fire descending upon the people like tongues of fire in Acts 2.1–3; Spirit as water pouring out and pictured as "the bottomless wellspring of the source of life" (Ibid.: 49).

> A theology of Creator Spirit overcomes the dualism of spirit and matter with all of its ramifications, and leads to the realization of the sacredness of the earth ... Instead of matter being divorced from spirit and consigned to a realm separate from the holy, it is an intrinsic part of the cosmic community, vivified, indwelt, and renewed by the Creator Spirit (Ibid.: 59–60).

This does not mean that Spirit is identified with natural matter. What Johnson emphasized is that the Spirit may work through created matter and challenge the dualistic separation between the Creator and creature but maintains the duality of both. A theology of the Creator Spirit overcomes the dualism of spirit and matter, and leads to the realization of the sacredness of the earth. The Spirit of God draws in its place a circle of mutuality and inclusiveness (Ibid.:60). The Spirit creates matter. Matter bears the mark of the sacred and has itself a spiritual radiance (Ibid.).

According to the wisdom literatures in the Hebrew Scriptures, the Spirit's functions are depicted as acts of womanly wisdom. This female figure of Spirit is the most acutely developed personification of God's presence and activity in the Hebrew Scriptures (Ibid.:52). Also, all life is a gift and woman wisdom, a personification of the Creator Spirit, gives that gift. She is responsible for the existence of all beings. This female symbolism, Spirit-Sophia, performs as a renewing

energy which profoundly affects human beings in their relationship with divine mystery and the rest of the world, weaving them round with a web of kinship (Ibid.:54).

1.4.4 The Wounded Spirit

Pneumatology, for Mark Wallace, is a term mixed with numerous western philosophical and theological strands. Negatively speaking, its meaning and significance are endangered by the distortion of western metaphysical transformation; however, it can be a symbol to refigure the language needed to empower our ethical capability to deal with the current issues. Mark Wallace's *Fragments of the Spirit* demonstrates a "rhetorical" performance which can appropriate pneumatology in the post-modern era. Wallace termed his project "ecological pneumatology" in which belief is in the Spirit, not as a metaphysical entity, but as a healing life-force that enables humans to flourish as well as engendering the welfare of the planet (Wallace 1996: 2). The Spirit is fully identified as nature-based in the environment and all life forms, human and non-humans. For Wallace, the Spirit is understood not as intellect, will or consciousness, but as healing and subversive life forms. Based on different biblical imageries, the modality of the Spirit is like water, light, dove, mother, fire, breath and wind. However, Wallace noted that there is no uniform standard for understanding the activity of the Holy Spirit which is portrayed as healing and life- giving, on one hand, and as capricious and judgmental, on the other (Wallace 1996:3).

For Wallace, the metaphysical load of the Spirit in the west is the bankruptcy of "green" pneumatology whether it is the Being-itself or the being of beings. The freedom and indeterminacy of the Spirit are endangered. Therefore, God as Spirit is regarded as both wholly other to creation and wholly enfleshed within creation as the green love who nurtures and sustains all living beings (Wallace 2000: 54). The main ecological implication of Wallace's "ecological pneumatology" is to "figur[e] the Spirit, in the economies of confronting violence and healing the earth, as a living embodied being who works for healthy communities within our shared planet home" (Wallace 1996: 4). His main thesis is the hope "for a renewed earth which [is] founded on the belief in the Spirit as the divine force within the cosmos who continually works to sustain all forms of life" (Wallace 2000: 52). "Nature itself in all its variety and diversity will be construed as the primary mode of being for the Spirit's work in the world" (Wallace 1996: 4).

What Wallace demonstrated is a kind of radical pneumatological ecology through which the entities in nature do not function as *symbol* representing the Spirit, but as the *being* of the Spirit Herself. Therefore, nature is the external

and visible dimension of the Spirit; the Spirit is the internal, abyss and invisible dimension of nature. This radical position pushed Wallace to condemn harshly the abuse of nature as "natural resources" adopting the position of bio-egalitarianism which asserts the intrinsic value of all life forms. Due to his immanence approach, Wallace pointed out: "If Spirit and earth mutually indwell each other, then God as Spirit is vulnerable to loss and destruction insofar as the earth is abused and despoiled" (Ibid.: 138).

Therefore, Spirit and the earth have a reciprocal indwelling of each other and they are inseparable and indistinguishable. "Spirit and earth are internally indivisible because modes of being are living realities with the common goal of sustaining other life-forms" (Wallace 2000: 59 – 60). It is natural that God as Spirit is vulnerable to serious loss and trauma insofar as the earth is abused and despoiled. Following Moltmann's theology of the cross as the death of God bringing the death and loss into Godhead, ecological pneumatology emphasizes that death enters the inner life of God through the cross of Jesus even as the prospect of ecological mass death enters the life of God through the Spirit's communion with a despoiled planet (Ibid.: 61). The "cruciform Spirit", like the cross of Jesus Christ, takes the burden of human sin and ecological damage into Herself. And, through the Spirit's benevolent cohabitation with all suffering and forgotten members of the universe, God empties Herself in the creation and all beings may enjoy fullness of life.

Against the notion of human stewardship and preferable to biocentrism, Wallace tended to adopt pantheism in rejecting Moltmann's panentheism and soft anthropocentrism. He called his own standpoint "revisionary paganism" by which he meant a revisioning of all of creation as a virtual sacred grove (Wallace 1996: 144). The boundary between human being and non-human being is blurred under the unity and bounding love empowered by the Holy Spirit. Under the earth-love of the Holy Spirit, human beings relate to all bio-life forms as a kinship relationship through which earth-love and earth-care are demanded instead of being "creative predators" over and against other living beings.

1.4.5 Pentecostal Ecological Theology

In the past ten years or so, Pentecostalism has aroused global attention, not only through the rapid growth of church members in general, but also by providing some distinctive theological approaches for different issues in particular. In the past, Pentecostal theologians have contributed many studies on the theology of religions, global theology, religious dialogue and political and ethical issues

through their Pentecostal pneumatology. Relatively speaking, ecological and environmental issues are still underdeveloped. Amos Young and A.J. Swoboda are the exceptions.

In his monograph, *Tongues and Trees*, Swoboda expressed modern Pentecostalism as capable of living into its own Pentecostal-charismatic spirituality and sensibilities on the one hand, and also speaking intelligibly into the wider theological arena on the other. For him, the Pentecostal-charismatic tradition locates pneumatology in an ecumenical community, and offers a fresh understanding and approach for imagining and sustaining the Spirit-baptized creation, the charismatic creational community, the holistic ecological Spirit and the eschatological Spirit of ecological mission.

First, based on the pneumatological motifs in the Hebrew Scriptures which emphasize creational and charismatic Spirit; in the New Testament which focuses on the dynamic relationship with the Christ; and Pauline ideas on the suffering creation in Romans 8:22–28, Swoboda pointed out that the most impressive text in developing biblical eco-pneumatology is Eph. 4:7–11 (Swoboda 2013:198). This text "will not only bridge a gap between the Hebrew Scriptures and the New Testament's Spirit narratives regarding creation, but offers Pentecostal theology a way to discuss creation pneumatologically" (Ibid.). In his fresh interpretation, the "descent" of the Christ is a Pentecostal Spirit baptism of the church and the whole universe. Although this interpretation is not without problem, for Swoboda, it remains a good connection between the Pentecost event, pneumatology and a creational theology. The Pauline text in Eph. 4:7–11 is a discussion of Christ's ascent and descent to and from heaven; it seems to be a dialogue with a rabbinical interpretation with Psalm 68, a traditional psalm of Pentecost. No matter whether this pneumatological hermeneutics is "correct," Swoboda emphasized that this text speaks not only to the indwelling of the Spirit in the earth, but also that she empowers humans to care for, protect, and defend the earth (Ibid.: 200).

Second, following the above-interconnected creation with the presence of the Spirit, eco-pneumatology also emphasizes the relational dimension of the creation in which the charismatic community is established. God's Spirit is the Spirit of the community in which the Spirit constitutes ethical renewal, the establishment of identity and the breaking down of walls (Ibid.: 206). Swoboda rightly pointed out that, in the close relationship between ecclesiology and ecology, both are linked with the Greek idea of *oikos*, household. Therefore, the charismatic community created by the Spirit can be extended "as a bridge to envisioning ecological stewardship with the Spirit who is embodied in creation" (Ibid.: 208). In line with eco-feminist theology, Pentecostal pneumatology asserts the

egalitarian roles within the Spirit-filled communities with diversity in nature and all the living environmental elements are the charismatic gifts of the Spirit.

Third, the Spirit is holistic in a sense that all living beings are dependent on the Spirit who is the breath of life. The whole universe is Spirit-grounded. The biblical Spirit is always a fleshy spirit who permeates into the innermost being of all living in the flesh. Therefore, there is no dualistic conceptuality of Spirit and matter, what the Spirit has been in a multi-dimensional way in which the sociological, physical, psychological, political and bodily elements are based (Ibid.: 220).

Last, Swoboda described the eschatological aspect of eco-pneumatology through which the kingdom of God with social justice and peace is anticipated (Ibid.: 229). Earth care is not in a vacuum but always in a concrete and historical situation. If nature is political in nature, then the Spirit indwelling must be a politics of the Spirit. The peaceful kingdom of God must be in terms of God's justice; therefore, the charismatic understanding of the Spirit is by no means to bring us to escaping the Spirit-filled universe, but she empowers us with the hope to resist the unjust and violence.

1.5. Reopening an Ecological Pneumatology

In Andrew Gabriel's article, "Pneumatological Perspectives for a Theology of Nature: The Holy Spirit in Relation to Ecology and Technology", he concluded that a pneumatological perspective of a theology of nature provides the kinship model as the Creator Spirit who is the Life-Giver to all of creation. Also, eco-pneumatological theology emphasizes the intimate relationship that God has with creation through the Spirit who dwells within it, though remaining distinct from it. Finally, the Spirit is drawing nature beyond what it is now and is empowering wounded nature (Gabriel 2007: 212). Furthermore, in the above numerous ways that theology can flourish in "greening of the Spirit", the modern and post-modern construction of eco-theology mainly focuses on three aspects: divinization of nature and an emphasis on the continuity between human beings and nature; a focus on the immanent side of the divine within nature; and pneumatology, regarded as the flourishing and healing of creation, emphasizing the eschatological-political Sabbath-rest in condemning the human exploration of nature in different ways (Kärkkäinen 2014: 85 – 94). It is natural for Christian eco-theology to develop the pneumatological potentiality in addressing the different themes within environmental problems. The third article of the ancient creed in expressing the Holy Spirit as the life-giver and life-sustainer would be a potential reformulation as the creating-healing power of the divine indwelling in the world. In

contrast with the dualistic framework of spirit and matter, coupled with the hierarchical construction of reality, the "greening" of the Holy Spirit profoundly empowers the holistic and dynamic participation between God, human beings and nature.

However, how and in what way can eco-pneumatology contribute to the environmental discussion on the demarcation between eco-centrism and anthropocentricism maintaining the distinctive role of the human being but also emphasizing the ontological continuity between nature and human beings? In emphasizing the unity of human beings and nature within the created community, in what sense can pneumatology existentially face the reality of the separation, and even alienation, between all beings in the created world? In the modern period onwards, the scientific-technological apparatus has been adapted to extend its dominating power over the world. How can we be responsible for conceiving this apparatus, expressed in the metaphor of the created image of God in flourishing the created garden? Also, in emphasizing a responsible attitude towards nature presented in the stewardship model, is there any other anthropological model for us to reconceive the ecological self who is fully inhabited within the earth and to re-articulate the whole universe with differentiating several modalities of different beings? In the following chapters, the above questions are addressed within the framework of Tillich's ecological pneumatology.

Chapter two, entitled Pneumatological Theology, starts to lay out Tillich's pneumatological foundation and the methodology of his theology. I argue that the famous concepts of Tillich's theology, such as, theological circle, theological existence and the method of correlation discussed in volumes one and two of Tillich's Systematic Theology under the polarity of "universality-particularity", has undergone a shift from being Christological to being pneumatologically based. This shift is profound, reaching its fulfillment in his Trinitarian framework which started in his earliest attempt in theological construction and is subtly, implicitly "hidden" in Tillich's last seminar on the question of theology of the history of religions. This chapter assumes that a pneumatological approach is Tillich's last theological attempt to reconstruct his whole theological project, and that the most decisive operation would be located in the interplay between the divine particularity of Christology and the divine universality of pneumatology, in which Tillich's last attempt in considering the possibility of theology of religions are based.

After establishing the epistemological foundation of pneumatology within Tillich's system, chapter three analyses the treatment of Tillich's pneumatology which I call "Spirit and the World". This chapter first articulates the intellectual heritage of his pneumatology to Spirit-movement and theologies of experience which are mainly located in the ontological approach of God in the medieval pe-

riod, the radical reformers' doctrine of the Holy Spirit, and Schleiermacher's approach of religious "feeling" and pneumatology. Second, in constructing a multifaceted dimensional connection between Spirit and nature, this study singles out the distinctiveness of F.W.J. Schelling's contribution in modelling Tillich's idea of the Spirit as such, and of the Spirit and nature in particular. The ontological demonstration of the Spirit in Tillich's philosophical-theological project manifests as the unifying principle of separation and union in life actualization and the ultimate fulfillment of the meaning and power of being, which are inspired by Schelling's idealist framework. Last, the symbolic-mediating apparatus of universal sacramentality, functioning in the finite forms from the pneumatological perspective, are articulated. Tillich's self-transcending realism and ecstatic naturalism formulate the fundamental idea of a theology of nature which is also grounded in Christology and pneumatology. The purpose of chapter three is in describing the trans- and multi-dimensionality of different life-forms which would be formally (through the ontological analysis) and materially (through the axiological demonstration) constituted in order to set up a Tillichian cosmology and humanity in order to package different spheres from materiality to spirituality into a coherence and unifying whole. The main thesis of this chapter three, which also lays out the ontological foundation of the whole book, is to demonstrate Tillich's unique understanding of inter-and intra-dimensionality of the Unconditioned and the conditioned on one hand, and disclosure of the ontological basic structure and elements shared with human beings and the cosmos in both universal and particular ways in order to prepare for the discussion in chapter four.

In chapter four, the main focus shifts to the relationship between human persons and nature, and Tillich's anthropology and cosmology are directly engaged in the discussion of environmental ethics. The meaning of the human being as "microcosm" is explored in the development for the thesis of Tillich's "cosmic anthropology" which overcomes the dichotomy between anthropocentricism and eco-centrism. Through the analysis of Tillich's anthropology, the distinctiveness and uniqueness of human persons is demonstrated in the context of the reciprocity of human beings and nature under the multi-dimensional unity of life. I argue that, under the distinct role of the human being and the different degrees of power shared by different levels of beings in actualizing their potentiality, Tillich's idea of "dimension" should be re-examined and integrated with the "hierarchical" metaphor in order to demonstrate the idea of "theanthropocosmic" in which the unified whole of nature and the distinctiveness of human persons are maintained.

Chapter five articulates the modern reduction of the above poly-dimensional functionality of life into the thingification of nature and humanity through the

scientific-technological matrix which can be traced back to a medieval theological origin in which western modernity is grounded. Apart from the analysis of the theological origin of modernity originating from the medieval nominalist theology, Tillich's so-called "theonomous technology" can be fully expressed under his framework of "essence-existence-essentialization", which is well situated finally in Tillich's understanding of pneumatological healing and eschatological dimension of the kingdom of God. Echoing the shift from Christology to pneumatology demonstrated in chapter two, the re-orientation of technology as the redemption of technical creation has also undergone a change from the manifestation of the New Being in Jesus as the Christ to the breakthrough of the Spiritual Presence and the ultimate fulfillment in the telos of the history.

Chapter six demonstrates the comparative study of environmental theology and the ecological ethics of Tillich, orthodox theology and Confucianism. The rich and potential resources of these three parties are shared in the common language of their ecological concerns: human beings as mediator of the divine principle and nature; Tillich's idea of microcosms, orthodox cosmic anthropology and the Confucian concept of great man. In contrast with the idea of environmental stewardship and master of the creation and nature, this concept of ecological self is more realistic and practical. Also, the "unity-in-difference" metaphor is shared by these three parties in constructing their cosmologies in which eco-centricism is rejected by them and a certain degree of hierarchical model is accepted. All these assertions are argued to shed light in the darkness of ecological catastrophe.

2 Pneumatological Theology

Introduction

For Tillich, the discussion of the doctrine of the Trinity is substantially different from the Trinitarian principle of God. In his volume one of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich located his idea of God as Spirit in which all Trinitarian presuppositions are grounded, and he anticipated that the Trinitarian principles must *begin with the Spirit* rather than with the *Logos* (Tillich 1951: 250). That is why when Tillich "reopened" the question of the Trinitarian symbolism after the discussion of pneumatology in volume three of *Systematic Theology*, he emphasized that, despite the Trinitarian problem being closely related to the Christological problem, "Christology is not complete without pneumatology" (Tillich 1963: 285). For Tillich, the doctrine of the Holy Spirit brings the fulfillment of Christology. Without pneumatology, Christology remains in an unfulfilled condition. Back to the question of Trinity, for Tillich, Trinitarian thinking responds to three fundamental problems; namely, the absolute and concrete elements in religious experience,[1] the concept of the living God[2] and God's threefold self-manifestations (creative power, saving love and ecstatic transformation) (Ibid.: 283). That is why, following the line of Schleiermacher and in contrast to Karl Barth, Tillich located the Trinitarian symbol as *postlegomena* instead of *prolegomena* of theology.[3] For Till-

1 For Tillich, the monotheist type of religion expresses the absolute character of human religious experience; the polytheist type of religion expresses the personal-concrete character of human religious experience. Therefore, the Trinitarian monotheism is able to integrate the two elements of religious experience. See (Tillich 1951: 228)

2 The concept of Trinity is primarily devoted to the Trinitarian principle of God as Living, which is a dialectical process of the Divine Life.

3 For Tillich, discussion of the doctrine of the Trinity is possible only after completing the discussion of Christology and pneumatology. Tillich asserted that he is in line with Schleiermacher. "It was an important step in the direction of an existential understanding of theological doctrines when Schleiermacher put the doctrine of the Trinity at the end of the theological system ... Schleiermacher is right when he derives these symbols [Trinitarian symbols] from the different ways in which faith is related to its divine cause" (Tillich 1963: 285). Although the location of the doctrine of Trinity demarcates Schleiermacher's and Barth's understanding of Christian faith, both shared the importance of ecclesiastical substance and function of Christian doctrine. However, a full discussion of their difference and similarity is beyond the scope of this book. Also, it should be mentioned that Tillich had his own reservations about Schleiermacher's Christological Trinitarian theology, though Barth's theological epistemology of Trinity is also seriously challenged as an "a priori" speculation by Tillich. For Tillich, disregarding the epistemological possibility of the Trinity and of exclusively negating the universal *logos* as the ontological possibility

https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110612752-003

ich, all religious symbols, including the Trinitarian symbol, reflect the revelatory and redemptive experience of theological knowledge (Ibid.: 285).[4] This chapter answers the question: in what sense, first, does pneumatology not only "complete" Christology in Tillich's theology but, second, also bring Trinitarian thinking into the complete and final stage? The chapter shows that this Trinitarian-pneumatological principle successfully resolves the internal tension of theological existence, theological circle and the problem related to theology of culture and church theology because, third, Tillich's pneumatology shown in volume three of *Systematic Theology* grounds perfectly the theological thinking which is constituted by the dialectical bipolarity between universality and particularity demanded by volume one of his *Systematic Theology*.

Also, pneumatology is no doubt one of the most important, yet least discussed, subjects in Tillich's scholarship, as Langdon Gilkey's *Gilkey on Tillich*, expressed (Gilkey 1990). This negligence of the doctrine of the Spirit can be partly explained by Tillich's incompleteness of his system whilst in Germany, and his dissatisfaction with the last volume of his own *magnum opus*, *Systematic Theology*, published in 1963.[5] However, as this chapter argues this negligence is unjustified because pneumatology was exactly employed by Tillich to re-open his entire theological system and to reconceive nearly all the problems under a pneumatological perspective.[6] This chapter also shows that the completion of this pneumatological consideration should be articulated within a Trinitarian framework, and this pneumatological determination character of theology dominated Tillich's later development. Though John Cooper's pioneer work, *The "Spiritual Presence" in the Theology of Paul Tillich*, has provided us with a comprehensive and solid discussion (Cooper 1997), his doctrine is especially relevant to Pauline pneumatological understanding. Cooper's work did not correlate

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of the Trinity respectively can be attributed to Barth and Schleiermacher. See (Tillich 1967a: 408 – 409).

4 It seems that, for Tillich, the mediating matrix of Trinitarian thinking and the Holy Spirit is the numerous manifestations of revelatory experiences, including that "the experience of God as a 'living God' and not as dead identity is a work of the Spiritual Presence as is the experience of the creative ground of being in every being, the experience of Jesus as the Christ, and the ecstatic elevation of the human spirit toward the union of unambiguous life" (Tillich 1963: 286).

5 Tillich attempted to articulate his Christian theology three times in his whole life. The first early attempt was the rough work on *Systematische Theologie* in 1913 (Tillich 1913). The second attempt was teaching *Dogmatik* in Marburg University in 1925 (Tillich 1925). The last attempt was the well-known *Systematic Theology* (1951 – 1963) in the US. See (Tillich 1951, 1957, 1963).

6 In the "introduction" of volume three of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich said "I believe that the volume itself (volume three), especially the section on the doctrine of the Spirit, implicitly answers many of the criticisms" (Tillich 1963:5).

with Tillich's pneumatology, his entire theological system in general and theological methodology in particular. Therefore, the uniqueness and distinctiveness of Tillich's pneumatology is still untouched in Cooper's book. In contrast, Panchiu LAI's *Towards a Trinitarian Theology of Religions: A Study of Paul Tillich's Thought* articulated Tillich's Trinitarian understanding of the theology of religions which is grounded in the interplay between Christology and pneumatology in which the relationship between Christianity and other religions is demonstrated. In Lai's book, the doctrine of the Spirit constitutes a theoretical demand for Tillich in reconsidering the whole framework of the method of correlation. Also, Lai noted that the shift from Christology to pneumatology plays a significant role in studying Tillich's entire system (Lai 1994). Also, in Steven Studebaker's recent article entitled "God as Being and Trinity: Pentecostal-Tillichian Interrogations", the importance of human experience and pneumatology in Tillich's Trinitarian dialectical principle was noted (Studebaker 2015). In his recent work, Amos Yong directed our attention towards Tillich's pneumatology and his correlation method. Concerning the danger of Tillich's system of betraying the centrality of Christology and confusing the divine Spirit and human spirit, Amos Yong tried to reconceive Tillich's entire system "from a pneumatological angle" (Yong 2015: 6). Inspired by Pentecostal theology, which insists on the centrality of pneumatology, "our solution is to start with the Spirit, who is both the Spirit of God in Christ and the breath of life in every living creature" (Ibid.: 9). As Amos Yong was disappointed with Tillich in that he "did not have energy to make a fresh start", this chapter argues that the interplay between Tillich's Christological correlation and pneumatological embodiment had already been established in Tillich's writings, though in a subtle way. Also, in Christian Danz's recent article, "Spirit and the Ambiguities of Life: Reflections on Paul Tillich's Pneumatology", Tillich's pneumatology is closely linked with the reflective disclosure of human spirit in particular, and achieves the realization of religion in history in general (Danz 2017).

This chapter reconstructs the pneumatological theology of Tillich, in which I argue that, first, pneumatology has a role in laying down a new foundation and justification for the methodological foundation of the theological circle which is primarily grounded in Christology. Second, for Tillich, the theological principle of "particularity-universality", which was originally established by *Logos* Christology, finds its ultimate foundation in pneumatology in which Tillich's entire theology of culture is also well grounded. Last, in his last lecture expressing the idea of theology of the history of religions, pneumatology still played a dominant role in guiding the thinking of the relationship between Christianity and non-Christian religions in general, and how to integrate the universal manifestations of the divine in other religions and Christianity in particular. In the process,

this chapter also demonstrates that Tillich's earlier formulation of his theology of culture and his later theology of correlation was consistent with his later articulation and understanding when he shifted his orientation from *Logos* Christology to Spirit-Christology in which the polarity of "particularity-universality" is the underlying principle that Tillich holds. This chapter examines the role of experience as the key concept for entering into Tillich's theological project (2.1.) and argues that the polarity of centeredness (particularity) and openness (universality) of the theological circle and method of correlation are well grounded in Tillich's *Logos* Christology (2.2.). Likewise, in his volume three of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich provided his pneumatology for tackling the unsolved question of Christology on one hand, and brings the polarity of "particularity-universality" back into his pneumatological language on the other (2.3.). Under the above analysis, the dichotomy of church theology and theology of culture is overcome under Tillich's pneumatological perspective (2.4.). Last, this chapter concludes with exploring the tension of Christology and why pneumatology should be re-examined in Tillich's earlier Trinitarian theology (2.5.); and argues for the pneumatological ground of his last lecture on the relationship between theology and history of religions (2.6.).

2.1 Experience in Theologizing

For Tillich, the theological mode is existential in nature and all activities participating in the boundary of the theological circle can be claimed as "theological"; however, the periphery of this circle is not fixed but extendable. In the "Introduction" of volume one of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich articulated a modality of theological existence in which the mode of concrete and existential attitude should be involved in the "theological circle". According to Tillich, engaging in theological thinking and activity means, not merely rational speculation, but that the existential situation of faith inescapably comes into the center. Using his own terminology, theological participation is actually of existential concern in which certain "religious" experience is expressed in the unity of the knowing subject and the known object. A detached epistemological framework and subject-object dichotomy are rejected in an ontological immediate awareness of the Unconditioned. This is exactly the meaning of what Tillich said, "Theology is necessarily existential" (Tillich 1951: 23).

Therefore, to be existential is to be experiential. Ultimate concern as the focus and theme of Tillich's theological project should be understood as a kind of "mystery" experience. That is why Tillich emphasized "experience" as one of the most important mediums for theological reflection. As a "medium"

of some objective sources, human experience is where revelatory events and happenings occur (Ibid.: 46). Tillich never mentioned "human" experience; no matter how religious in substance it is, it should not be regarded as the ground on which theology is built. Therefore, the emphasis on "human" experience as the medium of theological existence does not imply that theology can be reduced to anthropology or anthropocentric theology. For Tillich, theology should not be understood as a heteronomous religious attitude detached from the ontological ground of being. On the contrary, human participation in religious substance is a must. It is exactly why Tillich in his famous article, "The Two Types of Philosophy of Religion", insisted that his theology belongs to the tradition of the Augustine-Franciscan ontological approach to God (Tillich 1946a).[7] It is also the reason why Tillich has a sympathetic understanding of Schleiermacher's idea of "feeling of absolute dependence". Human participation cannot replace the prominent ontological role of the "Christ event" because, for Tillich, divine revelation is never derived from human experience but it "is given to experience and not derived from it. Therefore, experience receives and does not produce" (Tillich 1951: 46).

The role of experience in theological enterprise is debatable in the history of the Reformation. In contrast to the Reformed tradition, which is likely to narrow down the scope of experience in constructing theology, Tillich appeared to have a more sympathetic understanding of the radical reformers' view of the disclosure of the Holy Spirit in human inwardness and the legitimacy of human experience in theology (Ibid.: 45). For him, the former is theology based exclusively on Christological grounds, but the latter also validly allows for numerous possibilities offered by the Holy Spirit. It is important, for Tillich, that theological participation is grounded in the Christ event but not limited by it. The truth would be disclosed continuously through "open experience" mediated by the encounter of Christianity and other faiths. This means that theological existence comes into being within the *extendable* boundary (Ibid. Emphasis mine). It should be emphasized that, on the one hand, religious experience finds its validity within the flexibility of theological boundary; second, the Christ event and religious experience complement each other. Without experience as a medium, the Christian message cannot be received. However, if the role of religious experience is overwhelmed by the Christ event, the transformative power generated by the Spirit

7 A more substantial analysis is provided in 3.1. to illustrate the relationship between Tillich and the Augustine-Franciscan tradition. I argue that the reason why the notion of experience plays an important role in Tillich's theology is grounded in his appreciation of this ontological approach of God. Tillich also calls this approach "theologies of experience" which includes not only medieval mysticism, but also the radical reformers and Schleiermacher.

will be limited. If the Christ event is overwhelmed by religious experience, the particularity of the Christian message will be in danger. This means that neither the transformation issued by the Holy Spirit in human experience is identical with the benefit of such a Christ event, nor that the revelatory experience creates a whole new religious message (Ibid.: 46).[8]

It seems that, for Tillich, religious experience can find its validity only if the Holy Spirit grasps it (Ibid.).[9] The correlation between God's Word and the human word constitutes the possibility and actuality of theological knowledge. For Tillich, "faith seeks understanding" presumes the priority of faith in the process of knowing God. However, Tillich reminded us that this modality of faith must be regarded as "something ultimately [to] concern us" instead of the matter of intellectual certainty and moral actualization. Also, this faith is nothing to do with one's status of regeneration and/or sanctification (Ibid.: 10). In summary, for Tillich, theological existence comes "on the boundary" in which detached objectivity and subjective commitment are both involved. Whether an existence is "theological" depends on those within the "theological circle" making a judgement, but the criterion to judge, whether it is inside or outside, is a matter of accepting of the Christian message as ultimate concern (Ibid.: 46).

The questions of the location of the theological circle, and what the criterion is to be used, are also related to the question of the possibility of *theologia irregenitorum*. Tillich made this inquiry twice separately – in volume one of his *Systematic Theology* and in his lecture on the history of Christian thought. Can non-believers do theology? If not, would theology become the privilege of a Christian community? If yes, is it still correct to uphold "*faith* seeks understanding"? Is "regeneration" the necessary condition of engaging in theological activity? Or is theology purely an academic discipline, which is accessible and open to all intellectual participation? It seems that Tillich never attempted to answer these questions in a comprehensive and direct way. His basic assertion is "only he who experiences the Christian message as his ultimate concern is able to be a theologian, but nothing more than this can be demanded" (Tillich 1967a: 281). In my perspective, the crucial way for Tillich to tackle the question of the location of theological existence is whether he can provide a principle by

8 For the debate between magisterial reformers and radical reformers on the issue of the Spirit and the Bible, and the Spirit and the Christ, please refer to chapter three in this book in which I argue that Tillich's pneumatology is largely inspired by the radical reformers, although he also had reservations about their ideas on the "inner word".

9 It is clear that human experience itself is not qualified to be one of the sources of theology. What Tillich emphasized is the human inwardness experience indwelling from the Holy Spirit who grasps the human spirit as having mystical awareness towards ultimate concern.

which the outside *and* the inside of the theological circle can be maintained. In answering the above questions, Tillich emphasized, that following the above understanding of the theological circle and theological existence, on the one hand, no theological involvement can be done without concrete commitment to the theological circle. When a person participates in theological engagement, s/he "enters it (theological circle) as a member of the Christian church to perform one of the essential functions of the church – its theological self-interpretation" (Tillich 1951:10). However, on the other hand, the *periphery* of ecclesiology is not the judge for determining the correctness of theology. As Tillich said, the *theological* character of theology is not determined by the agreement or disagreement with the Christian message, but whether the message is treated as ultimate concern (Ibid.).

In my understanding, the proper answers for the above questions are found in the dialectical polarity of particularity and universality of the theological circle and its theological justification. For Tillich, the proper attitude of a theologian always goes beyond the boundary of the theological circle. The Christological center establishes the particularity of the Christian message; the extendable periphery of the circle constitutes the possibility of new and open experiences as the source of theological thinking (Ibid.: 45). In summary, if the focus of the theological circle is grounded in the *concreteness* and *particularity* of "Jesus as the Christ", then the *possibility* of involving diverse religious experience participating in the *extendable* theological circle should be established by the *universality* of Spiritual Presence in the human spirit. For Tillich, faith in Jesus as the Christ is grasped by the Holy Spirit to achieve an ecstasy situation. In order to balance the particularity and universality of the Christian message, in his later work, the proper theological framework would be a "Spirit-Christology" model under which theological existence and the theological circle would become well grounded.

2.2 Christological Correlation

For Tillich, the substance of theology is closely related to the methodology adopted. The subject matter of the theological discipline determines which method would be appropriate. If the "Spirit-Christology" is arguable as the determination of Tillich's theology as a whole, his method of correlation is also established through the connection with Christology and pneumatology.

In volume one of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich regarded theology as "apologetic theology" or "answering theology" (Ibid.: 6). The task of this theology "answers the questions implied in the "situation" in the power of the eternal mes-

sage and with the means provided by the situation whose questions it answers" (Ibid.). What apologetic theology attempts to do is to correlate the "question" implied in the situation and the "answer" provided by the Christian message. It is misleading to oppose this answering theology with Karl Barth's kerygma theology in a sense that, for Tillich, the proclamation of the Christian gospel is always situated in the heart of apologetic theology; otherwise, the Christian identity would be lost in the process of dialogue and encounter. What Tillich wanted to emphasize is that, in maintaining the particularity of the Christian message, kerygmatic theology will be in danger if it holds the supernatural character, which is beyond the context of the gospel, and tries to engage with it. That is why Tillich insisted that theology should be "mediating" in nature (Ibid.: 7). Another questionable criticism points to the "question-answer" relation, in that critics claim it would be in danger if the Christian answer is derived from the human situation. Actually, Tillich never claimed that the Christian proclamation should be based on the human analysis of the situation. Rather, both of them should be in a correlated relationship. The question always comes first, but it does not derive the answer. Otherwise, it would become "begging the question".

This method of correlation also finds its other formulation in Tillich's early development.[10] Religion is regarded as the depth of all cultural expression and it is not understood as a separate entity along with other cultural functions. In his famous address given at the University of Berlin in 1919, "On the Idea of a Theology of Culture", Tillich laid out his profound framework for the so-called theology of culture. He pointed out that theology is

> the concrete and normative science of religion ... By this means two allegations are refuted. First, theology is not the science of one particular object, which we call God, among others; the *Critique of Pure Reason* put an end to this kind of science ... Theology is a part of science of religion, namely the systematic and normative part. Second, theology is not a scientific presentation of a special complex of revelation. This interpretation presupposes a concept of a supernaturally authoritative revelation ... (Tillich 1919: 157).

In order to subordinate theology as the science of religion, Tillich established a unifying system of sciences (Tillich 1923). Under this normative and concrete consideration, the object of theology is neither the "thing-in-itself" outside the boundary of human empirical knowledge, as Kant indicated, nor the revelation understood as supernaturally unmediated through religious authorities (Tillich 1919: 157). Instead of objectifying the supernatural entity, the task of a theology

10 John Clayton has an excellent analysis on the shift of Tillich's concept of correlation from his early to later period. See (Clayton 1980).

of culture attempts, not to represent the idea of God as an external object, but rather to achieve a synthesis of cultural form and the religious *Gehalt* (Manning 2005: 122).[11] Revelation is not merely disclosed within the boundary of the Christian community for Tillich; the unconditioned is manifested through the sphere of culture (Thomas 2000: 32). In a later period, Tillich expressed this manifestation through the idea of awareness of unconditional, ultimate concern. The paradox of "absolute yes" and "absolute no" is experienced in the revelatory breakthrough into the secular forms. Religion is closely linked to different kinds of cultural form. For early Tillich, it is impossible to reduce religion into one of the functions of culture. That is why it would be a failure to reduce religion into Hegelian reason, Kantian ethics or Schleiermacherian "feeling" (*Gefühl*). No single function of the human mind can fully grasp the essence of religion, and the substance of religion can manifest through all these structures.

This chapter argues that there is a strong continuity between early Tillich and later Tillich in his understanding of the task of theology of culture. His methodology in the early period in rejecting the supernaturalist approach towards revelation, is maintained in his later approach in opposing the "docetic-monophysitic traits" of the Christian message (Tillich 1951: 64 – 65). The relevance of Christian revelation is sacrificed under orthodox affirmation. Furthermore, Tillich's theology of correlation finds no difficulty in affirming the Barthian criticism about the liberal attempt to derive the theological answer from the human situation. Using Tillichian terminology, the confusion of "essence" and "existence" is the real danger of nineteenth century cultural Protestantism. It is totally understandable for Barth, in Tillich's understanding, to distinguish the "infinite ontological difference" between God and human (Ibid.: 65).[12]

In rejecting Barth's supernaturalist understanding of revelation, Tillich, by no means abandoned the concept of God as the main focus in theology as a whole, and in methodological consideration in particular. Tillich insisted that epistemology is grounded in ontological consideration. The way of knowing God should be sustained by the way of God's revelation. Revelation is disclosed by God, but received by human beings. That means, for Tillich, the ontological

11 For early Tillich, the whole project of theology of culture is mainly expressed through the intra-structural relationship of "*Form-Inhalt-Gehalt*". In Clayton's excellent analysis, the difference between early Tillich's mediating theology as "*Form-Gehalt*" structure and later Tillich's "question-answer" theology of mediation is fully illustrated. See (Clayton 1980).

12 This chapter cannot discuss comprehensively the implication behind the relationship between Tillich, Barth and liberal theology. In short, in Tillich' mind, under his "Protestant principle", "liberal" and "orthodoxy" is not an "either-or" but a "both-and" relationship, and this approach is named as "neo-dialectical theology". See (Tillich 1948: xxvi-xxviii).

correlation between God and human beings precedes the epistemological way of construing the method of correlation. The interdependence of "God for us" and "we for God", expressing the *analogia entis*, is grounded in the method of correlation. It is noticed that the assumption of the analogy of beings does not provide the valid way for appreciating the natural theology in which the being of God can be derived by natural entities, even though Tillich believed in the inner power of nature as the bearer of the divine manifestation. For Tillich, the analogy of beings sets the ontological ground for comprehending the idea of God and the world; the analogy of faith expresses the religious dimension from the human finite attitude. They are not dichotomous in nature (Ibid.:131).[13]

In answering a Kantian theological epistemological question: How is it possible to understand God?, for Tillich, the term "theology" denotes all rational discourse towards *theos*, and this is merely a necessary condition, but not the sufficient condition for understanding the *Christian* idea of theology. The ground of Christian theology as a whole, is expressed in the doctrine of "*logos* became flesh" (Ibid.:16). This doctrine is able to identify Christian theology as *the* theology (Ibid. Emphasis mine), and "Christian theology has received a foundation which transcends the foundation of any other theology and which itself cannot be transcended" (Ibid.). "*Logos* became flesh" doctrine consists of the "absolutely concrete" and the "absolutely universal" in nature (Ibid.).

> Christian theology is *the* theology in so far as it is based on the tension between the absolutely concrete and the absolutely universal. Priestly and prophetic theologies can be very concrete, but they lack universality. Mystical and metaphysical theologies can be very universal, but they lack concreteness (Ibid.).

The absolutely concrete represents everything particular, and the absolutely universal represents everything abstract (Ibid.). For Tillich, "*logos* became flesh" integrates the universal *logos* and concrete historical human flesh under which all beings, no matter how much they are universal and/or particular, are to be included into this doctrine. In other words, Christian theology finds its own foundation in a highly inclusive ground in which everything existential would be a union within this particular and concrete flesh under a kind of personal relationship; simultaneously, every possibility would be united with the universal and abstract cosmic *logos* (Ibid.:17). For Tillich, this combination of universal *logos*

13 Tillich insisted that the knowledge of revelation is analogous in nature because the possibility of the knowledge of God should be grounded in analogy. Also, Tillich reminded us that analogy of beings should not be regarded as the way of natural theology to infer some understandings of God. It just performs the referential role like a religious symbol.

and concrete flesh expresses a paradoxical breakthrough into human culture to manifest its own truth (Ibid.: 57).[14]

What Tillich was concerned with is not merely the traditional theological *prolegomena* question, but the possibility and actuality of the validity of Christian theology outside the boundary of Christian community.

> Whether there is a theology outside Christianity and, if so, whether or not the idea of theology is fulfilled in Christian theology in a perfect and final way. Indeed, this is what Christian theology claims; but is it more than a claim, a natural expression of the fact that the theologian works within the theological circle? Has it any validity beyond the periphery of the circle? It is the task of apologetic theology to prove that the Christian claim also has validity from the point of view of those outside the theological circle. Apologetic theology must show that trends which are immanent in all religions and cultures move towards the Christian answers. This refers both to doctrines and to the theological interpretation of theology (Ibid.:15).

It seems that Tillich was trying hard to find a theological justification to set Christian theology on the boundary between Christianity and non-Christian religions in general and other cultures in particular.[15] And this justification can provide a function of guarantee for the validity well situated inside *and* outside of Christianity. Therefore, it is understandable why Tillich unified the principle of universality and particularity in order to fulfill the requirement of the validity outside of Christianity and inside of Christianity, respectively. In order to fulfill the requirement of crossing the boundary of the theological circle, the principle of universality provides the proper legitimacy for justifying the validity of the Christian message outside the Christian community. Simultaneously, in order to fulfill the requirement of identification of theological existence, the principle of particularity provides the justification within the theological circle. Therefore, the focus and the periphery of the theological circle are both fulfilled in the doctrine of "*logos* became flesh".

The above analysis can be explained comprehensively in the dialectical formulation between theology and philosophy. For Tillich, the difference between these two disciplines is grounded in the respective resource. Philosophy assumes the structure of universal *logos* in which both human mind and universes are shared under the goal of philosophy. It is the union of the human subjective

14 For the concept of "breakthrough" in Tillich's theology, see (Scharf 1999).

15 The relationship of Christianity and non-Christian religion was becoming problematic in the later stage of Tillich's intellectual development. This problem is treated in 2.6. of this chapter. I argue that the problem of "universality-particularity" had changed throughout Tillich's development.

logos and the objective *logos*. On the contrary, theology submits itself under the concrete *logos*, fleshly *logos*. It requires a concrete commitment towards it (Ibid.: 23). However, these two disciplines share a common basic structure; a philosopher is a hidden theologian.[16] What Tillich wanted to mention is not, in an actual sense, that philosophy is identical with theology, but in a potential sense that philosophy is theologically orientated. Alternatively, if a theological attitude tries to stake a universal validity, it should keep a detached distance from its existential commitment and extend obedience to the universal *logos*. If so, theology will be philosophically orientated (Ibid.). To be critical is to be obliged. Therefore, the mission of a theologian is to:

> take the risk of being driven beyond the boundary line of the theological circle ... Theology, since it serves not only the concrete but also the universal logos, can become a stumbling block for the church and a demonic temptation for the theologian. The detachment required in honest theological work can destroy the necessary involvement of faith. This tension is the burden and the greatness of every theological work (Ibid.: 25 – 26).

In summary, the philosophical realm and theological realm are totally different but overlapping. As Tillich said, they are neither in conflict nor in a synthesis (Ibid.: 26).

It is clear that Tillich formulated the material content of Christian theology as the combination of universality and particularity in the doctrine of the incarnation. The role of this material substance is to provide the justification for theological existence coming across the periphery/ boundary of the theological circle. In the following, the incarnation takes the function of constructing the formal criteria of Christian theology. Tillich emphasized that the object of theology, first, is "what concern[s] us ultimately" (Ibid.: 28). Negatively speaking, this criterion defends the independence of different human activities through the distinction of "ultimate concern" and "preliminary concern". However, these two types of concern are not in a polarity. "In and through every preliminary concern the ultimate concern can actualize itself." If so, the preliminary concern would become the object of theology (Ibid.:13). Positively speaking, all beings in the world that is inherent with ultimate concern are qualified to be the object of theology (Ibid.). That means, for Tillich, nothing should be excluded outside the theological circle as the second formal criterion shows that those things that de-

16 Tillich said, "his existential situation and his ultimate concern shape his philosophical vision. He is a theologian to the degree that his intuition of the universal logos of the structure of reality as a whole is formed by a particular logos which appears to him in his particular place and reveals to him the meaning of the whole" (Tillich 1951: 25).

termine our "being or non-being" should be regarded as the object of theology (Ibid.).

These two formal theological criteria provide the justification for the validity of crossing the periphery/ boundary of the theological circle. *The material content of these two criteria is concrete and particular but the boundary is extendable and universal*. In volume one of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich grounded his whole theology of correlation in the doctrine of the *Logos* Christology in which, he argued that the requirements of universality and particularity can find their fulfillments in this doctrine. Then, we find that this theological foundation, *Logos* Christology, will be replaced by pneumatology in volume three of *Systematic Theology*. It seems that, for Tillich, the doctrine of the Holy Spirit is more capable of fulfilling the above double requirements, both universality and particularity provided by "*logos* became flesh".[17]

2.3 From *Logos* Christology to Spirit-Christology

The doctrine of the Holy Spirit plays an important role in Tillich's system, not only because it correlates God's spirit and the human spirit as the system intends to work out, but also because it reconsiders the foundation of Tillich's entire theology of correlation.[18] Then, in what ways can this later doctrinal development fulfill Tillich's original intention in founding theology on *Logos* Christology?

First, in his lecture on the history of Christian thought, Tillich articulated *logos* Christology trends with emphasis on the transformation of the divine *logos* to become human, but that adoptionist Christology will emphasize more the divine *logos* that dwells into the human Jesus (Tillich 1967a: 80). The reason

17 Tillich had slightly touched the question of the Christological and pneumatological foundation of his own theological system. In footnote 13 of volume one of *Systematic Theology*, he mentioned that "the biblical foundation of the present system is indicated by the wording of the material norm: the New Being in Jesus as the Christ. This refers above all to Paul's doctrine of the Spirit ... the Paulinism of the present system is dependent on Paul's constructive doctrine of the New Creation in Christ which included the prophetic-eschatological message of the 'new eon'" (Tillich 1951: 50 – 51). Therefore, for Tillich, Paul's Christology and pneumatology are both the basic references for his theological system.

18 It is widely known that, Tillich himself was disappointed with volume three of *Systematic Theology* and considered it fragmentary, inadequate and questionable (Tillich 1963: Preface), but he never explained the reason. Pan-chiu LAI provides an excellent analysis of the problem of inter-religious dialogue in which Tillich reconsidered the validity of the entire theological method of correlation, and the interplay between his Christology and pneumatology which also creates a tension within Tillich's method of correlation; see (Lai 1994).

why Tillich, in his volume one of *Systematic Theology*, focused merely on the former and based his theological methodology on it may be partly explained by his consideration of the "universality" and "particularity" given by the transformation Christology suggested to him. However, at that time, Tillich did not consider the question of how the "universal" *becomes* "particular".[19] It may explain why, in his lecture on the history of Christian thought after the publication of volume one, Tillich just merely mentioned both types of Christology but did not consider the possibility of how to synthesize them (Ibid.: 32).

Second, when Tillich was moving forward to volume two of his *Systematic Theology*, Christology was reconsidered in a much broader and deeper way, at least in two directions. On one hand, Tillich pushed forward his criticism of the Chalcedonian definition of two-natures Christology, and simultaneously, he considered the complementarity of *Logos* Christology and adoptionist Christology (Tillich 1957: 138 – 150).[20] For him, in volume two of *Systematic Theology*, the basic question of Christology is how to maintain the Christ-character and Jesus-character expressed in "Jesus as the Christ". This means that Tillich is using another type of Christological language to continue the discussion of universality and particularity expressed in volume one. Also, the idea of "New Being" is adapted as an innovation to express the divine principle actualized in a concrete and historical life. The complementary forms expressed in that *logos* Christology were needed to explain the adoptionist Christology and, also, the former needs the latter for its fulfillment (Ibid.: 149). Under existential consideration, Christology should be soteriological in the sense that who God is should be totally dependent on who fully participates in man's existential predicament (Ibid.: 146). It seems that is why Tillich tended to employ a philosophical framework in which in the man Jesus as the Christ is the eternal unity of God and man, and this eternal unity has become historical reality (Ibid.).[21] In abandoning understanding the incarnation as metamorphosis, his ontological model

19 This "how-become" question was reopened in volume three of Tillich's *Systematic Theology*; see (Tillich 1963:144).

20 It is not the purpose of this work to discuss the first criticism of Chalcedonian Christology. Simply speaking, Tillich adapted the dynamic relational model of "eternal God-man-unity" to replace the traditional static "two natures in one person" model. See (Tillich 1949: 305 – 318).

21 Bruce Cameron employed a Hegelian model to interpret Tillich's Christology. See (Cameron 1976: 27 – 48). However, Tillich himself rejected Hegel's dialectical interpretation of infinity and finiteness in favor of a paradoxical representation of the incarnation. See (Tillich 1949: 309). Recently, some scholars noticed the nuanced relationship between J.W.J. Schelling and Tillich in the problem of Christology. The excellent example is Georg Neugebauer's *Tillichs frühe Christologie: Eine Untersuchung zu Offenbarung und Geschichte bei Tillich vor dem Hintergrund seiner Schellingrezeption* (2007).

tends to emphasize the divine unity of Godmanhood manifested in a personal life.

From volume one to volume two, we find that Tillich's Christology had undergone a shift from an emphasis on the *logos* Christology to an "eternal God-man-unity" in which he tries to balance the essential tension between the incarnational and adoptionist aspects of Christology. In order to emphasize a personal life as full of an authentic human condition, the individuality and concreteness of Jesus as the Christ should not be ignored. It is interesting that, in volume two, when discussing *how logos* changes into a human being, Tillich seldom uses the word, *became*, rather the words, "manifestation" and "participation" become the key words in describing the mechanism that happened in the life of Jesus Christ (Ibid.: 148 – 150).

What surprises us with Tillich's volume three of *Systematic Theology* is not only that he tried to revise the doctrine of Christology through pneumatological language, but that the idea of "Spiritual Presence" throws new light on the unresolved questions resident in the preceding volumes. It should be noted that Tillich's ambition is to put the polemical burden heavily on the doctrine of the Spirit (Tillich 1963: 5). The most important development, it will be shown, is that the complementarity of the universality and particularity of *logos* Christology mentioned in volume one is perfectly reformulated and resolved under the framework of Spirit-Christology in volume three of *Systematic Theology*.

Spirit-Christology means that the "divine Spirit was present in Jesus as the Christ without distortion" (Ibid.: 144). For Tillich, this aspect of Christology was shown in the synoptic gospels and Pauline tradition. All the stories recorded in synoptic traditions express that the Spirit directed and empowered Jesus to fulfill his mission. This configuration of Jesus "possessed" by the Holy Spirit, according to Tillich, succeeds as an important step in responding to the how-question that remained unanswered in volume two. The particularity of Jesus' own personal life was "procreated" by the divine Spirit (Ibid.).

> This story was justified by the insight into the psychosomatic level at which the Spiritual Presence works and the legitimate conclusion that there must have been a teleological predisposition in Jesus to become the bearer of the Spirit without limit (Ibid.:145).

In order to maintain the authentic humanity of Jesus, Tillich tended to shift his Christological orientation into the adoptionist approach; otherwise it would be dangerous to deprive Jesus of his full humanity in the so-called "crypto-Monophysitic" tendency of Christology (Ibid.). The human side of faith and love of the man Jesus can be regarded as the state of being grasped by the Spiritual Presence and, through it, by the transcendent union of unambiguous life (Ibid.:146).

For Tillich, despite Jesus experiencing an ambiguous and fragmentary state of faith, the "transcendent union of unambiguous life" bore him up (Ibid.).

Actually, in order to emphasize the idea that divine power manifests within the human structure, but does not destroy it, Tillich had to reconstruct a rather dynamic and interpenetrated vision of reality. Under this holistic and organic vision, the differentiation of all beings is not classified as different "levels" but "dimensions".[22] The understanding of Spirit-Christology is well grounded in his idea of "multi-dimensional unity of life" because the idea of multi-dimensionality of human life creates a much more dynamic mechanism to conceive the interplay between the divine power and Jesus' human spirit. The metaphor, *dimension*, that Tillich employed, shows that the essential relationship among all kinds of being are not in "mutual interference", and that they cross without disturbing each other and find no conflicts among dimensions. Therefore, no "hierarchical" levels are implied (Ibid.:15). Under this organic and integrated unity of the whole, the divine spirit is not regarded as the "upper" levels to control the "lower" Jesus' spirit, but rather that the Holy Spirit is fully present as the depth of Jesus' authentic life, and participates in each dimension of the person of Jesus Christ. Therefore, under this idea of multi-dimensional unity of life, Tillich could overcome the dichotomy between incarnational and adoptionist Christologies. The so-called "from above" or "from below" framework of Christology is no longer valid. The dimensions of the divine Spirit and the human spirit in Jesus are not separated from each other and their own substances can penetrate into each dimension without losing their own identities. That is why "the doctrine of the multi-dimensional unity of life answers the question of the psychosomatic basis of the bearer of the Spirit without such ambiguity" (Ibid.:145).

Back to the question of theological existence and the theological circle, if the groundwork of the particularity and universality involved in the theological circle is formally and materially based on "*logos* became flesh" in volume one of *Systematic Theology*, then, because of the development of the "Divine Spirit dwelling in Jesus' spirit" articulated in volume three, the particularity and universality question would be dealt with by pneumatology. It should be noted that the flexibility of the boundary of the theological circle is not defendable perfectly under the original idea of *logos* Christology whose main focus is tentatively placed on the particularity of the divine revelation in Jesus Christ. If "open experience" should be allowed and theology could be worked out outside the theological circle, the universality character demonstrated by pneumatology would be more appropriate than *logos* Christology in tackling this theological existence.

22 For the discussion of the multi-dimensionality of life, see chapter three.

Though Tillich coupled pneumatology and Christology together, it is obvious and nuanced that the orientation of volume three of *Systematic Theology* was shifted to emphasize the universal spiritual and theonomous manifestations into humankind in general and Jesus Christ in particular.

2.4 Reconsidering the Theology of Spiritual Community

If theology is the function of the Christian church (Tillich 1951: 3), the question concerning nature and the boundary of theology can be partly answered through the understanding of the idea of the church. For Tillich, there is no ground to separate theology of culture and ecclesiastical theology.

> The theology of culture acknowledges the necessity of the concrete standpoint in its continuity, and the church theologian in turn acknowledges the relativity of every concrete form compared with the exclusive absoluteness of the religious principle itself (Tillich 1919: 178).

The complementarity of the language of "universal-particular" occurred once again in early Tillich. From the side of the church theologian, the particularity and concreteness of the Christian substance should be always re-examined and relativized through the universal and critical principle.

In volume three of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich articulated his ecclesiology under the idea of Spiritual Presence. The church as the new creation is created under the power of Jesus Christ and the Holy Spirit. First, the power of the New Being manifested in Jesus as the Christ is not possible without the reception of the community of faith. That is why Tillich emphasized, in volume two and volume three of *Systematic Theology*, that Jesus as the Christ could not have brought the new reality without those who have accepted the new reality in him and from him (Tillich 1963: 149). Thus, the church (the community of faith) is ontologically the continuous bearer of the New Being in Jesus as the Christ. Second, Tillich asserted that the spiritual substance of the church in particular, and all "religious groups" in general, is powerfully created by the Spiritual Presence who is also the source of the New Being manifested in Jesus as the Christ, which is highly emphasized in Tillich's volume three of *Systematic Theology*. "The Spiritual community is unambiguous; it is New Being, created by the Spiritual Presence. But, although it is a manifestation of unambiguous life in the Christ and in those who expected the Christ" (Ibid.: 150), like all beings, the life of the church is ambiguous in the sense that essence and existence are both present. Therefore, Tillich tended to identify the essential nature of the church as "spiritual community"

which should not be regarded as the existential and physical-empirical existence of "church". "Spiritual community", under the impact of Spiritual Presence, embodies the power of the New Being and overcomes the ambiguous state of all kinds of religious life (Ibid.: 149 – 150). Therefore, spiritual community by nature should not be identical with any visible and physical communities, but is regarded as spiritual power and meaning created by the Holy Spirit inherent *within* these communities, as Martin Luther mentioned that spiritual community is invisible, hidden and open to faith only (Ibid.:150).[23] This means that the relationship between spiritual community and the visible church is analogous to religious substance (*Gehalt*) and its cultural form. The former, expressing the spiritual power and meaningful substance through the physical and external formal structures, remains as the hidden stage within different communities when Jesus as the Christ is still unnoticed.

The dialectical tension between spiritual community and the church is fully expressed in the parallel concepts of "latent" and "manifested" community.[24] Both of them are non-identical, but not separated. Spiritual community refers to the latent mode of theological existence within the church *and also outside* the church (Ibid.: 152 – 155).

> The term "latent" comprises a negative and a positive element. Latency is the state of being partly actual, partly potential; one cannot attribute latency to that which is merely potential ... In the state of latency, there must be actualized elements and elements not actualized (Ibid.: 153).

It is clear that, for Tillich, the distinction between the Christian church and other secular communities is not absolute in the sense that both are universally empowered by the Spiritual Presence, and that the ultimate criterion for distinguishing them is actually located in the self-negation and self-transformation manifested by the Protestant principle which is manifested through Spiritual Presence (Ibid.:154).

Through the analysis of pneumatology, Tillich's formulation of the tension between the periphery and the focus of the theological circle in volume one is articulated in volume three as the tension between the latency and manifestation

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23 When Tillich refered to Luther on the invisible church, the invisible and visible characters of the church are not in dichotomy but the former should actualize through the latter. See (Tillich 1967: 252). For Tillich's comment on the Reformation, see (Lindbeck 1983: 376 – 393).

24 Actually, according to Tillich, the distinction between "latent" and "manifest" was developed early in the essay called "*Kirche und humanistische Gesellschaft*". However, his pneumatology still remained underdeveloped. See (Tillich 1966: 66).

of Spiritual community. Though the framework of "Spirit-Christology" remains at the heart of the whole system, pneumatology undoubtedly provides the theological validity of the notion of theological existence *outside* the boundary of the church. Although Tillich maintained the balance between Christology and pneumatology, he emphasized that the spiritual community is the community of the New Being and it is created by the divine Spirit as manifest in the New Being in Jesus as the Christ (Ibid.: 155); the community of faith and love is no longer exclusively understood within the tradition of the Christian church. If so, the so-called "Church Theology" should not be limited by the ecclesiologically-laden and it should be understood in a much broader way to include different kinds of theological existence embodied within a universal vision under the impact of the Spiritual Presence.

Also, in order to relativize the concrete and absolute focus of the theological circle, Tillich's self-negation and self-criticism of the Protestant principle is applied to express the conquest of religion in self-elevation. Under the impact of his pneumatology, Spiritual Presence is not only regarded as the embodiment of spiritual grace and presence but also formulated as the criterion to critique the demonization and profanization of such embodiment (Ibid.: 245). Tillich mentioned that the Protestant principle is a manifestation of the prophetic Spirit (Ibid.). The original Christological language of the paradox of Jesus' death on the cross expressed in the Protestant principle is clearly resolved in the pneumatological language of the Spiritual Presence of graceful embodiment and prophetic criticism. This is the theological and critical meaning of Tillich's combination of Protestant principle and Catholic substance, which dominated in the early Tillich as "*gestalt* of grace" and re-formulated in Tillich's idea of pneumatological protest and *gestalt*.[25]

2.5 Towards a Trinitarian Pneumatological Perspective

It is obvious that the entire correlation method and its theological understanding of the relationship between Christian faith and culture are grounded in the doctrine of *Logos* Christology, which attempts to correlate the concrete and particular on one hand and the universal and abstract on the other hand. This section shows that, within his systematic development, Tillich's Christology underwent a shift in orientation from a transformational perspective to an adoptionist ap-

25 For the question of how Tillich combines the Protestant principle and Catholic substance as the concept of "*gestalt* of grace" under the doctrine of pneumatology, see chapter 3.3.3.2.

proach. In preserving the authentic dimension of the human Jesus, Tillich's Christology is inevitably coupled with pneumatology in order to correlate Jesus' authentic spiritual dimension and the divine spiritual presence. However, when pneumatology successfully replaces the language of Christology, a question of an imbalanced overemphasis on universality, informed by universalizing pneumatology, emerges. This is exactly the reverse problematic situation of an overemphasis on the particularity informed by *Logos* Christology. Perhaps this is one of the reasons for Tillich's dissatisfaction with his final system.

Neither *Logos* Christology nor Spirit Christology can alone maintain a perfect balance of the key polarity of "particularity-universality" as the ground and nature of theology. However, this section suggests that the idea of a Trinitarian pneumatology can serve as an embracing symbol to resolve the tension developed by the principle of "particularity-universality" in the dialectical life process within God as Spirit. For Tillich, God is Spirit and God has spirit. God's being is essentially living Spirit. In volume one of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich emphasized the importance of pneumatology in considering the ground of the idea of God.

> The situation is different if we do not ask the question of the Christian doctrines but rather the question of the *presuppositions* of these doctrines in an idea of God. Then we must speak about the Trinitarian principles, and *we must begin with the Spirit rather than with the Logos* (Tillich 1951: 250. Emphasis mine).

For Tillich, the primary symbol for describing the absolute and the abysmal nature of God is the symbol, *Spirit*, which implies that divine life undergoes a dialectical life process in which the triune God is "separate and reunite[d] simultaneously" (Ibid.: 242). Also, this Trinitarian life process as Spirit, as Trinitarian principle, has different and embracing symbols for the self-manifestation of the divine life with human beings (Tillich 1963: 294). Tillich's concern is *not* the Christian doctrine of the Trinity, but the presupposition of this doctrine, which means that the essential being of God's self-manifestation is expressed through this symbol. First, Godhead as the first principle expresses the abyss of the divine and the power of being infinitely resisting non-being. Second, the *logos* principle, regarded as God's self-objectification, represents the meaning and structure of this symbol. Third, the Spirit is regarded as the mediating principle for uniting the power in the first one and the meaning of the second in it. In a holistic sense, Spirit is the whole and the dynamic living process within the Godhead (Tillich 1951: 251).

The Spirit as God's living, as well as the Trinitarian process, is fully dynamic in self-manifestation in which the "Spirit in whom God 'goes out from' himself,

proceeds from the divine ground. He gives actuality to that which is potential in the divine ground and 'outspoken' in the divine logos" (Ibid.: 251). It should be noted that, under this Trinitarian principle, Spirit participates in the particularity of Jesus as Christ. The Spirit as the Spirit of Christ means that the universality expressed by the Spirit is fully and authentically coupled with the particularity of the man Jesus. Also, the Spirit reuniting the separated means that the outspoken incarnated particular *logos* would be reunited with the Godhead through the Spirit. Through this reuniting process, the post-existent Christ regains universality. Therefore, under this Trinitarian process, the "particularity-universality" starts its dialectical balance in the historical life of Jesus generated by the Holy Spirit, and completes the process in the exalted Christ empowered by the Holy Spirit as well.

In Tillich's 1913 "*Systematische Theologie*", the above Trinitarian principle was first articulated. In the beginning of the part on Dogmatics, God is articulated as a tri-unity living God; this tri-unity (*Dreienigkeit*) expresses the unity of the infinite manifoldness (Tillich 1913: 329). For Tillich, "since the appropriate arrangement of the dogmatics is given through the different moments of the concept of God, it is necessary to place the trinity at the beginning of the dogmatic system, ... since out of this reason each main part of the system has a direct relation to the trinity, so the trinity has to be discussed also at the mid-point of the System (Christology) and at the end of the System" (Ibid.: 330). It seems that, in Tillich's early consideration of his systematic theology, the doctrine of Trinity should not be interpreted as only one doctrine among the others, but it should be the underlying grounding principle for the whole system. That means his systematic theology in his original design is wholly Trinitarian.

Under the above Trinitarian principle, the incarnated *logos* expresses the outward moment of Godhead and represents the concrete and determined moment. "Through the exaltation of Christ, the tension is overcome in which the unity of God with the historical Jesus is realized, and whose completion was the cross" (Ibid.: 364–365). The doctrine of the exaltation of Christ was never fully explored in Tillich's mature *Systematic Theology*. However, the tension or dialectical relationship of "concrete-universal" was solved in the Trinitarian principle in general, and the symbol of the exaltation of Christ in particular. The historical particular human Jesus is exalted to heaven through the Spirit. In Tillich's language, "the Son is the immediate unity of all divine fullness, while the historical life of Jesus, the unity of God with the Son maintains itself, despite the tension that the singularity had brought in, in the unity of God with the exalted Christ, the tension is overcome, but the moment of singularity is preserved, however, no longer as an opposing factor that has to be overcome but as a justified and redeemed moment" (Ibid.: 365).

This chapter has demonstrated that the key motif "particularity-universality" offered by Tillich in order to ground the whole theological system in general, and theological methodology in particular, is not fully successful within his system. However, his Trinitarian pneumatology, which was implicitly shown in his early 1913 theological consideration and partly mentioned in his mature system, provides a promising and embracing theological symbol to successfully emphasize the particularity of the Spirit's indwelling in the human Jesus, and the universality of the risen Lord Jesus in his exaltation through the Holy Spirit. Therefore, the polarity of "particularity-universality" is interchangeable within the framework of the pneumatological particularity and Christological universality. The Trinitarian ground of the theological circle and theology of culture is well formed. The office of the Holy Spirit not only provides the legitimate ground for the extension of the theological circle, but also enriches the particularity of Jesus as the Christ. Also, Jesus as the Christ in turn provides the universal and cosmic vision of the uniqueness of the Christian message in the universalizing of the Spiritual Presence. As Tillich said, due to the openness of the doctrine of Trinity, the Trinitarian conception of theological thinking must be also open and not fixed.

2.6 A Pneumatological Theology of the History of Religions

In concluding the above discussion, Tillich's thinking had undergone a shift from a Christological to a pneumatological orientation. This occurred between his volume one and two, which were dominated by a Christological correlation method, and volume three, which was overwhelmed by a pneumatological perspective. It is arguable that one of the determining issues (perhaps the most influential) of this orientation shift in general, affecting Tillich's attitude towards non-Christian religions in particular, is the question of inter-religious dialogue. In fact, Tillich had participated in the Christian-Buddhist dialogue with Zen masters, Daisetz Suzuki, in New York and Ascona (1951 and 1953); and Hisamatsu Shin-ichi in Harvard (1957) before his trip to Japan in 1960.[26] After his Japan trip,[27] Tillich presented his Bampton lectures (delivered in 1961 and published in 1963) mainly on the issues of the inter-religious encounter. These significant events are remarkable in that Tillich seemed occupied with the difficulty of how to receive non-Christian religions under his correlation method if other religions are rightly re-

26 For the dialogue between Tillich and Hisamatsu Shin-ichi, see (Tillich 1970: 75 – 170). For the general analysis and interpretation of Tillich and his dialogue with Buddhism, see (Boss 2009).
27 The documental exchange between Tillich and Japanese Zen Buddhist scholars and Tillich's lectures in Japan were published; see (Fukai 2013).

garded as *not* the *culture* which raises the existential problem but are also valid as one of the *living religions*, like Christianity, in providing the religious answer. That means the correlation framework of a "religion-culture" mechanism would probably be challenged under the encounter of "religion vs religion". How can Tillich maintain his "question-answer" matrix when two and more different religions are also valid in providing the answers that address contextual-existential questions?[28] In fact, Tillich did not ignore this puzzle, but tried to integrate this inter-religious dialogue problem within the universality of Spiritual Presence, as he emphasized in the introduction of volume three of *Systematic Theology:*

> Another important characteristic of the present situation is the less dramatic but increasingly significant exchange between the historical religions, dependent partly on the need for a common front against the invading secular forces and partly on the conquest of spatial distance between different religious centers. Again I must say that a Christian theology which is not able to enter into a creative *dialogue* with the theological thought of other religions misses a world-historical occasion and remains provincial (Tillich 1963: 6. Emphasis mine).

It seems that the correlational method of "question-answer" was shifted into a consideration of religious *dialogue*. Non-Christian religions share the same role in providing the existential answers. After immigrating to America, Tillich became aware of the limitation and arrogance of philosophical and theological "provincialism", mainly engendered from his German soil and blood (Tillich 1953b). For him, maintaining his German heritage and remaining open to other possibilities in the context of American culture and theology was his "both-and" alternative. At his words, "America can save you from European and other provincialisms, but it does not necessarily make you provincial itself" (Ibid.: 160). Before the encounter with non-Christian religions, Tillich's mind focused on the possibility of *intra*-denominational ecumenical Christian theology, (e. g. Protestant and Catholic traditions, European and American theology) without reaching the consciousness of *inter*-religious dialogue. If American life, in a certain way, remedied Tillich from his European intellectual provincialism, his authentic experience of Christian-Buddhist dialogue probably redeemed him from *religious* provincialism. Then, if inter-religious dialogue was Tillich's final place in his lifelong theological journey, in what way did Tillich finish it? To what extent was his pneumatology employed in completing this project?

28 For this view I am indebted to Professor Pan-chiu LAI's analysis.

2.6.1 "New" Systematic Theology?

After the publication of volume three of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich participated in a course entitled "history of religions" with Mircea Eliade in Chicago from 1963 – 65, and presented his well-known last public lecture on "The Significance of the History of Religions for the Systematic Theologian" (1965); this lecture was commonly regarded as not only the final testimony of Tillich's theological journey, but also as a sketching of a *new* theological construction.[29] However, is it really totally new? In what sense was it for Tillich a new start? This section argues that this so-called "new" consideration is not totally absent within Tillich's intellectual development. At least, we can probably trace some indicators in his early essay on Schelling (1910) and some earlier articulations when Tillich expressed the idea of theology as *theonome Systematik* in his *System of Sciences* (1923); even this topic (theology and the history of religion) was slightly mentioned in his volume one of *Systematic Theology* (1951). However, it is definitely "new" in a sense that pneumatology would be probably the underlying regulating principle operating in his "final" solution, and this had never been expressed explicitly by Tillich before.

Tillich's first attempt at conceiving the problem of the history of religion was found in his early thesis on Schelling, *The Construction of the History of Religion in Schelling's Positive Philosophy* (1910). Victor Nuovo pointed out the similarity between Tillich's early articulation of Schelling's idea of the history of religion and his last description of this problem (Nuovo 1974: 26 – 32). For Tillich, Schelling neither accepted the Hegelian dialectical process of the absolute Spirit through which the absoluteness of Christianity was entitled, nor asserted the "supernatural" distinctiveness of Christian religion grounded by revelation. Schelling understood "history is essentially history of religion", and the beginning of history is the idea of the Fall (Tillich 1910: 77). Schelling packaged the whole historical process under the potency of God through which the dialectical construction of the history of religion was presented. The pre-historical stages were ruled by the first potency; the mythological age was the struggle between the first and the second potency; the final stage was anticipated with the pres-

29 This view was clearly expressed by Mircea Eliade's comment, " ...In the course of that superb and moving lecture, Prof. Tillich declared that, had he time, he would write a new Systematic Theology oriented toward, and in dialogue with, the whole history of religions ... At a certain moment during our joint seminar, I thought that Paul Tillich was in the process of elaborating a theology of History of Religions. But very soon I realized that his mind was working in another direction. What he was accomplishing in our unforgettable evenings was a *renewal of his own Systematic Theology* " (Eliade 1966: 31 – 33).

ence of the third potency. These three stages of religious history were closely related with three potencies of God, and Tillich seemed to re-build this threefold structure as the three elements of the "Religion of the Concrete Spirit" (sacramental, prophetic and mystical). Schelling's Trinitarian structure of God is profoundly disclosed within the dialectical tension founded in nature and human consciousness. For Tillich, Schelling understood God as the perfect spirit; "he is spirit, inasmuch as he includes within himself the triad of his mode of being, and he is perfect spirit because he is free from each one of these three forms. He is not even bound to the third" (Ibid.: 61).[30] It seems that Schelling, like Tillich, located pneumatology as the unifying principle for integrating the content of history and the Christ,[31] as well as maintaining the tension (balance) of the universal manifestation and the concrete particularity. Tillich asserted, for Schelling, " ... the third potency ... refers to the Johannine testimony of the coming of the Spirit after the glorification of the Son ... The unity of the universal and the individual in the Trinitarian personalities could give all three potencies a mythological character ... In the idea, the *antithesis of abstract universal and concrete individual is overcome* ... the absolute idea is the identity of the absolute universal and the absolute individual" (Ibid.: 153. Emphasis mine). Pneumatology, for Schelling and Tillich, is regarded as the unity of universality and individuality. This pneumatological universal-individual matrix reappears in Tillich's later articulation on the theology of the religions.

As mentioned in (2.2.), between 1919 – 1923, Tillich had sketched an outline of the scientific understanding of theology located within the structure of human science (*Geisteswissenschaften*) in particular, and science in general (*Wissenschaften*). According to Tillich, there are three divisions in each subject of human sciences: philosophy (aims at clarifying the nature and characteristics of the subject); spiritual/cultural history (demonstrates the typology of historical manifestation of the subject); and systematics (normative articulation of the subject combining the previous two parts) (Tillich 1919: 157). Therefore, the threefold framework of "philosophy-spiritual history-systematics" formally constitutes his understanding of theology. However, Tillich never actualized this project, except partially fulfilling the task in elaborating the "philosophy" of religion in his long essay entitled as "The Philosophy of Religion" (1923) and the *systematics* of religion (theology) in Marburg (1925). Obviously, the middle part of the original

30 This understanding of God as Spirit is perfectly matched with Tillich's later articulation of God as Living and Spirit in volume one of *Systematic Theology.*

31 "This is the content of all of history: the work of Christ, namely, to sacrifice his natural being in order to find himself again in spirit and in truth; this is the content of history because it is the essence of Spirit" (Tillich 1910: 111).

planning (spiritual history) remained undeveloped in Tillich's German period. Under his original construction, the "philosophy" element attempts to articulate the formal basic structure of the subject, religion; and the "systematics" element aims at providing the normative articulation of religious substance from a concrete standpoint. Therefore, the middle part, the history of culture/religion, is designed to *bridge* between the former philosophical side and the latter normative side of theology. In early Tillich, it is clear, but in a subtle way, that the universal history of religions and cultures is essential in articulating a theological project in a sense that it provides the material content for a theologian to substantiate the formal and the normative consideration on one hand, and also plays a role in balancing the universal-ontological elements (philosophy) and the revelation claims (systematics) on the other. Therefore, we can assert that the theme of the history of religions in Tillich's last lecture is not totally new during his intellectual development, but is clearly formally demonstrated in his early writings. In addition, one thing should be noted that distinguishes between the concept of the "history of culture/religion" in his early phase and the last lecture. What in early Tillich's mind was mainly regarded as "*Geistesgeschichte*" (spiritual history) in which several ideas in the light of history are presented without emphasis on the details of historical fact. Those particular and concrete world religions remained unnoticed in early Tillich.

The theme of the history of religion re-appeared in the part on the "sources" of Tillich's volume one of *Systematic Theology* (1951). The inclusive (contrast with the exclusive) attitude towards the sources of doing theology had already been mentioned in that part. In rejecting a heteronomous character for all sorts of revelatory claims, Tillich emphasized the experiential-participation elements of the biblical writers whose "participation was their response to the happenings which became revealing events through this response" (Tillich 1951: 35). Interestingly, Tillich asserted that the reason why the materials contained in the Bible should be regarded as the source of theology is *not* based on its historical documentation, but rather on the *pneumatic* power manifested through a historical-philological exegesis. Once again, the historical findings through the historical-critical method in biblical studies or church history are not Tillich's main concern; however, theologians can use all those materials *freely* based on its relation with the ultimate concern (Ibid.: 36). According to Tillich, nothing should be in principle or *a priori* exclusive from the ultimate concern in theologizing. Positively speaking, all beings are made available to the systematic theologian through a critical and ultimate concerned way.

Back to the history of religion, Tillich mentioned two distinctive reasons why a systematic theologian should take it seriously: practical and polemical-constructive reasons. Theology and theological thinking are always context-laden

and those expressions in cultural, religious and secular realms "in which he has grown up and from which he takes some content in every moment of his life, in his theological work and also outside" (Ibid.: 38). This practical way raises the questions of how and to what purpose should material be selected. Tillich directed us to another three considerations. First,

> a theological history of religion should interpret theologically the material produced by the investigation and analysis of the pre-religious and religious life of mankind. It should elaborate the motives and types of religious expression, showing how they follow from the nature of the religious concern and therefore necessarily appear in all religions, including Christianity in so far as it is a religion (Ibid.: 39).

Second, "a theological history of religion also point[s] out demonic distortions and new tendencies in the religions of the world, pointing to the Christian solution and preparing the way for the acceptance of the Christian message by the adherents of the non-Christian religions" (Ibid.). Last, "a theological history of religion should be carried through in the light of the missionary principle that the New Being in Jesus as the Christ is the answer to the question asked implicitly and explicitly by the religions of mankind" (Ibid.). For a theologian, the history of religion should be understood under the topology provided by the ontological expression of the essence of religion. This operation is analogous to the relationship between the "philosophy" elements and "spiritual history" elements in early Tillich. Also, history of religion is polemical in providing the materials concerning the existential question (questions) in order to point to receiving the Christian message (answers). Finally, the "question-answer" correlational mechanism, still functioning within a strictly *Christological*-orientated theology, should be noticed.

We can conclude that the problem of the history of religion is by no means a "new" topic for Tillich; rather the location and the function provided by the history of religion *was* determined by his very earlier theological construction. However, we should bear in mind that the phrase of the "history of religions" (plural!), which appeared in Tillich's last lecture, is essentially *different* from the previous one. The latter is concerned with the history of some particular and concrete living religions, while the former is still the abstraction (though material-based) from the presumption of the formal structure of the essence of religion.

2.6.2 Pneumatology as the Final Answer

As shown before (2.2.–2.3.), Tillich's overall systematic construction of theology had undergone a "shift" from a Christological to a pneumatological orientation.

This is not a "turn" because we find that Tillich had employed the doctrine of the Holy Spirit in volume three to reconceive and respond to the problem of Christology created in volumes one and two. The fundamental and unchanged premise is still in the matrix of "universality-particularity" which was still the underlying principle in Tillich's last lecture. This section argues that Tillich's pneumatology played an essential role in his last attempt at the *way* of the theology of the history of religions.[32]

Undoubtedly, the universal presence of the Holy in everything finite is emphasized in Tillich's volume three of *Systematic Theology*. Thus, in Tillich's last lecture, "The Significance of the History of Religions for the Systematic Theologian", exclusive Christocentricism is absolutely rejected not because the particularity of the Christological claim should be abandoned, but because it has the danger of reductionism in which the scope and the boundary of revelatory experience would be narrowed and limited within a certain sphere. Therefore, to affirm the value of the "history of religions" is to affirm the universal revelatory experience within humankind but it is always received in a distorted form. Therefore, no religion, including Christianity, can claim to be the absolute, highest and final (Tillich 1963c: 81). Likewise, Tillich started to doubt whether one single center of the history of religions exists.[33] This center should function as a concrete historical embodiment of the Divine with universal validity in human history. In order to maintain the polar tension between universality and particularity, Tillich even pushed his hard criticism towards all types of Jesusology in which universal significance seems distorted (Ibid.: 83). Facing the impact of the validity of those historical religions, if the revelation, salvation and empowerment are interpenetrated as Tillich claimed, the only way is to universalize the center (if any). That means, within Tillich's system, *the pneumatological revelatory experience is universally present and manifested as the New Being, which was historically and particularly embodied in Jesus as the Christ*.

Even in volume one of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich had already claimed the end of Jesusology when the historical particularity of the man Jesus is merely regarded as the bearer of the final revelation and the finality of revelation is pro-

32 Veli-Matti Kärkkäinen had noticed the relationship between Tillich's pneumatology and his last lecture on the theology of the history of religions. However, he classified the dynamic-typological theology of religions of Tillich's "Religion of Concrete Spirit" as essentially Christocentric; he contended that it "betrays a definite pneumatological orientation" (Kärkkäinen 2003: 231). Obviously, this study disagrees with this interpretation and argues that Christology and pneumatology both function in Tillich's theology of religions.

33 Tillich said, " ... there may be – I stress this, there *may* be – a central event in the history of religions ..." (Tillich 1963c: 81).

foundly and authentically seen through *sacrificing the whole finite particularity of the historical Jesus* (Tillich 1951: 132–134). Authentic final revelation embodies two interrelated perspectives: an abstract principle and a concrete picture (Ibid.: 135). The former is the idea of the transparency which denotes "the question of a medium of revelation which overcome its own finite conditions by sacrificing them" (Ibid.: 133). The latter pictures and actualizes the former principle in a historical and concrete way. Therefore, for Tillich, Jesus as the Christ as the final revelation is utterly and paradoxically determined by *the negation of all his historical particularity.*[34] "Jesus of Nazareth is the medium of the final revelation because he sacrifices himself completely to Jesus as the Christ" (Ibid.: 136). As Tillich emphasized, the unbroken unity of Jesus with the ground of his being and the transparent medium of historical Jesus, these two criteria of the finality of divine revelation are parallel with the divine pneumatological presence without distortion in Jesus as the Christ whose self-sacrificial love and faith are the creation of the divine Spirit.[35] That is the reason why, from volume one to three, Tillich strongly rejected all kinds of Jesusology, which claims the man historical Jesus as the object of Christian faith.

Likewise, the "universal-particular" embodiment should be coupled with theological criticism. All living religions should manifest the prophetic criticism in order to critique the distorted divine embodiments in the history of religions. In the overcoming of the demonization of all religions, self-criticism must always be constituted from the outside (secularity) and the inside (prophetic attack). In the process of fulfilling the inner *telos* and attacking the inner demonization of all religions, the identification of the concrete historical religions with the Ultimate is rejected and anticipated within the framework of pneumatology. In his last lecture, Tillich called this eschatological ultimate *telos* and universal em-

34 In volume one of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich emphasized that Jesus as the Christ is not grounded by his particular-historical words, deeds and even sufferings. All these are merely the consequences of the divine presence in him. "[I]t is never a moral, intellectual, or emotional quality which makes him the bearer of the final revelation … it is the presence of God in him which makes him the Christ. His words, his deeds, and his sufferings are consequences of this presence" (Tillich 1951: 135–136).

35 The historical Jesus, for Tillich, is never the basis of the Christian faith. Rather, Tillich's Christology is utterly based on the negation of the historical particularity manifested in the power of Spiritual Presence to emphasize the Jesus as *the Christ*. From this perspective, the difference between Tillich and Schleiermacher should be well noticed, as Tillich mentioned. "Schleiermacher's God-consciousness has an anthropological character. The term *Urbild* when used for Jesus as the Christ does not have the decisive implication of the term 'New Being'" (Tillich 1957: 150). The problem of Schleiermacher's Christology, for Tillich, reserves the original image of the essential human as the historical Jesus instead of the Christ.

bodiment as "The Religion of the Concrete Spirit" which integrates the three dynamic elements: sacramental, prophetic and mystical, with each religion embodying these three elements with different degrees. In Tillich's volume three of *Systematic Theology*, all these dynamic elements are closely linked with pneumatological determination: the *sacramentality* of the finite forms and beings is confirmed by the universal presence of the Holy Spirit; the personal *mystical* experience is grasped by the manifestation of the Spiritual Presence manifested in faith and love; and the *prophetic* self-criticism presented in the Protestant principle is transformed as the pneumatological *gestalt* in which form-creating and form-criticism are combined. For Tillich, all religions, including Christianity, are historically committed into religious ambiguity in the quest for the self-transcendence of the spirit. From the standpoint of the dialectical union of acceptance and rejection with all the tensions and ambiguity towards other non-Christian religions presented in his Bampton lectures, Tillich asserted, in his last lecture, that all religions would be involved in the dynamic struggle for the sake of fulfilling the ultimate *telos* under the structure of the Religion of the Concrete Spirit (Tillich 1963c: 90).

The above understanding of a theology of historical religion is fundamentally vertical instead of having a horizontal orientation. In volume three of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich clearly and strongly rejected all types of an evolutionary-progressive approach in general, and the Hegelian philosophical framework of the history of religion in particular. In the question of whether Christianity is the absolute religion, Tillich reformulated the question as to whether it is possible to affirm the revelatory experience, the foundations of religions, to have progressive possibilities (Tillich 1963: 337). Tillich's answer is yes and no. Under the impact of the Spiritual Presence, the genuine substance of divine empowerment and embodiment are not in a horizontal process. However, the empirical manifestations and numerous symbolic expressions of the cultural dimensions of religions are conditioned by the totality of the internal and external factors, which constitutes the destiny of historical progress. "Progress in this respect is possible between different cultural stages in which the revelatory experience takes place or between degrees of clarity and power with which the manifestation of the Spiritual is received" (Ibid.). Therefore, no religion can have the absolute claim; what remains is the struggle of the divine and demonic shared by all religions. Once again, Tillich recalled the ultimate critical power, the Protestant principle manifesting in the event of Jesus as the Christ, to overcome the divine-demonic matrix in every religion. We can conclude that, for the question of the absoluteness of Christianity, the historical manifestation of the Spiritual Presence cooperates with the prophetic power of Jesus as the Christ in relativizing the absoluteness of a particular historical religion and directs

the discussion towards the conquest of the ambiguity of religion. Pneumatology and Christology are the two complementary operators in Tillich's theology of the history of religions.[36]

In *The Dialectic of the Holy*, Robert Meditz rightly noticed that, in Tillich's theology of the history of religion, it is correct for Tillich to "balance a positive valuation of universal revelation with a critical assessment" (Meditz 2016:172). This means that the pneumatological-universal divine revelation and Christological-particular criterion constitute the material elements of Tillich's framework of theology of the history of religion. However, Meditz's argument is problematic in that it overemphasizes the "non-Christocentric" character of Tillich's religion of the concrete spirit, even though he rightly concludes that Tillich's position was against the reductionist, Jesus-centric orthodox-exclusive and secular-rejective approaches to theology (Ibid.:173). As this chapter shows, in his later period, Tillich tried to maintain the dialectical relationship between universal and particular divine revelation. This theological tension does slightly force him to doubt the possibility of the central event of divine revelation in history (Christology); and it seems that Tillich's final solution is to assert the possibility of numerous central events with the particular embodiment of pneumatological creation of the New Being. Under the impact of pneumatology, it is hard to assert that Tillich's theology of religions is still merely Christocentric. However, as the previous part of this chapter shows, although Tillich did shift his theological focus from Christology to pneumatology, he never accepted *pneuma*-centricism in order to abandon the New Being manifested in Jesus as the Christ in his later period. The symbol of the New Being, without emphasizing the historical particularity in Jesus created by the Holy Spirit, is still maintained and the universal dimension of the New Being is emphasized through the empowerment of the impact of the Holy Spirit.

In his essay, "Tillich's Theology of the Concrete Spirit", Frederick Parrella also noticed the internal problem of Tillich's balance matrix of "universality-particularity" and the external problem of the relationship between Christianity and other religions under the concept of the "Concrete Spirit." Parrella asked:

> has Tillich abandoned the Christocentric structure of his Systematic Theology for a kind of relativism where there 'may be' a central event in the history of religions that 'makes possible a concrete theology that has universalistic significance?' This approach appears to stand in contrast to the uniqueness and the universality of the Christ-event in his second volume and the reality of Jesus the Christ as the final revelation in the first volume. Second-

36 Tony Richie also noticed that the Christological criterion and pneumatological presence are the two keys for Tillich in developing a healthy theology of religions. See his essay (Richie 2015:146).

> ly, what is the relationship of his treatment of the divine Spirit in volume III to volume I and II, and to the religion of the concrete Spirit?" (Parrella 2009: 87).

Frederick Parrella is one of the few Tillichian scholars who had noticed the internal tension of universality and particularity engendered by the universal presence of the Holy Spirit and the particular revelation manifested in Jesus Christ, and how the significance of this tension endangers the relationship between Christianity and other religions in Tillich's entire system. This chapter can be viewed as an attempt to answer Parrella's above question in a direct way, despite his own answer being "no clear answers exist[s]" (Ibid.). In contrast, I suggest, the answer does exist but in a subtle way. The question of the particularity of Jesus as the Christ manifested in the New Being is relocated and reinterpreted into the framework of the universality of the Spiritual Presence. *Pneumatology fulfills Christology in a universal way, Christology grounds pneumatology in a concrete way.* Tillich's final solution points to a Trinitarian framework in which God as Spirit embraces the three modes of the Godhead which was mentioned in his earlier thesis on Schelling, presented in his volume one and anticipated in his volume three. Under the pneumatological-eschatological framework, the *telos* of all beings (all religions) would be fulfilled in the symbol of the Kingdom of God, which is also a symbol with a profoundly universal character and with an embracing power. As Tillich's final sentence in his last lecture asserts, "the universality of a religious statement does not lie in an all-embracing abstraction which would destroy religion as such, but it lies in the depths of every concrete religion" (Tillich 1963c: 94).

In concluding this chapter, Tillich clearly demonstrated the dominant position of pneumatology in his final phase of theological development in which two decisive doctrines, Christology and pneumatology, are functioning to represent the principle of universality and particularity which is examined as the focus of Tillich's entire system. Although Tillich never described his theology as pneumatological in method and in nature, this chapter has argued that the problem of theological epistemology, method of theology, theology of culture, church theology and theology of religions all reach a new vision under the emergence of pneumatology. The balance matrix of Christology and pneumatology in Tillich's later consideration plays such an important role in expressing the divine universal embodiment and particular criterion for manifesting the divine revelation in different realms of life.

3 Spirit and the World

Introduction

This chapter mainly focuses on Tillich's idea of pneumatology in which the role of the Holy Spirit is designed to correlate with the ambiguity of the multi-dimensional unity of life. In volume three of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich expanded on his ontological articulation of the being of God and of the world into a pneumatological perspective. Following the basic principle of Schelling's philosophy of identity and non-identity, Tillich, first, maintained the dialectical unity of God and the world in which supernaturalist and naturalist understandings are both rejected and transcended. Spiritual Presence is ultimately located in the matrix of the sacramentality of the world and the self-transcending of nature (3.3.2 – 3.3.3). Second, Tillich's pneumatology, following his early effort in connecting the Protestant critical principle and the Catholic sacramental principle, manifests the critical prophetic attack (prophetic Spirit) and immanent empowerment in the manifestation of the Holy Spirit (3.3.3.2). Third, based on the discussion of chapter two, we find that the above theological assertions are strongly and profoundly grounded in Tillich's interplay between Christology and pneumatology. Also, in this chapter, several important philosophical-theological resources of Tillich's pneumatology are explored. This chapter illustrates the basic ideas of Spirit-movement and theologies of experience, which include medieval and German mysticism, radical reformers and Schleiermacher (3.1.). Last, this chapter also explores the discussion of F.W.J. Schelling and Tillich to see how the idealistic framework influences the latter.

3.1 Spirit-Movements and Theologies of Experience

Tillich's ideas can be traced back to different, even rival and contradictory, traditions in which the commonality of all these elements can be easily found. Even though Tillich had mentioned diverse and numerous intellectual resources of his philosophical-theological thought on different occasions, it seems that he seldom talked about which tradition he was inspired by in constructing his pneumatology, except one sentence found in volume three of *Systematic Theology*. Tillich confessed his ideas of pneumatology, expressing that his systematic theology "is essentially, but indirectly, influenced by the Spirit-movements, both through their impact on Western culture in general (including such theologians as Schleiermacher) and through their criticisms of the established forms of religious

https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110612752-004

life and thought" (Tillich 1963: 126). No further texts and no figures (except Schleiermacher) are provided for a clear and distinct definition of what is meant by "Spirit-movements", except that Tillich himself had slightly touched on the debate between Lutheran/ Reformed traditions and the radical reformers on the problem of the freedom of the Spirit. Therefore, except for the radical reformers, we have no clear indication to confirm other traditions of the Spirit movements.[1] As chapter two shows, in his "introduction" of volume one of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich had already discussed the problem of the relationship between the Holy Spirit and human experience in the period of the Reformation.[2] However, in Tillich's mind, the term "Spirit-movements" embraces a rather broader and diverse meaning that, I think, includes all those theologies, spiritual and mystical traditions, which belong to "theologies of experience" as Tillich called them.[3]

It is not arbitrary to locate the Spirit-movements as part of the theologies of experience. It seems that, for Tillich, these two traditions overlap each other. In Tillich's classification, the theology of Augustine, the early Franciscan order, Bonaventura, evangelical enthusiasts and Schleiermacher, all share several characteristics: spiritual-mystical experience as one of the main sources of theology, the immediate awareness of the divine in human souls and other realms, the universal presence of Spiritual power, and the dynamic immanence of the divine. This means that, for Tillich, these figures and traditions are claiming that: "Experi-

1 It seems that, in Tillich's usage, "Spirit-movements" strictly indicated the radical reformers in the Reformation. However, this term is very vague. At least, it covers the Franciscan order and German mysticism. "When the Franciscan theologians of the thirteenth century insisted on the divine character of the principle of truth in the human mind or when German mystics of the fourteenth century insisted on the Logos' presence in the soul, *they expressed motifs of the Spirit-movements of past and future*" (Tillich 1963:126. Emphasis mine).

2 "For the Reformers, experience was not a source of revelation. The divine Spirit testifies in us to the biblical message. No new revelations are given by the Spirit. Nothing new is mediated by the experience of the Spirit power in us. Evangelical enthusiasm ... derived new revelations from the presence of the Spirit. The experience of the man who has the Spirit is the source of religious truth and therefore of systematic theology" (Tillich 1951: 45).

3 In volume three of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich employed the term "theologies of experience" to describe the whole western Christian tradition which emphasized the new manifestation of the Spiritual Presence and the close relationship between the work of Christ and of the Holy Spirit. "Every new manifestation of the Spiritual Presence stands under the criterion of his manifestation in Jesus as the Christ. This is a criticism of the claim of old and new Spirit theologies, which teach that the revelatory work of the Spirit qualitatively transcends that of the Christ. The Montanists, the radical Franciscans, and the Anabaptists are examples of this attitude. *The "theologies of experience" in our time belong to the same line of thought*" (Tillich 1963: 148. Emphasis mine).

ence as the inspiring presence of the Spirit is the ultimate source of theology" (Tillich 1951: 45). The Spirit-indwelling experience should be regarded as the main focus of the Spirit-movements and the theologies of experience. Thus, all those commonalities shared by these different figures in the theologies of experience are also regarded as Tillich's own theological construction, which is occasionally called "the ontological approach of God".[4] In his article, "The Two Types of Philosophy of Religion", Tillich distinguished two approaches for philosophical theologies, ontological and cosmological, which were originally established in the medieval period. For Tillich, most of the philosophical-theological problems in particular and the complex relationship between Christianity and culture in general are profoundly located and linked with these two alternatives. Also, the ontological approach, manifested in the so-called "Plato-Augustine-Franciscan" tradition, emphasizes the following points: "*Deus ist esse*", the immediate awareness of the divine in the human mind, and the mystical experience of the identity of subject and object in theological epistemology (Tillich 1946a: 11–15).[5] In the following, the theologies of experience in general and Spirit-movements in particular will be divided into three groups: medieval and German mysticism, radical reformers and Schleiermacher, in which the intellectual sources of Tillich's pneumatology can be demonstrated.

3.1.1 Medieval and German Mysticism

The basic meaning of the word, mysticism, refers to "the immediate union with God in his presence" (Tillich 1967a: 136). When Tillich packaged the main spirits of the Medieval Ages, scholasticism, mysticism and the biblical studies are linked. "The basis of the dogma was unity with the divine in devotion, prayer, contemplation, and ascetic practices" (Ibid.). Theology and spirituality were

4 Tillich employed several names to refer to this tradition: "ontological type", "mystical type", "the type of immediacy", and "theonomous type" (Tillich 1967a: 185).

5 In his article, "The Two Types of Philosophies of Religion", Tillich distinguished the ontological approach – which was established as the "Augustine-Franciscan" tradition – and the cosmological approach, which was expressed in Thomist tradition. The question of whether Tillich's theology belonged to the ontological or cosmological is beyond the scope of this study, even though the ontological elements are more evident in my study. John Dourley's intensive study provided sufficient arguments to justify my conviction; see (Dourley 1975). However, Donald J. Keefe, S.J. found many similarities of formal systematic structure and material content of theological substance between Tillich's system and the Thomist system; see (Keefe 1971). When I assert that Tillich's theology of experience is ontological in nature, it does not imply that Tillich agrees with Plato, Augustine and Bonaventura without reservation.

closely linked together in the Middle Ages and this mystical tradition was shared by different thinkers. As Tillich emphasized: "We have the more mystical point of view in Plato, Augustine, Bonaventura, and the Franciscans ..." (Tillich 1967a: 141). First, despite Tillich disagreeing with the dualistic framework of Platonic and Augustine's ideas in which the separation between human souls and reality in existence is achieved, the concept of union in an ontological and epistemological sense in these two thinkers inspired Tillich's own ontological structure of knowledge.

> Neo-Platonism also gave Augustine the basis for his interpretation of the relationship of God and the world; God is creative ground of the world in terms of *amor* ... he [Augustine] turned the meaning of Neo-Platonism into its opposite. Neo-Platonism was a negative philosophy, a philosophy of escape from the world. The elevation of the soul out of the material world into the ultimate is the meaning of Neo-Platonism. Augustine changed this emphasis; he dropped the idea of degrees, and instead *used Neo-Platonism for the immediate experience of the divine in everything, but especially in his soul*" (Tillich 1967a: 109. Emphasis mine).

In Augustine, the mystical experience of the divine in every soul is mentioned and the immanence of the divine should be interpreted as the *prius* of all goodness and truth. Being-itself is the identity of subject and object and an element of non-identity must be presupposed in the identity (Tillich 1946a: 14–15). Thus, the ontological structure of knowledge as the unity of the union and separation, and the dynamic structure of the divine as being and non-being are basically determined in the Augustine's ideas.

Following the line of Augustine, Tillich also highly appreciated the theology of experience in the early Franciscan order, especially Bonaventura (ca.1217–74). The struggle between the Dominicans and the Augustinian-Franciscan tradition can be regarded as the peak of the high Middle Ages. For Tillich, Bonaventura suggested a type of theonomous knowledge in which the boundary between divine knowledge and secular knowledge are blurred because "all knowledge is in some way rooted in the knowledge of the divine within us. There is a point of identity in our soul, and this point precedes every special act of knowledge" (Tillich 1967a: 185). The idea of God is not something to be proved to a conclusion but is prior to all conclusions and makes them possible. God is the light (divine light), which is the *transcendentalia* out of which we find truth in the empirical world.[6] God is not an object which the human argument can justify for or against. Therefore, under this immediate awareness of the presence of the divine,

6 For Tillich, this inner light doctrine affects the sectarian movements in different periods, and the Reformation, even in the rationalism of the Enlightenment (Tillich 1967a: 185).

the Augustine-Bonaventura tradition can recognize the divine presence in the universe and the culture.

Also, for Tillich, another influential figure is Joachim of Floris (ca.1130 – 1202). The spirit of Joachim's idea of pneumatological understanding of history had a profound significance for the different movements that followed, taking his ideas in several directions. According to Tillich, the extreme Franciscans, the sectarian movements in the Reformation, some philosophers of the Enlightenment, and the socialist movements, in a different sense adopted the revolutionary-progressive-utopian thinking of Joachim. The radical pneumatology of Joachim links the Trinitarian God with historical development and conceives the Holy Spirit as fully participating in the end of the world. Pneumatology and eschatology link together in the platform of historical development. Joachim of Floris provided a Trinitarian interpretation of history in which "the dynamic element which is always implied in Trinitarian theology has become horizontal, transferred to the movement of history" (Tillich 1967a: 178). In contrast with the interpretation claiming Joachim was committed into the Sabellianist heresy, Tillich, first, highly appreciated Joachim's idea of the dynamic concept of truth, which provided a higher criterion against Church authority. Church authority has its relative validity under the third period of historical development dominated by the Holy Spirit (Ibid.:179). Second, in Joachim's idea of the Spirit, there is something new in history. "In the third stage there will be perfection, contemplation, liberty and Spirit" (Ibid.). The functions of all mediated institutions between God and human beings will come to an end. Therefore, third, God will be all in all eschatologically. The presence of the divine Spirit in all beings is complete.

Last, Tillich derived much inspiration from the German mystic, Meister Eckhart who "was the most important representative of German mysticism" (Ibid.: 202). Compared with Tillich's Trinitarian principle of God as three different modes of God, Eckhart also distinguished between the divinity and God. For him, "the divinity is the ground of being in which everything moves and counter-moves. God is essential, the principle of the good and true. From this he can even develop the idea of the trinity" (Ibid.). Eckhart also understood the movement of God in three principles in which "the first principle is the being which is neither born nor giving birth; the second is the process of self-objectivation, the Logos, the Son; the third is the self-generation, the Spirit, which creates all individual things" (Ibid.). Tillich and Eckhart perceived the interchange between Being-itself and God who is always moving forward and backward. "The Trinity is based on God's going out and returning back to himself. He re-cognizes himself, he re-sees himself, and this constitutes the Logos" (Ibid.). Besides, the identity of God and the world is also emphasized. God's revelation in Jesus Christ is

located within human souls in which the generation of the Son and the eternal creation of the world are the same.[7]

3.1.2 Radical Reformers

Another theological source of Tillich's pneumatology originally came from the conflict between radical reformers and other reformers on the issue of the immediacy of the presence of the Spirit on one hand, and the relationship between Christ and the Spirit on the other. These two questions are closely related because they point to the question of the scope and nature of the freedom of the Spirit.

For Tillich, the evangelical radicals emphasized the presence of the Holy Spirit in the human mind instead of biblical writings. However, Luther is more focused on the objective-historical revelation in the Scriptures instead of the innermost center of human subjectivity. In this sense, the radical reformers seemed to place more emphasis on the openness and the freedom of the Spirit who can work according to her own will. That is also the reason why Tillich appreciated Zwingli in that he "had a fully developed doctrine of the Spirit" (Tillich 1967a: 257). Because Zwingli, for Tillich, expressed "God can give truth, through the Spirit, in non-Christians also". Tillich concluded that "the truth is given to every individual always through the Holy Spirit, and this Spirit is present even if the word of the Bible is not present" (Ibid.). For Tillich, the debate between Luther and the evangelical radicals is easily misinterpreted as an "either-or" question, which is formulated either that the work of the Spirit should be subordinated under the message of Christ as Luther believed, or the Spirit can reveal something new which is beyond the biblical message which is the radical reformers' concern.

If Luther and Calvin distinguished the work of the Holy Spirit as the inner testimony of the Word of God and the biblical writings as the outer testimony of the Word of God, Tillich would be disappointed with the way that the magisterial reformers intended to limit the Spiritual power within objective biblical lit-

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7 Tillich said, "The world is in God in an archetypical sense ... The essence, the archetypes of everything, are in the depth of the divine ... Therefore, the generation of the Son and the eternal creation of the world in God himself are one and the same thing ... The creature, including man, had reality only in union with the eternal reality ... The depths of the soul in which this happens Eckhart called the 'spark', or the innermost center of the soul, the heart of the soul, or the castle of the soul ... In this way the Son is born in every soul. This universal event is more important than the particular birth of Jesus" (Ibid.).

eral meanings. This is because, for Tillich, the Holy Spirit works within the boundary of the biblical words, but is not limited by the literal meanings of them. Therefore, Tillich preferred to talk about the Holy Spirit as the Word-creating Spirit instead of Word-witnessing Spirit. The "new" element and the creative work of the Holy Spirit in creating the Word of God is not related to a quantitative sense, but is related to the multifaceted and deep meanings inspired by the embodiment of the Holy Spirit. In volume three of *Systematic Theology*, when Tillich stated clearly his standpoint in explaining the meaning of "Word of God", he shifted his attention from the divine *Logos* to Spirit-determined language in which the Spiritual Presence overcomes the subject-objective dichotomy (Tillich 1963: 255 – 256).

> In theonomy, language is fragmentarily liberated from the bondage to the subject-object scheme. It reaches moments in which it becomes a bearer of the Spirit expressing the union of him who speaks with that of which he speaks in an act of linguistic self-transcendence. The word which bears the Spirit does not grip an object opposite to the speaking subject, but it witnesses to the sublimity of life beyond subject and object ... Here we are at the point where the term 'Word of God' receives its *final justification and characterization*. Word of God is the Spirit-determined human word. As such it is not bound to a particular revelatory event ... it is not bound to religion in the narrow sense of the term ... it is not tied up with a special content or a special form (Ibid.: 253 – 354. Emphasis mine).

If the biblical literature is regarded as the "Word of God", Tillich regarded the "Word of God" in a more general and universal sense that all kinds of human language are qualified as the word of God if it becomes the bearer of the Holy Spirit. No empirical, practical, and secular limitations are able to limit the work of the Holy Spirit in creating divine words. Therefore, the words are manifesting God's power, and revelation is not determined by the doctrinal assertions from some religious authorities, but is conditioned by the presence of the Holy Spirit. Tillich clearly stated that "they [all human languages] can become the Word of God, if they become mediators of the Spirit and have the power to grasp the human spirit. This applies both positively and negatively to biblical as well as to all other literature" (Ibid.: 124). The normal and original structure and meaning of human language are maintained and transcended into a theonomous-pneumatological union.

If the Holy Spirit speaks in and through human linguistic mediums, this implies that an objective-external bearer is necessary for the Spiritual Presence. The Holy Spirit cannot work in a vacuum. Therefore, the problem of the mediations of the Holy Spirit distinguishes Tillich's position from the radical reformers' ideas, even though the latter largely influenced Tillich's pneumatology. According to Tillich, in order to liberate Christian faith from all kinds of authority, radical re-

formers attacked the Pope of the Catholic Church and the Bible in the name of the Spirit. They insisted: "The Spiritual Presence breaks through the established Word and the established sacrament" (Ibid.: 125). The Spirit dwells in the depth of human souls directly and completely. Therefore, for the radical reformers, the human inwardness is the space of "inner word" of the Holy Spirit. It seems that Tillich had reservations about the idea of the inner word for the word "inner" carries an unfavorable spatial imagery in which the dichotomy between the outer and inner is built. For Tillich, the Spirit always works through a medium and the tradition of language.

> When the enthusiasts of the Reformation period expressed the "inner word" they had received in their language, it was the word of the Bible, of the tradition, and of the reformers, but illuminated by their own experience of the Spiritual Presence. By this light they gained insight into the social situation of the lowest classes in their society and further insights into the Spirit's freedom to work in the personal life over against ecclesiastical and biblical heteronomy (Ibid.: 127).

For the question of the work of Christ and the Holy Spirit, Tillich, who is actually quite sympathetic with the evangelical radicals, considered that neither did the evangelical radicals intend to isolate Jesus Christ from the Holy Spirit, nor single out the dominant role of the Holy Spirit in God's revelation and in Christian life. Without the Spirit, Christ is blind; without Christ, the Spirit is empty. This underlying principle of Tillich's pneumatological-Christological perspective also comes from the basic conviction of the radical reformers. Tillich believed that the work of Christ and of the Spirit is highly related and should not be disconnected. Following the understanding of Joachim, the Spirit for the radical reformer is also "the Spirit of the Son who rules the second period and of the Father who rules the first period" (Tillich 1951: 45). The most important reminder is that the Spirit will bring the third new period into being. Even though the radical reformer's radical aspects of the role and the work of the Holy Spirit profoundly inspired Tillich's position, he did not want to be too extreme. Spirit and Christ always work together. In order to emphasize the interplay between Christology and pneumatology, Tillich strongly complained that it is theologically unsound for the magisterial reformers to regard the uniqueness of the Christ-revelation as identical with a forensic doctrine of justification by faith. The main weakness for the magisterial reformers is that "the Spiritual Presence's impact was replaced by an intellectual acknowledgment of the doctrine of forgiveness by grace alone" (Tillich 1963: 128). In over-emphasizing *sola scriptura*, the pneumatological embodiment and empowerment are easily reduced as the action of establishing a conviction of the literal truth of the biblical words, which contradicts the nature of the Holy Spirit.

3.1.3 Schleiermacher

Chapter two indicates that Tillich and Schleiermacher both agreed with the locality of the theological starting-point as "an immediate experience of something ultimate in value and being of which one can become intuitively with" (Tillich 1951: 9). This "mystical a priori" expresses an identity principle between experiencing subject and the ultimate in the religious experience. For Tillich, Schleiermacher's concept of "feeling" (*Gefühl*) should be understood against his background of Romanticism in which the identity of infinite and finite is emphasized (Tillich 1967a: 372–373).[8] Schleiermacher, for Tillich, was attempting to go beyond the boundary of Enlightenment and Romanticism, which deeply influenced Schleiermacher, to constitute a theory of religion which was strongly against deistic theism and Kantian moral-religious theory because these both fell into the danger of the disjunction of subject and object (Ibid.: 392). According to Tillich, the idea of "*Gefühl*" is

> the impact of the universe upon us in the depths of our being which transcends subject and object ... It means that there is an immediate awareness of that which is beyond subject and object, of the ground of everything within us ... This is the essence of what is called religious experience, the presence of something unconditional beyond the knowing and acting of which we are aware (Ibid.: 392–395).

God is "God-for-us" in which the dichotomy of subject-object is abolished. God is not an object besides other objects. God is present in our immediate consciousness.

Also, Schleiermacher suggested a positivist instead of a constructivist definition of Christian theology, in which the function of theology is the *description* of the faith as it is presented in the history of Christian churches. Therefore, Christian doctrines are the second-order reflection of the Christian religious consciousness (first-order) represented in the Christian community. Therefore, the speculative character of theology is not related to the Christian idea of theology and it could fall into an error of the enlightenment-rational matrix of the philosophical theology. In this aspect, Tillich had reservations about the concept of the positive science of theology, which Schleiermacher held.[9]

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8 We can find numerous similarities between Tillich and Romanticism thinkers. Nicholas of Cusa's "*coincidentia oppositorum*", Giordano Bruno's ecstatic naturalism and Goethe's *gestalt* theory, are mentioned by Tillich in articulating the secret correlation with Luther's mysticism and the identity philosophy of early Schelling (Tillich 1967a: 373–384).

9 For Tillich, Schleiermacher is inconsistent by the fact that he "begins with a general concept of religious community as it is manifested universally in the history of humanity. From this he

For the doctrine of pneumatology, as chapter two indicates, Tillich and Schleiermacher rejected the speculative Trinitarian doctrine, which emphasizes the epistemological possibility of *essential dei*, but asserts the possibility of the idea of Trinity only through the manifestations of divine revelatory experiences. Even though Tillich by no means repeated Schleiermacher's doctrine of Trinity,[10] both accepted that "the doctrine of the Trinity stands at the end as the completed doctrine of God" (Ibid.: 408). Tillich followed Schleiermacher's method in emphasizing the saving experience grounded in Christology and manifested in pneumatology, which both ultimately point to the Trinitarian idea of the divine. For Schleiermacher, the Holy Spirit is the divine mediator for the Christ-saving effectiveness of the Christian consciousness within the sphere of the Christian community. Christ and the Spirit work together. "The pneumatological bears the Christological and the Christological is the source of the pneumatological" (Colle 1999: 303).

For Schleiermacher, following the Calvinist-Reformed tradition, Spirit, as mediating Christ's new humanity to us, thereby extends Christ's redemptive work to us (Hector 2008: 2). The inseparability within the Christian religious consciousness of Christ and that of the Spirit is highlighted. It is legitimate for Christians "to describe their experiences in the sphere of grace as the immediate being and life of Christ within them ... [or as] ... the indwelling of the Spirit of God" (Schleiermacher 1830: 124.3, 577). Though both are interlocked with each other, the Christological and the pneumatological each require their own distinct consideration. The communion of the Holy Spirit is dependent on and subsequent to the Christological mission. The union of the divine essence with human nature in Jesus Christ is the font from which proceeds the analogous (but distinct) union of divine essence with human nature through participation in the Holy Spirit in the life of the church.[11]

The problem Schleiermacher had to face is that redemptive work was offered by Christ only; however, how can this redemptive effect further function in the

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derives a concept of the essence of religion. This is no longer positivism. It is a philosophical analysis of the essence of a thing. This presupposes constructive judgment about what is essential and what is not. His concept of the feeling of unconditional dependence is certainly a concept of a universal and philosophical type" (Tillich 1967a: 402).

10 It is clear that Tillich's dialectical conception of living God as the Trinitarian principle of God as Spirit would not be accepted by Schleiermacher because Schleiermacher's idea of Trinity is ultimately Christological-based (Tillich 1967a: 408).

11 It should be noted that Schleiermacher did distinguish all of the Spirit's activities prior to Christ, including the Spirit's participation in creation, prophecy and even in the incarnation from the Holy Spirit as the common spirit of the Christian church.

Christian consciousness if we are now formed and encountered in the Christian community? Or, how can the church's influence be equated with Christ's influence? We must reproduce Christ's activity as our own, according to Schleiermacher, but we cannot do so on our own. Our reproduction of Christ's activity is itself wholly dependent upon Christ. Redemption, in Schleiermacher's view, cannot be based upon our initiative, for it is "the beginning of a higher form of life which only Christ can communicate, because only in him is it originally present. It seems obvious, then, that here no causal agency can be attributed to the person who is being taken up into fellowship, for the higher form cannot be in any way derived from lower stages of life as present either in the individual or in a group of people yet to be converted" (Schleiermacher 1830: 492–493).

Schleiermacher asserted that the faith community's activity must, in some respect, be Christ's own activity. The one who mediates Christ's presence to us must be God. We are conscious of the fact that our redemption depends wholly upon God's activity; we are conscious that redemption is mediated to us through the community; from this, it follows that such mediation must itself be God's activity. Schleiermacher pointed out that, "in the Christian Church, as individual influences no longer proceed directly from Christ, something divine must exist. This something we call the Being of God in it, and it is this which continues within the Church the communication of the perfection and blessedness of Christ" (Schleiermacher 1830: 116.3). This Being of God in the church is the Holy Spirit. Secondly, the role of the Holy Spirit is to explain the way that God mediates Christ's activity to us through the Spirit's presence in the church. For Schleiermacher: "The Holy Spirit is not something that, although divine, is not united with the human nature, but only somehow influences it from without"; hence, "the man on whom the Spirit works is not thereby made a participator in the Spirit. Only one in whom and through whom he works has received the Spirit" (Schleiermacher 1830: 123.2). Therefore, the mediatorial role of Christ is constitutive for participation in the common spirit of the church. The communication of the Holy Spirit is a prolongation of Christ's activity for he is the source of that communication as "everyone is conscious … [of it] … being connected in the closest fashion with the rise of faith in him, and everyone recognizes that the same is true for all the others" (Schleiermacher 1830: 121.2, 563).

3.2 God as Spirit

The above section provides evidence that Tillich's entire theology of the Holy Spirit is located in Christian traditions. However, it is surprising that Tillich's pneumatology remains untouched in many scholars' works. Among the numer-

ous theological identities of Tillich, such as, theologian of culture, existential theologian, apologetic theologian, he is seldom regarded as a "theologian of the Spirit". It seems that Tillich's well-known theological terms, such as, method of correlation, theology of culture, God as being-itself, etc., are not related to his pneumatology. It is hoped that the arguments in the previous chapter convincingly reject this misleading impression. And, positively speaking, even though Tillich did not explicitly state the pneumatological foundation of his entire theological system, the arguments have already demonstrated that those key concepts, theological circle, method of correlation, theology of culture, Christology, etc., are closely integrated into a huge theological rubric through a pneumatological perspective; also, their internal and external tensions produced by the systematic construction are resolved in the doctrine of the Holy Spirit.

If pneumatology as a theological methodology is the final and decisive consideration of Tillich in repackaging his theological system, the material content of his pneumatology is still unanswered. For Tillich, who is the Holy Spirit? What is the function of the work of the divine Spirit? Although the discussion of the doctrine of the Holy Spirit is fully developed in volume three of Tillich's *Systematic Theology*, it should be noticed that, in volume one of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich had already laid down some important hints for exploring his pneumatology through which the complete version of the idea of God is explored under a Schellingian framework of "God as Spirit". Furthermore, it seems that Tillich's concern is neither to articulate a *Christian* doctrine of God as Spirit, nor to develop a kind of pneumatology in a dogmatic sense. *Pneumatology,* for Tillich*, is primarily the foundation and the telos of the presupposition of the inner divine process of the being of God, which is strangely regarded as "Trinitarian principle" in contrast with the doctrine of the Trinity* (Tillich 1951: 250). The Trinitarian principle has ontological priority over the doctrine of the Trinity because, for Tillich, all assertions about the doctrine of the Trinity must be ontologically and logically derived from the Trinitarian principle, which is pneumatologically based. Therefore, neither is he concerned about whether the understanding of the Spirit is orthodox, nor does he establish his pneumatology within the Christian tradition. From the demarcation of the Trinitarian principle and the doctrine of the Trinity, Tillich's pneumatology is not associated with the traditional Christian doctrine of the Holy Spirit. If there is still something connected with Christian elements, we can assert that Tillich is trying to provide an ontological ground (presupposition) for the understanding of the Christian idea of the Trinity. Therefore, Tillich was right in pointing out that the discussion of the Trinitarian God should be started by pneumatology, instead of by Christology. "The dogma of the Trinity can be discussed only after the Christological dogma has been elaborated. But the Trinitarian principles appear whenever one speaks meaningfully

of the living God" (Ibid.: 251). In the section of "God as Spirit and the Trinitarian principles", Tillich established the philosophical-theological matrix of pneumatology, living God and Trinitarian principles under the category of "life as spirit" in which the pneumatological ontology was first articulated.[12]

Tillich often acknowledged his debt to F.W.J. Schelling, not merely in a sense of completing two theses at the beginning of Tillich's intellectual development, but also that his whole systematic theology cannot be rightly understood without Schelling's influence (Tillich 1955c: 392).[13] Regarding Schelling's role in the history of German philosophy, Tillich strongly rejected the common conception which tended to locate Schelling as the transaction period between Kant and Hegel without seriously engaging the uniqueness of Schelling's philosophy, although, compared with Hegel's system, Schelling's own system was not completed and was always a work in process. Without an acquaintance with Schelling's thought and its influence on Tillich, Tillich's doctrine of God and of God's relation to the world cannot be rightly understood. Before we directly engage with the doctrine of God of Schelling and Tillich, we need to have a brief review of the critical position of Schelling's philosophy in general, and his idea of spirit and nature in particular.

3.2.1 Schelling's *Naturphilosophie*

Through Schelling's philosophy of nature, Tillich emphasized the union between human and nature in an epistemological and ontological sense. The resolution of enlightenment philosophy was to solve the dualist and monist dichotomy within the subjective self and the objective world. For Tillich, Schelling's philosophy of nature was regarded as the deduction of the German idealist attempt in the rise of tension created by human autonomy rationality.[14] This part will demonstrate Schelling's contribution within the context of German idealism in order to disclose Tillich's approach.

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12 Wolfgang Vondey employed the term, pneumatological ontology. Unfortunately, in Vondey's essay, the relationship between ontology and the pneumatology of Tillich's theology is still underdeveloped. See (Vondey 2015).

13 In his own words, Tillich says, "Meine Arbeit an den Problemen der systematischen Theologie ware undenkbar ohne ihn ..." (Tillich 1955c: 392).

14 For Schelling's work on the philosophy of nature, see (Schelling 1797) and (Schelling 1802a). For other scholars' work on this topic, see (Esposito 1977), (Bowie 1993: 30 – 44), (Snow 1996: 67 – 92), and (Brown 1977: 91 – 97, 166 – 171).

"*Aufklärer*", as the criterion of reason, judges all beliefs, rules and texts.[15] It represents a special ideological approach to employing universal laws as a mechanism for understanding the internal and external connection. Two possibilities exist: skepticism and materialism. Due to the radical doubt presented in human reason, its radical skepticism form will doubt the existence of the external world and of other minds. Epistemology undergoes the change from "what" to "how" in emphasizing the methodological discussion instead of the content of knowledge. Radical skepticism insists that the external world is nothing more than the human idealist projection (Beiser 2000: 19 – 20). Furthermore, enlightenment subordinates all beings under the mathematical and mechanical laws in order to reduce them into something material. What we can know is something material in substance. This kind of materialism rises out of the "mind-body" problem in which either spirit and idealist substance are reduced as material substance, or all materials are regarded as the representative of the human mind (Ibid.: 21 – 22). Two motifs of enlightenment philosophy, criticism and naturalism, ultimately produce two results: skepticism and materialism. The former tries to cancel the objective existence of all beings and treat them as human idealist projections in order to negate independent external existence. The latter reduces all human ideas to a functional measurement of the naturalist and materialist construction and the objective validity merely exists in a physical and measurable world.

Kant's transcendental idealism and empirical realism attempted to release the above tension created by criticism and naturalism.[16] In order to synthesize the objective world and subjective mind, truth is regarded as the unity between a concept and related objects. The human mind itself is not capable of creating an epistemological object; this means that all knowable entities are correlated with the conditions of knowing subjects, that knowable entities are the representations instead of the "thing-in-itself". Therefore, the legitimate boundary of human knowledge is limited within the union of understanding and sensitivity. Beyond this limitation, human knowledge is theoretically invalid. Kant's solution seems to have two distinct levels of entities, which imply that the condition of human knowledge is based on a certain correlation relationship between the human mind and external world, but he never seemed to successfully justify it.

Fichte disagreed with Kant's solution because the representative character of the external world cannot escape from the challenge of Hume's skepticism; an

15 For the idea of the Enlightenment and its criticism, see (Schmidt 1996).

16 For a Kantian synthesis of transcendental idealism and empirical realism, see (Palmquist 1993).

idealistic conception of mind and body still exists (Ibid.: 29 – 30). In order to justify the legitimacy of human knowledge, overcoming the dualistic conception of subject and object is needed, though, to a certain extent, representation is certainly external to our human experience. The idea of "absolute ego" includes "ego" and "non-ego" to set the progressive target instead of stable substance. That means, for Fichte, unity with the external world is always the target under which the human self can never master the non-ego world. With this understanding, dualism cannot be overcome forever. However, ego tries to communicate with the external object in order to create human knowledge (Ibid.: 21 – 22).

However, when humans couple with the natural world, it is natural for the former to swallow the external world. This means, for Fichte, that the Kantian dualist problem is still unsolvable because, when Fichte's ego absorbs the external world, the world is regarded as the product of human minds; and the resistance raised from the external world will simultaneously divide into two realms of existence – representations under the limits of human knowledge and the unknowable "thing-in-itself". In summary, the dilemma cannot be solved under Fichte's absolute ego, which either tends to subject the external world under his idealist framework, or maintains the gap between subjective consciousness and the objective world. For Tillich, the outcomes of Fichte's program will be either an absolute human ego or that the epistemological gap remains (Tillich 1951:171).

For Schelling, Fichte's criticism and Spinoza's dogmatism are not sufficiently powerful to resolve the problem. For the latter, objective entity (non-ego) absolutizes itself and subordinates human freedom as an infinite objective expression; for the former, self would be expanded as absolute self and the world would be swallowed. Though these two attempts try to achieve the unity of self and the world, no ultimate synthesis is possible (Copleston 1994:100 – 102). The *Naturphilosophie* proposed by Schelling tries to maintain the tension and balance of identity and non-identity between subject and object; all attempts of the dualistic and monist approaches are not tenable.[17] Leibniz inspired Schelling to interpret matter as a living force in which different life forms actualize into different but connected dimensions. Thus, difference is maintained but is not in separation (Beiser 2000: 33 – 34). Schelling was dissatisfied with Fichte's reduction of nature as "non-subject", this negative attitude towards na-

17 For the relationship between Schelling and German *Naturphilosophie*, see (Morgan 1990: 25 – 37). Based on the discovery on the interpretation on Plato by early Schelling, scholarship started to investigate the origin of Schelling's *Naturphilosophie*; see (Baum 2000: 199 – 215).

ture causing the absolutizing of self. Positively speaking, "nature" is regarded as "creative creativity", an independent and non-reducible integrated whole (Jähnig 1989: 223). Though the Kantian conception of "organism" is approved and appreciated by Schelling, the Kantian employment of this concept through regulative understanding instead of constitutive understanding results in a guiding teleological concept but does not constitute an authentic understanding of nature.

Following Schelling, Tillich was against dogmatism about an absolute objective world (Tillich 1912: 47), and he employed the Schellingean notion of *Identitätsprinzip* into the concept of nature. "Nature is visible spirit, spirit is invisible nature" (*Natur ist hiernach der sichtbare Geist, Geist die unsichtbare Natur*), under which subject and object are closely connected within the living dynamic force and expressed as two related but distinctive dimensions (Tillich 1912: 53).[18] "The absolute synthesis is realized also in the natural process, in living productivity, which is the cause of all natural products, and in nature as subject (*natura naturans*)" (Ibid.: 53). Tillich pointed out that the synthesis should not be regarded as activity produced by human consciousness; otherwise, it would not be ultimate and perfect. Therefore, the boundary of the Kantian notion of "thing-in-itself" would be broken (Tillich 1912: 34). Nature integrates subject and object, one and many, into itself because this unity is already presupposed and before the separation between nature and spirit. Subjectivity and the ideal are the internalization of the living force, while objectivity and reality are the externalization of the living force. The authentic and absolute synthesis merely exists in the creative dynamic of living nature. The breakthrough of the gap between humanity and nature establishes the unity of God and nature; God is understood as creative nature under which God, humanity and nature are correlated within the principle of identity. "Unity with God is attained in the aesthetic experience of nature" (Tillich 1912: 57). Simultaneously, this identity is authentically coupled with dichotomy, under which spirit is no longer bounded by nature and is to be treated as higher nature. "Spirit is actual only when it posits within itself the conflict of nature and spirit" (Tillich 1912: 58). Tillich admitted that the transcendent freedom expressed in spirit guarantees the realization of the identity principle.

In other words, nature is not merely the Kantian representation in human perception, but is a dynamic process returning to itself through human spiritual realization. It is a teleological unifying system. The representational world is one

18 See also (Gunther Wenz 1979: 76 – 78).

of the epistemological dimensions through the realization of nature itself. Therefore, Tillich said:

> It is not enough to prove that the ego is everything; rather, on the contrary, it must be understood that everything is like the ego. Nature is not an incomprehensible limit of action; it is itself action, creating will, becoming freedom, striving for consciousness. It is the gradual conquest of conscious over unconscious action until it attains equilibrium in man as a natural being (Tillich 1910: 45).

In contrast with the Kantian notion of organisms as a regulative principle, Tillich emphasized the inherited idea of "*telos*" in nature. Nature in itself is regarded as a dynamic organic whole instead of a human idealized framework imposed into nature.

Beyond the dichotomy between subjectivity and objectivity, Schelling's idea of nature embraces the concept of absolute as the dynamic force under which the synthesis of subjectivity and objectivity is achieved. In contrast with dogmatism locating the absolute on the objective side or criticism locating it on the subjective side, Schelling attempted to go beyond this dualistic matrix and regards nature as an unlimited boundary. Self-consciousness is embraced into the higher actualization of a natural dynamic force instead of Fichte's absolute self-consciousness.

However, for Tillich, the uniqueness of the philosophical contribution of Schelling does not lie merely in the philosophy of nature or the identity principle, but also constitutes the unity of essentialism and existentialism. Spinozistic mystical naturalism was radicalized by Schelling's principle of identity. The former notion of the ontological unity of everything in the eternal substance creates the philosophical formula, *deus sive natura*, which is easily misunderstood as the pantheistic conception of "God is identified with nature". Tillich, following Schelling, argued that it is absurd to assert that God is the totality of beings, but should be regarded as identified with *natura naturans*, the creative nature (Tillich 1951: 233, 1957: 6). The uniqueness of Schelling's philosophy of nature was summarized by Tillich: "His [Schelling's] whole philosophy of nature was an attempt to show the indwelling of the potential spirit in all natural objects and how it comes to its fulfillment in man ... Schelling's own program, the presence of the spiritual in the material. Thus, the philosophy of nature becomes in Schelling a system of intuitions, in a half-philosophical, half-aesthetic way, of the power of being in nature, a power which is beyond the separation of the spiritual and the material" (Tillich 1967a: 441).

For Tillich, the teleological-eschatological structure of the movement of divine powers and powers of beings is evident in Schelling's philosophy of nature. In the mood of the anti-Spinozistic concept, Schelling's nature is understood as

partly biological and psychological instead of a geometrical matrix. "In this construction the process of nature proceeds from the lowest to the highest forms of nature, and finally to man in terms of a contrast of two principles [unconscious and conscious] ... He [Schelling] tried to show how slowly in all different forms of nature consciousness develops until it comes to man where it becomes self-consciousness" (Ibid.: 442). Therefore, for Tillich, the dark side (unconscious) of nature and God is introduced by Schelling as the breakdown of his essential understanding of the identity of God and nature. Also, in volume three of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich, following Schelling but in a different way, also constructed a dynamic model to integrate the material dimension to the spiritual dimension of nature. Paradoxically, Tillich abandoned the highest and lowest categories in his model and rejected the optimistic eschatological-evolutional conception in his understanding.

3.2.2 Spirit as the Third Potency

For Schelling and Tillich, a set of opposing and polar principles constitutes the being of God and the world. Schelling called them potencies and Tillich named them as ontological elements. These ontological elements under the principle of the Spirit are in a perfect harmonious condition and maintain the dynamic and living character of the living God in which the identity and difference of the elements are in balance. Likewise, the world differs from God in that it is characterized by a disharmonious tension between the qualities. As a result, it is marked by brokenness and estrangement. The world participates in God's being because it is constituted by the same qualities that constitute the divine life, but it does so in a distorted and fragmentary way.

First, God and the world are constituted by a set of opposing principles and their relations. This introduces Schelling's doctrine of potencies. There are, he asserted, three potencies (powers) within God's nature. One is the power of love. Schelling denoted this power with the symbol "A". It requires a ground, something to support it. Hence there is another power, the power of selfhood and subsistent being, symbolized by "B". With these two powers, "the being which is love may subsist as independent and be for itself" (Schelling 1815: 96 – 97). These two powers are opposed to one another. The power of love is "the outflowing, outspreading, self-giving essence" of God; the other power is the "eternal power of selfhood, of return into self, of being-in-self" (Ibid.: 97). By the power of love the divine nature is eccentric and outgoing; by the power of selfhood God's nature is centered and self-grounding. Despite this opposition, God's nature is not simply the eternal antithesis of these powers; it is also their eternal

unity. "It is indeed one and the same [divine nature] which is the affirmation and the negation, the out spreading and the restraining" (Ibid.: 98 – 99). We must, therefore, speak of a third power in God, the unity of the first two (Ibid.: 97 – 98). This unity is the first two powers in their identity and their difference. It is their unity, but a unity that does not annul their distinctive properties.

In understanding Schelling's three potencies in the being of God, Tillich comments on Schelling's view: Schelling

> construed two or three principles in the ground of the divine, the unconscious or dark principle, the principle of will which is able to contradict itself, on the one hand, and the principle of logos, or the principle of light, on the other hand (Tillich 1967a: 442).

These same principles are present in Tillich's idea of God. Schelling's first potency (B), the power of selfhood, becomes the abyss nature of God, the principle of depth and power. This is the basis of God's being God. It is the ground and the power of being of all that is (Tillich 1951: 250 – 251). For both Tillich and Schelling, this first power gives God substantial reality; it is that by which God eternally conquers nonbeing. The second potency (A) becomes in Tillich's thought the principle of meaning, designated by the term *logos*. It is the principle of structure, definition, creativity, and revelation (Ibid.: 251). Schelling's third potency, the unity of the first two, appears in Tillich's theology as Spirit, which is the actualization and the unity of the principles of power and meaning (Ibid.: 249 – 251). These principles of being recur, according to Tillich, in life. Life includes three elements: self-identity, self-alteration and return to one's self (Tillich 1963: 30 – 32). The same pattern of the movement of life corresponds to Schelling's three potencies. Self-identity corresponds to the power of selfhood [B]. Self-alteration corresponds to the outgoing power of love [A2]. Return to self corresponds to the unity of the first two potencies [A3]. This is why, according to Tillich, God may be called the living God. "He is the eternal process in which separation is posited and is overcome by reunion" (Tillich 1951: 242).

When Tillich articulated God as the ground of the structure of being (Ibid.: 238), all the ontological elements of being and the functions of life in the finite world are found primordially in God's being as life and spirit. For Schelling shared with Tillich, both human history and nature are grounded in the dialectical relation of those potencies (Schelling 1815: 199). For both, God is the ontological and the dynamic structure of powers in which the world participates and shares.

Also, though the ontological polarity creates the internal tension within the Godhead of God, Tillich and Schelling shared the conviction that the powers within God are in a perfect and eternal harmony. For Schelling, the potencies,

each being the antithesis of the others, cannot co-exist without some mediation. In them, each strives to be, to assert itself and to negate the others. Without some resolution of the tension inherent in their conflictual striving, the divine nature would be wild and chaotic, without order. The resolution, which is an eternal one, takes the form of establishing a hierarchy of the potencies (Ibid.: 128–130). In this hierarchy, the first power (B) assumes the lowest position; the second power (A2) takes the middle position; and the third power (A3), the unity of the first two, takes the highest. In God's nature, however, there is an eternal hierarchy of powers that establishes a dynamically stable divine nature.

Although Tillich concurred with Schelling on the main point, he did not go as far as Schelling on subsidiary matters. The main point is that the powers that constitute the divine life exist in God in eternal perfect harmony:

> The polar character of the ontological elements is rooted in the divine life, but the divine life is not subject to this polarity. Within the divine life, every ontological element includes its polar element completely, without tension and without the threat of dissolution (Tillich 1951: 243).

However, Tillich did not affirm some of Schelling's other theses. He betrayed no inclination to represent the polar elements within God in a *hierarchical* way. Whereas, for Schelling, the harmonious co-existence of the potencies depends on their being ordered in a hierarchy, for Tillich the co-existence of the polar elements "without the threat of dissolution" in the divine life is apparently without condition. He thus lacked Schelling's conviction that the eternal harmony of the powers in a hierarchy is, as it was, a contingent fact. Tillich did indeed allow for talk about God's eternal conquering of the negative within the divine being (Tillich 1963: 404), but the nonbeing in question relates to the element of dynamics – one of the polar elements – within God. The relation, within God, of being to nonbeing is the relation of the "world" pole of the ontological structure to the "self" pole, of meaning to power (Tillich 1951: 189, 246). While this relation is highly significant in Tillich's theology, it is quite different from Schelling's thesis. Schelling's claim is that God's eternal act of overcoming is a matter of harmonizing the potencies by establishing them in a hierarchy. For Tillich, God's eternal act of overcoming consists in conquering the power of nonbeing, which is linked with the "self" pole of the ontological elements. This distinction from Schelling has a large effect on Tillich's theology. It means that Tillich and Schelling treat God's freedom in very different ways.

Furthermore, the world exhibits the ontological structure of the powers in a disharmonious form. According to Schelling, the creation of the world occurs when God, by a free although timeless decision, externalizes the potencies

that constitute the divine nature and allows them to collapse out of their state of hierarchical harmony. In this collapsed state, they revert to their natural state of opposition to one another. They cannot co-exist in this state, for each contradicts the others as it strives to assert itself. Since they cannot co-exist, their respective strivings produce a history, first in the physical universe, then in human history, in which the potencies sequentially assert themselves and gain dominance (Schelling 1815:191). This sequence of the potencies' self-expression in nature and history mirrors their hierarchical ordering in God's nature: first the dark power of selfhood (B), then the lucent power of love (A2), finally the third, unifying power (A3) (Ibid.: 197). The result is that the course of cosmic history mirrors the nature of God, except that whereas the potencies exist in God in an eternal harmonious hierarchy, they exist in the world initially in a state of contradiction and sequential development. And yet, the eternal hierarchy functions as a *telos* for natural and human history, for the goal of this history is the establishing of a hierarchy of the potencies in the finite universe as it subsists eternally in the divine nature. The evolutionary development of organic beings, culminating in the appearance of humanity, and the subsequent history of humanity are marked by the gradual triumph of the second power (love) over the first power (selfhood). At the end of history, when the second power has completely subordinated the first to itself, the third power (the perfect unity of the first two) will become actualized in the world. In this way, the powers relate themselves to each other in the finite as they do eternally in the divine nature.

Tillich likewise held that the world reflects the powers of God's being but without the harmony that exists in God. Like God, the finite world includes an element of nonbeing. But, whereas for God, nonbeing is included only as something that is eternally overcome, in the world nonbeing constitutes a threat to being (Tillich 1951: 246 – 247). In the finite world being is limited by and opposed to nonbeing (Ibid.: 189). Likewise, life, under the conditions of finitude, is ambiguous: The unity of life "is threatened by existential estrangement, which drives life in one or the other direction. Self-integration is countered by disintegration, self-creation is countered by destruction, self-transcendence is countered by profanization" (Tillich 1963: 32). Tillich and Schelling are agreed, then, that the structures that are found in God without disruptive tension are found in the world in a tensed, separated way. However, as noted previously, Tillich did not see the harmony of the powers in God as a function of their hierarchical ordering. As a result, Tillich had no interest in interpreting the course of cosmic and human history as a development of the dynamics inherent in the powers.

3.3 Spirit and the Nature

3.3.1 Multi-dimensionality

3.3.1.1 Boundary in Crossing

Tillich is famous as a "theologian on the boundary"; this understanding was documented in his autobiographical essay, "On the boundary", published in 1936 and later revised and published in 1966 in a book form. There is no substantial change in these two versions apart from some slightly revised translation. The meaning of the word, *boundary*, seems without questions; it is commonly regarded as the condition describing Tillich's personal and intellectual existence, involving more than one realm. However, the usage of this term is not fixed and the meaning shifts in different contexts. Also, this key word does not function merely as a self-interpreting matrix in order to gather all the contrasting, even rival, elements within Tillich's life, but it is crucial to understanding how Tillich views reality.

"*Grenze*", the meaning of this German word is vague. It denotes something on the "boundary", facing the "border-line", something on the "limit", on different "alternatives" and something on the "frontiers". It seems that Tillich never provided a definite meaning for the term; rather he employed various personal and intellectual materials to enrich and substantiate this term. Or, we can say that, Tillich employed the same word in different contexts to symbolize different but related meanings. However, we are certain that "*grenze*" was not the term first employed by Tillich after he moved to the US. In his early book, *Religiöse Verwirklichung* (1929), Tillich had already appreciated this term as "the best place for acquiring knowledge" (Tillich 1936: 13). Perhaps it is worthy to examine again Tillich's self-characterization of this term.

> When I asked to give an account of the way my ideas have developed from my life, I thought that the concept of the boundary might be the fitting symbol for the whole of my personal and intellectual development. At almost every point, I have had to stand between alternative possibilities of existence, to be completely at home in neither and to take no definitive stand against either. Since thinking presupposes receptiveness to new possibilities, this position is fruitful for thought; but it is difficult and dangerous in life, which again and again demands decisions and thus the exclusion of alternatives. This disposition and its tension have determined both my destiny and my work (Ibid.).

In Tillich's earlier version included in *The Interpretation of History* (1936), the word "boundary" in the above paragraph was originally translated as "borderline" (Tillich 1936a: 3). In the texts, Tillich described his thought and life which were always in the mode of being between two alternatives. When Tillich

talked about the "*grenze*" between autonomy and heteronomy, "life cannot stand only on its own boundaries; it must also live at its center, out of its own abundance". Here, we find a "center-boundary" matrix in Tillich's ideas. Besides, when Tillich articulated the relationship between theology and philosophy, the "*grenze*" situation was most clearly seen in it (Tillich 1936: 46). "Theology and philosophy, religion and knowledge, embrace one another. In light of the boundary position, this appears as their real relationship" (Ibid.: 56). Also, when Tillich described the relationship between Lutheranism and socialism, he employed the concept, *kairos:* this concept employed as "a boundary concept between religion and socialism has been the hall mark of German religious socialism" (Ibid.: 78). Likewise, when Tillich expressed the disadvantages of German idealism; he mentioned the "boundary of idealism" (Ibid.:83). Last, in his final section entitled "Retrospect: Boundary and Limitation", Tillich emphasized that all he described were the "possibilities" they were opposed and the way they could be correlated. More, they are the dialectic of existence through which "each of life's possibilities drives of its own accord to a boundary and beyond the boundary where it meets that which limits it" (Ibid.: 97). In his final words in the book, Tillich's subversive expression made the things more complex: "In its [Eternal] presence, even the very center of our being is only a boundary and our highest level of accomplishment is fragmentary" (Ibid.: 98).

Another important, but less noticed essay, "Frontiers" (1962), has remarkable significance for the understanding of the term, *grenze*. This was Tillich's address delivered in Frankfurt on the occasion of his reception of the Peace Prize of the German Book Trade in 1962. Against this background, Tillich explained again this most "fitting symbol", theoretically and practically. In this text, there were several points Tillich articulated for the first time. First, Tillich employed the term, *frontier*, to replace the term, boundary, despite both being interchangeable. Second, Tillich described the term in concrete ways: to be on the *frontier/ boundary* is to exist in *tension and movement* (Tillich 1965: 53. Emphases mine). Tillich said:

> It is in truth not standing still, but rather a crossing and return, a repetition of return and crossing, a back-and-forth-the aim of which is to create a third area beyond the bounded territories, an area where one can stand for a time without being enclosed in something tightly bounded (Ibid.).

It seems that, for Tillich, the fulfillment of territorialization is ultimately textured within de-territorialization. The existence of boundary/ frontier is not intended to protect and to establish identity, but its existence is to be crossed and to be transcended. Therefore, Tillich emphasized that the function of the boundary / fron-

tier is not to territorialize different realms for maintenance and defense. The ideal situation is not side-by-side existence without tension, but rather one which is interrelated, interchangeable and fluid. If one is afraid of crossing and reversing the boundary/ frontier, the anxiety of disturbance will lie on one side and the will to eliminate it on the other (Ibid.). Thirdly, apart from tension and movement, a boundary/ frontier functions as the mirror of one's own limitation and, simultaneously, points to the Other beyond. Therefore, the boundary/ frontier will be a challenge or an invitation to let someone to leave the security and become open to the unknown Other (Ibid.: 54).

Also, the term boundary/ frontier does not merely intend transgressing across the line, but "it is also something which must be brought to fruition" (Ibid.: 57). That means the boundary setting constitutes the being of the beings; it determines the dimension of the form of all beings. Tillich emphasized that, in order to reach out to the unbounded, the bounded condition must be recognized. In this text, finally, Tillich pointed out that the boundary/ frontier is essential for grasping and recognizing reality. The ontological meaning of a being is, simultaneously, different from other beings based on the boundary setting. Therefore, to "define" a being is to "bound" (*ab-grenzung*) it (Ibid.). The image of the "boundary" carries the abundant meaning of Kantian and post-Kantian epistemological projects. For a Kantian framework, the human epistemological limitation was mapped within the boundary of the empirical realms. No transcendental object would be represented. This limit-metaphor of Kant's philosophy finds the analogy in Tillich's concept of the finitude. Alternatively, Schelling's transcendental idealism provides a powerful apparatus for transgressing the limitation of the finite in his concept of the intellectual intuition.

The above preliminary discussion of the concept, *grenze*, points to a fundamental focus of Tillich's thought. For him, reality was neither dualistic nor monistic, and we notice that the "multidimensionality" of reality expressed in Tillich's volume three of *Systematic Theology* is perfectly located in the idea of "*grenze*". The *grenze* does not primarily function to separate and divide reality into different spheres which are totally independent, isolated, and with no contact point or overlapping realms. However, simultaneously, all beings in the world are territorialized through different *grenze* which leads to the distinctiveness of beings. Also, reality is with the center and being open to each other. The existence of the *grenze* is to define the boundary and the possibility of a being; it establishes the form for them and to make them what they are. Simultaneously, this center must not be closed in on itself; it should be open for the one beyond itself. For Tillich, center-orientated and beyond-orientated coincide. Lastly, the "*grenze*" emphasizes the movement of back-and-forward through which the whole reality is not static, but is in a dynamic process with a form-

structure. The mixing and blurring of different realms or spheres manifests the tensions, breaking them down and reconstructing them. It is full of ambiguity and is a hybrid. The flux of reality does not ultimately erase the boundaries of all beings. Tillich's polarity of different ontological elements indicates the dialectical matrix of the realities in which the non-essential character of reality is perfectly echoed with the dialectical polarity of "particularity-universality" and the "center-periphery" metaphor of Tillich's theology mentioned in chapter two. Employing the term in volume one of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich emphasized that all beings are in the duality of divergence and convergence, like the relationship between philosophy and theology, and no conflict or synthesis can be found (Tillich 1951: 26 – 27).

3.3.1.2 Ontological Structure

Reality is never defined by dualistic or monistic conceptuality. Every inquiry presupposes the ontological articulation in which the answer is given to the question of what the being is. For Tillich, the being-question should not be understood as the inquiry for the meta- and super-substance behind the phenomenon, as ontology should not be confused with metaphysics. The former represents the basic structure present in every encounter of reality and its descriptive character is distinct from the speculative construction of the latter (Tillich 1954: 23). Although Tillich's articulation of the "essence-existence" framework seems to recapture Plato's two realms of Idea and Matter or Aristotle's distinction between potentiality and actuality, Tillich always presented it as a polarity instead of a dualistic framework. The underlying principle of ontological polarity is mutual participation of different elements. Being is always being of self-relatedness and self-belongingness (Tillich 1951: 165). For the inquiry of the relationship between human beings and nature, Tillich articulated the ontological question of inquiring into the basic structure and essential elements of all beings that are shared by human beings and nature. The answer for this ontological question determines the basic analysis of all beings (Tillich 1951: 163). For Tillich, the ontological structure of all beings, in replying to the ontological question, constitutes the possibility of all human experience; therefore, experience must be dynamic and interactive. All beings participate in the ontological dynamic structure, but only humans have awareness about this structure (Ibid.: 168). The searching for ontological meaning constitutes the ontological distinction of human beings, because only humans have direct awareness about the basic structure and elements of the ontology (Thatcher 1978: 1 – 24). Human beings have always belonged to the ontological structure, which is not an external thing existing in the world; rather it is the primary modality of the multifaceted

relationship between human beings and nature (Kelsey 1967: 51–76). Although the comprehensive and interacting vision of the different dimensions of reality is fully present in volume three of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich anticipated in his volume one the special articulation of human beings within the cosmos. In facing the dilemma of adopting the strictly behaviorist perspective towards other beings, resulting in maintaining the strangeness of the Other or reducing the whole universe into a huge machine, resulting in adopting pure materialistic perspectives, Tillich suggested a third perspective. A human being is a "being in whom *all levels of beings* are united and approachable" (Tillich 1951: 168, 260. Emphasis mine). Therefore, Tillich's anthropology and cosmology are closely related in that all dynamic elements of ontological structures are actualized within the being of the human species. For Tillich, human beings are regarded as "microcosms" and the image of God because "the ontological elements are complete and united on a creaturely basis" (Ibid.: 259). What happens in the microcosms happens in the macrocosms through mutual participation. Reality is one and many in a sense that "it is one in the manifoldness of its texture" (Tillich 1954: 20).

Being is always being in the environment. However, the concept, environment, is not a neutral term. The environment is always a *human* environment in which human beings participate. "Environment is made up of those elements of his surroundings that are relevant for him as man. A man and his dog have the same surroundings, but a different environment" (Tillich 1957a: 139). For Tillich, the so-called "pure" environment does not exist because the environment is not referred to in an objective sense of natural entities. The distinction between "surroundings" and "environment" is grounded in an idea that "environment consists in those things with which it has an active interrelation" (Tillich 1951: 170). In other words, human beings build up a meaningful fabric with the environment. "Self and environment determine each other". Human being not only is in the environment but also *has* the environment (Ibid.).

For Tillich, the human being is regarded as "self" in a sense that only humans can be aware of the ontological structure in which s/he belongs and is concerned by the separation of one's self from the world. This means that environment and human self constitute a dialectical correlation in which human beings participate in the environment to create meaningful actions; at the same time, human beings are able to transcend the environment to create something universal. Human beings are always conditioned by the environment and, at the same time, are able to create a "world" which transcends the environment. The notion "world" and "environment" are both relational terms. Both share the structure of "being-with" and not just assemblies of things. *Kosmos* (Greek) and *univasum*

(Latin) both refers to something meaningful and as a structural whole (Tillich 1951: 170, 1957a: 140).

> If we encounter world, we encounter it as a whole that is structured in time and space, in geometrical and biological forms, in things and consciousness of things, in laws and spontaneity, in the positive and the negative (Tillich 1957a: 140).

The human being is being-in-the-world; the world is in the environment but beyond it (Tillich 1951: 170). Human beings locate themselves in the environment and transcend it to construct the world in which human beings totally belong to the world but, at the same time, are separated from it. Tillich mentioned that the "world" is a human complicated meaningful rubric. However, the world is not merely an outer part for the human to comprehend but, at the same time, it belongs to human innermost self.

Likewise, self-consciousness and world-consciousness are interrelated concepts. In Tillich's ontological framework, "self-world" constitutes the basic polar ontological structure, which is the primal modality of all human action, including understanding, moral action and aesthetic judgment, etc. Those activities presupposed this basic ontological structure.

> The truth of all ontological concepts is their power of expressing, that which makes the subject-object structure possible. They constitute this structure; they are not controlled by it (Tillich 1951: 169).

For Tillich, all kinds of human activities and existence presuppose the basic polar "self-world" structure, which derives the ontological basic subject-object structure, and does not necessarily imply the epistemological dualistic framework. In contrast, Tillich emphasized that the awareness of the self is also the awareness of the other.

Far from the material construction in establishing the correlation of human self and the encountered world, Tillich focused on the formal articulation of the ontological elements of this "self-world" basic structure. These elements in the ontological structure are constituted as polarities (Tillich 1951: 164). Three pairs of these ontological elements attached in the ontological structure are mentioned: individuality and participation, dynamics and form, freedom and destiny (Tillich 1951: 165). First, all these three pairs of ontological elements are not separated in their essential structures. All beings in the world, including human beings, are living within these three pairs of ontological elements. In other words, the basic ontological polar structure manifests itself in threefold ways. Second, for Tillich, individuality, dynamics and freedom involve the concept of "self-relatedness of being" which means the ontological power of self-

constitution and self-centeredness (Tillich 1951: 169). Even in the inorganic realm, a certain degree of "selfhood" must be assumed (Tillich 1951: 169). Third, for Tillich, participation, form, and destiny, involve the concept of "belongingness of being" which manifests in all beings as belonging to the whole. The self and the whole have mutual transformation and participation.

The polar element of "individualization" does not mean a self-contained and self-sufficient individual. What Tillich emphasized is the ontological element of "self-centered" shared in all living beings. They all share a different degree of centeredness in their beings (Tillich 1951: 175). "Participation" involves sharing, having in common and being a part (Tillich 1952: 88). In his *Courage To Be*, Tillich emphasized that the matrix of participation does not intend to be a search for "equal-identity" but is a kind of "partial identity and partial nonidentity" (Ibid.). When human beings encounter the environment and the world, it means each human being participates as one part of it and, at the same time, the whole world participates in a part of each human being. Therefore, Tillich tended to employ the power of being instead of substance in articulating the mutual participation of human beings in the world. A human being is not merely a part of the world; s/he participates in and responds to the structure and power of nature. For Tillich, in a human being, the world is present not only indirectly and unconsciously, but also directly and in a conscious encounter (Tillich 1951: 176).

> Considered cosmically, he [human being] participates in the universe because the universal structures, forms and laws are open to him. And with them everything, which can be grasped and shaped through them, is open to him (Tillich 1951: 176).

In *The Courage To Be*, Tillich pointed out participation as "being a part of something from which one is, at the same time, separated" (Tillich 1952: 88 – 89). Courage to be essentially is the courage to be as a part and the courage to be as oneself (Ibid.). Participation and individuality are an ontologically dialectical constitution which concretely and spiritually manifests in human moral integration, cultural creativity and religious transcendence.

The polarity of form and dynamics creates the being of beings. "Form should not be contrasted with content. The form which makes a thing what it is, is its content, its *essentia*, its definite power of being" (Tillich 1951: 178). "Dynamic" denotes the potentiality of the beings (Ibid.: 179). It maintains the vitality of beings and empowers the form to create something new. Also, it symbolizes the power of becoming and creativity. "Vitality is the power which keeps a living being alive and growing ... is the creative drive of the living substance in everything that lives towards new forms" (Ibid.: 180). For human beings, dynamic power empowers human cultural creativity to transcend the environment to cre-

ate some new forms of beings. Through these cultural transformations, human beings and nature share the process of grasping and shaping (Ibid.: 182).

The polarity of freedom and destiny denotes self-transcendence and its limitation. For Tillich, "freedom" does not mean the human will; instead, when the human being is free, s/he is able to choose and respond (Ibid.: 183). Tillich tended to describe the whole structure and all elements constituting a human being as a human when he talks about human freedom (Ibid.). That means freedom is regarded as an ontological category rather than a moral concept. The word "destiny" does not mean "fate" which has strong connotations of necessity. Rather, Tillich tended to express this term as the horizontal background for human decision. It means that all human decisions are contextualized and historical which is the "concrete totality of everything" connecting with all human action and decision (Ibid.: 184 – 185). It includes all biological, psychological and spiritual structures. It is interesting that Tillich described "freedom" in the natural world in an analogical sense. Based on the *Gestalten* structures of all living beings in the world, a certain degree of reaction is understood under the natural boundary. That means the polarity of freedom and destiny can apply into the natural realms as the polarity of spontaneity and law. For Tillich, the living being in the natural world is not wholly biological and naturally bounded; the inner living structure of them involves the mechanism of spontaneity.

Apart from the ontological articulation of the structure of beings, Tillich emphasized the ontological structure of rationality. The relational and dynamic structure of reason shares the same pattern of polarity of beings. The concept of "reason" (*logos*), for Tillich, is not merely regarded as logical reasoning. This naked nature of "reason" could erase the object under a subjective epistemological framework (Tillich 1951: 93). The classical notion of *logos* concerns beings and the ends of all living beings instead of the effective means. This ontological articulation of *logos* is dominant in the classical tradition from Parmenides to Hegel. It denotes "the structure of the mind which enables the mind to grasp and to transform the reality. It is effective in the cognitive, aesthetic, practical, and technical functions of the human mind" (Ibid.: 72). Ontological reason is the foundation of human activities; it refers to the structure and the power of beings. Following the classical usage, *logos* is present in the human mind and all beings; the former refers to the grasping and shaping functions of human *logos* as "subjective *logos*"; the latter refers to the structural forms of reality as "objective *logos*" (Ibid.: 75). Due to the unifying foundation originally constituted by the universal *logos*, the human mind and reality share the same *logos* character (Ibid.). The mutual relationship between subjective and objective *logos* is analogous to the ontological polarity of the self-world structure. Ontologically speaking, the human mind participates in the environment and constitutes

the fabric of meaning. "Grasping-shaping" are interdependent. The former has the connotation of penetrating into the depths, into the essential nature of a thing or an event, of understanding and expressing it; the latter has the connotation of transforming a given material into a *gestalt*, a living structure which has the power of being (Ibid.: 76).

Due to the ontological character of reason, Tillich tended to articulate knowledge through the ontological framework (Ibid.: 94). This ontological structure of knowledge is not static and limited, but is full of the dynamics of human grasping and shaping, acting at an epistemological level. The knowing subject and the known object, for Tillich, are located in the dialectical process of knowledge as "union-separation-reunion", like the pattern of the dialectical movement of life and the ontological process of God. For Tillich, the epistemological distance is assumed in all types of knowledge. "Detachment is the condition of union epistemology" (Ibid.). "Union" assumes the distance and the distance points to the union. The knowing subject and the known object are not separated and are identical with each other, but always in a process full of tension and union (Ibid.: 95). The separation ensures the self-centeredness of all beings; the union ensures the integration and union of all beings (Ibid.). Emotional elements are included in the dialectical process of knowing. Knowing points to the inter-subjectivity of all beings; otherwise, knowing will be reduced to "controlling knowledge" which will erase the subjectivity of all beings. Depersonalization and objectification will happen under controlling knowledge in which the human eros is neglected (Tillich 1951: 99).

3.3.1.3 Multi-dimensional Structure

In volume three of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich repackaged the above analysis of beings and *logos* into a comprehensive and complex vision of life. A human being is the being-in-language who employs different conceptual tools to articulate her feelings and experience. The language s/he uses is not merely subjective but discloses an authentic experiential encounter with reality. Therefore, Tillich emphasized that the role of "metaphor" is to describe the experiential encounter between human beings and reality (Tillich 1959a: 402). The choosing of metaphorical language highly depends on the complex nature of human beings' experiential encounters; the changeability of using different metaphors reflects the different types of experience inherited in human experience (Tillich 1963: 15). In volume three of his *Systematic Theology*, when Tillich describes the ontological understanding of reality, he mentioned two types of metaphor: level and dimension.

For Tillich, "level" denotes a kind of hierarchical thinking in which all beings are classified and understood under different levels of a hierarchy. All beings are located in certain types of levels according to different criteria and considerations. Under this hierarchical vision, no dynamic and vertical moving exists and the arrangement would be fixed according to the level of power and values (Ibid.: 13). Ontologically speaking, the power and value of all beings are leveled; anthropologically speaking, mind, psychic and body within a human being are also leveled; from the perspective of nature, inorganic, organic and psychic are leveled (Tillich 1959a: 403). This "level"-metaphor emphasizes the equality of the same level.

> There is no organic movement from one to the other; the higher is not implicit in the lower; and the lower is not implicit in the higher. The relation of the levels is that of interference, either by control or by revolt (Tillich 1963: 13).

"Level" ontologically implies being self-contained and self-sufficient in different degrees in which the internal and the inner relationship between all beings is excluded (Tillich 1959a: 404). There is no internal dynamic for them to come across the boundary. In the relation of body and mind, the "level" metaphor would either reduce the mental to the organic, or assert the interference of mental activities in the biological and psychological processes (Ibid.; 1963: 14). In the relation of religion and culture, religion would be regarded as being at a superior level to control culture or some cultural functions; this suppression may lead to revolutionary reactions in which culture tries to engulf religion and subject it to autonomous reason (Ibid.).

In summary, Tillich asserted that this hierarchical thinking should be rejected. The configuration of reality would be neither a static, nor a self-sufficient leveled entity in which the mutual interpenetration and interaction are inconceivable. This level-hierarchical metaphor of the world is highly contradictory with Tillich's own theological imagination of the blurring of religion and culture. Also, Tillich noted that there are at least two crucial elements, which are powerful weapons for attacking this metaphor. In the Renaissance, the "coincidence of the opposites" from Nicholas of Cusa "mediates the infinity of the infinite and realizes that the infinite would cease to be infinite if the finite stood beside it as a limiting sphere" and Martin Luther in the Reformation, the idea of "*finitum compax infiniti*" and "the saint is a sinner, and the sinner is just, not because he has climbed to a higher level, but because God's forgiveness has descended to him" (Tillich 1959a: 403; 1963: 13). Hierarchical thinking is attacked by both philosophical and theological heritages.

Tillich preferred using "dimension" to replace the metaphor of "level". The reason why Tillich adopted this metaphor is "not the number of possible dimensions, but the nature of it" (Tillich 1959a: 405). Therefore, for the question of how many dimensions should exist, Tillich pointed out that we cannot limit the numbers a priori; the reality human beings encounter is open and dynamic. For the character of the metaphor "dimension":

> The difference of the realms of being in such a way that there cannot be mutual interference; depth does not interfere with breadth, since all dimensions meet in the same point. They cross without disturbing each other; there is no conflict between dimensions. Therefore, the replacement of the metaphor "level" by the metaphor "dimension" represents an encounter with reality in which the unity of life is seen above its conflicts. These conflicts are not denied, but they are not derived from the hierarchy of levels; they are consequences of the ambiguity of all life process and are therefore conquerable without the destruction of one level by another (Tillich 1963: 15).

In the above articulation, Tillich basically described the main idea of his holistic and cosmic views of reality in which different "dimensions" encounter each other with no conflicts caused by the structure itself. It denotes the harmonious character of the universe with tensions. Also, different "dimensions" are not atomic and self-contained; they fully and profoundly engage with each other in maintaining their own spheres. Therefore, different "dimensions" have their own unique and distinctive realms in which no interference is possible; different dimensions are interrelated and interpenetrated; the unity of different dimensions has the ontological priority over their tensions; the conflict and tension generated by different dimensions are not created by the hierarchical model of beings but occur in the mixture between essential and existential conditions which Tillich called "ambiguity".

Under this interpenetrating and holistic vision of reality, the metaphor of "dimension" discloses the possibility of the crossover of different dimensions. Tillich emphasized that each dimension is authentic and present in different modalities in which we can articulate the concept of "all-in-one". Neither dualistic, monastic nor pluralist perspectives are appropriated. Employing the Aristotelian distinction between *dynamis* and *energeia*, Tillich intensified his vision with the polarity of potentiality and actuality in which different dimensions are all present and real but in different modes. The matrix of "potentiality-actuality" is present and real in all dimensions but functions in different conditions. Therefore, for Tillich, "real" is not classified as the external existence in time and space but as a mode of existence. "Real" can be distinguished between "latent" and "manifest" conditions. The phrase "multi-dimensional unity of life" emphasizes two directions: unity with multitudes. Although some dimensions are not actual-

ized, they are still real in a potential sense. Therefore, in a potential sense of reality, all life is real because all dimensions are all present in different life-forms (Tillich 1963: 15 – 16). The question as to whether they are actualized will be dependent on certain conditions existing (Ibid.: 16). For example, in the dimension of an atom, an inorganic dimension is actualized but all other dimensions are potentially present (Ibid.: 16 – 17). Likewise, Tillich liberated the word, *life*, from the polarity of life and death, and universalizes it into all realms of beings: "the ontological concept of life liberates the word 'life' from its bondage to the organic realm and elevates it to the level of a basic term that can be used within the theological system only if interpreted in existential terms" (Ibid.: 12).

Therefore, echoing Tillich's earlier essay on "Nature and Sacrament", materialistic and spiritualistic reductionisms are rejected in favor of the dialectical relationship of vitalistic and naturalistic understanding with the depth of symbolic significance of the divine.[19] Therefore, the dispute between the physical and biological frameworks of the organic world would be avoided for the reason that these two methodological considerations basically function on two different dimensions of life (Ibid.: 14). "Either-or" is not the underlying principle of Tillich's multi-dimensionality. On the same line, biologism and psychologism are too extreme to level the body and the mind into different levels. Likewise, for Tillich, there is no super-being of the "super"-natural realm, or pure "natural" beings in "nature". Sacred and secularity, soul and body, ultimate and penultimate, organic and inorganic, etc., are mutually inter- and intra-related to each other.

Tillich's notion of "potentiality-actuality" can be easily misunderstood as an evolutionary approach for the process of all life forms. However, the picture is more complicated and subtle. Tillich himself had reservations about the concept of "process" partly because he found it difficult to commit to the teleological-progressive character of the idea of process. In his introduction to volume three of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich expressed clearly that he could not share the optimistic perception of Teilhard de Chardin's evolutionary idea of process. Likewise, at a more fundamental level, the futurist orientation of the concept of process is unacceptable because it overlooks the "existential" elements of reality. Tillich employed the Aristotelian distinction of the potentiality and actuality with a distinctive qualification that is closely linked with his "essence-existence" matrix. Life as the "actuality of being" denotes the existential character of the being. Although Tillich stated clearly that "the actualization of some dimensions of life is that others must already have been actualized" (Ibid.: 16); this does not imply that the process of actualization must be linear in a forward direction

19 For the full analysis of Tillich's earlier understanding of nature, see (3.2.2.).

(though it may be). Therefore, the question of whether Tillich's idea of the multi-dimensional unity of life consists of an evolutionary character is still unclear unless the full analysis of different ontological categories – spatiality, temporality, causality and substantiality – under the historical dimension is explored.[20]

In articulating different dimensions of life, Tillich employed the phenomenological method to determine the specialty of each dimension which is regarded as the given in reality. In contrast with any theoretical explanation or deduction, the number of dimensions is flexible (Tillich 1963: 17). The openness of the criterion for determining the special dimension offers the flexibility and uncertainty of the changeable nature of reality. "With these criteria in mind, and without any claim to finality, several obvious dimensions of life may be distinguished" (Ibid.). It seems that Tillich provided a rather weak justification as to why he distinguished the five dimensions: inorganic, organic, psychic, spiritual and historical. First, these five dimensions can best be seen in the modification of time, space, causality and substance (Ibid.: 18). Second, theologically, this classification was articulated under a theological system in order to "determine concretely the source and the consequences of the ambiguities of all life process" (Ibid.). For the first reason, Tillich explained that each dimension has its own criterion for determining the modality of these four categories, but all dimensions are united. All dimensions are classified into different but not separate categories. "Inorganic space and organic space are different spaces; psychological time and historical time are different times; and inorganic and spiritual causality are different causalities" (Ibid.). Therefore, all reductionist attempts are not justified and are rejected. For the second reason, the analysis of the different life-forms is not for the sake of natural scientific findings, but it provides a comprehensive analysis of the problem of the ambiguities in order to point to Christian answers.

The matrix of multi-dimensionality offers other alternatives for Tillich to abandon the highly confused categories, such as nature or matter, etc. Tillich mentioned the ontological priority of the inorganic dimension being not merely based on its overwhelming quantitatively character, but because this dimension should be regarded as the "first condition" for the actualization of all dimensions (Ibid.: 19). Without the actualization of the inorganic realm, the actualization of other dimensions is impossible. Therefore, the inorganic realm is the ground for the different dimensions of life. As mentioned before, other dimensions are potentially present in each dimension. "Matter" is wrongly characterized as pure material entity; therefore any scientific-naturalistic imperialism is

20 For the historical dimension of the ontological categories, see (4.1.2.2.).

excluded, not because scientific validity is non-Christian, but because other dimensions of reality would be ignored under its reductionist character.

Under the framework of multi-dimensionality of life forms, the question of the transition of one dimension to another dimension is inevitable. Under what condition can one dimension transform into another dimension? This question leads to a conflict between religious creationism, Aristotelian philosophy and biological evolutionary theory. Tillich affirmed the modern biological explanation of the genesis of the appearance of organisms, and pointed out there was no contradiction between Aristotelian potentiality and evolutionary actuality. Under the interplay between potentiality and actuality, the organic dimension is potentially present within the inorganic dimension. The question of whether and when the organic dimension could appear would be determined by certain preferable conditions. Likewise, it is interesting that Tillich articulated a world of self-relatedness. For him, the organic dimension is characterized as being a self-related, self-preserved, self-creating, and self-continuing *gestalt* (Ibid.: 20). However, all these functionalities of self-awareness are potentially present in every dimension, especially in the inorganic realm. Therefore, for Tillich, no thing is merely a thing. Tillich is not trying to provide a scientific proof for the existence of a mindful nature or the presence of a materialistic soul. Neither giving a mystical imagination, nor establishing an intuitive participation, Tillich intended to extend the concept of self-awareness into the material world. Then, how can Tillich justify this claim? We should bear in mind that, first, Tillich is trying to describe the ontological qualities of all beings instead of giving scientific experimental findings. Second, multi-dimensionality points to the "unity and diversity of life in its *essential nature*" (Ibid.: 12. Emphasis mine). For Tillich, "essentiality" means the potentiality, the power and the dynamic of the being. It is a state of "not-yet" and "to-be". Ontologically speaking, all beings share the basic "self-world" structure in which self-centeredness is present in all dimensions in different degrees. "Central structures are present not only in the organic but also in the inorganic realm, notably in the atomic and subatomic elements of matter" (Tillich 1954: 44 – 45). If the terminology of the self and the world carries too much anthropocentric character, Tillich actually did not intend to limit this basic polarity to the human world. In his *Love, Power and Justice*, the polarity of "center-whole" applies universally in the realm of all beings. For Tillich, all beings, inorganic or organic, have different degrees of self-centeredness in terms of power and force. In his volume three of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich linked the concept of individuality and centeredness together.

> Centeredness is a quality of individualization, in so far as the indivisible thing is the centered thing. To continue the metaphor, the center is a point, and a point cannot be divided.

> A centered being can develop another being out of itself, or it can be deprived of some parts, which belong to the whole; but the center as such cannot be divided-it can be destroyed. A fully individualized being, therefore, is at the same time a fully centered being (Tillich 1963: 32).

Neither the concept of "individualization" nor "centeredness" should be understood as a self-closed and self-sufficient atomic individual. For Tillich, all beings, despite embracing different degrees of these two ontological qualities, have certain dimensions of "centeredness". As Tillich said, "since individualization is an ontological pole, it has universal significance, and so has centeredness, which is the condition of the actualization of the individual in life" (Ibid. 33). The manifolds of all beings manifest different degrees of power, which is ontologically related to the dimensions of self-centeredness. In this sense, among all beings in the world, human beings embrace the most intensive dimension of self-centeredness; simultaneously, they are also the beings capable of participating in the power of the whole. In summary, "centeredness" should be universally employed in describing the micro- and macro-cosmic dimensions of the inorganic realm. The structural centeredness constitutes the form of being as being. Therefore, there is no ontological gap between inorganic and organic realms.

For the organic dimensions, Tillich preferred to adopt the *gestalt* understanding of the biological life forms. The distinctiveness of this dimension presents the appearance of self-awareness, which means that "all encounters of a being with its environment are experienced as related to the individual being that is aware of them" (Ibid.: 36). Under this interrelation between individual self and its environment, physical laws should not be regarded as the only valid way to conceive the behavior and production of biological life forms. *Gestalt* theory allows the possibility and actuality of the organic self-creation in which the structures are not pre-programmed and fixed. Self-creativity and all psychological patterns are organically textured within every organism in which they all have their "worlds" with certain meaningful structures.[21]

Following the philosophies of life, Tillich reserved the important dimension for "spirit", which designates the particularly human dimension of life and general description of all life forms. "Spirit" is the power of life, which nourishes all functions within different life forms. Tillich rejected attempts to reduce the dimensionality of spirit into the "intellectual mind" and was discontented with a spiritualistic interpretation of reality. Back to the original element of this term, it denotes the unity of power and meaning (Ibid. 22). The dimensionality of the *pneuma* should not be regarded as the highest realm of the unity of life

21 For the analysis of Tillich's idea of biological self-creation, see (4.1.2.1.).

which is external and alien to all other dimensions; it embraces human consciousness, perception, intention and rationality but transcends all of them in range, in structure and in dynamics (Ibid.: 24).

Tillich confirmed the relationship between the metaphor of "multi-dimensional unity" and the graduation of value. Under the hierarchy-level metaphor, the beings at the highest level are counted by the criterion favorable to human beings, e. g. the power of rationality or ethical consciousness, etc. It follows that human beings would be regarded as the highest and perfect beings due to the high amount of these qualities that they have. However, based on the rejection of the hierarchical-level vision, the valuation of different dimensions needs to follow another scheme for the criterion. Tillich called it an ontological criterion, which is "according to the rule that value judgments must be rooted in qualities of the objects valuated, and it is a criterion which should not be confused with that of perfection" (Ibid.: 17). The graduation of the value system must be derived from the ontological structure and its elements. Tillich expressed that "the criterion of such value judgment is the power of a being to include *a maximum number of potentialities* in one living actuality" (Ibid. Emphasis mine). This implies that the reason for counting a being with a higher value is based on the number of the potentialities within this dimension which are actualized. Therefore, human beings would be in the highest grade because nearly all dimensions are potentially present in the dimension of human beings. For Tillich, a human being is the highest being, not based on the consideration of the hierarchical grading system but on an ontological structural analysis.

For Tillich, the highest does not imply the most perfect (Tillich 1951: 260; 1963:17). There is no necessary connection between the rankings of the beings and the degree of the valuation that the beings embrace. Even so, Tillich seemed to assert that it is difficult, if not impossible, to compare the perfectibility between the natural world and human beings. "Subhuman does not imply less perfection than in the case of the human. On the contrary, man as the essentially threatened creature cannot compare with the natural perfection of the subhuman creatures. Subhuman points to a different ontological level, not to a different degree of perfection" (Tillich 1951:260). Although Tillich does not provide the universal criterion for perfection, we can assume that no being has achieved this stage of perfection because all life, as the actuality of being, from potentiality to actuality, is a mixture of essential and existential elements. Instead of perfection, Tillich articulated the ambiguity of all the beings in the process of the actualization. Also, human beings are threatened creatures in a sense that they would either maintain their state of potentiality, or even destroy their essential structure (Carpenter 1988: 43). Therefore, human beings and nature are under

the structure of "fall" which means both are committed to an ambiguous situation. For Tillich, the title of the "highest being" is reserved to the human being.

3.3.2 Ecstatic Naturalism

3.3.2.1 Ecstasy and Self-transcendence

The category of "transcendence and immanence" was abandoned by Tillich in describing the relationship between God and the world because this pair of concepts commits the error of the demarcation between naturalistic and supernaturalistic interpretations in which, first, the spatial imagery is constituted as open to the misunderstanding of different levels of reality. Also, second, God and the world would be easily misinterpreted either as two separated beings or one static whole. Tillich rightly understood the idea of *deus sive natura* as the identification of God with the creative ground of nature; the naturalistic idea of God is in danger of the failure to have the distinction between the finite and the infinite. That means, for Tillich, supernaturalism is correct in locating an infinite distance between God and the world, but the notion of the highest being among the beings would be established in destroying the authentic meaning of the infinite and the finite as well. Also, naturalism is right in asserting the idea of God as the creative ground for all beings, but the ontological distinction is erased.

Tillich proposed an "ecstatic" understanding of God and the world, and this idea was first articulated in his early essay, "Realism and Faith" (1929), and was further developed in volume one and volume three of *Systematic Theology* in which Tillich's pneumatology provides a profound interpretation of this concept. Divine manifestation, for Tillich, is never disclosed in a vacuum, but is within the context of natural phenomena, ordinary experience and secular realms, etc.; and transcends all the basic structures of these contexts without destroying them. This basic assertion of divine revelation includes, first, the depth and ultimate meaning of the non-divine contexts which are manifested. Based on the identity of the finite and the infinite, absolute and relative, the divine precedes nature and manifests through it (Tillich 1951: 79). Second, the heteronomous and the autonomous character of the divine manifestation are strongly rejected through the way of the unity of the depth and the power of being-itself. Third, the subject-object dichotomy is overcome in a theonomous union in which the subject and the object are united in a dialectical identity without losing their own identity.

The above characteristics of the divine manifestation point to the ideas of "mystery", "ecstasy", and "miracle". In volume one of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich emphasized that the ecstatic experience given by the presence of the Holy Spirit is always misinterpreted as the "antirational" and "irrational"

which would ultimately violate the basic essential-rational structure of all beings. Ecstasy denotes something beyond the finite structure through the ontological shock of the manifestation of being-itself (Tillich 1951: 112–113). Furthermore, as Tillich asserted that revelation is salvation, this ecstatic-revelatory experience must embrace the healing and transforming power through the participation of the power of being in general and in the power of the New Being in Jesus as the Christ in particular (Tillich 1957: 167). The ecstatic condition always embraces the subjective and objective sides into one whole. They are not separated. As with the idea of ultimate concern, Tillich emphasized not only what ultimately concerns human beings subjectively, but also objectively "that which determines our being or not-being" (Tillich 1951: 11–14). If the concept of "ecstasy" denotes the divine manifestation subjectively elevating out of being, the concept of "miracle" refers to the same event objectively. These two correlated concepts share the basic assertion that the mystery of divine revelation does not destroy the natural structure of reality, but manifests the divine substance through this structure. The world is regarded as the sign-events of God's manifestation in which, first, the nonbeing of the natural events is transformed and healed by God's grace and power. Second, all beings in nature function as the symbols signifying the mystery of God. Last, the ecstatic experience occurs in the divine presence (Tillich 1951: 117).

In volume three of *Systematic theology*, Tillich located the above divine manifestation and its revelatory experience within the doctrine of pneumatology. Divine Presence represents the Holy Spirit embodied in nature and brings nature into the self-transcendence stage. Therefore, the mode of presence is not only "resting" there but also "driving out" (Tillich 1963: 112). "The spirit, a dimension of finite life, is driven into a successful self-transcendence" (Ibid.). Under the idea of the multi-dimensional unity of life, Spirit-created ecstasy expresses the universal impact on all realms of life, and thus the problem of the ambiguities of all dimensions could be answered. Tillich emphasized that the power of the Spiritual Presence does not destroy the structure of the natural world, but fulfills the ontological and essential structure of the objective world. Following the logic of the identity of subject and object, the Holy Spirit and nature would maintain their own substances without merging into the one. However, the union overcomes the dualistic opposition between the divine and nature.

> He who contemplates is aware of the ontological structure of the universe, but he sees it ecstatically under the impact of the spiritual Presence in light of the ground and aim of all being. He who prays earnestly is aware of his own situation and his "neighbor's" but he sees it under the spiritual presence's influence and in the light of the divine direction of life's processes. In these experiences, nothing of the objective world is dissolved into mere subjectivity. Rather, it is all preserved and even increased ... A union of subject

> and object has taken place in which the independent existence of each is overcome; new unity is created (Ibid.: 119).

The objective nature is no longer regarded as the representation of a human subject's ideas, and the essential nature of human beings and nature is re-created in a transcendent union which is grounded by the dynamic-universal structure of the Holy Spirit.

3.3.2.2 Self-transcending Realism

In constructing the fruitful alternative between supernaturalism and naturalism, Tillich proposed an "ecstatic" or "self-transcendence" to understand the relationship between the power of being and all beings. These two ideas are identical in which the finite natural world is able to be a symbol to point beyond itself towards something ultimate. Therefore, no dualistic separation and static monism are possible (Tillich 1957: 7). For Tillich, the authentic structure of nature should be positively confirmed; otherwise, its objectivity would be easily dissolved into the representation of subjectivity. This objective structure should be packaged as the form of the religious substance. This attitude of "self-transcending realism" is well articulated by the artistic expressionist style which also influenced Tillich's entire theological thinking.

For Tillich, expressionist artists were concerned with the cosmic setting and the immeasurable depth of their paintings in which the spiritual meaning of the real structure of nature is manifested through their natural forms (Tillich 1929b: 66 – 67). Realism is regarded as the rejection of supernaturalism and idealism because the former does not allow the transcendent power within the structure and the latter negates the gap between the unconditional and conditional. Like the biblical picture of Jesus as the Christ, the biblical writers neither portray the objective biographical details of the historical Jesus, nor project the idealistic image onto the historical figure. Tillich adopted the expressionist approach in the "historical" writings about Jesus as the Christ in that writers (painters) are grasped by the New Being created by the Holy Spirit, and participate in the profound meaning of the subject matter. Therefore, the product is neither a naturalistic copy nor an idealistic ideal. The self-transcendent meaning of the divine manifested through the realistic formation of the subject is also manifested through every encounter with the biblical picture of the New Being (Tillich 1957: 116).

In his "Realism and Faith" (1929), Tillich distinguished three types of realism: technological, mystical and historical. The technological realism transforms the human *logos* as the controlling rationality and reduces the multi-leveled reality to one dimension or level of being. Therefore, the union of human logos and

nature is diminished. The mystical type is in danger of negating the real structure of reality. Though both of them are struggling for victory over the other, they both share the weakness of negating concrete historical existence. Historical realism should be linked with the self-transcendent faith in which "the ultimate power of being, the ground of reality, appears in a special moment, in a concrete situation, revealing the infinite depth and the eternal significance of the present" (Tillich 1929b: 78). Tillich reminded us that this divine historical manifestation through the historical present is both regarded as grace and judgment. The divine power both confirms and negates the power of a being in order to transform it to be the transparent being bearing the power of the being. Therefore, realism should be always "transcendent" in a sense that the ecstatic experience grasped by the Holy Spirit is presupposed.

3.3.3 Pneumatological Sacramentality

3.3.3.1 Nature as Sacrament

No thing in nature is merely a thing (Tillich 1963: 34). This simple sentence expresses a dynamic and unifying perspective about the multi-dimensional unity of life in Tillich's theology. Nature, a highly ambiguous term, in Tillich's eyes, is viewed neither as the scientific-technological object nor the magical substance, but is to be perceived theologically as "the finite expression of the infinite ground of all things" (Tillich 1948a: 4). His "*infra Lutheranum*" background allows us to adopt a mutual indwelling of the two natures of Christology in which the presence of the infinite in everything finite is theologically possible, and Schelling's idealist philosophy of nature provides him with the ground of the philosophical identity between humans and nature.

Any object or event would become a medium functioning as a sacramentality in which the transcendent is perceived to be present (Tillich 1929a: 108). In his early essay, "Nature and Sacrament", Tillich expressed a new theory of realistic sacramentality in which several understandings of nature are rejected. He outlined some more common conceptions of nature: magical-sacramental, rational-objective, vitalistic, and symbolic-romantic. First, the magical-sacramental view of nature considers everything to be filled "with a sort of material energy which gives to things and to parts of things, even to the body and the parts of the body, a sacral power" (Ibid.: 100). As the distinction between sacred and the profane is not a fundamental one, "the natural power in things is, at the same time, their sacral power, and any commerce with them is always both ritualistic and utilitarian" (Ibid.). Second, there has never been a merely magical relation to nature; this is most impressively and consistently expressed by math-

ematical physics and the technical control of nature. Now there are merely "things" in nature. Tillich expressed:

> Nature is brought under control, objectified, and stripped of its qualities. No sacramental conception can find a root in this soil. Nature cannot become the bearer of a transcendent power; it can at most be an image of it, a witness to it. But the rational-objective view of nature is also never fully applicable. The qualities of things resist any attempt at their complete eradication. Even in the structure of the atom there is something primordial, a *Gestalt*, an intrinsic power. And the highly complicated machines created by the applied sciences are, in many ways, analogous to the basic organic forms; they can gain a new magical power over the minds of those who serve them (Ibid.).

Third, in the vitalistic philosophy of nature, everything, the whole world-process, is envisaged as an expression of life, and an immediate power of being is attributed to things. In this philosophy, "nature recovers its power again, but it is a power without meaning; and power without meaning is ultimately impotent" (Ibid.). Last, "the symbolic-romantic interpretation of nature attempts to give back to nature its qualitative character, its depth, its meaningfulness, by interpreting nature as a symbol of the spirit. The power of things is the power of soul or spirit in them" (Ibid.). This view provides rich possibilities for interpretation, but again, it is not a sufficient view: this view "is very little aware of the real structure of nature. It gives us the creations of an arbitrary imagination. The quantitative, calculable "nature" of physics is certainly not overcome by it; only subjective imagination has been added" (Ibid.). All these fail in some crucial way to bridge the dualism of matter and spirit/ mind and reality.

Against all the above understandings of nature, Tillich attempted to retrieve the sacramental power inherent in nature. Therefore, the latter two views, vitalistic and symbol-romantic, are closely accepted by his realist approach. Nature is not only a chaotic mass, but is embodied with sacred power without the loss of the real structure of the being of nature. Likewise, although Tillich emphasized that the character or quality of nature itself is closely related to the sacred power it symbolizes, those qualities are only to be considered as the bearer of a sacred power. Therefore, the quality of the natural object is a necessary but not sufficient condition for becoming a sacrament. In his volume one of *Systematic Theology*, based on the universal-ontological understanding of being-itself, Tillich insisted that nothing is excluded from the participation of the ultimate ground of beings, and nothing is qualified and worthy in itself to represent ultimate concern. This is the reason why the whole reality has become a medium of revelation but is never identified with the divine (Tillich 1951:118). The power and meaning of nature are disclosed through, but are not in, the objective physical structure. Tillich emphasized that the subjective and objective approaches of understand-

ing nature are not sufficient. In this context, Tillich tended to accept that nature embodies a kind of symbolic character in revealing something ultimate.

For Tillich, the whole theology of sacramentality relies on a theology of realism, which is inspired by Tillich's favorable artistic style, expressionism. For Tillich, in rejecting the subjective-impressionist and objective-naturalist style, the core of expressionism is the cosmic setting and its immeasurable depth (Tillich 1929b: 66). Therefore, the reality of expressionism is not the empirical-observable realms of beings that belong to the realm of scientific-technological matrix, but is the depth dimension of reality. Because this realism "is not interested in the natural forms of things for their own sake but for their power of expressing the profounder levels and the universal significance of things" (Tillich 1929b: 67). Tillich called it a kind of "self-transcending realism" (*glaubiger Realismus*), which "is a universal attitude toward reality. It is neither a merely theoretical view of the world, nor a practical discipline for life ... it is a basic attitude in every realm of life, expressing itself in the shaping of every realm" (Tillich 1929b: 67). Basically, the basic modality and structure of nature is confirmed but not closed with a sense that the ultimate reality is not trapped on the surface of an empirical reality. The realistic attitude functions not as a transcending escape from reality, but as a key to opening the power and meaning of the depth of reality. Therefore, the invisible power and meaning is always manifested through the visible forms of the beings. Following Tillich's "*form-Inhalt-Gehalt*" framework of theology of culture, the spiritual *gehalt* reveals its power and meaning through the natural forms and structures. Tillich emphasized that this approach is not to idealize the real through projecting the idealistic substance into the natural phenomenon. On the contrary, the dimension of faith in this realism is to confirm and transcend the structure of reality at the same time. It points to the really real. Through the given natural forms, this realism functions as symbolic embodiment and "tries to point to the spiritual meaning of the real by using its given form" (Tillich 1929b: 67).

It is understandable, for Tillich, to reject both the Catholic idea of transubstantiation, which transforms a symbol into a thing to be handled, and the reformed tradition of the sign character of the sacramental symbol (Tillich 1963: 123). Considering the Catholic side, nature as symbol presenting the spiritual power is not functioning as "*opus operatum*" in order to receive the objective grace from the divine power. Considering the reformed side, it is also not a sign for the faith community to remember the divine saving event in the past. In summary, it participates in the power of what it symbolizes and, therefore, it can be a medium of the Spirit (Tillich 1963: 123).

The sacramental material is not only a sign, but also it stands for a symbol participating in what it signifies and is intrinsically related to what is expressed

(Tillich 1963: 123). The theology of symbol is closely related to his self-transcending realism. Self-transcending realism confirms the concrete form of nature as the embodiment of spiritual power and meaning. Tillich insisted: "The new realism was not interested in the natural forms of things for their own sake, but for their power of expressing the profounder levels and the universal significances of things" (Tillich 1929b: 67). For Tillich, symbol participates in the power and meaning it symbolizes. The ontology of symbol establishes a double-edged function in which the infinite was forced downward towards the finite and the finite was forced upwards towards the infinite (Tillich 1951: 240). The divine can be disclosed in the secular through symbolic participation. Nothing in nature is excluded as not qualified as the potential medium of divine revelation. "It is not the thing or the event as such which has revelatory character; they reveal that which uses them as a medium and bearer of revelation" (Ibid.: 119). Tillich had sufficient awareness of the danger of demonization of religious symbols; therefore, the power of the symbol manifests itself as participation in the divine on one hand; also it should manifest a kind of self-negating power to conquer the demonic domination within the symbol on the other. A symbol is qualified as the bearer of the divine only if it contains the elements that can symbolize the Other, and it should conceal the elements to let it have transparency before the divine. We can conclude that this double qualification of a religious symbol is grounded in Tillich's Christological considerations.

Tillich's sacramental theology is closely linked with his doctrine of salvation. In Tillich's early demonstration of sacramental thinking, Christology and soteriology are linked with the power of sacramental bearer. In order to attack magical and mythological usage, the Protestant tradition should bring nature into the context of the history of salvation where the demonic quality of nature is conquered in the New Being manifested in Jesus Christ (Tillich 1929a: 102–103). "Any sacramental reality within the framework of Christology and of Protestantism must be related to the new being in Christ" (Tillich 1929a: 109). For Tillich, the New Being manifested in Jesus as the Christ is the new creation universe. Moreover, in his Christology, the essential Godmanhood manifesting within existential and historical conditions, is interpreted not merely as a religious personality, but *as a basic divine sacramental reality* (Tillich 1948a: xxiii. Emphasis mine). Cosmic Christ as the New Being also represents the paradoxical character of the divine symbol in which "the absolute side of the final revelation, that in it which is unconditional and unchangeable, involves *the complete transparency* and *the complete self-sacrifice* of the medium in which it appears" (Tillich 1951:151. Emphasis mine).

In Tillich's early articulation of self-transcendent realism and the idea of sacramentality, he proposed a "new realism" in which power and meaning are

found within physical nature and historical reality, not superimposed upon them. "The power and meaning of nature must be sought within and through its objective physical structures. Power and physical character, meaning and objective structure, are not separated in nature. We cannot accept the word of mathematical science as the last word about nature, although we do not thereby deny that it is the first word" (Tillich 1929a: 101–102). Also, "the power of nature must be found in a sphere prior to the cleavage of our world into subjectivity and objectivity. Life originates on a level which is "deeper" than the Cartesian duality of *cogitation* and *extensio*" (Ibid.:102). The apprehension of the inherent powers of nature is not easy, especially for rational discourse. "Everything which is merely object can be approached directly with scientific reasoning and technical tools. That which precedes mere objectivity needs initiation" (Tillich 1929b: 65). Technical reason is not capable of overcoming technological realism, in which case, the rational person subjects things to control and use. Since the power of being is discovered by thought, the thinking subject in this case may become, intentionally or unintentionally, the bearer of all power. One concedes to things only so much power as they should have in order to be useful. Reason becomes the means of controlling the world. The really real (*ousia*) of things is their calculable element, that which is determined by natural laws. Anything beyond this level is without interest and not an object of knowledge. This relation to reality is called "realistic" today (Ibid.:69–70). Tillich describes his realist perspective of the sacramental nature:

> If nature is interpreted in this realistic and, at the same time, historical way, natural objects can become bearers of transcendent power and meaning, they can become sacramental elements ... Nature, by being brought into the context of the history of salvation, is liberated from its ambiguity. Its demonic quality is conquered in the new being in Christ. Nature is not the enemy of salvation; it does not have to be controlled in scientific, technical, and moral terms to be deprived of any inherent power, in order to serve the "Kingdom of God," ... nature is a bearer and an object of salvation (Tillich 1929a:102–103).

The emancipation of nature from the demonic distortion is enhanced by Tillich's early theology of history and the doctrine of Christ through which the kairological revelation within human history manifests the redemptive power in overcoming the distorted condition and empowers the nature to be the bearer of the depth of history. In his "Kairos and Logos" (Tillich 1926a), "nature with its forms and laws is always a heavy weight on the scale of thought for a static and against a dynamic epistemology. This is particularly true where nature is under the rule of mathematical form, and therefore is removed almost completely from the decisive character of perception ... But *to tear apart from nature and*

history and distribute them into two kinds of metaphysics would mean to disrupt genuine elements of reality" (Ibid.: 162. Emphasis mine).

In volume three of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich tried to develop the doctrine of pneumatology in order to answer numerous criticisms on one hand, and to re-articulate his theological perspective in the light of the doctrine of the Holy Spirit on the other.[22] Though Tillich emphasized that the divine spirit is essentially correlated with the human spirit, it does not exclude the Spiritual presence indwelling in the whole multi-dimensional unity of life. Given the rejection of the dualistic and supernaturalist reduction, the Spiritual power and meaning manifests as the "dimension of the ultimate" or "the dimension of depth" (Tillich 1963: 113). That means that Tillich rejected the idea of mechanical understanding of the spiritual causal participation in the universe, for this conceptuality would seriously reduce the Spirit as one of the physical causes within the matrix of causality. Likewise, the universality of the Spiritual Presence is the expression of the radical effective embodiment of all personal and historical events. Therefore, for Tillich, we have no reason to adopt the narrow sense of the concept of "sacramental" which denotes some particular objects and acts as qualified to be the medium in the experience of divine spirit in a faith community; but, rather, to enlarge the sense to *cover everything* in which the Spiritual Presence has been experienced (Tillich 1963:121. Emphasis mine). The Spiritual community "is free to appropriate *all symbols* which are adequate and which possess symbolic power" (Tillich 1963:123. Emphasis mine). In traditional Christianity, word and sacrament come together. For Tillich, under the impact of Spiritual presence, all human spoken words and the biblical written word function as the mediators of the Spirit.[23]

If everything in the world is potentially regarded as a symbol, which symbolizes and participates in the divine, the divine as the Spirit indwells in all beings. Through the sacramental thinking, the divine Spirit and the world interpenetrate into each other. Every being participates in the power and the ground of being;

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22 For the interplay between Christology and pneumatology in the development of Tillich's theology, see chapter two.

23 As I argue in chapter two, Tillich seemed to have a more sympathetic understanding towards the radical reformers' view of the disclosure of the Holy Spirit in human inwardness and the legitimacy of human experience in theology. Therefore, for the relationship between the Word and the Spirit in the Reformation, in contrast with the Reformed tradition, Tillich seems to embrace the power and meaning of the Word within the boundary of the Spirit. Though the Holy Spirit would not reveal something external and alien to the Word, but will enhance the different levels of meaning and power of the Word. This is the reason why Tillich called Spirit Word-creating Spirit instead of Word-witnessing Spirit in a sense that Spirit does not increase the amount of the word but profoundly enriches the deepest meaning of the Word.

therefore, it is adequate to express everything is "in" God or God is "in" everything. However, Tillich reminded us that, in articulating the relationship between God and the world, both concepts of transcendence and of immanence are committed into the charge of spatial imagery whose validity is limited and bound within the finite structure (Tillich 1951: 263). However, this does not mean that temporality and spatial imagery are forbidden in describing the relationship of God and the world. "Immanence and transcendence are spatial symbol" (Tillich 1951: 263). The danger of applying those finite symbols into the essence of God is to reduce the infinity of God into something finite. Therefore, the function of the symbol tries to remind us that the application of the symbol is intended to point to something qualitative inside of God.

Tillich has often been charged with entering into the danger of pantheistic understanding in which God and nature are identical with each other, and this resets the list of God's transcendence and the collapse of the distinction between God and the world. Commentators have charged him with reducing all beings to the being of God, and vice visa. However, it is unfair to locate Tillich in the camp of pantheism, despite his insistence on expressing God as the ground and the power of beings. First, it is absurd to identify God as the totality of beings. Tillich emphasized that, what Spinoza highlighted as *deus sive natura*, God is identical with the creative nature (*natura naturans*) instead of the assemblies of natural beings (*natura naturata*) (Tillich 1957: 6). Therefore, second, exactly in line with the above assertion, Tillich rejected naturalist pantheism and upheld the infinite distance between the whole of natural objects and the infinite ground of beings. As Tillich said, "God as the ground of being infinitely transcends that of which he is the ground" (Tillich 1957:7). Third, in volume two of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich once again mentioned a phrase, self-transcending, to indicate the complex relationship between God and the world. In abandoning the idea of a "super"-naturalist understanding of God, Tillich asserted that the main problem of the supernaturalist matrix is that it is not only incorrect in projecting the spatial imagery onto God (God in a highest realm), but he also theologically asserted the demarcation between God and the world in which no mutual participation is possible (Ibid.: 7). The danger of supernaturalism is to make "the finite pointing beyond itself" inconceivable (Ibid.: 7).

The theology of pan-sacramentality tries to present the "ecstatic" character of God and the world. In volume one of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich located this concept in the discussion of divine revelation and human reason. "Ecstasy" means the human mind is grasped by the divine mystery and transcends, not destroying its own structure and ordinary situation, but going beyond itself (Tillich 1951: 112). Even if human rationality is shocked in the ecstatic experience, its rational structure and form are maintained. Divine revelation always manifests it-

self through a rational framework, and reason is grasped to point to something beyond itself. Following this line, in volume two of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich applied the above ideas universally to the relationship between God and the world. "Ecstasy as a state of mind is the exact correlate to self-transcendence as the state of reality." (Tillich 1957: 8) That means, theologically, the whole reality is experienced within the mystery of divine revelation and presence, and the structure of the whole reality is the divine expression of the divine. Tillich clarified that, when the world symbolically participates in and points to the divine, the world negates itself and affirms itself (Tillich 1957: 9). Therefore, the world as sacrament means the world is to be negated and to be confirmed by the divine at the same time. "Whatever one knows about a finite thing one knows about God, because it is rooted in him as its ground ... anything one knows about a finite thing cannot be applied to God" (Tillich 1957: 9). This dialectical understanding (confirmation and negation) of symbolic knowledge between God and the world constitutes the epistemological assumption of Tillich's idea of the pan-sacramentality of the world.

3.3.3.2 Pneumatological Protest and *Gestalt*

Tillich's concept of pneumatological sacramentality tries to amalgamate his early theological dialectic between divine confirmation and negation, and the forming-creating and forming-negating power engendered in the Protestant principle through a pneumatological perspective. For the early Tillich, the articulation of the idea of a theology of culture meant establishing a positive and unified matrix in which religion and culture were organically combined. Also, it is misleading to assert that the purpose of Tillich's theology of culture is to accommodate religious content and cultural expressions. The dialectical divine yes and no are always in the heart of his entire theology. During his German period, in Tillich's project of religious socialism, the Unconditioned was by no means limited wholly and completely in some particular conditioned, even in the religious sphere, and, simultaneously, the Unconditioned was fully present and empowered in every cultural and political group. This kind of double-movement of the "*gestalt* of grace" combing the divine transcendent criticism and immanent embodiment is paradoxically interdependent with each other (1929e: 206).

In his early essay, "The Formative Power of Protestantism" (1929), Tillich appreciated the "theology of the Word of God" powerfully expressed in the Reformed-Barthian tradition, for providing a transcendent and critical judgment towards the secular world, and attempting to differentiate the Word of God and the word of the human. However, Tillich emphasized, despite this type of theology (Tillich later called it the "supernatural" type) which inspired the source and

the ground of his Protestant Principle, the ultimate foundation of theological protest must not be grounded in an anti-secular religious realm, but should be in the interplay of the immanent power which is inherent in the structure of reality, and the infinite distinction between beings and being-itself. Therefore, as Tillich claimed that, the power of this principle is always in but not of and above us (Ibid.: 210). The theological critical power is closely stamped with the divine grace of reality. For the Protestant principle can be connected with the Catholic substance, but both are distinguished from each other.

> In contrast to this Catholic understanding of the reality of grace ..., Protestantism asserts that grace appears through a living Gestalt which remains in itself what it is. The divine appears through the humanity of the Christ, through the historical weakness of the church, through the finite material of the sacrament. The divine appears through the finite realities as their transcendent meaning (Ibid.: 212).

In contrast with the Catholic transmutation and the sanctification of reality, Tillich asserted the importance of the mediating character of the Protestant conception of grace in which the divine transcendent grace would not be blurred with the immanent part of the world; rather both are interrelated through the mutual participation between God and the world. Tillich located this idea of mutual participation within the matrix of the Lutheran Christological formula, *finitum capax infiniti*. Also, with the *communicatio idiomatum* of the two natures in Jesus Christ, there is no difficulty in conceiving the unity in difference in the co-structure of God and the world. Tillich's universal application of the concept of "*gestalt* of grace" extends into the idea of the church, Christ and even the whole of reality.

The essential component of Tillich's Protestant Principle is to resist and to critique all identification of the finite with the infinite; this criticism rejects the demonic *hybris* within the realm of all human creation and production. If Tillich's sacramental thinking tries to escape the charge of the consecration of nature, it is reasonable for him to introduce this Protestant principle as a transcendent criterion and judgment for differentiating the divine and nature. This is the reason why Tillich reminded us that the concept of the purely natural sacrament is unacceptable in a Christian sense, and that nature should be redeemed through participation in the history of salvation in order to be liberated from its demonic elements (Tillich 1929a: 110). However, salvation is not to destroy and to demolish the structure of reality. Divine grace has two hands through which all the finite forms of reality are restricted not to go beyond its boundary, and participate in the deep structure of all realities through the divine indwelling in it. Therefore, Tillich tried to combine the criticism offered by the Protestant princi-

ple and the embodiment offered by the Catholic substance in the concept of *gestalt* of grace that is Christologically grounded.

As mentioned in chapter two, the development of Tillich's theology underwent a shift from Christology to pneumatology in which the tension of the universality and particularity is unveiled in nearly all Christian doctrines. The concept of the Protestant principle, as Tillich emphasized, should be concrete in a sense that "the Protestant protest against itself must not remain merely dialectical" (Tillich 1929: 213), theology should allow this powerful principle, fully expressing its criticism within the realm of secularity. It follows that Tillich distinguished the reality of the Protestant ecclesiastical reality, which would properly lose its true nature, and the empowerment of the Protestant principle, which was originally based on the historical particularity of Christian faith, but not bound by it. In 1948, in order to maintain the tension between the protest power against itself and remaining itself, Tillich grounded this whole theological criticism and grace in his Christological assertion: In the power of the New Being that is manifest in Jesus as the Christ (Tillich 1948a: xxii). For the transcendent and the immanent side of the Christology enabled Tillich at that time to articulate a principle which originally came from its particularity in history, but which is by no means restricted by history and manifests the *gestalt* of the divine presence universally. Even Tillich seemed not to be aware, even implicitly, of this type of tension in his Protestant principle and the Catholic substance; or we can assert that Tillich seemed quite satisfied with putting this burden onto the shoulders of his Christology.

In 1963, the emergence of pneumatology in a certain sense restructures and repackages nearly all theological answers provided by Tillich's Christological claims. In his introduction to volume three of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich slightly touched on this problem and reminded his readers that, in this volume, one of the main targets was to unite the Protestant principle and the Catholic substance (Tillich 1963: 6). Tillich intensively discussed the essential and the existential nature of the spiritual community through the interplay between the Protestant principle and the Catholic substance. Within the line of his early articulation of the concept of the church, Tillich tried to argue for the "latent" and "manifest" stages of the spiritual community in which the former one expresses the divine grace as unlimited despite being "hidden" within the realm of secularity; this secular realm is an embodiment of the divine criticism towards the church. The latter one is no longer "invisible" and open to assert the power of the New Being manifest in Jesus as the Christ. Tillich does not distinguish between two different and unrelated entities of religious communities, but radically asserted that spiritual power is ontologically, authentically and universally presence in all communities, even anti-Christian churches. Spiritual Presence mani-

fests itself immanently in different communities, enabling themselves to be the *gestalt* of grace and, at the same time, radically condemns all attempts at the demonization and profanization. Tillich correlated his early Christology and later pneumatology under the category of the spiritual community in a threefold sense. "In mankind as a whole in preparation for the central manifestation of the divine spirit, in the divine Spirit's central manifestation itself, and in the manifestation of the Spiritual Community under the creative impact of the central event" (Tillich 1963: 149). The central event or manifestation – the New Being – is coupled with the divine Spirit. For Tillich, the power manifesting and grounded in the New Being is not merely restricted by the historical particularity of the center of history, Jesus as the Christ but, in a universal way, experienced by the Spiritual Presence in the different realms.

It is clear that Tillich located his radical interpretation of the infinite and unconditioned power, which is grounded in the Protestant tradition, but went beyond it, into the "prophetic Spirit" (Tillich 1963: 245). This Spirit of the prophetic tradition transcends all particular churches and every realm of religious or quasi-religious groups and, ontologically, indwells and is present in the innermost being of all groups and different realms. This universal and communitarian idea of the Holy Spirit, for Tillich, seems more adequate in balancing the universality and the particularity of the concrete manifestation with the universal empowerment embodied in the New Being. Also, his lifelong insistence on the critical power inherent in the Protestant Principle seems organically and perfectly mixed with the immanent forming-power expressed in a concept of pneumatological *gestalt* (despite Tillich never employing this phrase).

4 Persons and Nature

4.1 Reciprocity

Tillich asserted a belief that human persons and nature are ontological and existential, intertwined through recursive, interactive, causally efficacious, historical relations. In short, the idea of "reciprocity" serves as an overarching theoretical framework for the paradigm. Within this framework, the epistemology, metaphysics and axiology are holistically interrelated as an isomorphic structure between human beings and nature. Thus, the keystone concept of reciprocity establishes the paradigm's systematic unity. Tillich conceived of the relationships between nature and persons as manifold and complex. In his volume one of *Systematic Theology*, the basic ontological structure and elements of all beings are formally established as the fundamental articulation of the creatures. Thus, in his volume three of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich intensified and expanded this formal ontological articulation in a material-substantial vision in which, firstly, the dynamic picture between persons and nature are reconstructed as a multi-dimensional unity of life. Secondly, the formal ontological structure in volume one is packaged into the "actualizing process" in volume three through the bipolar process of the *dynamis* and *energeia*. Lastly, human *pneuma* is firstly discussed in volume three as a key concept *to differentiate and to maintain* the continuity between persons and nature. Tillich's key concept of persons and nature as microcosmos and macrocosmos respectively, cannot be understood if the above discussion has not been fully illustrated.

4.1.1 Life Structure and Elements

For Tillich, the fundamental basic structure between persons and nature is described as a dialectic-polar structure of "self-world" from which all other ontological, epistemological and ethical structures are derived. Thus, the dialectical polarity of persons and nature constitutes the interrelation and interpenetration between the human self and the natural environment. "Each pole is meaningful only in so far as it refers by implication to the opposite pole" (Tillich 1951: 165). Likewise, no isolated entity is possible and the epistemological distinction of a subject-object scheme is possible only if this basic primordial structure is assumed. That is why, based on this complementarity of self and world, Tillich strongly rejected subjective idealism and objective realism in which the former would never reach the boundary of the objective world, or all contents in nature

https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110612752-005

are only the projection of the absolute self; and the latter would find it difficult to answer the ground and the possibility of objective knowledge. "The self without a world is empty; the world without a self is dead" (Ibid.: 171).

Tillich emphasized that this dialectic-polar structure of "self-world" is never the object among other objects which would fall into the category of epistemological subject-object distinction. Actually, this correlated concept is the power and the horizon for constituting the possibility of other ontological and epistemological relations. Therefore, a human person, under a categorical framework, is not a Cartesian knowing ego or a liberal-atomic individual. This human person "includes the subconscious and the unconscious 'basis' of the self-conscious ego as well as self-consciousness" (Ibid.: 169). The idea of self should be never reduced as the subject; and the idea of the world should not be regarded as a collection of objective entities. The conceptions of subject and object are logically and ontologically derived from the self-world polarity. For Tillich, the process of objectification produces an ontological reduction process, which can powerfully deprive items of power and meaning. Thus, "world-object-thing" and "self-ego-thing" are the double process of the same objectification in reducing the multi-dimensional functionality into a cognitive function and finally a technological employment. Therefore, it is important not to confuse "self-world" polarity and "subject-object" dichotomy.

Also, Tillich emphasized the impossibility of naturalism without human subjectivity and idealism without objective realism. "Self" and "world" are correlated. They are not identical within an absolute unity or divided into two opposite entities. Monism and dualism are not Tillich's alternative philosophical visions. Self and world are both independent and interdependent structured wholes in which the meaningful structures are well-grounded in *logos*, as manifested into subjective *logos* and objective *logos*. "Reason makes the self a self, a centered structure; and reason makes the world a world, a structured whole" (Ibid.: 172). The concept of *logos* or reason, for Tillich, is never regarded as logical reasoning. *Logos* manifests the ontological union of the subjective side and the objective side of *logos* in which the basic ontological and epistemological structure and function of human persons and nature are articulated. Therefore, at an ontological level, human persons and nature are united and mutually participating in an integrated whole. At an epistemological level, the knowing subject participates in the known object in order to establish the epistemological union. Therefore, for Tillich, cognitive participation is always a dialectical union of separation and participation, which assumes the epistemological distance, and mystical union.

If "self" and 'world" are not denoted as an objective existence, both terms are an "original phenomenon" (Ibid.: 169) which precedes the existence of all be-

ings. It should be noted that this basic ontological structure applies to *all levels of beings*, including human and non-human, as their *essence*. Therefore, self-centeredness and self-relatedness must be attributed to all living and non-living beings. For Tillich, a "self-world" polarity exists in human persons, non-human beings and nature. "One can speak of self-centeredness in atoms as well as in animals, whenever the reaction to a stimulus is dependent on a structural whole" (Ibid.). Tillich believes that "no thing is merely a thing", which means that all beings embrace the internal structured wholes and correspond to the outward corresponding structured whole. Meanwhile, "each being *has* an environment." (Ibid.: 170.) The concept of environment is not primarily denoted as the empirical-natural world, though both terms are related. "Its environment consists in those things with which it has an active interrelation." (Ibid.) A human person is understood as a "person-in-the-world" which characterizes the human self as fully embodied in the whole rubric of the natural environment, and this provides meaningful exchanges for constituting the human person. For Tillich, even all non-human beings and their correlated environments should be understood as a meaningful and structural complex system.

Following the bipolar structure of self-world, three pairs of ontological elements constitute it, in which the side of "self" consists of "individualization," "dynamics" and "freedom"; and the side of "world" consists of "participation", "form" and "destiny." All beings in the world consist of these pairs of ontological elements as the concrete content of the basic ontological structure. That means, these pairs of elements are not external to the "self-world" structure, but are the fundamental constitutive understanding of the persons and nature. Within the bipolar structure, the one pole is correlated with the opposite pole. As Tillich mentioned, "individualization-dynamics-freedom" expresses the self-relatedness of being; "participation-form-destiny" expresses the belongingness of being. (Ibid.: 165) Thus, no self-sufficient and self-contained individual is possible and being is always being-in-context. No individual self and community have ontological priority over the other.

Human persons and nature share all these pairs of ontological elements at different levels. For Tillich, the polarity of "freedom-destiny" is decisive among other pairs for, through this structural element, all beings make the passage from the essential to the existential condition without destroying the essential power. Human finite freedom actualizes potentiality in order to actualize what nature and humanity essentially are. The *telos* of all beings is paradoxically actualized to be both the fully developed creatureliness and fallen creatureliness. (Tillich 1951: 255) Though the human person experiences the concept of freedom as deliberation, decision and responsibility due to the completeness of humanity, this does not mean that all other non-human beings in nature are excluded from this

category and completely dominated by physical-mechanical laws. Otherwise, human persons and nature would fall into two separated realms in which no ontological union is possible between human autonomous freedom and natural deterministic law, as the Kantian dilemma manifested in his first and second *Critiques*. The polarity of spontaneity and law is constituted in the inorganic *gestalten* as the polarity of freedom and destiny is constituted in the human realm. For Tillich, human persons and nature participate in the isomorphic structure of self-centered action and surrounding contexts.

> Nature does not obey – or disobey – laws the way men do; in nature spontaneity is united with law in the way freedom is united with destiny in men. The law of nature does not remove the reaction of self-centered *Gestalten*, but it determines the limits they cannot trespass. Each being acts and reacts according to the law of its self-centered structure and according to laws of the larger units in which it is included. (Tillich 1951: 186)

Destiny and natural law do not cancel or reject the possibility of human freedom and natural spontaneity, but allow them to act freely within the boundary of the given. A free act is not possible in a vacuum. "Destiny is not a strange power which determines what shall happen to me" (Ibid.: 185). The action of all beings is possible only within the given formed by all surrounding contexts.

4.1.2 Life Actualization

In volume three of Tillich's *Systematic Theology*, his anthropology is well constructed within the whole being of the universe. Against the metaphor of "levels", Tillich preferred the imagery of "dimensions" to describe the different intersecting of all kinds of life-form. The choice, replacing the metaphor of "level" with "dimension," reflects the dislocation of the hierarchical matrix and centers on the blurring and mixing of the organic flow of different dimensions of life. All dimensions – inorganic, organic, psychic, spiritual and historical – cross their boundaries without losing their own identities. The multi-dimensionality of life "describes the difference of the realms of being in such a way that there cannot be mutual interference; depth does not interfere with breadth, since all dimensions meet at the same point. They cross without disturbing each other; there is no conflict between dimensions ... these conflicts are not denied, but they are not derived from the hierarchy of levels; they are the consequences of the ambiguity of all life processes" (Tillich 1963: 15). The interpenetration and fusion within poly- and trans-dimensionality constitutes an interactive, dynamic and vitalist vision of the realities. The basic idea of Tillich's dynamic vision of all life-forms is that all dimensions are real but not always in actual status.

Therefore, for Tillich, when someone encounters someone/ something, it means that the one who encounters is the mixture of all dimensions, though some dimensions are in a potential stage, and some are in an actual stage. Even in the inorganic realm, all other dimensions are potentially present. "In this sense one speaks of the vegetable realm or the animal realm or the historical realm. In all of them, all dimensions are potentially present, and some of them are actualized." (Ibid.: 16) For Tillich, the interplay of potentiality and actuality means that there is not any metaphysical and transcendental core in any realm or dimension. This non-substantial approach of Tillich's idea allows the ontological blurring of spirituality, humanity, animality and materiality.

The above multi-dimensionality of all species presupposes a certain kind of evolutionary understanding. Tillich emphasized that the condition of the actualization of one dimension is that other previous dimensions have been actualized. Therefore, "the dimension of spirit would remain potential without the actualization of the organic." The continuum within different dimensions expresses that there is no possibility of a clear-cut mechanism to allocate human "exceptionalism." Therefore, although Tillich maintained that the human being is the highest being in an ontological understanding, he did not commit to an anthropocentric understanding.

4.1.2.1 Organic Life and Biology

For Tillich, under his framework of multi-dimensionality, the relationship between human beings and nature has been articulated as the multifaceted level of self-actualization of various life-forms within the interplay of ontological elements. In volume three of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich devotes lengthy discussions to biological and organic life in general, and its psychological and spiritual dimensions in particular. It is impressive that Tillich neither resisted locating the ideas of self-creativity and self-transcending merely in the realm of human spiritual creations, nor reserved them to highly metaphysical concepts of the divine. One of the ways to analyze the role of human beings within the cosmos is to examine the relevance of Tillich's thought on the questions of the inorganic, organic, psychological and spiritual realms, and expend its significance into the question of the boundary between nature and human beings. This section shows that, first, in contrast with the Darwinian evolutionary theory and Teilhard de Chardin's process understanding of life, Tillich's *gestalt* conception of biological science provides a unique understanding of the self-creativity and self-transcending of organisms, through the comparison with German biologist, Jakob von Uexküll (1864 – 1944)'s discovery in biological sciences. Second, his idea of multi-dimensional unity of life blurs the boundary between human beings and animals; this

trans- and poly-dimensionality concept of life entails his non-essential and dynamic understanding of reality which provides the fluid, changeable and non-static imagery to blur the boundary of human beings and other organic life-forms without losing their identities, and so falls short of the charge of anthropocentricism.

In this part, I will argue that, first, Tillich's rich resources in understanding organic life in general, and animal life in particular, are proposed in order to reject both the Darwinian evolutionary theory in his early career and Teilhard de Chardin's teleological-theological theory in his nearly final phrase of academic life. Tillich's understanding of the *gestalt* science of biology, compared with the German biologist, Jakob von Uexküll's (1864 – 1944) discovery, is more theoretically capable of articulating a self-creativity and self-originating field of organic life. Second, in the understanding of the multi-dimensional unity of life, Tillich allocated "animality" within the flow of trans- and poly-dimensionality of historical, spiritual, psychic, organic and inorganic realms of the universe. This concept provides a strong criticism of the essential understanding of human beings and animals on one hand, and the rejection of a linear evolutionary progress on the other, thus uprooting anthropocentricism.

Very few research studies touch on the problem of Tillich and biology[1] and, most probably, the reason for this neglect can be partly accounted for by unacceptable misreadings of volume three of *Systematic Theology*, mainly focusing on Tillich's theology of human culture, resulting in an interpretation which is essentially anthropocentric in nature. Human morality, culture and religion are merely ontological products of the pneumatological dimension within the human realm. Tillich's abundant discussion of the inorganic, organic and psychological dimensions of life constitutes the essential analysis of the possibility and actuality of a theology of life which is highly and profoundly inclusive in nature. However, Tillich's critical appreciation of Pierre Teilhard de Chardin's idea of evolutionary theory could easily create a misleading impression that Tillich's theory of the life process is identical with the character of the theory of evolution. However, in addition to Tillich's own criticism about the overly-optimistic eschatology within Teilhard's ideas (Tillich 1963:5), Paul H. Carr rightly mentioned that Tillich's ontological interplay between being and becoming, and the overcoming of non-being throughout the process of life constitutes difficulties, so that Tillich cannot commit unconditionally to evolution theory. (Carr 2005: 734 – 735). Actually, this section argues that the tension between Tillich and Teilhard is not merely laid on the methodological level between science and theology, as rightly

1 Exceptions are (Carr 2005, Huchingson 2005, Haught 2002 and Grigg 2003).

pointed out by Michael W. DeLashmutt (DeLashmutt 2005: 739 – 749), but is also found in the incompatibility that both approaches have in contrasting the conception of biological science with an evolutionary type in general and Teilhard's in particular. Through the introduction of Jakob von Uexküll, we find that Tillich's own biological conception for exploring the self-originating, self-creativity and self-transcending of organic life would be more fruitful and promising.

Tillich seldom touched on the problem of biology throughout his academic life, but in his early work, *The System of the Sciences* (1923), his *gestalt* science of biology was first illustrated. In this work, an architecture of the three different and related sciences is systematically constructed. First, the sciences of thought, which includes logic and mathematics, focus on the forms and patterns of the human thought without being concerned about the objects of thought. Thinking itself is the focus of human thought. Second, the sciences of being, which divides three sub-branches of sciences: the physical sciences (the mechanical, dynamic and chemical sciences); the "*gestalt*" sciences (biology, psychology and sociology); and the sequences sciences (the historical, political, biographical, cultural, etc.). This second group of sciences focuses on the empirical and objective "real" beings that provide the material content and direction to the structures and categories of thought. Last, the sciences of spirit, in which the meaning, purpose and validity of sciences are concerned, include philosophy, art, religion and theology.

Likewise, biology locates under the category of "*gestalt*" sciences where the concern is not merely to discover the "natural laws" of the structure of beings, but also to disclose the "*gestalt*" structure of all organic beings. This structure embodies the whole realm of the so-called "organic-technical" group of beings. As Tillich said, "A *gestalt* is ... a multifaceted and qualitatively determined being whose parts are not quantities, but qualities, or members of a whole" (Tillich 1923: 62). First, in his systematic arrangement, Tillich distinguished mechanical-physical science and "*gestalt*" science in order to emancipate organic beings from the perspective of physical laws. Tillich emphasized that "as far as the biological problem is concerned, one simply cannot make 'life', in the biological sense, *a pure object of external perception*, as one can physical things" (Tillich 1923: 84. Emphasis mine). Biological life resists being reduced to merely physical entities because, secondly, "*gestalt*" science takes the concept of "vitality" very seriously. The vitality of organic beings consists of the *bios* sphere and the psychic dimension of the living *gestalt* (Ibid.). Tillich mentioned that the biological and psychological dimensions are essentially correlated; both dimensions express the interior and exterior aspects of the living *gestalt*. Therefore, it is totally inadequate to employ mechanical law functions to explain the behavior and living phenomenon of organic living beings; and it is also wrong to reduce them to

a materialistic apparatus. Therefore, for Tillich, organic living beings (human and non-human animals) cannot be interpreted under the Cartesian mind-body dualistic understanding.

Concerning the methodology of biology, there were two rival paradigms in the science of biology in the nineteenth century. The dominant perspective was physical science, oriented so that the methods of physical-mechanistic law were employed in studying organic living beings. Under this paradigm, the criterion of the "law" method is the only legitimate apparatus for explaining the behavior of living beings. The contrasting research approach was entitled a vitality paradigm in which the teleological relation of all organs and functions to the unity of life are concerned. Under this approach, the "*gestalt*" method is adopted to replace the former mechanical one. Tillich was not a biologist, but it seems that he was well informed about the above academic disputes in biology in the German-speaking world, though he never acknowledged the background and the details of the above discussion in his book, *The System of the Sciences*. For Tillich, when he discusses the methodology of biology, he clearly mentioned that the basic contradiction of the above two scientific paradigms is misunderstood as the dichotomy of teleology and causality (Ibid.: 85), which constitutes biological life as two different and distinct realms of being. This demarcation had been rejected by Tillich through adopting a dialectical approach in which the purposiveness of living organic beings is essentially embodied in the structure of life itself; the organ and functions of all parts of life cannot be understood without the reference of purpose (Ibid.: 86). However, this dynamic and purposiveness of living *gestalt* should not be regarded as the cause of formation; otherwise, it would become another new and mystical principle of causality (Ibid.: 86). In sum, the *gestalt* "laws" are functional and explanatory principles, but the self-organizing and self-generating aspects of living *gestalt* should also be maintained.

Tillich expressed his strong reservation about the theory of biological evolution in his understanding of organic gestalt sciences. For him, the problem caused by the theory of evolution is that it attempts, unambiguously, to employ rational-mechanical scientific laws and sequences to subdue the biological sphere (Ibid.: 87). It seems that Tillich rejected evolutionary theory by refusing to acknowledge a universal ideal category which tries to embrace all the universal and particular beings under a single unifying sequence-law pattern. "In the organic world ... a union of all individuals is meaningless. The individual offers a resistance that compels the universal concepts to designate a series of attributes as inessential, to exclude them from rationalization" (Ibid.: 86). This rejection of the universal category finds its same tone in volume three of *Systematic Theology* in which Tillich expressed the unknowability of the unity and universal catego-

ries of time and space (Tillich 1963: 314). For him, the theory of evolution is partly correct in the sense that the law and the sequence method can be employed in a natural history category. However, what is missing in the theory is, for Tillich, the lack of empathetic understanding of the creative element revealed by every individual living *gestalt*. In this sense, biology cannot be separated from psychology, concerning the dimension of consciousness within the dimension of the organic life. During Tillich's later period, this rejection of body-mind dualistic conceptuality was replaced by the multi-dimensional unity of life in which the psychic dimension of the biological dimension is able to present the "internal creativity" (Ibid.: 89).

Although Tillich did not provide any indication for the readers, it is reasonable for us to associate his *gestalt* theory with German biologist Jakob von Uexküll (1864 – 1944).[2] Uexküll's groundbreaking work in biology was published as *Umwelt und Innenwelt der Tiere* (The Environment and Inner World of Animals) in 1909 and *Theoretische Biologie* (Theoretical Biology) in 1920,[3] just before the publication of Tillich's *The System of the Sciences* (1923), three and four years respectively. In these works, Uexküll challenged the traditional mechanistic physical scientific approach towards biology and tried to offer a kind of subjectivist epistemology in order to re-introduce the autonomous organism as a subject into the life-sciences and, at the same time, to make subjectivity an object of the scientific method. Uexküll pointed out that all organisms are neither mechanically programmed, nor arbitrary and random, but have an active response to their environments and create their own life-world, which he called "*Umwelt*". Therefore, the concept of the universe as the creation of countless individual *Umwelten* challenged the idea of one universal objective world (Rüting 2004). Every single organism would have its own life-world, and their sharing multi- and inter-universe constitutes the interplay of the unique and independent life-worlds. This biology, conscientious of its subjectivity and the interdependence of organisms, provided Uexküll with arguments against the modern worldview, which he saw as being misguided by anthropocentrism, speculative Darwinian theories and the misuse of machine analogies.[4]

2 It is interesting that Tillich himself acknowledges his usage of "*gestalt*" as a "system of self-contained causality" from a Berlin sociologist and economist, Dr. Alexander Rustow. See (Tillich 1923: 230, note 4).

3 For the intellectual biography of Jakob von Uexküll, see (Rüting 2004).

4 Ibid. In the current discussion on animal studies, Jakob von Uexküll's contribution is highly emphasized, see (Buchanan 2008: ch.1). Also, Heidegger's discussion about animality in his *The Fundamental Concepts of Metaphysics* is inspired by Uexküll's ideas. It signals some ways in which philosophical reflection could inform and be informed by a zoocentric ethology. But, it

Tillich's philosophical-biological perception of the organic life shared the same vision with Uexküll's understanding, and located whole sets of understanding within the ontological articulation of life. Based on the life's self-integration which lies in the ontological interplay of individualization and participation, life's self-creativity lies in the interplay of form and dynamics, and life's self-transcending lies in the interplay of freedom and destiny; all dimensions of life are moving in circular, horizontal and vertical dimensions with the essential potentiality and existential actuality. All life-forms drive for a new centeredness with their own uniquesness. Under Tillich's multi-dimensional conception of life, different forms of life constitute a universe of multi-centeredness and multi-directed development. In a formal articulation, first, self-integration presupposes "there is centeredness in all life, both as reality and as task ... There is nothing outside life which could cause its movement from centeredness through alteration back to centeredness" (Tillich 1963: 30). Second, self-creativity denotes the function of growth to search for a new center of life. "Life drives towards the new. It cannot do this without centeredness, but it does it by transcending every individual center" (Ibid.: 31). Third, self-transcending of life means "life drives beyond itself as finite life" (Ibid.). It should be noted that all these life developments are counterbalanced by its negative elements: disintegration, destruction and profanization. Tillich's combination of essential and existential elements in articulation of all life's ambiguous situation distances himself with all types of Darwinian optimistic vision.

Concerning Tillich's conception of the organic realm of life through his understanding of ontological-biological analysis, organic life actually embraces several dimensions which contain vegetable, animal and psychological realms. They are overlapping with lack of definition of the transition between them. In volume three of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich insisted on employing the *gestalt* understanding of biological life which is the earlier articulation of biological life in *The System of Sciences:* "The organic dimension is characterized by self-related, self-preserving, self-increasing, and self-continuing *Gestalten*" (Tillich 1963: 20). For the methodological consideration of biological life, the struggle between mechanical-physical laws and *gestalt* sciences is replaced by the conflict between the Aristotelian and evolutionary theories. (Ibid.: 20)

In addition to the similarities between Tillich and Uexküll's understanding of biological science, Tillich had a very detailed explanation of his own articulation of the different categorical descriptions of various dimensions of life. First,

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should be noted that Heidegger's view on animality is challenged by his committing deeply to his anthropocentrism. See (Calarco 2008: 28).

Tillich's conception of the historical dimension of life could be easily misunderstood as another version of Darwinian evolutionary biological theory. This section tries to demonstrate that Tillich's own version, represented in the idea of the multi-dimensional unity of life, is far more complicated and nuanced. In fact, Tillich never intended to envelop his concept of multi-dimensionality of life with the content of Darwinian ideas, though it seems that Tillich appreciated the evolutionary victory of rejecting the supernaturalist intervention in explaining the transition from inorganic to organic realms. The fundamental problematic of evolutionary explanation of biological life is whether and how we can articulate the "historicity" in the dimension of inorganic and organic realms.

4.1.2.2 Life-Category and Historical Dimension

For Tillich, the ideas of "history proper" and "historical dimension" are distinguished in a sense that human persons and nature both participate in the ambiguous intertwinings of historical process, though authentic historical creativity is reserved merely to human actualization. The concept of history proper includes purpose, intention, will and action (Tillich 1963: 302). To be historical is to transcend the given situation and this idea is inevitably defined as being within the realm of human freedom. We do not find any substantial examples in the evolutionary species and the astronomical universe expressing "purpose" and "freedom" (Ibid.: 305). Although "creativity" would be discovered in the natural process, as Tillich mentioned:

> The dynamics of nature create the new by producing individuality in the smallest parts as well as in the largest composites of nature and also by producing new species in the evolutionary process and new constellations of matter in the extensions and contractions of the universe. (Ibid.)

However, the embodied meaningful events happening in human history are qualitatively different from the "new" forms of life produced in the universe. If history is characterized by the idea of purpose, freedom and a teleological sense of process, it is hard to employ the concept of "historical" in the inorganic and organic realms. Also, to a certain extent, Tillich seemed to reserve the "absolute meaning" and "significant uniqueness" within the dimension of human spirit to be actualized in cultural, ethical and religious realms. "If there were absolute meaning in a tree or a new animal species or a new galaxy of stars, this meaning could be understood *by men*, for meaning is experienced *by man*" (Ibid. Emphasis mine). However, Tillich asserted: "There is no realm of life in which the historical dimension is not present and actualized in an anticipatory way.

Even in the inorganic, and certainly in the organic, realm, there is *telos* (inner aim) which is quasi-historical, even though it is not a part of history proper" (Ibid.: 306). Although there is no "freedom" found in the inorganic and organic realms, "spontaneity" is expressed in an analogical way. It is significant that Tillich distinguished between the historical dimension of all realms of life and history proper which remains within the human spirit. In order to clarify their difference and the highly vague phrase, "nature participates in history", different concepts of categories of all realms of life and the relationship of history should be clearly demonstrated.

Time and space are always correlational. As Tillich famously quoted, "the more a realm is under the predominance of the inorganic dimension, the more it is also under the predominance of space; and conversely, the more a realm is under the predominance of the historical dimension, the more it is also under the predominance of time" (Ibid.: 315). It does not mean that temporality is absolutely absent in the realm of the inorganic, and spatiality is absolutely absent in the realms of the organic and spiritual. For Tillich, the correlational matrix between temporality and spatiality from inorganic to spiritual realms is not static and fixed. The more it is in the realm of the inorganic, the more dominant is the quality of exclusiveness between time and space. The more it is in the realm of the spiritual, the more dominant is the quality of participation between time and space. In the realm of the inorganic, all temporal movements are interpreted within the framework of spatiality. Temporality and spatiality exclusiveness are in the character of the inorganic realm. In the realm of the organic, the *gestalt* concept is introduced within the consideration of organic temporality and spatiality, in which the exclusiveness has been broken by the interpenetration of the different parts of the whole. In the realm of psychological awareness, Tillich asserted that spatiality is still predominant over temporality in which the internal awareness of the spatiality overcomes the boundary of the external space, and internal consciousness of memory and anticipation are more actualized in the power of participation. The realm of the spiritual dimension is restricted to human beings, the main feature of temporality and spatiality is the power of abstraction manifest in positing limitation without limit (Ibid.: 317). Spiritual temporality and spatiality creatively unite the abstract and concrete limitedness, through which the physical and spiritual time and space are correlated. Historical time and space are raised to human consciousness in searching for the meaning and aim of history. Under the dominance of the spiritual dimension, the quality of temporality and spatiality has priority over measurable time and space. Therefore, historical time has a double sense that is essential to qualifying the historical dimension of all life and human history proper. The formal ontological character of the irreversibility of "after-each-other-ness" of time is poten-

tially present in all dimensions of life, and the material character is the drive towards the fulfillment actualized in human historical consciousness.

Although Tillich's idea of the multi-dimensional unity of life has a similarity to the theory of evolution by virtue of emphasizing the "process" of life, Tillich, in the last part of his *Systematic Theology* volume three, clearly mentioned that the whole framework of multi-dimensionality is absolutely poly-centered, multi-layered, scattered and weblike, in contrast to a single linear forward-looking temporality assumed in the theory of evolution. Also, if the universe is non-linear, then the human beings, *homo sapiens*, can, by no means, be interpreted as the final product of a linear futurist process of evolution. First, the concept of "temporality-spatiality" is unity-in-difference and independent-in-relational (Ibid.: 313 – 314). Each category (time, space, causality and substance) is differentiated within itself according to the dimension under which it is effective; therefore, one (historical) time for all dimensions does not exist (Ibid.: 313). However, though the unity of each category is presupposed, it cannot be known in human knowledge (Ibid.: 314). Second, Tillich's famous wording, the "struggle between time and space" (Ibid.: 315) characterizes the indefinite, multi-oriented and trans-territorial nature of temporality-spatiality among the inorganic, organic, spiritual and historical dimensions. Under this understanding, "the more a realm is under the predominance of the inorganic dimension, the more it is under the predominance of space; the more a realm is under the predominance of the historical dimension, the more it is also under the predominance of time" (Ibid.); the organic-biological sphere is different from the inorganic realm in that the exclusivity is broken by the element of participation. The immanence of temporality and spatiality is embodied within the whole process of the development. For animal life, the internal temporality and spatiality are added, though space is still predominant over time; under the self-directed movement, the directedness of growth and the futuristic character of self-awareness, time prepares for the full breakthrough of its bondage to space which occurs in time under the dimension of history (Ibid.: 317).

Historical time and space include inorganic, organic and psychic temporality and spatiality in the actual sense; however, historical time and space are potentially present in the inorganic and organic aspects. Therefore, the forward linear perception of historical dimensions is merely actualized fully in human beings but not in other dimensions of life. Tillich insisted that human temporality and spatiality (time and space under the dimension of spirit), and historical time and space are not separated from organic/ inorganic temporality and spatiality. The linear irreversibility of temporality in the historical dimension and the creative unlimitedness in the dimension of spirit *is based on but not caused by* the circular spatiality in the inorganic and organic dimensions. In summary,

the element of temporality as "after-each-other-ness" and the element of spatiality as "beside-each-other-ness" coexist and they find their own terms in different dominant dimensions.

4.1.2.3 Animality and Humanity

In organic life-forms, the concept of animality is one of the decisive steps to examine the continuity of human persons and nature. As this chapter aims at demonstrating the reciprocity between human beings and other organic life-forms, we have to study Tillich's point of view on the boundary between animality and humanity. First, against the metaphor of "levels", Tillich preferred the imagery of "dimensions" to describe the intersecting of all different kinds of *zoe*, rather than the *bio*-sphere only. The term "dimensionality" emphasizes the dislocation of the hierarchical matrix and centering with the blurring and mixing of the organic flow of different dimensions of life. All dimensions – inorganic, organic, psychic, spiritual and historical – cross the boundaries without losing their own identities. The multi-dimensionality of life "describes the difference of the realms of being in such a way that there cannot be mutual interference; depth does not interfere with breadth, since all dimensions meet in the same point. They cross without disturbing each other; there is no conflict between dimensions ... these conflicts are not denied, but they are not derived from the hierarchy of levels; they are the consequences of the ambiguity of all life processes" (Tillich 1963: 15). The interpenetration and fusion within the poly- and trans-dimensionality constitutes an interactive, dynamic and vitalist vision of the realities.

Second, what is the inner-mechanism of the above inter- and intra-dimensionality of different life-forms? Tillich employed the Aristotelian distinction of "*dynamis-energeia*" to demonstrate the interrelation of potentiality and actuality of all beings (Ibid.: 12). The basic idea of Tillich's dynamic vision of all life-forms is that all dimensions are real but not always in actual status. Therefore, for Tillich, when someone encounters someone/ something, it means the one who encounters is the mixture of all dimensions, but some dimensions are in a latent potential status, and some are in actual stages. Even in the so-called inorganic realm, all other dimensions are potentially present. "In this sense one speaks of the vegetable realm or the animal realm or the historical realm. In all of them, all dimensions are potentially present, and some of them are actualized" (Ibid.: 16). For Tillich, the interplay of potentiality and actuality emphasizes that there is no any metaphysical and transcendental core in any particular realm or dimension. This non-essentialist approach of beings reinforces the blurring of the human/ animal distinction; humanity and animality are interrelated and interpenetrated.

The hybrid "humanimality" challenges human privilege while upholding the human/animal borders (Freeman 2010).

Third, the above multi-dimensionality of all species presupposes a certain degree of evolutionary understanding of the life process. Tillich emphasized that the condition of the actualization of one dimension is that other previous dimensions have been actualized. Therefore, "the dimension of spirit would remain potential without the actualization of the organic" (Tillich 1963: 16). In that sense, animality has an ontological priority over humanity in a biological genesis sense. Or, at least, the continuum within different dimensions frustrates the human "exceptionalism" mechanism, which attempts to relocate human privilege among the other beings in the biological, epistemological and ontological senses. Meanwhile, the uniqueness of the human being expressed in human *geist* is embodied in human being by virtue of the fully actualized condition; this does not mean that, on one hand, it exists exclusively in the human world and, on the other, the dimensionality of spirituality does not exist in the other dimensions. Or, in a Tillichean sense, human spirituality is definitely potentially present in animality.

Tillich seemed to restore the dimensionality of spirit to the human sphere; therefore, the term "spirit" is always functionally associated with "soul", "mind" and "reason," in a highly anthropological connotation. However, this almost strictly anthropological understanding was challenged by Tillich in favor of the original meaning of "spirit" as "power of life" which points to a basic function in the doctrine of life (Ibid.: 24). "It [spirit] expresses the consciousness of a living being in relation to its surroundings and to itself. It includes awareness, perception, intention. It appears in the dimension of animality as soon as self-awareness appears; and in rudimentary or developed form, it includes intelligence, will, directed action" (Ibid.). Following the previous discussion of the potential presence of spirit in animality, we can conclude that Tillich's standpoint does not imply that we are justified in extending anthropological territory to cover the realms of animality in order to articulate a human-like imagery for animals. This process humanizes animals and has two weaknesses; one is to confirm the binary distinction human/animal by extending one category the human to cover the other; the second is to deny the specificity of animals altogether (Braidotti 2006: 108). However, it was also possible for Tillich to relocate humanity in terms of animality. Tillich went further in that there is no fixed point in time and space that can be determined as identifying the appearance of human beings; the transition from one dimension to another dimension is totally outside any patterns or forms of historical determinism. In summary, the human being is not merely always human-becoming, but also images of humankind are always linked with other non-human dimensions; at least, if it is appropriate to imagine

a human being as a human-becoming-animal, then the idea of the evolutionary process plus supernaturalist input of the soul of humans is no longer valid for Tillich.

If self-awareness is the common space for the organic realm of animality and the spiritual realm for the human being, Tillich emphasized that this implies that humans and animals share the same realm of experience, that: "all encounters of a being with its environment are experienced as related to the individual being that is aware of them … (it also implies that) with awareness a past and future are open in terms of remembrance and anticipation" (Tillich 1963: 36). However, this "awareness" experience is not an object of objective scientific observation, because it "is submerged in both dimensions, the biological dimension on the one side and that of the spirit on the other side" (Ibid.: 37).

Tillich's cosmic-universal soteriology tries to extend the boundary of the transformative power originally from the New Being to cover the whole universe. Thus, the symbol of "Christ" embraces the historical and non-historical types of all finite beings by conquering its estrangement (Tillich 1957: 89). Although Tillich's Christology clearly states that the incarnation indicates the essential God-manhood manifesting the historical manhood, the theological meaning is by no means anthropological exclusively. "The function of the bearer of the New Being is not only to save individuals and to transform man's historical existence but *to renew the universe*. And the assumption is that mankind and individual men are so dependent on the powers of the universe that salvation of the one without the other is unthinkable" (Ibid.: 95. Emphasis mine). Under the multi-dimensional unity of life, Tillich's above statement is no longer an assumption but his understanding of an integrated and unifying universe. This ontological interdependence of all living beings widens the soteriology to cover animals and human beings as well. This mutual-interpenetration ontology does not limit the boundary of salvation to be within the human realm, but also provides a theological imagery of animals as aware of estrangement. "The interdependence of everything with everything else in the totality of being includes a participation of nature in history and demands a participation of the universe in salvation" (Ibid.: 96). Also, Tillich regarded human beings as "microcosms" in whom the New Being manifests the universal transformation power through a personal life which assumes that "what happens in him happens, therefore, by mutual universal participation". So, "what happens to man happens implicitly to all realms of life, for in man all levels of being are present" (Ibid.: 120 – 121).

Likewise, in his final part of *Systematic Theology* volume three, Tillich continued his interpretation of the universe under the category of "history" and correlates the historical ambiguities with the Christian answer in the doctrine of "Kingdom of God". However, it is clear for Tillich that the symbol of the Kingdom

of God is not merely a symbol correlating the complexities in history; it also provides the answer to the universal meaning of beings. "Since history is the all-embracing dimension of life, and since historical time is the time in which all other dimensions of time are presupposed, the answer to the meaning of history implies an answer to the universal meaning of being" (Tillich 1963: 350). The universal elements of the Kingdom of God embrace all dimensions of life in the universe. For Tillich, the immanent side of this symbol emphasizes inner historical-political dynamics, and the transcendent side indicates nature, with human beings receiving the eternal blessedness and participation in the divine life (Ibid.: 405).

There is no direct reference in Tillich's writings for us to address his idea of animal ethics. However, for Tillich, every living being shares the self-transcendence trace in a qualitative sense. The term "great" denotes living beings, and includes animals and the whole universe, pointing to the qualitative mystery of the structure of the whole. This mystery of all beings implies self-transcendence in the sense of dignity (Ibid.: 89). Human beings and non-human beings embody the ontological self-transcendence of life dimension manifesting the dignity of "inviolability" (Ibid.). This idea "is a valid element of all reality, giving dignity to the inorganic as well as to the personal"(Ibid.). What is Tillich's position in addressing the relationship between human and non-human animals? Tillich said that "... in the relation of man to all other living beings a change took place only where the relation of man to some animals became analogous to the relation of man to man." (Ibid.: 91) Does this sentence imply Tillich's anthropocentric apparatus? Maybe, but not necessarily. If the unconditional demand of the personal realm manifests the inviolability which must be acknowledged, then it is most probably implied that the dignity of the animal is also inviolable, analogous to the situation of humanity.

Although Tillich did not employ value theories to address the animal problem, it seems that it was not difficult for him to affirm the intrinsic value of all living beings based on the above idea of inviolability. However, in contrast with the current animal ethical theories, Tillich would have his distinctive approach. First, in Tillich's understanding of morality as personal self-integration, the question of animal ethics is not whether animals primarily have a moral status, or why human beings should treat animals morally. Many animal ethical theories are portrayed as uncovering some sort of fundamental identity shared by all animals in order to represent that identity in the political and legal arena. Either this homogeneity of the animals discourse lies in the ability to suffer as Peter Singer's theory of animal liberation (Singer 1975), or there is an attempt to argue for the entitlement of animal rights, as Tom Regan does (Regan 2004).

These arguments are good in intention but fall short by supporting an anthropocentric identity logic (Calarco 2008: 8).[5]

In the actuality of all life's self-transcendent process, all organisms share the ambiguity of holiness and profanization. They mix together. Inviolability and violability are the fundamental principles underlying all living beings. Life is the subject and, simultaneously, is an object. All organisms suffer in pain and experience feelings of shame in different degrees. "In all these cases the sublime center of self-awareness is deprived of its greatness and its dignity" (Tillich 1963: 92). Tillich expressed this condition as the tragedy of nature and of animals as well. Therefore, for Tillich, there is no need to be committed to the anthropocentric machine in order to argue for compassion for the suffering of animals, or assume the subject-rights entitlement in order to argue for the idea of animal rights. Under the self-transcendence of animal life in particular, and organic life in general, the vulnerability of animals is confirmed, and it demands human ethical treatment.

Second, Tillich's own articulation of animal ethics is subtle. Like Levinas' ethics of the recognition of the Other (Levinas 1988), Tillich insisted that the Other imposes an unconditional moral command. When someone enters into the "I-Thou" relationship, the "ought" is disclosed and is experienced. "Therefore, the other self is the unconditional limit to the desire to assimilate one's whole world, and the experience of this limit is the experience of the ought-to-be, the moral imperative" (Tillich 1963: 40). Can we simply extend this other self into the animal Other? If a moral imperative exists, Tillich asked, "[w]hether and where there is a moral imperative" (Ibid.: 45). The encounter with the Other constitutes the sufficient condition of the moral imperative, because the Other constructs the unconditional ontological limit for someone to bypass. As Donna Haraway said, our relationship to animals is an ethical one because they are radically Other to us. The radical animal Otherness confronts us as the recognition of alterity in which our access is always imperfect, indirect and highly mediated. The alterity uproots the certainty of human self-understanding and other-understanding. The question of "who" never ceases becom-

5 The identity thesis, suggested by Calarco to refer to Singer's and Regan's approaches to animal ethics, argues that, if the beings that are identical or fundamentally similar in ethically relevant ways, they deserve identical or fundamentally similar consideration. Thus, what they contribute only results in and reinforces certain anthropocentric stance in our community. Therefore, when animal rights theorists and animal liberationists employ classical humanist and anthropocentric criteria to argue for granting animals certain rights or protecting them from suffering, it is these very criteria that have served historically to justify violence towards animals.

ing, and involves a rescripting of the political as a space of incoherence, indeterminacy and vulnerability (Grebowicz & Merrick 2013: 97).

However, for Tillich, the question is what kind of encounter should be counted as an ethical encounter? Tillich lamented that, "the transition from the potentially personal encounter to the actual one is a field with countless ambiguities, many of which put before us painful decisions" (Tillich 1963: 45). Therefore, "being is being-in-encounter" is not sufficient enough because it is still abstract, until the concrete encounter happens. For Tillich, concreteness means participation. Without concrete participation, there is no authentic Other-encounter. (Ibid.) The question of animals is not how to articulate a category "animal" and to examine the substance; for Tillich, it is indeed like the Derrida's cat's gaze, the concrete event of the animal looking at me. As Derrida said, "and from the vantage point of this being-there-before-me it can allow itself to be looked at, no doubt, but also—something that philosophy perhaps forgets, perhaps being this calculated forgetting self—it can look at me. It has a point of view regarding me. The point of view of the absolute other, and nothing will have given me more food for thinking through this absolute *alterity* of the neighbor" (Derrida 2008: 11. Emphasis mine).

Therefore, this alterity of Derrida's radical position challenges the anthropocentric metaphysical tradition, and resists all labeling effects of reducing/ manufacturing a homogeneous, essentialist and reductive category. Similar to Tillich's multi-dimensionality of animality, we cannot and should not find a common "animality" but, rather, a heterogeneous series of beings and poly-dimensional unity of relationship exists. Then, the last question is: how should we treat this neighbor? Tillich mentioned this story of Good Samaritan as a reference for us to rethink the idea of "participation of love". Facing the Other, the ontological limit resists all types of controlling knowledge to subdue the Otherness; it discloses the ethical demand to let all parties have empathically mutual participation (Tillich 1963: 45). It is interesting that, for Tillich, the particularity of the one would be the obstacle in participation (Ibid.). As Derrida emphasized, the otherness cannot be reduced or subordinated into a unity. Tillich employed the theology of agape as the power and ground for us to unite together, and, most importantly, only divine agape can let someone participate in the center of the other and accept all the particularities even if the alterity exists (Ibid.).

This section concludes with the position that Tillich's thought is fruitful and promising in dealing with the question of animals, though it is in a subtle and detour way. Tillich's non-anthropocentric position, trans- and poly-dimensionality, challenges the hierarchical axiological and ontological structure which dominates western conceptuality and, without it, falls short of ethical relativism. Also, his non-essential and dynamic understanding of reality provides the

fluid, changeable and non-static imagery to blur the boundary of the human beings and animals without losing their identities.

4.2 Microcosm

For Tillich, human beings are not merely one type of creature among other living creatures. In a Heideggerian sense, only human beings can be aware of the structure of their being. The uniqueness of human being is not based on supremacy among all living beings, or that the human being is regarded as *animal rationale* in an Aristotelian sense. For Tillich, the idea, *human*, means that one is aware of one's finitude and potential infinity (Tillich 1951: 258). His doctrine of *Imago Dei* points out that, in human beings, the ontological elements are complete and are united on a creature basis, on one hand and, on the other hand, are united with God as the creative ground (Ibid.: 259). The above double ontological structures constitute, first, the human being as the mediator between the divine and all other beings. Tillich adopted a classical notion that human being is the *microcosm*[6] because all dimensions – inorganic, organic, psychic, spiritual and historical – are all present and actualized in human being (Ibid.: 260). Second, the ontological structure of human being is analogous to the divine *Logos* that means the *ground of being mandates the telos of human beings*. Based on this anthropological understanding, the fulfillment of the created purposiveness of creation is dependent on the actualization of human finite freedom. No other beings are constructed and required to fulfill the above mandate. We could say that the role of human being is a co-creator (Hefner 1993). "God is primarily and essentially creative; man is secondarily and existentially creative" (Tillich 1951: 256).

It seems that the notion of "microcosm" can be rightly articulated as the fundamental idea of Tillich's understanding of the relationship between human beings and nature. In this idea, the discontinuity and continuity between human persons and nature are perfectly revealed. In his early essay, "*Die Überwindung des Persönlichkeitsideals*", Tillich distinguished between the idea and the ideal of personality, based on his appreciation of Greek and Renaissance philosophy of the microcosm which emphasizes the interdependence of personality and the universal structure of beings (Tillich 1927b: 117). The concept of personality manifests the self-determination of power to overcome its nature. However, this self-

6 The concept, microcosm, originally comes from Greek antiquity and can be traced back to pre-Socratic times, and was later adopted and enriched by the Greek Orthodox fathers. Later on, it can be found in Renaissance philosophy and German philosophy as well.

determination of human power, which actualizes the power of human freedom and reaches for the universal, does not exclude human beings from the other beings. Because, first, the notion of microcosm expresses the ontological unity shared by human beings and the universe."Human freedom is a function of this structural interdependence of self and the world, of microcosm and macrocosm. Man can become a unity and totality in himself, because he faces a world that is a unity and totality. And man has a world that is a unity and totality because he is a unity and totality in himself" (Ibid.). Employing the *logos* structure in Tillich's volume one of *Systematic Theology*, the subjective *logos* (human being) and the objective *logos* (world) correlates with each other in the same ontological *logos*, which is also based on the basic ontological structure of the self-world matrix. Second, based on the above assertion, the co-structure of "being closed" and "being open" of human beings is established in a dialectical way. On one hand, this double structure constitutes the essential structure of human being within the universe, that the more self-determination is achieved, the more union is constituted. On the other hand, this structure also implies the existential risk of being self-closed and identity-lost. "The more the openness prevails, the more the personality is in danger of remaining bound to the ... cosmic whole. The more the closedness prevails, the more the personality is in danger of losing its creative ground and the fullness of life" (Ibid.). Last, Tillich appreciates the idea of "power of being'' instead of "power over being''. Using the categories of recent environmental thinking, the former seems to emphasize bio-centricism more, but the latter focuses more on anthropocentricism. The idea of the power of being indicates the priority of "abundance of life, vitality, connection with all powers of beings, and the dynamic movement increases ... life is kept open" (Ibid.: 119). Likewise, the idea of the power over being indicates the transcendence of the human person in nature and manifesting the technological domination over others; however, the anthropological uniqueness is also maintianed by Tillich in articulating the centeredness of human persons.

4.2.1 Freedom

The power of self-determination manifests itself as the power of freedom to determine one's self and not to be bound to one's given nature (Tillich 1927b: 115). For Tillich, without this power of self-determination, it is impossible to articulate human persons as having personality. This power of self-determination empowers human beings to stand over against oneself. It should be remembered that this power does not exclusively belong to humanity, but only a human can activate this power to be against nature and one's self. The formal character of

human freedom presents itself as a transcendent concept instead of an empirical object. A human being is not a natural object who is wholly bound within the necessity of natural laws; rather human persons are profoundly embodied in the power-force of beings and fully actualize this ontological power to realize their potentialities. Tillich asserts:

> ... to be free means to have power over one's self, not to be bound to one's given nature ... he who is free is so as this special individual with his special nature, law and form to which he is subject, and which he expresses and transcends in every personal act. It is the same reality, the human individual, the person, who is bound to his nature and to the whole of all nature and yet who controls his nature, thus being in it and above it at the same time. The depth of the problem of freedom is this cleavage in the same being; it exists and yet it is related to its existence by determining it (Ibid.: 115 – 116).

Therefore, reaching universality is first articulated as the power of freedom in the human person in the application of language to be liberated from the bondage of all concrete conditions to establish the "world" which is the structural unity of an infinite manifoldness.

For Tillich, the correlation of human persons and nature is dependent on the function of human freedom. Even though all beings share the basic ontological structure, human persons are the only beings who are able to construct an idea of "world". For Tillich, "world" is not the same as, but is closely related to "environment". The transcendent power of the human person is profoundly manifested in the transcendence of every possible environment (Tillich 1951: 170). Human freedom breaks the limits and boundary of finitude in order to establish an integrated texture of meaningful structure. This structure "includes and transcends all environments" and shares the ontological self-structure of human persons. Thus, freedom functions to actualize the completeness of self and the world. "World-consciousness is possible only on the basis of a fully developed self-consciousness" (Ibid.: 171). As we have noticed in the polar structure of freedom and destiny in the analysis of the ontological elements, human freedom is always correlated with destiny. Though self-creating and self-transcending, organic and inorganic beings manifest the actuality of their spontaneity, the *telos* of human freedom directs towards moral, cultural and religious realms in which human persons are always supposed to be in a transcendent position to evaluate, judge and respond to all circumstances. However, it should be noticed that the power of establishing a meaningful world implies human persons are both separated from and connected with this world. The greatness of the human being is totally grounded in this double character in the relationship with this self-world structure. As a microcosm, there is a danger of being totally

bound into the world of beings, or of isolating the self out of connection with beings.

Second, human freedom is authentic and decisive only through "the unconditional demand addressing itself to every potential personality to become an actual personality" (Tillich 1927b: 118). For Tillich, freedom is not a personal will but is the depth of reality. The character of moral individual personality is ontologically constituted by freedom. "The unconditional character of the demand to become personal is the ethical expression of the ontological structure of being itself" (Ibid.). Thus, moral freedom is always related to the human constitution instead of establishing moral norms or moral laws. Also, moral personality is ultimately rooted in the structure of being-itself. Therefore, it is neither a pre-personal vitality nor heteronomous command. (Ibid.) For the employment of the symbol of personal freedom, Tillich strongly rejects its abuse in highlighting a special or highest personal being for this would easily become an idol as a thing among others. At the same time, Tillich rejected the naturalistic (pre-personalism) approach to cancelling the depth dimension of the vital basis of human personality. (Ibid.: 118 – 119) Human freedom also equips humans to be aware of the unconditional moral command and to be able to transcend natural mechanisms.

Finally, the most decisive point is the power of contradicting human essential nature (Tillich 1957: 31 – 32). Tillich emphasized human freedom as "finite freedom" in which the greatest and weakest are identical, because freedom should be understood as an ontological possibility which is the driving force towards the transition from essence to existence. This transition is both the fulfillment of the creation and the fall of the created.

Human uniqueness is first articulated as human creativity manifesting in different realms of spiritual dimensions. In volume three of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich mentioned the polarity of freedom and destiny creating the possibility and actuality of life's transcending dimension (Tillich 1963: 86). Self-transcendence, in the sense of the greatness and dignity, implies human persons and nature moving towards something ultimate and holy. Analogous with the human sacred realm, Tillich emphasized that we should consider the inviolability of the organic realm and "greatness" of the inorganic realm.

4.2.2 Infinity

For Tillich, another human uniqueness is the awareness of infinity within human finitude. The relationship between infinity and finitude is neither regarded as the dialectical polar ontological structure, nor the dualistic-supernatural-

istic approach of two levels of existence. As a human being, the experience of the threat of nonbeing and the self-transcendence towards the infinity are embodied within the structure of human finitude. "Being, limited by nonbeing, is finitude" (Tillich 1951: 189). A human person "who is this being, must be separated from his being in a way which enables him to look at it as something strange and questionable" (Ibid.: 187). Thus, it is clear that, for Tillich, nonbeing is a dialectical concept in which authentic life actualizes itself through the overcoming and returning of this idea. Tillich made a famous assertion that the idea of nonbeing should be understood in a dialectical negativity within the being of God, instead of a negative principle outside being-itself. There are beings which ultimately participate in being-itself and are constituted with nonbeing. However, only a human being is able to "experience" finitude (Ibid.: 190).

Within the understanding of the multi-dimensional quality of life, the idea of "infinity" should not be interpreted as the existence of a "super"-level of being. Therefore, when we affirm human uniqueness as human infinity, neither are we talking about the transformation of human being as super-being, nor perceiving an infinite being among other beings. Tillich expressed the concept of infinity as a transcendent horizon which directs human consciousness beyond the finite context. Therefore, infinity is always an idea of potentiality and possibility.

> In order to experience his finitude, man must look at himself from the point of view of a potential infinity. In order to be aware of moving toward death, man must look out over his finite being as a whole; he must in some way be beyond it. He must also be able to imagine infinity; he is able to do so, although not in concrete terms, but only as an abstract possibility (Ibid.: 190).

On one hand, this infinite possibility of human persons is the inwardness of the ontological structure of human beings. Also, more importantly, the potential presence of this infinity, as unlimited self-transcendence, is grounded by God as being-itself that reveals the power of the negation of the negative elements in finitude.

God, as being-itself and the power of being over nonbeing, is ontologically related to the ontological structure of human persons, that always functions as a directing power of the human towards unlimited possibility, and presents itself as a demand for an unconditional moral demand in constituting the authentic personality. For Tillich, God as being-itself is not infinity itself (Ibid.: 191). Or, it should be more accurate to express that God's infinity is beyond the polarity of infinity and finitude. "Being-itself manifests itself to a finite being in the infinite drive of the finite beyond itself" (Ibid.). God is hidden and revealed. Human persons are open to the infinity and bound in the finitude; this double structure is possible in the manifestation of being-itself.

4.2.3 Spirit

For Tillich, the distinctiveness of human activities in the function of life is actualized in morality, cultural creativity and religious participation in which the dimension of spirit is manifested in the unity of power and meaning. In volume three of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich repackaged his doctrine of human being as the spiritual dimension of life in self-integration, self-creativity and self-transcendence in order to extend the meaning of human freedom and the awareness of infinity into the correlation matrix of the Holy Spirit. Tillich reserved the term, *spirit*, to characterize human life which unites the power of being with the meaning of being. On one hand, under the multi-dimensional unity of life, the human spirit should not be excluded from other dimensions of life in which the boundary between spirituality, animality and materiality are blurred. Therefore, under Tillich's holistic version of reality, it is not possible to separate the religious and all secular spheres. Human cultures, a moral dimension and religious pursuit are interdependent with other psychological, biological and inorganic spheres of life.

Tillich first introduces the idea of "spirit" in his systematic construction of human sciences in *The System of Sciences* in which,

> The essence of spirit, its inner tension, its dynamic character, is derived from the infinite opposition between thought and being ... spirit is neither a mode of thought nor a mode of being. In spite of its dependence on both of these elements, it is an irreducible mode. Spirit is the mode of existing thought (Tillich 1923: 137).

As such, the human spirit is beyond the ontological articulation of being and thought, characterized by both the universal mode and the particular mode of validity and meanings. Therefore, according to Re Manning, for Tillich, "any spiritual science must contain both a universal a priori formal analysis and an historical concrete analysis of the distinctive act of the human spirit, namely historical creation (i. e. culture)" (Re Manning 2013: 441). The object of human sciences participates in the subject. It is co-creative and productive. (Tillich 1923: 146) Thus, according to Tillich, the normative character of the human sciences is given to their productive character. Norms as such are not given from the external spheres, but are created by spiritual creation itself. "[E]very spiritual act is the positing of a norm; insofar as the human sciences productively participate in this act, they are normative." (Ibid.: 149) As such, for Tillich, theology of culture as the normative spiritual science of culture is to adopt systematically a religiously normative stance towards the meaning of culture. Religion is not one sphere of meaning alongside the others. It is the depth, attitude and substance

within all spheres which are the spiritual-creative productions of the human spirit. Thus, the universal forms, material content and norms of the cultural productions of the human spirit are all integrated with each other.

In volume three of the *Systematic Theology*, human persons actualize potentiality in the dimension of spirit in self-integration, self-creation and self-transcendence of life. Morality is the function of life in which the human spirit comes into being and morality itself is the constitutive function of the spirit. (Tillich 1963: 38) Culture is another function of life in which human spirit can cultivate others through the function of *theoria* and *praxis*. The former expresses the multi-functionality of human language to grasp the world, and the latter expresses the action performed by spiritual life in a continuation of the technical act. (Ibid.: 57–64) Religion is the last function of life in which the human spirit seeks for the self-transcendence towards the ultimate. Based on the mixture of essence and existence, all life-functions in the dimension of the human spirit are inevitably ambiguous and are in the quest for the breakthrough and healing of the divine revelation as Spiritual Presence.

4.3 Reconsider the Dimensional-Hierarchical Metaphor

As the above two sections (4.1. and 4.2.) showed, we can conclude a complex and multi-faceted relationship between human persons and nature. For Tillich, on one hand, the dialectical polarity of the ontological structure of human being and nature clearly constitutes the inner connection and interrelationship between human beings and other beings in the world. However, on the other hand, this holistic and dynamic picture does not violate the distinctiveness and uniqueness of human persons in the world. For Tillich, the human being is in the world and above the world. No anthropology and theory of nature can negate this basic assertion. If we employ the language of environmental ethics to repackage Tillich's idea, I would propose that Tillich's position is beyond the eco-centricism and anthropocentricism in which the human being is the center of the world and shares the basic ontological structure of the world.

If Tillich strongly rejected a hierarchical perspective towards reality, does he commit to a radical eco-egalitarianism in which all beings should be axiologically equal? This section argues that, even though Tillich emphasized that the last two dimensions, spiritual and historical, come to their full actualizations only in human beings, in whom as the bearer of the spirit the conditions for them are present (Ibid.: 25), we must bear in mind the following. First, the basic ontological structure, self and world, is universally valid in *all living beings*, meaning that the three ontological polar structures: individualization and participation,

dynamic and form, freedom and destiny, are universally shared by all beings, though in different forms and content. And, second, Tillich insists that the graduation of value among the different dimensions is an *ontological* but not an *ethical* question (Ibid.: 17).

Following the idea of *gestalt*, every being is a structural whole in which an idea of "self" should be attributed to all individual *gestalten* (Tillich 1951: 169). In that sense, Tillich asserted that selfhood, self-relatedness and self-centeredness are all established in all living beings. This self-centeredness is the innermost constitution of all living *gestalt*; it is open to be reduced, but not distorted as, otherwise, the *gestalt* would become a thing. Then, is it possible for human beings to have a cognitive understanding about other beings? It is interesting that, first, Tillich expressed that we human beings do not have any direct or indirect knowledge about the meaning of the other being's behavior. We are the "strangeness" for each other. We are always indirect and uncertain in overcoming this strangeness through analogy, but without always success (Ibid.: 168). Therefore, the Other is always the otherness-in-strangeness. It implies that the animal other is never the object of technical knowledge to be *sub-jected* into our human epistemological framework, but is the *eros*-subject for us to participate into their lives through participatory knowledge.

Although, second, Tillich defined the human being as a "microcosm", this is merely to express that the "ontological elements are all complete" in humans, not in other beings. Tillich insisted that, though the human being occupies a pre-eminent position in ontology, not as an outstanding object among other objects, but as that being who asks the ontological question and in whose self-awareness the ontological answer can be found (Ibid.), the "subhuman does not imply less perfection than in the case of the human" (Ibid.: 260). The criterion of animal perfection does not lie in our human knowledge and perception. Under the ontological criterion expressing a value judgment based on the maximum number of potentialities in one living actuality (Tillich 1963: 17), as Tillich said, human beings contain all dimensions in actual status and they can enjoy the status of the highest being even though the "level" pyramid is replaced by the multi-dimensional model. We should remember that Tillich's wording is that "(m)an is the highest being *within the realm of our experience*" (Ibid. Emphasis mine). That means, according to a human being's awareness of their own *Dasein*, s/he embodies the power to transcend the environment and to build a multi-faceted world. However, it does not mean that the human being is the highest *in the world*. Echoing Jakob von Uexküll's discovery of all organisms creating their own meaningful world, we can conclude that human beings are the highest in their own world but, by no means, is this universally valid in the natural world. Tillich said that it is always difficult, if not impossible, to compare

the natural perfection of non-human beings with finite freedom of human beings. The highest one can become the worst one, and the lowest one can become the most perfect one. There is no single and universal principle of gradation of value to be applied in the whole universe.

It seems that *Seinsfrage* does make the human special. The specialty of human *Seinsfrage* merely constitutes the human ironical situation that, among all living beings, a mere human being is aware of her/his finitude, meaning that the human being participates in the ontological structure, like other beings, but s/he is also *estranged* from nature. Following Jakob von Uexküll's discovery, Tillich emphasized that human beings and animals share the experiences that they both have in an environment which is *their* environment. The environment is not merely surroundings, but "consists in those things with which it has an active interrelation" (Tillich 1951: 170). Both types of being belong to the environment and have the environment in their own ways. It is clear that, for Tillich, "man has a world" (Ibid.) means that a human being is able to transcend every possible environment to construct a world. However, we have to bear in mind that "the world is the structural whole which *includes and transcends* all environments" (Ibid. Emphasis mine). Therefore, we can conclude that human beings and animals both participate in their own environments; the distinction between them being that human beings have transcendence in world-forming, which is actually expressing the finitude and estranged conditions of the human state.

We should notice that Tillich is not an ecological egalitarian, meaning that, even though his model of multi-dimensional unity of life supports the dynamic interplay between potentiality and actuality, the distinction between the highest and lowest beings is still valid. In volume one of the *Systematic Theology*, the term "dimension" still remained unnoticed by Tillich; the ontological difference and the power of different levels between human persons and other beings dominate his writings. Tillich often reminded us that completeness and incompleteness of the ontological elements (individualization and participation, destiny and form, freedom and destiny) between human and non-human beings are clearly distinct and not the same (Tillich 1951: 260). Besides, the most decisive point is that, from volume one to volume three, Tillich insisted all levels (or dimensions) of life spheres are present and actualized in human persons, and other dimensions are only potentially present in other life realms. Therefore, it seems that there is *a center* in the concept of the multi-dimensional unity of life. This human center represents the focus of the universe in which all dimensions of life are present and actualized in this center. Thus, the hierarchical model with center and different levels of power is maintained within the dimensionality of life.

Life actualizes itself through the actualization of the power of life. Tillich emphasized that, in the *hierarchical* structure of life,

> the more centred a being is the more power of being is embodied in it. The completed centred, self-related and self-aware being, man, has the greatest power of being. He has a world, not only an environment, and with it infinite potentialities of self-realization. His centredness makes him the master of his world. But *where there is centredness there is a hierarchical structure of power.* The nearer to the center an element is, the more it participates in the power of the whole (Tillich 1954: 44. Emphasis mine).

Different lives share different degrees of the power of life in their encounter, moving forward and returning. The dynamic picture represents the power flows within each other and transforms them into one self. These processes are going on in every moment of life, in all relations of all beings. They go on between those powers of being which we call nature, between humans and nature, and between humans themselves. The power of the center and the power of the whole are correlated. Every life has different degrees of the power of centredness and the power of the whole. According to Tillich, due to the completeness of the self-centredness of the human persons, the polarity of the self-world structure in human persons is the most completed and actualized form. In that sense, a human person is the highest being. Therefore, Tillich did not abandon the hierarchical language to describe the multi-dimensional unity of life.

Also, the power of life is linked with the ontology of love. For Tillich, life is being in actuality and love is the moving power of life. Power and love are the ontological drives inherent in all life-forms to actualize their potentiality. Otherwise, there is no being at all. "Being is not actual without love which drives everything that is towards everything else that is. Love is the drive towards the unity of the separated". Tillich insisted that love cannot be described as the union of the strange but as the reunion of the estranged (Ibid.: 25). Every self is self-related and a complete self is completely self-related. It is an independent center, indivisible and impenetrable, and therefore is rightly called an individual. Love is the foundation, not the negation, of power. Both ontological items (power and love) constitute the dialectical union of the actualization of life in separation and reunion. (Ibid.:49)

If all beings in the world have inherent different degrees of the power of being, it implies that different functionalities of individuals are classified and leveled in an integrated whole within the universe. Individuals are unique in their definitive character, and this character is relative to context in the sense that neither holism nor individualism is Tillich's entire position. Compared with an Aristotelian framework, DeMarco suggested the term, "ecological contextualism", in which "the functions of the parts of a living individual make sense

relative to the function of the whole in a different way than the function of the whole makes sense relative to its contexts" (DeMarco 1997: 111). Thus, we can also find the ecological model of Thomas Aquinas who, like Tillich, tried to maintain ecological holism and individual particularity. For Thomas, creation integrity cannot be separated from the way that God becomes friends with humans. In Willis Jenkins' *Ecologies of Grace*, Thomas' environmental ethical model does not commit into the dichotomy of non/anthropocentricism and the danger of human dominion over nature. The world naturally belongs to God, and God uses human experience of the things that naturally belong to God to perfect the specific way humans come to belong to God. First, divine goodness formally shapes creation's integrity, rendering it a similitude of God's goodness. Thus, diverse creaturely natures together adumbrate the absolute simplicity of God's goodness, and they represent divine perfection as they act for their proper ends, realizing the real relation to the creator by realizing the natural perfections that govern the form of their essences (Jenkins 2008: 122). Thus, creation integrity includes not only individual creatures, but the pattern and orders by which they are related to one another, and the natural whole they together comprise as the common good of all creation. Therefore, the creation integrity includes ordered unity and real diversity. God's grace perfects humans through exercise of their faculties and teaches humans how to "use" other creatures. Thus, the ecological order of Thomas is basically hierarchical in nature in a sense that the rational capacity between humans and other creatures is qualitatively different, however, this division between human and other creatures is not disconnected in a sanctifying dynamic. Humans are naturally over other non-human beings and this ontological distinctiveness is ordained to knowing and praising God from creation (Ibid.: 132).

5 Towards a Theonomous Technology

Introduction

For Tillich, the nature of "modernity"[1] is understood as the orientation of the horizontal-futurist dimension of the human attitude towards reality. This radical transformation was originally rooted in the late medieval period and radicalized within the classical and humanistic orientation of the Renaissance in the following two ways, which Tillich called the problem of the historical existence of humanity. One is the transcendental foundation, which made the historical fate of humanity relatively unimportant compared with eternal destiny. Another is the immanent foundation, which allows the historical fate of humanity to appear to be in a preliminary stage in the continuous progress towards perfection (Tillich 1939: 227). For Tillich, the decisive spirit of this period of historical time is the "control of nature and society by human reason" (Ibid.: 226). This is concretely manifested in scientific-technological rationality, which expands its dominant and transformative power over all realms of life. This analysis of modernity is profoundly expressed through Tillich's framework of secularity within the sacred, cultural matrix within the religious sphere (5.1.). During Tillich's intellectual development, the existential roots of the being of technology had changed from the "divine-demonic" to a "rational-cultural" analysis in which the ambiguous character of technology is demonstrated (5.2.–5.3.). Likewise, this existential analysis points to the quest of redemption within Tillich's method of correlation. This chapter argues that the problem of technology as the ambiguity of human spiritual creation can be framed within the healing of Spiritual Presence and the technological utopian character can be fulfilled and rejected in the symbol of the Kingdom of God (5.4.). Under the healing of the pneumatological and eschatological manifestation of divine redemptive power, humanity and reality are transformed into a complex of "mutual service and fulfillment" in which the exploitation of things and the mechanization of personality are overcome (Tillich 1927b: 14).

1 Tillich had briefly mentioned the modern period as beginning with the Renaissance (about 1450) and ending with the first decades of the twentieth century (Tillich 1939: 226).

https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110612752-006

5.1 Modernity and the Nature Lost

The analysis of modernity reflects a paradigm shift in the relationship between human beings and nature. In a very brief illustration of the absence in the intrinsic power of reality and the rise of the human center in domination over nature, Tillich provided several theological-philosophical strategies for explaining the distorted polarity of the "self-world" ontological structure. First, the monotheist tradition of Christianity emphasizes the distinction of the creator and the creatures; the sacred power of created reality is exorcised by the commandment of God. Also, under the dualistic separation of the transcendent and immanent in Platonic philosophy, the intrinsic value and power of reality is attributed to the transcendent ground of beings. The elevation of humanity above existence in term of the intuition of people's essence is regarded as a continuous process of widening the gap between sacred and secular. In the Reformation, the authentic religious ethos is ultimately found in the vertical dimension of God and the human soul. Even though some degrees of nature-mysticism and sacramental thinking remain in Lutheranism, nature and history are regarded as the object of the "order of God" in which the secular world is to be subjected to the control of the Kingdom of God in Calvinism (Tillich 1927b: 120 – 121).

The above historical-intellectual development destroys the basic relationship between human and nature. "All this has led ... to a strong anti-sacramentalism, to an extreme devaluation of things, and on the other hand, to a most impressive elevation of domineering personalities, contemptuous of nature and things" (Ibid.: 122). The modern capitalist-technological hegemony, resulting in the de-humanization of humans and de-sacralization of nature, is just the result of the above situation. Therefore, for Tillich, the violation of the human relationship with nature is basically a spiritual problem in a sense that western philosophical and theological content, in changing their substance, reinforces and produces modern scientific-technological power in their form. In the following, I argue that the western technological matrix is grounded in certain theological discourses. In Tillich's project of theology of culture, the question of technology is dominant from the very beginning and until the end of his life. The diagnosis of western modernity can be first articulated as the paradigm shift in the Renaissance and, finally located in medieval nominalism.

5.1.1 Paradigm shifts in the Renaissance

In the essay, "The World Situation" (1945), Tillich had the ambition to give a comprehensive and solid analysis of "the present world situation" as the title indi-

cated. Looking backwards, Tillich pointed out that the "present world situation" is basically the outcome of the rise, triumph and the crisis of the bourgeois society (Tillich 1945: 166). From a sociological and economic analysis, Tillich asserted that there are three phrases through which the complex matrix of human rationality manifests itself as the dominant factor in the analysis of the modern world. In the first, the new society struggled to establish itself over the remnants of a disintegrating feudal society; secondly, the new society came to triumphant power through the creation of a world mechanism of production and exchange; last, humanity struggles to regain control over the self-destructive forces loosed by a regnant industrial society (Ibid.).

For Tillich, his religious-cultural concern was the disclosure of the "inner logic and meaning" of the above situation instead of merely providing a descriptive analysis. In the first phrase, human rationality was regarded as the guiding principle in all social construction and cultural activities; the purpose of the application of human rationality is to free capitalist society from feudal society (Tillich 1945: 166). Reason is perceived as the positive power for resisting all kinds of hegemony and external power in order to regain an autonomous position in cultural and religious realms. Human rationality is not merely a kind of thinking process; rather, it empowers the human being in pursuit of truth and justice in the world. In this sense, "modernity" is the result of the human ability to fight against all kinds of feudal and authoritarian social structures (Ibid.). The revolutionary and critical substances of human rationality are appropriated for the flight of the heteronomous machines; human goodness and passion for justice are manifested (Tillich 1967a: 328). In the second phrase, the global political-economic system is established through the matrix of production and exchange (Tillich 1945: 166). Human rationality is transformed and is reduced to a technological orientation in which the dominant feature is the machine of a "means-ends" relationship. Tillich categorized the transition from the first phrase to the second phrase as "revolutionary reason transforming into technical reason" (Tillich 1945: 168), in which reason is no longer a liberating power but is a weapon of control and dominance used by capitalists. It is located in the huge machine of production and reproduction, with collaboration with the capitalist-market exchange, the revolutionary character is transformed into a technical character (Ibid.). Tillich described:

> The displacement of revolutionary reason by technical reason was accompanied by far-reaching changes in the structure of human society. Man became increasingly able to control physical nature. Through the tools placed at his disposal by technical reason, he created a worldwide mechanism of large-scale production and competitive economy, which began to take shape as a kind of "second nature," a Frankenstein, above physical nature and subjecting man to itself. While he was increasingly able to control and manipulate

> physical nature, man became less and less able to control this "second nature." He was swallowed up by his own creation. Step by step the whole of human life was subordinated to the demands of the new worldwide economy. Men became units of working power ... The movement of the mechanism of production and consumption were irrational and incalculable. So it became for the masses a dark and incomprehensible fate, determining their destiny, lifting them today to a higher standard of life than they had ever before known, throwing them down tomorrow into utter misery and the abyss of chronic unemployment (Tillich 1945: 168).

Tillich emphasized that, under the transition, human rationality becomes the power for maintaining the status quo rather than the liberating power to break through the ordinary situation.

In the nineteenth century, natural science became the monopoly of human knowledge and technology followed as the most effective means to the end. This natural science-technical understanding connected with the global-capitalist economic mechanism, dominating the world of meaning and value in which instrumental value becomes the standard and criterion, with a loss of intrinsic value and *telos* of all beings.

> Science itself became positivistic: reality must simply be accepted as it is; no rational criticism of it is permissible. The so-called "fact" and its adoration replaced the "meaning" and its interpretation. Statistics replace norms. Material replaced structure. Logical possibilities replaced existential experience. The quest for truth became a method of foreseeing the future instead of creating it. Rational truth was replaced by instincts and pragmatic beliefs ... Philosophy was largely restricted to epistemology. It became the servant of technical progress, its scientific foundations and its economic control. Following the breakdown of belief in rational truth as the determining factor in life, "technical reason" ... became decisive throughout the world as far as the dominance of western influences reaches (Tillich 1945: 184 – 185).

In *The Religious Situation* (1926), Tillich concluded with three main distinct but interrelated characteristics of modern society: capitalist economy, mathematical natural science and technology.

> ... mathematical natural science which pursues the goal of demonstrating that reality is governed wholly by its own laws and is rationally intelligible. ... [mathematical calculation] applies to world-ruling technique with its will to conquer space, time and nature and to make the earth a well-furnished dwelling of man. It applies, finally, to capitalist economy which seeks to provide the greatest possible number of men with the greatest possible number of economic goods, which seeks to arouse and to satisfy ever increasing demands without raising the question as to the meaning of the process which claims the service of all the spiritual and physical human abilities (Tillich 1926: 47).

All three concrete cultural creations, expressing a kind of self-sufficient and self-fulfillment mentality, cut off all sources of meaning of life (Ibid.: 48). The existence of technology originally demonstrated a liberating power for releasing human beings from the demonic power inherited from nature. This utopian imagination in victory over matter and controlling nature is manifested in the vision in the Renaissance (Tillich 1926: 49). For Tillich, the remarkable change in the world situation happened in the nineteenth century. The controllable power of technological rationality and positive science extended to all realms of human and non-human life forms. However, the worldview was manifested in the notion of rationality in the eighteenth century (Tillich 1945: 184), in which the liberation of reason is the means to acquire harmony between human beings and society. In Tillich's analysis, all the distinctive and complex social, economic and political situations emerging around the eighteenth and nineteenth century are the natural outcomes of the cultural creations of the Renaissance in which the ideal type of human being in the cosmos is clearly expressed by those great Renaissance thinkers (Tillich 1945: 166). That means, for Tillich, that the ideal vision promoted in the Renaissance provides the entrance key to western modernity. The modern period begins with the Renaissance by controlling nature and society through human rationality (Tillich 1939: 226).

For the inquiry about the origin of western modernity, it is clear that Tillich focused on the developmental progress of the notion of "rationality"; he noted that we should trace back to the Renaissance in which a particular kind of conviction about human rationality was adopted. First, in the Renaissance, a universal ideal of personality was derived through the liberation of individual rationality, and it brought the harmonious fulfillment of society and human beings (Tillich 1945: 167). "The development of reason as the quest for truth was identified with the development of humanity" (Ibid.: 184). The universal human ideal and the harmonious society were regarded as the ideal type of human community. This ideal was manifested as the task of every human cultural activity: in the economic realm every single pursuit of individual interest should be for the maximization of the well-being of the whole community; in the political realm, the common good would be attained through democracy; in the religious realm, the conformity of a believer's morality and piety was attained through the individualization of biblical readings and religious experiences (Tillich 1945: 167). In summary, for Tillich, this Renaissance individuality was in some ways closely related with the liberal-capitalist atomic individual in that the former seeks for the unifying and harmonious whole with the cosmos, and the latter, to some extent emerging from the former, had more emphasis on a self-contained and sufficient individual self who constitutes the "subject-object" dichotomy.

The spiritual orientation expressed in the Renaissance was perfectly identified with the modern understanding of self-realization and world-controlling mentality. Tillich termed this particular ideal as the positive type of world-shaping and world-controlling (Tillich 1963b: 186). In Tillich's classification of three historical culture creations, classical Greek culture focused on the circular model in which all life forms actualized their potentialities within the cosmos; second, the vertical orientation was emphasized in transcending the world towards the ultimate God in the Medieval Ages; last, in the Renaissance and Reformation, the dimension shifted into the horizontal mode in which the ideal world was manifested as the fulfillment of spiritual life through controlling and transforming (Ibid.). In summary, a particular type of horizontal modality which dominated the telos of all beings occurred in the Renaissance.

For Tillich, western modernity is, in principle, a production of horizontal life orientation, and, materially speaking, dominated by a scientific-technical mode. In the depth of the spirit of the Renaissance, humanism was political and technologically oriented, and the ideal of humanity was expressed in a nature-dominating and society-controlling way. The fulfillment of universal humanity and the balance between individuals and nature were achieved through the liberation of rationality (Tillich 1945:166 – 167). The most crucial point is that the transcendence of a person's life fulfillment was shifted from the vertical to the horizontal dimension in that substantive personal self-actualization occurred through the (technical) transformation of self, others and the world (Tillich 1961: 79). The result was "rational man, the active center of his world, analyzing, controlling, and changing it according to his purpose"(Ibid.).

Paradoxically, the relationship between human beings and nature is expressed as that ideal humanity is both the *fulfiller* and the *destroyer* of nature. Tillich asserted that the human being is the microcosm in the Renaissance in a sense that the human being is the "center" of the universe; all beings are connected and bound within each other through human beings and this bounding power is inevitably ambiguous as a kind of dominating power of the universe (Tillich 1946: 278).

> Related to this is the idea of man as the microcosm who stands in the center of the cosmic forces, uniting them within himself and called to unite them in the whole of nature by knowledge and control of the cosmos forces. The long, partly dark, partly open history of these ideas runs from its Persian-apocalyptic beginnings through Paul and Irenaeus to Nicolaus Cusanus, and from the romantic philosophy of nature, the other from the mathematical sciences to the industrial control of nature. In both ways man is considered to be the destroyer as well as the fulfiller of nature (Tillich 1946: 278).

The thought of Nicolaus Cusanus as the main representative of the humanism of the Renaissance is twofold: the first is to bond human beings with nature; the second is to elevate human beings to being the center of the universe. Therefore, it is indisputable that the new vision for human beings and nature inherent in the Renaissance is the key to understanding the origin of western modernity.

It is interesting that the idea of nature expressed in the Renaissance can be traced back to religious aspects of the Medieval Ages. For Tillich, echoing with Ernst Cassirer's analysis, the mystical piety in the Medieval Ages implies the "secularization" of nature (Cassirer 2000: 51). In the Franciscan order, the notion of love breaks the gap between spirit and nature; within the mystical experience with God, the object of love extends to all beings in nature. As Cassirer said: "in Franciscan mysticism the medieval mind begins the great work of redeeming nature and liberating it from the stain of sin and sensuality" (Ibid.,: 52). Likewise, Renaissance epistemology provides the justification for this medieval love, in echoing the Franciscan universal love; Nicolaus Cusanus was seeking for the love closely related to the knowledge. "All true love is based on act of knowledge" (Ibid.). For Nicolaus Cusanus, based on the understanding of God's image inside all beings, searching for knowledge of nature is identical with searching for the knowledge of God. Knowledge of God and knowledge of nature are not two distinct and separate knowledges but overlap. Nature is precisely the mirror of God's glory and it is the book written by God's hands.

> We are still on religious ground here: but at the same time the background ... into the free, open field of objective science has been accomplished. Neither subjective feeling nor mystical sentiment suffices to understand the meaning of the book of nature. Rather, it must be investigated; it must be deciphered word for word, letter for letter. The world may no longer remain a divine hieroglyph, a holy sign; instead, we must analyze and systematically interpret this sign (Cassirer 2000: 53).

In Cassirer's analysis, the modern objective understanding of nature is built upon a religious perception of the divine within nature. Therefore, the modern scientific-technological framework cannot be properly understood without an analysis of religious background.

Contrary to the secularization thesis, which commonly holds that western modernity is understood as the absence of God or decline of religion, the divine and sacred pursuit is neither abandoned nor rejected in the modern undertaking, but the spiritual orientation has rather shifted from the *vertical* to the *horizontal* dimension towards the world. For Tillich, every cultural form is religious in substance. The modern cultural matrix is no exception. The modern scientific-technological attitude towards the world should be regarded as the complex relationship between religion and technology, rather than adapting an either-or

mechanism or reductionist explanation. In the thought of Nicolaus Cusanus, Tillich asserted, the idea of "*coincidentia oppositorum*" constitutes the co-existence between the infinite and the finite. "The finite potentially in the infinite, the infinite actually in the finite" (Tillich 1967a: 373). This notion grounds the unity of the interpretation of the world and the interpretation of God. It seems that "*coincidentia oppositorum*" opens the way of discovery of nature and implicitly the way is religious. Tillich asserted:

> The divine is not in some place alongside of the world or above the world, but is present in everything human and natural. In some respects, one can say that modern naturalism was born out of the mystical idea of the coincidence of opposites. This was not simply a methodological approach to reality, rationalistic or empiricist. Behind it was an experience that nature is not outside of creative reality, but is potentially before the creation in God (Tillich 1967a: 374).

Likewise, for Nicolaus Cusanus, a human being discovers the finitude in which s/he is imprisoned; reason does not accept this bondage and tries to grasp the infinite with the categories of the finite. The above conviction was intensified throughout the Romanticism period. As Tillich argued, despite the contrasting viewpoints between empirical science in the eighteenth century and Goethe's idea of science, it is consistent for both in searching the internal natural laws in nature. In Goethe, the integrated whole of nature, the balance between the infinite and the finite are emphasized (Tillich 1967a: 375 – 376). The "philosophy of imagination" in Romanticism is the modern version of human self-transcendence. The horizontal construction in Romanticism, manifesting the tension between the finite and the infinite, anticipates the modern scientific-technological controlling of human society and nature. "So this is not only the infinite *above*, but also the infinite *ahead*, presenting in each new moment an infinite variety of possibilities for romantic element which has entered his country also" (Ibid.: 377).

5.1.2 The Nominalist Origin

However, the story does not end in the Renaissance. As Michael Gillespie states in *The Theological Origin of Modernity*, "the shapes that modern thought subsequently assumed were not arbitrary reoccupations of medieval positions but a realization of the metaphysical and theological possibilities" (Gillespie 2008: 12). Also, Gillespie pointed out that modernity came into being as the result of a series of attempts to find a way out of the crisis engendered by the nominalist revolution (Ibid.: 15). In the Renaissance, in adopting the presupposition of the

nominalist ontology, the human being was placed as the center of the universe, resulting in an intensification of the autonomous attitude; in the Reformation, in following the nominalist presupposition, the reformers place the authority of God and the Bible as the center in order to fight against the heteronomous church authority. However, under Gillespie's analysis, naturalism in the modern world is the final victor because although it "helped to ameliorate the conflict, it could not eliminate the antagonism at its heart without eliminating either God and man. However, one cannot abandon God without turning man into a beast, and one cannot abandon man without falling into theological fanaticism" (Ibid.). It seems that the enlightenment and German idealism to a large extent are the answers to the above "struggle between autonomous reason and heteronomous authority".

Similar to Michael Gillespie's perspectives, Tillich convincingly traced back the origin of western modernity to a theological turn in the thirteenth century which was regarded as the decisive origin of western modern technological mind-sets. It is well known that the task of Tillich's theology or philosophy of religion is grounded in a theonomous vision in that religious substance and its culture form are perfectly integrated. Tillich mentioned that this vision happened in the high Medieval Age. However, paradoxically speaking, the thirteenth century is both the high point and the turning point of the Middle Ages. As Tillich said, "the whole destiny of the Western world was decided at this time [the high Medieval Age] *in a very definite way*" (Tillich 1967a: 180. Emphasis mine). This so-called "very definite way" is the formal structure of modernity, religiously framed in the thirteenth century. For the history of the conflict between autonomy and heteronomy, Tillich mentioned the genuine breakthrough of autonomous reason, destroying the medieval theonomy, was crystallized in nominalism. The period of the Renaissance and Reformation is merely when the conflict grew into a new intensity (Tillich 1952: 85). In Tillich's mind, the task of a theologian of culture is twofold in fighting against an empty autonomy and a destructive heteronomy in that both are regarded as the main characteristics of modern culture and originally emerged in the thirteenth century.

In Tillich's reading of the theological development in the high Middle Age, Bonaventura, Thomas Aquinas and Duns Scotus are the three main representatives (Tillich 1967a: 180). Among them, "Duns Scotus was the greatest of them all as a scholar, and he was also the starting point of new developments on which *the whole modern period is dependent*" (Ibid. Emphasis mine). As Tillich mentioned in "The Two Types of Philosophy of Religion", there are two approaches to conceiving God that were originally exercised in the high Middle Ages (Tillich 1946a). In the ontological approach, God is the presupposition of all human knowledge, and the knowledge of God is immediate awareness within the

human mind. This knowledge is the divine light in our soul. "Only on the basis of this immediate knowledge of the ultimate principles of reality can we find truth in the empirical world" (Tillich 1967a: 184). This approach was adapted by the Augustine-Franciscan-Bonaventura tradition, which Tillich called the "theonomous" attitude. The other approach is the cosmological tradition that is famously expressed by Thomas Aquinas, who asserted that human knowledge about God starts with God's effects instead of His being. In starting with the observation of God's world, we can conclude their cause (Tillich 1967a: 187). Therefore, contrasting with the ontological approach, the human being is separated from being itself; we should start with the finite world and then discover God in our acts of cognition (Tillich 1967a: 186).

For Tillich, these two approaches to the understanding of God and the world "is the ultimate cause of the secularization of the western world" (Tillich 1967a: 186). Why does the above theological dispute impact the understanding of modernity? Or, in a strong sense, Tillich asserted, the problematic is the "cause" of secularization. The secret was unveiled in the tradition of the Aristotle-Thomas tradition and the nominalist theologians intensified it. For Thomas, the Aristotelian method of starting with the external world is logically correct, but without the internal certainty about God. Authority must complete it. This means that the church plays the role of guaranteeing the truth, which can never be fully reached merely by an empirical approach to God. Therefore, Thomas' autonomous knowledge and heteronomous church authority first destroyed the theonomous attitude (Tillich 1967a: 186–187). Second, Duns Scotus rejected both ontological and cosmological approaches to God. For him, there is an infinite gap between the finite and the infinite. As a nominalist, Duns Scotus pointed out that all human knowledge of God is an analogy. Likewise, "there is only one way that is open to receive God, the way of authority, the way of revelation received by the authority of the church" (Tillich 1967a: 187). Tillich discovered that, related to a modern empirical scientific attitude, Duns Scotus introduced two types of positivism. One is the religious or ecclesiastical authority mentioned before. The second is the empirical method through which we must discover what is positively given in nature through the methods of induction and abstraction (Tillich 1967a: 187). Finally, William Ockham completed the story. For him, God is totally out of human reach. Therefore, God can be reached only by subjecting ourselves to the biblical and ecclesiastical authorities. "Cultural knowledge, the knowledge of science, is completely free and autonomous, and religious knowledge is completely heteronomous" (Tillich 1967a: 188). In Thomas, human reason is able to express the existence of God. In Duns Scotus, human reason is unable to express revelation. In Ockham, revelation stands alongside of reason, even in opposition

to it. Therefore, for Tillich, at the end of the Middle Ages, "the religious and secular realms are separated" (Tillich 1967a: 188).

Theologically speaking, the nominalist tradition provides the religious soil for the development of human autonomous rationality and individualistic thinking. Tillich asserted that,

> according to nominalism, only the individual has ontological reality; universals are verbal signs which point to similarities between individual things. Knowledge, therefore, is not participation in character. It is an external act of grasping and controlling things. Controlling knowledge is the epistemological expression of nominalist ontology; empiricism and positivism are its logical consequences. But pure nominalism is untenable. Even the empiricist must acknowledge that everything approachable by knowledge must have the structure of 'being knowable.' And this structure includes by definition a mutual participation of the knower and the known. Radical nominalism is unable to make the process of knowledge understandable (Tillich 1951: 177).

That means the mode of individuality and external knowledge is grounded in nominalist ontology in which different realms of knowledge are external and separated. Religious knowledge and secular knowledge belong in two separated realms. For nominalism, the universals are nothing; only the individual exists.

> On the basis of its dissolution of the universals, nominalism objects to the concept of a universal power of being or to the concept of being-itself. But nominalism cannot escape the implicit assertion that the nature of being and knowing is best recognized by a nominalist epistemology. If being is radically individualized, if it lacks embracing structures and essences, this is a character of being, valid for everything that is. The question then is not whether one can speak of being-itself, but what its nature is and how it can be approached cognitively (Tillich 1951: 231).

Likewise, the French political philosopher, Marcel Gauchet, agreed with Tillich's analysis on the nominalist origin of western modernity. For Gauchet, "our ways of thinking and behaving in the world are radically shaped by the logic of religion in general and by the logic of Christianity in particular" (Cloots 2008). In his book, *The Disenchantment of the World*, modernity is "coming out of religion"; Gauchet stated that modern society is another version of the human being reconceived, in terms of the world and the divine. Following Hans Blumenberg's thesis that the absolute transcendence of God in late-medieval nominalism and theological voluntarism was of vital importance for the growth of autonomous reason in modernity, Gauchet pointed out that the modern incentive to invest in the world arises from within Christian religion. Compared with other religions, Christianity emphasizes the doctrine of the incarnation in which the "beyond" and "here" are theologically linked which creates an inner-worldly dimen-

sion to go beyond "pure escapism" and "pure submission". Therefore, the religious concern for the world-beyond is integrated with the world-here-now.

As Ian Thompson's *Being and Meaning. Paul Tillich's Theory of Meaning, Truth and Logic* correctly points out, Tillich's lifelong fight against nominalism is mainly because, first, nominalism denies the presence of universal powers of being in things, denies the tendency of an existing being to strive towards its telos, and denies an intrinsic connection between being and value. Also, second, it leads to heteronomy in religion and politics. Because of Ockham's exaggeration of will over intellect, everything has to be subjected to biblical and ecclesiastical authorities. Last, nominalism tends to deprive religious and cultural symbols of their ultimate meaning by its radical restriction of the meaning of being the finite individual things (Thompson 1981: 70 – 76).

5.2 Divine-Demonic Ambiguity of Technology

Modern technology is the outcome of the modern interpretation of the divine, human beings and nature. The basic formal structure was first shaped at the end of the Medieval Ages, and then, intensified in the Renaissance and the Reformation, and finally crystallized in the Enlightenment and the scientific revolution. During the life of Tillich, the problem of technology is one of the main focuses of his theology of culture.[2] Technical creation constructs our basic conception of our innermost beings and the related "world". Basically, the evaluation of technology should be neither overestimated nor underestimated. The ambiguity of technology is veiled both to those who are blissfully and blindly

2 For Tillich, the issue of technology is not secondary in his intellectual consideration. In his German period, Tillich had slightly mentioned the correlation between technology and the Kingdom of God in his 1913 *Systematische Theologie*. During the period of his teaching in the Dresden Institute of Technology, Tillich published two intensive articles on the understanding of technology which are titled "The Logos and Mythos of Technology (1927) and "The Technical City as Symbol" (1928). Also, in my study, two important manscripts entitled as "*Religion und Technik*" and "*Der natürlich-schöpfungsmäßige und geschichtlich-eschatologische Sinn der Technik*" written in 1929 are also related to this issue. After immgrating into America, Tillich published numerous articles and gave different lectures on the problem of science in general and technology in particular. Several articles are particularly important in my study: "The Person in a Technical Society" (1953), "Participation and Knowledge: Problems of an Ontology of Cognition" (1955), "Confirmity" (1957), "Thing and Self" (1958). It should be noted that, in Tillich's later period, he was also concerned about the problem of nuclear weapons and the significance of space travel. His articles include: "Seven theses concerning the Nuclear Dilemma" (1961), "Has Man's Conquest of Space Increased or Decreased His status? " (1963).

trusting in technology and to those who consider its realization to be a nightmare. These two misleading attitudes will veil the inner secret of modern technology. Since the boundaries of technology are defined by what surrounds it, no merely "neutral definition is possible.[3]

In Tillich's early German period, the discussion about technology is basically framed and closely connected with human spirit, nature and even the kingdom of God. However, its nature is highly ambiguous. First, Tillich rejected the idea that technology is external and is a neutral entity indifferent to the natural realm and human society; it exists objectively in our world as a means for us to employ. In contrast, Tillich expressed that technology is *part of the nature*, instead of a foreigner and an alien in nature. By the essence of technology, the "means-ends relationship" ontologically structures what technology is. The functionality of all organic forms sufficiently manifests such a means-ends ontological structure, expressing that *technology is nature-based*. In his earlier essay, "The Logos and Mythos of Technology" (1927), Tillich mentioned that the "*logos*" of technology is fully manifested in its enlisting means to an end. This universality of technology is present whenever purposes are realized (Tillich 1927: 51). "Where something is successful through the use of suitable means, there is technology" (Ibid.: 52). Therefore, for Tillich, technology is basically and primarily nature-based and nature is essentially technic-based. Tillich emphasized the blurring of technology and nature. The figure of technic-nature itself is the essence and life form of all organisms.

Nature acts technically; it acts cunningly (Ibid.). The richness and complexity of nature are not possible without a technical element.

> Nature acts technically when the carnivorous plant, comparable to the jaws of an excavating machine, close itself at the slightest presence of an insect, when the eye is a model for a photographic camera, when a bird is the model for an airplane, and when a dolphin is the model for a submarine. Nature cannot bring any new gestalt into existence without the use of new kinds of cunning, new kinds of technical element (Ibid.).

In nature, based on the wholeness of the *gestalt* perspective towards the organism, the means and the ends are barely distinguishable, being closely mixed into each other within their numerous life forms. Means and ends are not separated

3 Ian G. Barbour, in his Gifford Lectures, (1990) pointed out that neither pessimism nor optimism is fruitful for disclosing the essence of technology. Similar to Tillich, Ian Barbour asserted that technology cannot be described as either beautiful or ugly but is always in an ambiguity situation. He emphasized that the purpose and the function of technology are socially orientated, and should be redirected towards the realization of our humanity and environmental values. See (Barbour 1993: 3 – 25).

and integrated into biological and psychological functioning within organic life forms. The purpose is not external to the organism, but its end is life-creation itself. In a manuscript, entitled "*Religion und Technik*"(1929), Tillich emphasized that the living forms of all organisms are technically based; therefore we can find an analogy between "*natürlichen Formen*" and "*technischen Formen*" (Tillich 1929: 248). The dichotomy between the means and the ends does not exist; both are mutually indwelling within each other (Tillich 1927: 52). The techno-nature is a complicated concept in which technology is embodied within the organic *gestalt* instead of the creative input and production of the human spirit.

Second, when the spirit comes in, the picture changes. "It is different with the Spirit: it separates what belongs together in the living process. It determines the end and it seeks out the means. And when the end is achieved, then the means become insignificant" (Tillich 1927: 52). Therefore, the spirit will "create" object, which has no internal meaning other than that of the purpose for which they were created. Two types of technology are mentioned: "developmental technology" (*die entfaltende Technik*) and "actualizing technology". Both types essentially manifest a form of transformation power (Tillich 1929: 248, 1927: 53). The developmental technology manifesting the spirit enters into the living *gestalt* in order to protect it from destruction, to preserve it, and above all, to develop it. Tillich asserted that the goal of developmental technology is for cultivation, nourishment and healing. Therefore, we can say that it is not merely a technology, but is more than that. The spirit tries to sustain, nourish and develop the potential of all living forms, but through enlisting the means towards the ends. Likewise, the actualizing technology manifesting the spirit creates a new possibility of existence. It is not merely creating a new mode of communication and connection, but "an objectification of the spirit that itself becomes transformed through those objectifications" (Tillich 1927: 53). The new art form, culture form and scientific form belong to this category.

Third, the remarkable significance and impact in the modern world is "transforming technology" (*die umgestaltende Technik*) (Tillich 1929: 248). In contrast with the above numerous articulations on "technology", the main characteristic of transforming technology is its modality of purposive structure in which its technical existence is grounded. Its creativity is transformative and destructive in nature. The purpose that this technology serves is external to the material it uses. For Tillich, this transforming technology is constituted as divine substance in which unconditioned elements are manifested. Unconditional purposiveness results in unconditional rationality (Tillich 1927: 54).

> The complete purposiveness of the whole and of the parts as they relate to one another; the exclusion of everything superfluous, the pressing on to a complete, inner necessary; the

> thorough engineering that constitutes the glory and ideal of technology, which gives the technical gestalt its inner beauty, as the overcoming of chance and arbitrariness in a personality is reflected in the spiritual beauty of that person's face" (Tillich 1927: 54).

Transforming technology is a divine-sublime apparatus, which is self-sufficient and self-contained. No surprise, ambiguity, or accident can happen. It manifests a special and structural beauty and divine glory, which is disclosed in its inner necessities and perfection mechanism. It is clear that the inner rationality imposed by the spirit fully demonstrates the objectification of this technical *gestalt*.

In a section of Tillich's 1927 essay, "Systematics of Technology", Tillich mentioned the flux and instability of a systematics of technology. However, technical *gestalt* is a further development of human organs (Tillich 1927: 55). It is expressed in the using of a tool or a machine. The former has grown organically together with human beings and this gives production with tools the character of a vital expression. However, the machine is a particular technical *gestalt*. Tillich mentioned that a machine is attended and operated but not used by hand. Its distinctive and impressive character lies in its individuality, which has an uncanny and demonic effect (Ibid.: 56). Likewise, Tillich correlated this type of technology with a cultural and religious substance. The individuality of the technology determines its structure and essence, and is independent in nature. It symbolizes the unlimited possibility. "This unlimited character of the machine and its being a particular gestalt is the reason for its revolutionary significance for society" (Ibid.). Because the unlimited possibility is a temptation, possibility and temptation coincide.

Last, Tillich emphasized that technology is a symbol of de-demonization (Ibid.: 60). It plays a religious role in liberating the human being from demonized nature, to free human beings from the wild and numerous limitations. Also, technology constitutes and promises an eschatological hope in which space and time are integrated and the idea of one community is possible. However, this religious function is actualized through the domination of nature and human beings. However, for Tillich, the substance of technology is empty in a sense that it is paradoxically unable to provide the meaning and value of life in its fullness of life. It is divine in a sense that it promises us an unlimited future and encourages us moving forward towards a better world, utopia. Therefore, for Tillich, technology is godlike because it is creative and liberating, but it is also demonic because it is enslaving and destructive. In summary, it is ambiguous and should be redeemed.

In Tillich's early manuscript on systematic theology (1913), the question of technology is articulated with the problem of religion and theology. It seems that the validity of technology, articulated as a kind of cultural creation (*sachli-*

che Kulturarbeit), should be justified (*rechtfertigt*) under the theological principle. It points to the value of technology in the serving of the Kingdom of God, and brings the Kingdom of God to its fulfillment (*vollendete Gottesreich*) (Tillich 1913: 415). Tillich asserted that, first, technology is a manifestation of the human spirit's victory over nature (*der Herrschaft des Geistes über die Natur*). This victory should be understood as the revelation of the human spirit and its freedom, which is analogous to God's creation. Materialistic creations in human realms are totally different from natural creations. It is a kind of "miracle" (*Wunder*) (Ibid.: 417). Second, the fulfillment of the Kingdom of God depends on technology. Tillich emphasized that temporality and spatiality are united in technology in serving to build a unified human community. This unity (*Einheit*) is constituted by "technical creation" (*die Schöpfung*) (Tillich 1929d: 251), and is the stable foundation (*die ständige Basis*) of historical contingency. For early Tillich, technology is positive in evaluation in that it closely connects with moral and religious activities (Tillich 1913: 417). It seems to him that, echoing Karl Marx's notion of dialectical materialism, the lower level of the society, materialistic creation, is the necessary base for the upper level of the society, idealistic creations.

However, Tillich also strongly expressed his worries about the problem of technology in his early period. The above understanding of technology connecting with theological principles is merely justified as its "ontological character" (*der Seins-Charakter*) for its "existential character" (*der Existenz-Charakter*) is destructive in nature (Tillich 1929c: 248). The mixture of its ontological and existential elements is manifested as its character of ambiguity which symbolizes the paradoxical existential situation of the enslavement of human beings in a human spirit of mastery in a new modality (Ibid.). Second, technology can bring the fulfillment of the Kingdom of God, but it also bounds all finite human beings universally in pursuing unlimited possibilities. Tillich called this situation the "paradox" (Tillich 1913: 416).[4] In an early manuscript, "*Religion und Technik*"(1929), Tillich clearly pointed out that the essence of technology is a kind of "dialectical character" (*der dialektische Charakter*) in which the mixture of godlike and demonic (*Göttlich-dämonisch*) characteristics is manifested (Tillich 1929c: 249). The "unlimitedness" (*Unendlichkeit*) and "eschaton" (*Eschaton*) blur in the construction of technology (Tillich 1929d: 251). Technology is no longer a machine external and objective for humans to operate; it is an eschatolog-

4 Uwe Carsten Scharf asserted that the early Tillich was a technology enthusiast; he started to be aware of the destructive side of technology in his later years. This is a one-sided view and has a lack of documental support. For this view, see (Scharf 1999: 58 – 59).

ical potential utopia to be anticipated and actualized. In technology, the transcendence reference is lost at the cost of human Babel-like association (Ibid.). For Tillich, technology is full of ambiguity and needs to be redeemed (*Erlösung*) under the God's "yes" and "no" (Tillich 1929c: 249; 1913: 417).

For Tillich, the meaning of technical creation is twofold. One is to conceive the "*Sachgehalt*" of it through the external-empirical analysis. We can question technology, what purpose it serves and what means it uses. Technology, under this consideration, manifests itself as a "thing", the validity of which can be objectively and empirically verified. In this sense, all technical productions are regarded as something "neutral" and having an "external" matrix for us to manipulate and control in a right or wrong way. However, Tillich reminded that the above analysis will veil the truth, even if it is not totally misconceived. The authentic nature of technology does not lie in this aspect, but merely discloses itself as "symbol" in which its truth is always unveiled within the texture of human beings, historicity and ultimate concern. Technology is not merely "technology" in a sense of the application of scientific analysis in the production of certain anthropological means. Therefore, we will miss the being of technology if we only understand the nature of technology through anthropological and instrumental perspectives. In contrast, the innermost structure and essence of technology can only be conceived in the ontological analysis of technology (Tillich 1928: 179). Under the analysis of "symbol-substance", technology paradoxically symbolizes the divine character of overcoming human estrangement, but, simultaneously, it creates a new "feeling of uncanny" ("*Unheimlichen*") in developing another type of internal estrangement. The German term, "*Unheimlichen*", denotes the modality of "no-home". For Tillich, this condition is feeling "not homelike, not familiar, foreign and threatening" which is our situation as such, even if there are *no* particular threats and feelings of uncanniness present (Ibid.). This means that it is not a concrete object constituting this feeling; rather it is a type of Heideggarian "understanding of being" (*Seinsverständnis*).

> If we interpret Dasein's uncanniness from an existential-ontological point of view as a threat which reaches Dasein itself and which comes from Dasein itself, we are not content that in factical anxiety too it has always been understood in this sense. When Dasein "understands" uncanniness in the everyday manner, it does so by turning away from it in falling; in this turning-away, the "not-at-home" gets "dimmed down". Yet the everydayness of this fleeing shows phenomenally that anxiety, as a basic state-of-mind, belongs to Dasein's essential state of Being-in-the-world, which, as one that is existential, is never present-at-hand but is itself always in a mode of factical being-there (Heidegger 1925: 234).

Following Heidegger, Tillich described this human uncanniness feeling as not threatening from something coming from outside, but as there being no partic-

ular object to threaten us. For the human being, as "being in the world" (*in-der-Welt-Seins*), s/he tries the best to escape from such uncanniness, and make her/himself at home in existence (Tillich 1928: 180). Technology plays this role and manifests its power to help human beings to escape the ontological uncanniness and let them feel at home in existence. Therefore, the problem of technology is fundamentally not on the level of technic but ontologically related to the level of being. "The history of science is also a history over uncanniness. This victory only comes to its fulfillment, however, in technology" (Ibid.: 181). Under the perfect domination of the situation, "uncertainty" is no more a possibility. The uncanniness of the earth becomes a home for humanity. In summary, technology dominates all beings and lets all beings come home (Ibid.: 182).

However, it is a technological myth in which a new, original, special type of uncanniness is produced through de-demonizing of the world. This new existential uncanniness produces a second nature for human beings by which a new alienation between human beings and nature occurs.

> The soil, the bond with the living earth, is taken away. Hewn or artificial stone separates us from it. Reinforced concrete buildings separate us more than loam, wood, and bricks from the cosmic flow. Water is in pipes, fire is confined to wires. Animals are excluded or else they are deprived of their vital powers. In the technical context, trees and plants are arranged to serve the rational objective of "relaxation" (Ibid.: 183).

Technology brings us "certainty" and "conformability" but transforms the world to be strangers and lifeless. Tillich emphasized that, even if technology embodies the power to liberate the human being from the world, this power is ungrounded and empty (Tillich 1927: 60). It cuts off the living connection of all living forms and dominates all life forms through pursuing a technological utopia (Ibid.). The structure of technology is technical-purposefulness in nature; it embraces all the beings into a huge purposefulness, resulting in the internal necessity. This type of necessity is a kind of beauty (Ibid.: 54). It is interesting that, for Tillich, the internality of technology is full of "pure creative will" which is organically linked with the economic and political impulse in realizing its whole form. Therefore, technical science, political systems and economic production are Trinitarian in nature (Ibid.: 58).

Tillich had reservations about the pessimism of the Frankfurt School's attitude towards the Enlightenment project in general and technology in particular. The condemnation of the destructive side of technology is one-sided; for Tillich, it is basically a human autonomous cultural creation and embodies the liberating power for overcoming estrangement. The nature of technology is ambiguity full of creative and destructive forces.

5.3 Rational-Cultural Ambiguity of Technology

For later Tillich, there is no change in his discussion of technology; the ambiguity of technology and the demand for redemption remained as his main concern. However, the whole discussion shifted into the ambiguity of rationality, and how the destructive character and domination over nature are clearly demonstrated. Through the disclosure of the independent and unique inner structure of technology, the purposive rational structure, as Tillich called it, the essence of technology is posited. The ambiguity of technology is unveiled through the discussion of *logos* and its structure.

The concept, reason, *logos*, is never merely a kind of reasoning or calculative rationality. Tillich preferred "ontological reason" in articulating the ontological formation of *logos* (Tillich 1951: 172). This ontological articulation is predominant in the classical tradition from Parmenides to Hegel; "reason is the structure of the mind which enables the mind to grasp and to transform reality. It is effective in the cognitive, aesthetic, practical, and technical functions of the human mind" (Tillich 1951: 72). Also, for Tillich, ontological reason is not the anti-thesis with human emotion, passion, desire and love, etc. The destruction of reason is identified with the destruction of the human being. In the depths of ontological reason, no dichotomy is found. "It is cognitive and aesthetic, theoretical and practical, detached and passionate, subjective and objective" (Ibid.).

Reason embraces a cognitive structure, which is not merely functioning in a human's mind, but operates in the whole universe. Following the ancient Greek tradition, Tillich employed the concept of "*logos*" to differentiate human subjective employment and the objective, worldly employment (Tillich 1951: 72, 75). Both constitute an epistemological correlation of "the *logos* structure of the grasping-and-shaping-self and the *logos* structure of the grasped-and-shaped world" (Ibid.: 75). Epistemological possibility and reality are grounded in an epistemological ontology. The human self and the world share the same and united *logos*, rational structure. This ontological rational structure is simultaneously the basic and fundamental ontological structure of self-world (Tillich 1951: 76, 168). Through grasping and shaping, the human mind encounters the objective world in order to transcend the surrounding environment and establish the cultural world. The objective world is simultaneously transformed by the human subjective *logos*.

> The description of "grasping" and "shaping" in this definition is based on the fact that subjective reason always is actualized in an individual self which is related to its environment and to its world in terms of reception and reaction ... In receiving reasonably, the mind grasps its world; in reacting reasonably, the mind shapes its world. "Grasping" in this con-

> text, has the connotation of penetrating into the depth, into the essential nature of a thing or an event, of understanding and expressing it. "Shaping" in this context, has the connotation of transforming a given material into a *Gestalt*, a living structure which has the power of being (Tillich 1951: 76).

For Tillich, knowing is always bound with its ontological understanding which presupposes the ontological and ontic relationship between the knower and the known. "Grasping-shaping" entails and assumes the ontological structure and it is not merely a description of knowing action. Tillich is expressing the ontological structure of knowledge (Ibid.: 94).

As Tillich emphasized, the understanding of knowing is a part of the ontology. It means "knowing" itself is an event within the totality of events (Ibid.: 71). Therefore, epistemology is a part of ontology; reason is a part of being. The ontological boundary always limits and structures the periphery of the knowing action and its knowing structure. If the ontological reason is the essential articulation of the being of reason, reason is seeking for the form of union (Tillich 1951:94). Union presupposes separation. Knowledge itself presupposes distance and detachment, but the goal of knowledge is to seek for union. The essential union is the ontological ground of epistemological agents. Epistemological union is the union of the separated, stranger and alien. However, they are not wholly alien to the knower. Every act of knowledge tries to overcome the gap. Following Plato's *eros* can drive us toward reunion of the separated. Therefore, knowledge as a unifying and participatory knowledge is always functioning in transformation and healing (Ibid.: 85).

Technical reason is merely one function among others. Its validity is grounded in "reasoning" and determines the means while accepting the ends from "somewhere else" (Ibid.: 73). For Tillich, when technical reason is the companion of ontological reason and the "reasoning" function is used to fulfill the demands of reason, technical reasoning is important and required. However, the problem is the corruption of technical reason, if "it is not continually nourished by ontological reason" (Ibid.: 73). First, technical reasoning produces a "means-ends structure"; it will dehumanize human beings and result in thingification of the thing. Second, when technical reasoning dominates the whole process of reasoning, controlling knowledge will be produced.

The structure of rationalization is the remarkable feature of technical reason, which is manifested as the structure of a "means-ends" relationship with the method of calculating and measurement. This one-dimensional understanding of rationality reduces the richness and complexity of rationality into something observable and calculable (Tillich 1961: 79). In an essay, "The Person in a Technical Society" (1953), Tillich mentioned Kierkegaard, Karl Marx and Nietzsche as

prophetic critics of the technical society (Tillich 1953: 124–127), pointing to "depersonalization" (Ibid.: 133). For Tillich:

> Man is all this because of the basic structure of being that is complete in him; he has a centered self in correlation with a structured world ... In all of them the result is depersonalization, for the person is a centered whole to which all his functions are subjected. As soon as one function is separated from the others and put into the control over the whole, the person is subjected to this function and through it to something that is not itself (Ibid.:133).

Under the power of technical rationality, everything becomes a function or the functional matrix becomes the dominant structure. Technology embodies a kind of transformative power to reduce everything to "means" only. Meaning and personality are conditioned by its transformative power as a tool to serve other ends. For Tillich, a human being is not a *homo faber* who is able to speak because of having universals but is a social human with I-Thou relations, a theoretical human because of the ability to ask and to receive answers, a moral human because of being able to make responsible decisions, and a religious person because of having awareness of, and belonging to, both finitude and the infinite. (Ibid.: 132–133)

However, we should bear in mind that the analysis of technical reason refutes the dichotomy between ontological reason and technical reason but emphasizes that both types of reason are essential in unity. The "ontological concept of reason always is accompanied and sometimes replaced by the technical concept of reason" (Tillich 1951: 72). Also, when Tillich warned us that the ultimate concern of technical reason is the means instead of the ends, he added that "there is no danger in this situation [reason in the technical sense determines the means] as long as technical reason is the companion of ontological reason and 'reasoning' is used to fulfill the demands of reason" (Ibid.: 73). Also, Tillich added, "technical reason, however refined in logical and methodological respects, dehumanizes man if it is separated from ontological reason. And, beyond this, technical reason itself is impoverished and corrupted if it is not continually nourished by ontological reason" (Ibid.).

It is obvious that Tillich is neither a naïve pessimist nor an optimist about technology. The nature of technology is ambiguous, for Tillich. The structure of purposefulness in technology is not necessarily destructive and depersonalized; it is adequate and meaningful only as an expression of ontological reason and as its companion (Ibid.). However, the result is destructive if technical reason works alone, or technical reason elevates itself as the reason itself. For Tillich, the destructive consequences and the slavery conditions are not directly and naturally produced by technical reason itself, but all the outcomes are created by the detachment of ontological reason. Based on the separation between ontolog-

ical and technical reason, the latter bypasses its own limit and then ambiguity is created.

Also, the disaster created by technology is its "controlling knowledge" (*Herrschaftswissen*) (Tillich 1955a: 69),[5] in which the ontological modality of separation is external to the ontological union of separation and participation (Ibid.:70). For Tillich, epistemology embodies a dialectical process of separation and union. However, controlling epistemology dominates the condition of detachment under which the knower and the known are both subjected into an estranged detached framework (Tillich 1951: 97). The communicative equality between both subjects changes into an unbalanced mode in which the subjectivity of the subject is elevated and the objectification of the object becomes "thingification". Tillich emphasized that the "elements of subjectivity" and "self-relatedness" inherent in all beings will be distorted and destroyed. Knowledge presupposes the element of separation and union, the outcome of "objectification and thingification is caused by the lack of union. In other words, the technical rationality manifests its transformative power to erase the correlation connection of all beings and reduce all subjectivities into a "thing".

In his *Systematic Theology* volume three, Tillich located the problem of technology as an item of human spiritual self-creation; this was developed first in his earlier manuscript on systematic theology of 1913 (Tillich 1913: 416 – 417). In 1963, Tillich tried to articulate the theology of technical culture under his systematic theological project in which human language and technology are characteristic of two major human spiritual self-creations (Tillich 1963: 57), both of which are ambiguous. The main content of this ambiguity is the replacement of the external purposes created in technical production by the internal *telos* of all organic and inorganic processes. This externality of technical purposefulness transforms all internal ends as being means only (Tillich 1963: 61). Due to the ambiguity of the determination of the ends, technical rationality uses its power on the determination of means, and creates the means without ends. Two outcomes occur. One is the emptiness of the means in the technical world; another is the introduction of external heteronomous authorities to determine which ends we should adopt.

Technical ambiguity manifests in three types: freedom and limitation, means and ends, self and thing (Tillich 1963: 61). First, technical creation discloses the unlimited capacity of human freedom which is exactly the essential nature of the human being in transcending the environment to which s/he belongs. However, simultaneously, technology seduces a forgetfulness about the ontolog-

5 The term, *Herrschaftswissen*, comes from Max Scheler.

ical boundary. "It [Technology] opens up a road along which no limit can be seen, but it does so through a limited, finite being" (Ibid.: 73). The paradoxical implication of this ambiguity is the limit of the unlimited, which points to the fundamental ambiguity of finite freedom. This is both the dignity and the tragedy of human beings (Ibid.). Second, technical rationality is powerless in determining the meaning of its own creation. It seems that progress is the ultimate goal for the development of technology, but progress itself is empty in a sense that it creates numerous economic products through economic production. It creates an ideology that a technical society is a needs-satisfaction society in which human need and human desires are actually mixed (Ibid.: 74). The forgetfulness of the meaning of unlimited technical production seduces humans to believe that this is the expression of the human self-creation of life; but it is basically a series of meaningless production exercises. Last, what Tillich calls a "genuine ambiguity" (Ibid.), the thingification of technical rationality manifests its transformative power. "A technical product, in contrast to a natural object, is a 'thing'. There are no 'things' in nature, that is, no objects, which are nothing, but objects, which have no element of subjectivity. But objects that are produced by the technical act *are* things" (Ibid.). This transformation is double-edged. Through technical production, natural beings are transformed into "things" in which the natural relationship and structures are destroyed, and human beings are also transformed into "things" among things. As a result, the whole human society and the natural world would become a world of things. Tillich emphasized "the liberation given to man by technical possibilities turns into enslavement to technical actuality. This is a genuine ambiguity in the self-creation of life, and it cannot be overcome by a romantic, that is, pre-technical, return to the so-called natural" (Ibid.).

Tillich distinguished two types of "object" in which the "logical object" is assumed in all epistemological rationality, but the "existential object" is constituted under a particular framework (Tillich 1958: 113). The former is normally posited in a subject-object epistemological framework, but the latter is absorbed into a process of "objectification" through which the subjective elements of all beings are erased. Tillich emphasized that the former is "*objectum, Gegenstand*", meaning that something stands against you. The latter is a "thing" (*Ding*) (Tillich 1951: 173). All beings resist objectification that results from producing a thing. Tillich asserted that even a tool itself is not a thing. No thing is merely a thing (Tillich 1951: 173). In an ontological polar understanding, Tillich pointed out that the individualization elements constitute all beings as the subjective center which is never neglected (Tillich 1958: 114). However, technology transforms all beings into a "thing" (Tillich 1963: 74), and it is shared with all beings in the condition of ambiguity in the quest for salvation.

5.4 Theonomous Reorientation of Technology

5.4.1 The Existential Roots

Technology, as one of the human spiritual creations, shares the destiny of cultural ambiguity, meaning that its nature is a mixture of essential and existential beings. Before the discussion of Tillich's "theological answer" for the technical quest for salvation under his theology of technical culture, it is important to examine the existential content of the technical ambiguity. It is the roots of the demonic and slavery character of technical rationality.

First, under the existential condition, the rational polarity of beings constitutes a contradiction and they move against each other. Technical rationality can fall into the contradiction of autonomous and heteronomous rationality due to the lack of concern for the depth of reason (Tillich 1951: 83). On one hand, technical rationality "affirms and actualizes its structure without regarding its depth" (Ibid.: 83); it leads to the condition of being autonomous in which technology is obedient to nothing but its own structural laws, and tries to keep itself from any resistance. Also, technical heteronomy manifests itself as institutional power to deny any individual subjective reaction. For this double existential dichotomy between technical autonomy and heteronomy, Tillich mentioned that, under technical reason, "autonomy conquered all reactions but completely lost the dimension of depth. It became shallow, empty, without ultimate meaning, and produced conscious and unconscious despair. In this situation, powerful heteronomy of a quasi-political character entered the vacuum created by an autonomy which lacked the dimension of depth" (Ibid.: 86). Autonomy is empty and heteronomy is destructive. The existential condition of technology is first expressed as an "emptied destruction" or "destructive emptiness".

Second, the formal element and the emotional element within the structure of rationality create conflicts under the condition of existence. Technical rationality expressed as controlling knowledge to dominate all patterns of knowledge, will result in a rational formalism and "intellectualism" (Ibid.: 90). Under the existence condition, technology adopts detached attitudes towards all beings and reduces the richness and complexity of all dimensions of the beings into one particular dimension. The existential condition of technology is secondly expressed as "formalism without *eros*" (Ibid.).

Third, the existential condition of technology is closely connected with the human existential condition. For Tillich, the "fall" of technology manifests as a technological *hubris*, which is self-elevation into the sphere of the divine (Tillich 1957: 50). Technical science is regarded as the contemporary human great creation, which plays a religious role in overcoming human estrangement from the

world. However, this technological salvation myth drives itself towards the temptation of *hubris*. Tillich mentioned that Hegel had committed himself into a kind of metaphysical *hubris* when his system is intended to contain all possible truths (Ibid.: 51). Likewise, technology is Godlike in ignoring its own finitude in which cultural creativity and divine creativity are confused. Self-elevation is an idolatrous act through which the finite is regarded as infinite, preliminary concern is regarded as ultimate concern.

Also, the existential condition of technology can be expressed as "*concupiscentia*". It means the unlimited desire to draw the whole reality into one's self (Ibid.: 52.) Tillich pointed out that one of the human estrangements is not merely to destroy something, but is the intention to unite all things into one's self. This unlimited desire for union is the adequate expression of technological desire in which material, spiritual, cultural and religious dimensions are "united" under the scientific-technical matrix. Technological desire is "the desire cognitively to draw the universe into one's self and one's finite particularity" (Ibid.: 53).

Finally, under the existential condition of technological estrangement, human beings and nature both suffer from the meaningless condition, which occurs in the fundamental ontological self-world structure. For human beings, the world they face is no longer a meaningful one, but an alien world which is destructive and emptied. Tillich emphasized that the world under the domination of technology faces the "structure of destruction" (Ibid.: 60) in which Tillich laments

> It [The world] ceases to be a world, in the sense of a meaningful whole. Things no longer speak to man; they lose their power to enter into a meaningful encounter with man, because man himself has lost this power. In extreme cases the complete unreality of one's world is felt; nothing is left except the awareness of one's own empty self (Ibid.: 61).

Human beings and nature are suffering from "falling to pieces". This universal estrangement is not merely a doctrine of universal human estrangement but it applies to the basic condition of human society under the domination of technological rationality.

5.4.2 Theonomous Culture

Tillich's solution to technological ambiguity is characterized as theonomous culture, which is generated by the Holy Spirit. Technical creation as the self-creation of life under the impact of the human spirit should be determined and directed by the Spirit instead of breaking and destroying it. "Theonomy" implies the

"law" functioning under the dimension of the Spirit towards the ultimate *telos*, the unity of being and meaning (Tillich 1963: 249). This "law" generated by the Holy Spirit does not indicate the subjection of autonomous rationality to heteronomous religious laws. The basic aim of theonomous culture is to "[turn] the humanistic indefiniteness about the 'where-to' into a direction which transcends every particular human aim" (Ibid.: 250). Although the content of theonomous human creation is profoundly dynamic and eschatological, Tillich mentioned some points to follow.

First, theonomy manifests as ultimacy within the concrete historical condition. Following the basic motto of Tillich's theology of culture, ultimate concern and cultural creation are articulated as a "substance-form" matrix. No religious power and meaning can be found without a concrete cultural-historical bearer. "The first quality of a theonomous culture is that it communicates the experiences of holiness, of something ultimate in being and meaning, in all its creations" (Ibid.: 251). Religious elements are immanent in cultural creations, which point to something ultimate. The "symbol" character of theonomy could not be empirically fixed within a particular context. Human creativity and autonomous rationality should not be terminated in order to achieve the Spirit-directed culture, but both cannot achieve it directly.

Second, theonomy manifests ultimacy through permanent and dynamic struggle. No historical situation can have the claim to be the situation of theonomy. Theonomous manifestation is always fragmentary. For Tillich, this idea is inevitably eschatological. "Theonomy is prior to both [autonomy and heteronomy] ... at the same time, is posterior to both" (Ibid.: 251). The goal of theonomous culture is not to balance extreme autonomous rationality and a radical heteronomous matrix, but rather, to try to attack the extremes of both, and implement the depth, unity and ultimate meaning of both. In that sense, theonomy actualizes itself as a critical demand of human creations. "The permanent struggle between autonomous independence and heteronomous reaction leads to the quest for a new theonomy" (Ibid.).

Third, theonomy manifests divine power and meaning in overcoming the cleavage of subject and object. For Tillich, the ambiguous condition of human cultural creation is largely expressed as the cleavage between subjectivity and objectivity. The way of overcoming this is twofold. One is transcendent unity. Pneumatological theonomy provides the power to unite the separate and overcome the cleavage. Another is the depth of cultural creation. Pneumatological presence empowers ordinary entities in order to equip them as the bearer of the Holy. Therefore, the Word of God is not something external to human words, but is the Spirit-determined human words (Ibid.: 254). These two elements are closely linked together. The transcendent unity between different par-

ties can be achieved only in the impact of the religious depth of their cultural creations. The estrangement between communities can be overcome only in the divine presence in human creations.

5.4.3 Kingdom of God and Technological Utopia

In Tillich's early manuscript on systematic theology (1913), Tillich correlated "*Technik*" and "*Reich Gottes*".

> The dialectical dilemma of a material culture is the subjugation of the spirit under the world through rulership over the world. The theological principle justifies material, cultural work (technology) by viewing the revelation of God in it, by putting it [technology] into the service of the kingdom of God, and by recognizing its eternal significance in the completed kingdom of God (Tillich 1913: 416).

Tillich emphasized, in this early theological consideration, that the problem of technology should be understood as a dialectical problem. It means, as a human spirit creation, technology embodies the positive value in itself; but theology should not leave it alone by adopting an attitude of negating culture. Analogous with the dialectical character of "yes" and "no" for technological creation and destruction, theology should adopt an analogical dialectical attitude towards technology through a Trinitarian theological principle. For the first theological principle as a doctrine of creation, technology manifests "a revelation of the domination of spirit over nature" (Ibid.: 417). It manifests the liberating power of the human spirit but, simultaneously, it is the deepest bondage of the spirit. Therefore, theology should confirm the contribution of technology but, at the same time, it should come to the judgment as an action of redeeming technology. For the second theological principle as a doctrine of the *Logos*, the estrangement of technology is indicated and overcome by salvation. Last, in the third theological principle as God as spirit, technology is dialectically confirmed and rejected under the manifestation and condemnation of Spiritual Presence and the Kingdom of God (Ibid.: 417).

Although the above theological response to the problem of technology is far from clear and substantial enough, the ambiguous character of technology is located within the theology of culture through which the dialectical "yes" and 'no" of theological redemption is expressed. Compared with his early dialectical approach towards the creative and destructive dimensions of technology, Tillich, in his later period, focused on the eschatological ambiguity of technological futures, and how the question of technology could be closely connected with the historical progress of humankind. It seems that it would be justified for Till-

ich to correlate technological utopia with the doctrine of the kingdom of God; human history with eschatology. In his German period, Tillich tended to consider the historical problem through a Christological interpretation of the kingdom of God, which is substantially different with his pneumatological approach in the later period.

For Tillich, history is not only one of his theological concerns but the central problem of his thought, especially after his return from World War I (Tillich 1948a: xvii). In his early period, he struggled with the Christian supernatural message and secular revolutionary movements in particular, and the transcendent and immanent interpretations of history in general. In participating in religious socialism, the *Kairos* circle, Tillich tried to provide an accurate interpretation of history in which conservatism and utopianism are transcended and reinterpreted under the Protestant concept of *Kairos* (Ibid.: xx).

The concept, *Kairos*, is closely connected with the demands derived from the philosophy of history. Basically, Tillich critiqued two main types of the interpretation of history. The absolute type emphasizes the absolute tension within historical consciousness; but it tends to place one particular historical situation as more important than others (Tillich 1922: 42). The relative type demands a universal historical consciousness; however, it transforms itself into an endless repetition of relativities (Ibid.: 42). For Tillich, these two demands should be fulfilled and abandoned simultaneously. Because the former one regards that the absolute breaks into finite time without becoming identical with any finite reality. It always remains in its transcendence. But, for the latter, the transcendence elements are lacking and the progress of history becomes the security of the status quo. For Tillich, the transcendence and immanence of history constitute a paradoxical interpretation of time, and point to the idea of *Kairos*.

Kairos is regarded as "the conditioned surrenders itself to become a vehicle for the unconditioned" (Ibid.: 42). It is clear that, in his essay "Kairos" (1922), Tillich strongly stated his criticism of the supernatural theology of history which represents a pure type of escapism. Under this supernatural interpretation, history and time can be resolved into divine eternal time and this will annihilate the importance of the historical moment. In order to maintain the reality of historical time and the breakthrough power of the unconditional, Tillich adapted the triple structure of "autonomy – heteronomy – theonomy" to understand the relationship of *Kairos* and historical time. For him, the historical time process is a dynamic and creative power through its dialectical movement through which historical autonomy is actualized; it strongly rejects the status quo represented by the heteronomous interpretation of history. *Kairos* represents the theonomous breakthrough into concrete historical time, and it cannot be regarded as a synthesis stage of the dialectical relation between autonomy and

heteronomy. Rather, theonomy as a *Kairos* is to maintain the absolute tension, and the concrete situations are united. Kairotic affirmation of a given situation is the presupposition of theonomy. It is a moment of historical time in which the ultimate is transparent in the finite forms of temporality. The historical process is open to the unconditional without claiming to be unconditional itself.

Therefore, in his early framework, theology of history is interpreted under the theonomous theology of culture. Temporality is the form of *Kairos*, and *Kairos* is the "substance" (*Gehalt*) of temporality. Tillich emphasized that neither *Kairos* nor temporality can be interpreted as two parallel timelines in which no interaction occurs; *Kairos* cannot replace temporality. The structure of historical time is not destroyed and must be assumed. The ultimate substance (*Gehalt*) manifests the power as critical and assumes dialectical attitudes towards the historical finite situation. Based on the reservation of temporality, historical fate and destiny are affirmed by faith and decision. Theonomy emphasizes that the ultimate is encountered in the dimension of depth of the temporal situation. The eternal appears in temporal and historical forms.

This kairological thinking is dangerous in a sense that, in Tillich's later reflection, the relationship between conditioned history and the unconditioned ultimate is either an openness of the conditioned to the dynamic presence of the unconditioned or a seclusion of the conditioned within itself (Tillich 1922: 43). That means, *Kairos* would be expressed in religious or secular symbols as the expectation of the kingdom of God. This reflects the awareness of the misuse of the *Kairos* idea by Emanuel Hirsch to justify the rising power of the Nazi party and it pushed Tillich to clarify his thoughts. It is clear that from early Tillich's justification by grace through faith to his later Protestant principle, *Kairos* thought is closely linked to self-criticism categories in order to avoid the self-elevation of finite form. Christology bears this unique *kairos* role to judge all *kairos* claims in history.

For early Tillich, *kairos* is related to Christian eschatology, which "is the theoretical expression of the Christian belief that in every historical event in the past and future there is a relationship to an ultimate fulfillment, which lends meaning to relative and conditioned fulfillment" (Tillich 1927a: 278). The moment of time, *eschaton*, is nothing about the "last" event in history but is the fulfillment, fully actualized in history (Ibid.: 276). Tillich had no interests in the end of time, but concentrated on the fulfillment of time. This historical fulfillment is transcendence in a sense that the overcoming of the ambiguity of history is not merely interpreted as the last event of history but as the discontinuance of time. For Tillich, the Unconditioned breaks through history and brings time into fulfillment through interrupting the continuity of time. This interrupting is negative and destructive, but determinative. *Kairos*, manifesting the Unconditioned inter-

rupts the finitude of time and transforms it into the Eternal which is what the religious symbol, the kingdom of God means (Ibid.: 280).

Likewise, in his early articulation, Tillich's understanding of the kingdom of God is Christological. In his "*Christologie und Geschichtsdeutung*" (1930), Tillich asserted that history and the Christ are correlated. Christology is a doctrine for discussing the absolute concreteness manifesting Him in history, and that the meaning of history is determined by this Christological event (Tillich 1930: 243), in which historical beginning and the end are irrelevant; rather, this event constitutes the meaning and the center of history (Ibid.: 249). Therefore, it is clear that, in Tillich's early consideration, Christology, *Kairos* theology and the kingdom of God are the "three-in-one" solution of the historical problem. All these symbols manifest the dynamic breakthrough of the Unconditioned in history in a paradoxical way.

However, in volume three of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich located the discussion of the kingdom of God within the context of pneumatology instead of Christology. Tillich emphasized that, in correlating the ambiguity of life in general and its historical dimension in particular, the kingdom of God, Spiritual Presence and Eternal Life are three symbols interrelated with each other. Also, the symbol of the Kingdom of God is more embracing than the other two because inter- and trans-historical dimensions are concerned. The former, interhistorical dimension of the Kingdom of God, manifests the pneumatological presence within history through the Kingdom of God symbol; the latter, transhistorical dimension of the Kingdom of God, manifests the ultimate answer to the ambiguity of history through the symbol Eternal Life.

Tillich's later pneumatological eschatology replaced the early Christological employment in the following ways. First, the early Christological breakthrough within history represents the internal divine manifestation in history. However, there are two difficulties that Tillich faced. First, Christology lacks transcendence elements in the interpretation of history. Second, in his volume three of *Systematic Theology*, when Tillich discussed "the central manifestation of the Kingdom of God in History" (Tillich 1963: 364), his inquiry is to where the beginning and the end of Jesus Christ as the center of history are (Ibid.: 366). This question was never asked by Tillich in his early period, because, for Tillich, the beginning and the end of the center of history are identified with the beginning and the end of the manifestation of the kingdom of God in history (Ibid.). If, as Tillich emphasized, the beginning and the end of history should never be counted quantitatively, and the manifestation of the kingdom of God is the history of God's revelation and redemptive history, the universal dimension of the interpretation of the kingdom of God is demanded. This is the reason why Tillich reminded us that there would be other centers in history. Last, Tillich intended to articulate

a universal and cosmic vision of his theology of culture in volume three of his *Systematic Theology*. Therefore, he employed two religious symbols, Spiritual Presence and the kingdom of God, which both constitute the embracing character and the universal in nature. Of course, there is no reason to believe that Tillich abandoned the Christ event as the center of history from the perspective of Christianity. He even emphasized that the Christ event is the criterion and the judgment of other centers. However, it is clear that Tillich was seeking for a more universal and immanent theological principle to carry on the religious substance of the kingdom of God. Pneumatological eschatology was, most probably, Tillich's solution.

Back to the problem of technological utopia, we have already discussed the ambiguous character of technological creation in the section on "existential roots". In addition to the ambiguous character of technological creation under the dimension of the human spirit, the whole question of technology should be located within the context of the historical dimension. Analogous with the other dimension of life, the historical dimension is characterized as self-creation and self-transcendence in both of which symbol of "progress" and "utopia" are the focus of human history. As Tillich said, "history, in terms of the self-creativity of life drives towards the creation of a new, unambiguous state of things. And, history, in terms of the self-transcendence of life, drives toward the universal, unambiguous fulfillment of the potentiality of being" (Tillich 1963: 332). It is clear, in the modern or post-modern context, what Tillich said in the above quotation about the new, universal, unambiguous fulfillment of being is nearly actualized in our scientific-technological achievements.

Therefore, technological creation in a certain sense is the answer to the meaning of history. For Tillich, "progress" is not merely a factual description, but a symbol pointing to something ultimate. That is why Tillich called it a "quasi-religious symbol" (Tillich 1963: 352), and he elevated technological progress to the level of law in historical development. Tillich asserted, "We must look at its use [concept of progress] as a universal law determining the dynamic of history. The significant side of progressivistic ideology is its emphasis on the progressive intention of every creative action and its awareness of those areas of the self-creativity of life in which progress is of the essence of the reality concerned, for example, technology" (Ibid.: 353). The historical-technological progress represents the metaphor of an unlimited end to the process. Technology is the best symbol to represent this imagery of historical progress. "The better tool, and generally the technically better means for whatever end, is a cultural reality of never ending consequences" (Ibid.: 338). It seems that Tillich has a strong reservation on this attitude of "never ending progress without end". This analysis of technological progress is exactly the extreme consequence of

the horizontal dimensional shift of the Renaissance. In 1963, Tillich reasserted "the flight into transterrestrial space is the greatest triumph of the horizontal over the vertical" (Tillich 1963b: 190). However, Tillich pointed out that the existential meaning of this type of technological progress is never asked for or replied to. Technological progress is the "forwardism for the sake of going forward", as a "genuine" historical interpretation of history; this symbol of progress provides an inner-historical impetus to push history moving forward.

Besides, there are two forms of "progressivism" which are without end and have the final state of fulfillment. The latter is utopianism. Both dimensions are interrelated and also reject each other. For Tillich, the creative imagery of utopia as the actualization and fulfillment of human potentiality is originally the spirit of the Renaissance; it lies behind the various forms of revolutionary movements. The symbol of utopia anticipates the "third" stage of the historical development in which historical reality would have a final transformation. It is not sure whether we already exist in this stage through our scientific-technological matrix. However, it is quite interesting that, in 1963, Tillich had anticipated the unpredictable and ambiguous character of the "future" of humankind and historical development. Tillich called this period "posthistory":

> The question is whether one must anticipate a stage of the evolutionary process in which historical mankind, though not as human race, comes to an end. The significance of this question lies in its relation to utopian ideas with respect to the future of mankind. The last stage of historical man has been identified with the final stage of fulfillment-with the Kingdom of God actualized on earth. But the "last" in the temporal sense is not the "final" in the eschatological sense. It is not by chance that the New Testament and Jesus resisted the attempt to put the symbols of the end into a chronological frame. Not even Jesus knows when the end will come; it is independence of the historical-post-historical development of mankind, although the mode of "future" is used in its symbolic description. This leaves the future of historical mankind open for possibilities derived from present experience. For example, it is not impossible that the self-destructive power of mankind will prevail and bring historical mankind to an end. It is also possible that mankind will lose not its potential freedom of transcending the given—this world make of him something no longer man—but the dissatisfaction with the given and consequently the drive toward the new. The character of the human race in this state would be similar to what Nietzsche has described as the "last man" who "knows everything" and is not interested in anything; it would be the state of "blessed animals." The negative utopias of our century, such as *Brave New World*, anticipate—rightly or wrongly—such a stage of evolution. A third possibility is a continuation of the dynamic drive of the human race toward unforeseeable actualization of man's potentialities, up to the gradual or sudden disappearance of the biological and physical conditions for the continuation of historical mankind. These and perhaps other chances of posthistorical mankind must be envisaged and liberated from any entanglement with the symbols of the "end of history" in their eschatological sense (Tillich 1963: 307–308).

Most obviously, the evolutionary process of human and non-human beings, which we are now undertaken through the scientific-technological achievement, includes other living beings in the world. Facing the endless progress of technological achievement, Tillich raised three possibilities. First, based on the mass destructive power generated by technology, humankind and the earth will come to the end. Second, humanity would be redefined as the being to be evolved, no longer bound by the limitation and the given. Third, it would be possible that human beings will actualize their potentiality about the unknown future. Actually, the above three articulations of human possibilities for the future through the utopian imagination are not the ultimate answer. However, Tillich questioned whether the "last" stage is identified with the "final" fulfillment of human history, and he criticized the problem of utopianism, especially a technological one.

In 1951, Tillich was invited back to Germany to deliver a series of lecture on the topic of utopia at the Deutsche Hochschule für Politik in Berlin. Tillich asserted that the idea of utopia is, first, rooted in the ontological structure of possibility, temptation and expectation of human existence. Besides, the historical and unhistorical interpretation of history both presuppose the idea of utopia which manifests the ideal stage of human history (Tillich 1953a: 125 – 129, 142 – 154). Most important, the ontological structure of utopia is disclosed as the following: echoing the early articulation of technological de-demonic apparatus, Tillich emphasized that the structure of utopia is the negation of the negative (Ibid.: 155) in which the human finitude and estrangement are overcome. This is exactly the character of quasi-religious substance in providing the promise of the redemptive possibility within human history. For Tillich, religion and technology are playing the same role in resolving human estrangement with nature. Tillich stated it clearly:

> The true meaning of the technological utopia is not that we can make better tools – this is a pleasant consequence that can also be unpleasant; but its true meaning is that we in this way appropriate nature to ourselves in a form that overcomes estrangement. This appropriation, however, is at the same time also an intensification of estrangement, for in appropriating nature we transform it, make it into an object, a tool, a means, and subordinate it to ourselves ... [a Chicago theologian asked Tillich about the meaning of the kingdom of God, and he led Tillich to his desk, snapped on his desk lamp and said] This is the kingdom of God - meaning, of course, the technology making possible man's appropriation of nature (Ibid.: 160).

For Tillich, the essence of the utopia of technology is grounded in "the realization of man's essence over against the negativities of nature in the context of technological achievement" (Ibid.: 161). Therefore, the nature of utopia is ambi-

guity in a sense that it is also a mixture of the essence and existence. First, utopia is neither an illusion nor a projection of the human ideal. It manifests the inner aim of human and historical existence; therefore, technological utopia contains the "truth" in its essence (Ibid.: 168). Second, its positive elements bear the ontological possibilities in itself through which human persons and society are motivated to move forward (Ibid.: 169). Third, as early Tillich indicated, the most impressive characteristic of technological utopia is ist transformative power. Though utopia is "without a place", it does not mean that it is not present or absent. Rather, the root of its power mechanism is the essential and the ontological discontent of human beings in all directions, manifesting its power through political, economic and cultural realms (Ibid.: 169).

Likewise, the above positive apparatus of technological utopia is structurally coupled with its negative distractions. The falsehood nature is existential, mixed with its truthfulness, not because it promises or depicts something fantastic in the future, but because it veils the ontic and existential nature of the human being and society (Ibid.: 171). Also, the ontological possibility is a temptation in nature. Technology elevates human freedom in an absolute sense. "The unfruitfulness of utopia is that it describes impossibilities as real possibilities and fails to see them for what they are, impossibilities, or as an oscillation between possibility and impossibility" (Ibid.: 171). Last, technological falsehood and unfruitfulness inevitably lead to disillusionment, which Tillich called a metaphysical pre-ultimate entity elevating into the ultimate. This sacralization either preserves the past as absolute or justifies some political actions by means of terror (Ibid.: 173).

It is clear that, for Tillich, the solution for the ambiguity of the whole ontological structure of technological utopia lies in the basic structural analysis of life as the mixture of the essential and existential nature which is demonstrated in volume three of his *Systematic Theology*. Tillich neither adopted a pessimistic nor an optimistic attitude towards the future of technology. Therefore, he strongly criticized the pre-modern naïve standpoint of returning back to re-uniting with nature, despite this idea sharing some truths in asserting the essential connection between human beings and nature. Also, embracing the advance development of technology to tackle the problem of technology is a deadlock. The weakness and limitation of technology cannot to be solved alone. In his 1951 Berlin lecture, Tillich finally inquired into the problem of how we can radically transcend negativity unveiled in technology. Tillich seemed to adapt a Hegelian scheme of dialectical overcoming the positive and the negative of the technological matrix. "The positive remains in spite of the power of the negative, and the demand for a way beyond this negativity lead to the *transcendence of utopia*" (Ibid.: 173. Emphasis mine). Hegelian dialectical logic tries to preserve the posi-

tive and the negative, and moves forward through overcoming all the negative elements, but preserving them in a transcending way (*aufheben*). The basic structure of Tillich's idea of redemptive transformative power is a way of "go-beyond" in which the ontological structure of being would not be destroyed but reconciled with the divine in the existential estranged condition.

The doctrine of the Kingdom of God represents an "intrusion" or "breakthrough" into the self-creative and self-transcending horizontal movement of a technological-historical dimension (Ibid.: 174). This kairological-vertical breakthrough into the historical-horizontal dimension manifests the combination of early Tillich's Christological-*kairos* doctrine and his later pneumatological-kingdom doctrine. The radical transcendent breakthrough constitutes the manifestation of divine meaning and power through temporal existential structures. Under the theonomous vision in his theology of culture, Tillich emphasized that the horizontal-technological-temporal structure is preserved in a qualified way in which divine judgment condemns the estrangement condition and elevates it in a transcendent union with the divine. In volume three of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich packaged the whole ambiguity of human technological creation under the consideration of spiritual presence and the kingdom of God. The former manifests the divine revelation within the inner struggle of human history and the latter represents the *telos* of human history.

5.4.4. Pneumatological Healing

Preserving and transforming cultural form and content are constantly regarded as the basic kernel of Tillich's idea of theonomy. From a *logos*-structure perspective, theonomy means "autonomous reason united with its own depth ... reason actualizes itself in obedience to its structural laws and in the power of its own inexhaustible ground" (Tillich 1951:85). From a pneumatological perspective, theonomy articulates the state of human culture under the impact of the Spiritual Presence. The effectiveness of the cultural laws is manifested under the directedness of the self-creation of life under the dimension of the Spirit toward the ultimate in being and meaning (Tillich 1963: 249). Tillich's radical articulation emphasized that the *telos* of human creation would be fulfilled, but not destroyed by the power of the Spirit-determined and -directed (Ibid.: 250). Tillich's pneumatological theology of culture has two tasks: all human cultural creations are potentially bearable for the manifestation of divine power and meaning; this means the cultural form and content are functioning as a sacramental medium in which the transcendental ultimacy is immanently experienced. Also, the demonic character, its extreme heteronomy and autonomy, are overcome, not

through the destruction of its form but through the reunification with theonomy (Ibid.: 251). For Tillich, the reason why technological creation is corrupted is because, without the depth of the transcendent, the independence of the empty autonomy and the hegemonic heteronomy will fight each other. Therefore, theonomy manifests its depth and ultimacy as divine revelation and redemption through the reunion of the breakdown and estrangement.

For Tillich, divine revelation and salvation coincide, which means that the content of divine disclosure is always manifesting the divine healing power and reconciling meaning. In his essay, "Redemption in Cosmic and Social History", published in 1946, Tillich recalled the universal and cosmic significance of the Christian idea of salvation by means of emphasizing that the objective and universal salvation is ontologically prior to the individual salvation (Tillich 1946: 274). The Christian concept of salvation is never regarded as the redemptive act to widen the gap between the human person and nature implied in the post-Kantian theology in general and Ritschlian theology in particular. Nature and human beings participate in the fall and salvation. This essay anticipated Tillich's idea of redemptive significance within the concept of multi-dimensional unity of life. For him, salvation should not be regarded as "once-for-all" or "either-or" of the redemptive stage. Redemption is always fragmentary and anticipatory. The former represents the immanent character of salvation happening in time and space, but the latter unveils the transcendent union as the fulfillment of created *telos* of the world. It is important for Tillich to understand salvation as "healing" and he indicated the salvation power as the re-establishment of unity, integration and wholeness (Ibid.: 276). The universal and cosmic dimension of redemptive healing embraces the multi-dimensional natures of different entities, from body, soul to social-economic order and history.

In conquering the ambiguity of technical creation, Tillich located the whole question under a pneumatological framework in which an idea of theonomous technology is expressed.

> For the Spirit, no thing is merely a thing. It is a bearer of form and meaning and therefore, a possible object of *eros* ... they [the technical object] can be considered and artistically valuated as new embodiments of the power of being itself. This *eros* toward the technical *Gestalt* is a way in which a theonomus relation to technology can be achieved (Tillich 1963: 258).

The fundamental deadlock of technological creation constitutes a cleavage between subject and object. This dilaceration functions as a result of the objectification/ thingification of the object which is unable to bear and express powerfully the interrelationship between meaning and being. The "thing" is impossible to love, but only to control and dominate. Under the Spiritual Pres-

ence, the healing power redeems the *gestalt* of the technical product from the "thinghood" of technological creation. The concept of *gestalt* exhibits the integrated whole within itself, and always connects the surrounding environment with its center. The technical matrix under the impact of the Spiritual presence is no longer external and alien to the human being, but it is re-orientated to the ethical dimension with human *eros* and is symbolized as the divine embodiment expressing ultimate meaning.

According to Tillich, this theonomous technology manifests ultimate concern in producing objects "which can be imbued with subjective qualities" (Tillich 1963: 258). The inter-subjective, communicated rationality between the human being and the technical creation is structurally connected with the ultimate end instead of conquering by purposive rationality (Ibid.). Last, the unlimited possibility of technology is overcome by the manifestation of the character of finitude (Ibid.). Put in detail, technological creation commits itself into the problem of mixing with freedom and finite limitation. The pneumatological breakthrough of technological production discloses the temptation of unlimited possibilities, which is closely connected with creative abstraction. Under the analysis of the existential condition, technological *hubris* and desire are fully explored with the possibilities between creation and destruction. The unlimited freedom of the illusive promise created by technological creation is ultimately an illusion of the new liberation, which would finally result in a new form of slavery (Tillich 1963: 258). Also, the alienation produced by technological production is existentially grounded in human *concupiscence* and *hubris*. The redemptive faith created by the Spiritual Presence grasps human beings in the condition of ultimate concern through which the ontological elements of human beings are open to the Holy Spirit, and, simultaneously, human beings accept their own finitude in faith. Tillich's famous doctrine of justification by grace through faith (Tillich 1957: 179) enables the reconciliation between human beings and the world. This unity is created by the unity in love manifested by the Spiritual Presence instead of the human domination over the world by force. In addition to the pneumatological love dimension between human beings and technological production, the reorientation of ultimate *telos* is refigured in the production in which technic is able to serve the innermost *telos* of the beings. "The divine Spirit, cutting out of the vertical direction to resist an unlimited running-ahead in the horizontal line, drives toward a technical production that is subjected to the ultimate end of all life processes – Eternal Life" (Tillich 1963: 259). Therefore, the eschatological dimension of the pneumatology manifests the fulfillment of all created beings under the theonomous impact of technical creation, which is the harmonious unity among all beings in which divine love is regarded as the union power and meaning created by the Holy Spirit.

For Tillich, love is not merely a kind of human sentiment or emotion, but a kind of ontological structure and power of all beings. All beings are essentially united together, but existentially estranged in actuality. Love, as the moving power of life, empowers all life forms to actualize their potentialities, and acts as the moving drive towards the unity of the separated. "Love manifests its greatest power there where it overcomes the greatest separation" (Tillich 1954: 25). It is quite obvious that Tillich's idea of the ontological understanding of love is inspired by Hegel's early fragments on the idea of love in which Tillich noted, "the deep insights into the dynamics of the love relationships, not only on the human level, but in all living reality" (Tillich 1967a: 412). For early Hegel, same as Tillich, love is the reunion of the separated in an ontological sense. Therefore, the transcendent unity of unambiguous life created by the Holy Spirit manifests the reunion power engendered by divine *agape* through which all beings are accepted without restrictions, despite the beings having committed into the stage of the profanized, demonized and estranged conditions; out of the pneumatological *agape* the holiness, greatness and dignity of the loved objects are re-established (Tillich 1963: 138). *Agape* is so special in Tillich's mind because it is not only one of the spiritual gifts created by God, but it is God Himself. It is the divine life itself, characterized as love itself, that drives the divine towards the creature and through the creature towards Himself (Ibid.).

According to Tillich, the dangerous condition of controlling the character of knowledge expressed in technical rationality does not merely produce separation and detachment between subject and object. As Tillich emphasized that separation and participation are the basic elements of all types of epistemological action, no knowledge is possible without either of them. The problem is twofold: First, technical rationality transforms all beings into a "thing" (Tillich 1951: 97) which becomes ultimately and completely controllable and calculable. All kinds of subjective qualities are deprived. Second, the danger of technical rationality does not create the structure of "subject-object" but it "objectifies" all beings as "objects" (Ibid.). The divine *agape* redeems the structure of the participating-relational epistemology out of the purposive rationality and controlling knowledge of technical power. Employing the terminology from volume one of *Systematic Theology*, Tillich's pneumatological *agape* reunites technical reason with ontological reason. As Tillich emphasized, "technical reason ... dehumanizes man if it is separated from ontological reason. And beyond this, technical reason itself is impoverished and corrupted if it is not continually nourished by ontological reason" (Tillich 1951: 73). Redemption in the realm of technology expresses that, ontologically, technical reason should be located as an expression of ontological reason and its companion (Ibid.).

6 Environmental Ethics in Dialogue: Tillich, Orthodox Theology and Confucianism

Introduction

Both Judeo-Christian traditions and western philosophical traditions are commonly criticized for anthropocentrism and dualism, which are regarded as issues central to the global environmental crisis. Western dualistic conceptuality, with its demarcation between transcendence and immanence, and a hierarchical mode of thinking, are now being challenged by movements, such as radical eco-egalitarianism, ecofeminism, the deep ecological movement, and posthumanism. From these perspectives, the emergence of secularization results in the divine absence from the world, and promotes a scientific-technological mindset which consolidates human rationality and subjectivity, and which deepens the western ecological crisis.

Recently, attempts to explore the ecological implications in different religious traditions have brought balance to the above highly generalized picture. These studies insist that religion should not be regarded as bankrupt in dealing with the environmental crisis, but rather that it provides fruitful and promising resources for us to rethink the ecological question from a different angle. In this context, the east-west religious-ecological dialogue establishes a platform in which different religious traditions try to articulate the inter- and intra-textual readings of the other (as well as their own) in order to explore numerous potentialities and possibilities for ecological thinking.

Under the categories, "sacramentality" and "cosmic anthropology", this chapter argues that cosmology and anthropology, expressed in the Orthodox tradition, Confucianism and Paul Tillich's work, share a similar ontological and cosmic vision which is relational, dynamic and universal in nature. Also, these three lenses emphasize the uniqueness of the human being in the universe without committing to anthropocentrism. Further, it will demonstrate that a human being can be regarded as the "center" but not the "master" of the world. These three lenses find no difficulty in the assertion that a human being can be "being-in-the-world" and "being-above-the-world" at the same time. Third, re-enchantment of the world seems to provide an opportunity for the renewal of human spirituality in which instrumental rationality about the world should be reconsidered in order to perceive the world as a sacrament, a gift, and a living organism instead of a huge mechanical machine. Also, adherents of these lenses uphold an anthropocosmic vision which emphasizes the interrelationship between human beings and nature, communication between self and community,

https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110612752-007

and the mutuality between humans and God (Heaven). I will first argue that Tillich's notion of sacramentality is ontological-universal in character, and that this concept expresses the nature of the multi-dimensionality in the universe which is based on his pneumatology. Likewise, in the Orthodox tradition, the universe is also regarded as the sacrament in which the essence of all beings is grounded in the *Logos*. This sacramental thinking, inspired by Christology, conceives the world as a symbol pointing to its divine Creator. In Confucian cosmogony, transcendence and immanence are interrelated within a dynamic and holistic whole in which the underlying principle of the universe is wholly embodied within the structure of the world. Second, I will argue that the notion of "cosmic humanity" is the key concept of these three lenses. In both Tillich's and Orthodox teachings, the human being is regarded as a "microcosm" in which different dimensions of the universe are embraced in the human being who is understood as the highest being in Tillich's anthropology and the priest of the cosmos in Orthodox teachings. In Confucianism, the essential part of the human being is connected with transcendent Heaven, and the human being is mandated with the duty of the creative transformation of the world by the Heaven. Finally, in concluding the paper, the ecological implication of these three lenses will be explored.

6.1 Christian Sacramentality and Confucian Cosmogony:[1]

6.1.1 Tillich's Pneumatological Sacramentality

As the previous chapters show, pneumatology, for Tillich, first, plays a decisive role in reconceiving the entire theological project. The interplay between Christology and pneumatology constitutes the theological methodological consideration for integrating universality and particularity in the divine revelation and redemption. Thus, the being of God and the New Being manifested in Jesus as the Christ are well grounded in the Spiritual Presence as the unity of power and meaning. Second, Tillich is distinctive in correlating life universal, and human life in particular, with the divine Spirit. Spiritual Presence brings the self-transcendence of life into the multi-dimensional unity. The Spirit, for Tillich, is not only regarded as the life-power and vitality of the different life-forms, she also dwells in the historical dimension of the multi-faceted levels of beings and reveals the fulfillment of the *telos* of all beings. In this sense, the term sacramen-

1 It should be noted that the understanding of the meaning of sacrament or sacramentality in the Catholic church has undergone a developmental and changing history; see (Kadavil 2005).

tality denotes the presence of the infinite in the finite, and finite symbols point to the infinite. Tillich's idea of sacramentality is wholly and definitely pneumatological.

In volume three of his *Systematic Theology*, Tillich expressed a dynamic and unifying perspective towards a multi-dimensional understanding of life. For him, the concept of "life" embraces different "dimensions" in which the interplay between potentiality and actuality is intertwined. Therefore, nothing should be reduced to "thing" only. As he emphasized, "no thing in nature is merely a thing" (Tillich 1963: 34). Nature is viewed neither as the scientific-technological object nor the magical substance, but is to be perceived theologically as "the finite expression of the infinite ground of all things" (Tillich 1956a: 4). On one hand, Tillich strongly rejected sacralization of nature when he describes a realist interpretation of the real structure of nature. Under the multi-dimensional unity of life, the infinite divine and the finite creatures are clearly distinguished but not separated. On the other hand, the innermost structure of nature as the form of the divine substance of the Spirit constitutes the theonomous attitude towards the universe in which the divine and nature are interpenetrated. Tillich's "*infra Lutheranum*" background allowed him to adopt the mutual indwelling of the two natures of Jesus Christ in whom the presence of infinite in everything finite is theologically possible; in addition, Schelling's idealist philosophy of nature provided him with the philosophical identity between God, human beings and nature. Based on his understanding of the ontological-universal structure of being-itself, God is the ground and the power of beings. Every being is grounded in the innermost part of the God's being. Therefore, all objects or events become a medium, functioning as a sacramentality in which the transcendent is perceived to be present (Tillich 1929a: 108).

Although Tillich emphasized that the character or quality of nature itself is closely related with the sacred power it symbolizes, those qualities are only to be considered as the *bearer* of a sacred power. Nature is the object of Christian redemption. Therefore, the quality of the natural object is a necessary but not sufficient condition for becoming a sacrament. For Tillich, revelation and salvation are interchangeable. In volume one of his *Systematic Theology*, based on the universal-ontological understanding of being-itself, Tillich insisted that nothing is excluded from participation in the ultimate ground of beings, and nothing is qualified and worthy in itself to represent ultimate concern. In order to be the medium of divine revelation, it should also be the object of divine redemption. This is the reason why the whole reality has become a medium of revelation but has never been identified with the divine (Tillich 1951: 118). The power and meaning of nature are disclosed through, but not in, objective physical structure. Tillich emphasized that the subjective and objective approach towards the under-

standing of nature is not sufficient. In this context, Tillich tended to accept nature as embodying a kind of symbolic character in revealing something ultimate.

For Tillich, the whole theology of sacramentality relies on a theology of symbol in which the sacramental material is not only a sign, but also stands for a symbol that participates in what it signifies, and is intrinsically related to what it expresses (Tillich 1963: 123). The theology of symbol is closely related to his notion of self-transcending realism (*glaubiger Realismus*). As Tillich noted, "self-transcending realism is a universal attitude toward reality. It is neither a merely theoretical view of the world, nor a practical discipline for life ... it is a basic attitude in every realm of life, expressing itself in the shaping of every realm" (Tillich 1929b: 67). This type of realism confirms the concrete form of nature as the embodiment of spiritual power and meaning. Following Tillich's "*form-Inhalt-Gehalt*" framework of theology of culture, the spiritual *Gehalt* reveals its power and meaning through natural forms and structures. Tillich insisted, "the new realism was not interested in the natural forms of things for their own sake, but for their power of expressing the profounder levels and the universal significances of things" (Ibid.). Through the given natural forms, this realism functions as symbolic embodiment and "tries to point to the spiritual meaning of the real by using its given form" (Ibid.). For this reason Tillich rejected both the Catholic idea of transubstantiation, which transforms a symbol into a thing to be handled, and the reformed tradition of the sign character of the sacramental symbol (Tillich 1963: 123). Considering the Catholic side, nature as symbol representing spiritual power is not functioning as "*opus operatum*" in order to receive objective grace from the divine power; considering the reformed side, it is also not a sign for the faith community to remember the divine saving event. In sum, nature as symbol participates in the power of what it symbolizes, and therefore, it can be a medium of the Spirit (Ibid.).

In Tillich's early demonstration of sacramental thinking, Christology and soteriology are linked with the power of a sacramental bearer. In order to attack magical and mythological usage, the Protestant tradition needs to bring nature into the context of the history of salvation, so that the demonic quality of nature is conquered in the New Being in Jesus Christ (Tillich 1929a: 102–103). "Any sacramental reality within the framework of Christology and of Protestantism must be related to the New Being in Christ" (Ibid.: 109). For Tillich, the New Being created by Jesus as the Christ is the new creation universe. Moreover, in his Christology, the essential Godmanhood, manifesting within the existential and historical conditions, is interpreted not merely as a religious personality, but as a basic divine sacramental reality (Tillich 1948a: xxiii). Cosmic Christ as the New Being also represents the paradoxical character of the divine symbol in which "the absolute side of the final revelation, that in it which is unconditional and un-

changeable, involves the *complete transparency* and the complete self-sacrifice of the medium in which it appears" (Tillich 1951: 151. Emphasis mine).

However, the above Christological orientation shifted into a pneumatological perspective in volume three of *Systematic Theology*. In that work, Tillich tried to develop the doctrine of pneumatology in order to answer numerous criticisms on one hand, and to re-articulate his theological perspectives in the light of the doctrine of the Holy Spirit on the other.[2] Though Tillich emphasized that the divine spirit is essentially correlated with the human spirit, it does not exclude the Spiritual Presence indwelling in the whole multi-dimensional unity of life. Given the rejection of dualistic and supernaturalist reduction, spiritual power and meaning manifests as the "dimension of the ultimate" or "the dimension of depth" (Tillich 1963: 113). Likewise, the universality of the Spiritual Presence is the expression of the radical effective embodiment of personal and historical events. Therefore, for Tillich, we have no reason to adopt the narrow sense of the concept of "sacramental" in which some particular objects and acts are qualified as the medium for the experience of divine spirit in a faith community but, rather, Tillich enlarged the sense to cover *everything* in which the Spiritual Presence has been experienced (Ibid.: 121. Emphasis mine). The spiritual community "is free to appropriate *all* symbols which are adequate and which possess symbolic power" (Ibid.: 123. Emphasis mine).

6.1.2 Orthodox Cosmic Liturgy[3]

If Tillich's final articulation of the divine presence in the finite were located in his pneumatological sacramentality, the Orthodox understanding of the world as sacrament would heavily rely on Christology. According to Fr Alexander Schmemann (1921–1983), a Russian Orthodox priest, the elements of the Eucharist reveal something really fundamental about the world in which we go about our daily lives (Schmemann 1965). The "ultimate" meaning of the matter used in a sacrament could better be regarded as matter unveiled to reveal something about the divine. This "sacramental quality" is entailed in Orthodox teaching about the world as a sacramental cosmology (Theokritoff 2009: 181–182). In the doctrine of creation and salvation, Orthodox teaching insists that the original beauty of the created world is the reflection of the glory of the Creator; there is an

2 For the interplay between Christology and pneumatology in the development of Tillich's theology, see chapter two.

3 The term, cosmic liturgy, is borrowed by Hans Urs von Balthasar's book title, *Cosmic Liturgy: The Universe according to Maximus the Confessor.*

ontological linkage between the Creator and the creature. The whole world is understood as an icon to symbolize the divine. Also, the cosmic fall points to the suffering of all things. Human and Earth are bound together in an integrated whole under the economy of God's saving activity.

Greek Patristic thought originally articulated the above ontological correspondence between the Creator and the created in which the concept of *logoi* shares with, and is created by, the divine *Logos*. The Patristic theologians, such as Origen, adopted the Stoics' idea of *spermatikos logos*, which rejected the materialistic understanding of God, and emphasizes that the divine *Logos* is present in all things. Likewise, Origen combined the transcendence of the Platonic archetype with the immanent presence of the Stoic *spermatikoi logoi* as the differentiated articulation of the single divine *Logos* who is also the divine Wisdom (Bradshaw 2013: 9 – 13). To perceive the *logoi* in the created world is the act known as *theōria physikē*, which translates roughly as natural contemplation, through self-denial and other related virtues such as forgiveness, obedience and charity. In St Dionysius the Areopagite, nature is more like theophany because the whole reality points beyond itself to its divine source. It seems that the liturgical understanding about the sensible world offers a mystical contemplation of the unity of the world and God.

This theological climax was found in a later Greek Father, St Maximus the Confessor (ca. 580 – 662); he clearly believed the sensible world to be a kind of cosmic liturgy. He argued that all the *logoi* of beings subsist as one in an incomprehensible simplicity. The divine *Logos* has possessed all the *logoi* of particular beings from all eternity, and they are gathered together in Christ. Therefore, "the one *Logos* is many *logoi*" expresses the uncreated within the created ultimately according to God's plan (Ibid.: 18 – 19).[4] For Maximus the Confessor, created beings participate in God through the *logoi*, though this dynamism is lacking in Plato's idea of Forms. The whole cosmos is moving towards the fulfillment, which is the ultimate union with God. The *logoi* of beings may be obscured but not be distorted. As he said, "nothing that is natural is opposed to God" (Louth: 2013: 62 – 63). Maximus the Confessor insisted that human contemplation of the *logoi* of the created beings is a mode of communication with the divine *Logos* leading to mystical union with God. According to Alexei Nesteruk, this communicating mode is a kind of "spiritual vision of reality in which the ontological roots of things and beings have their grounds beyond the world" (Nesteruk 2003: 25). This spiritual orientation towards the created world is a contemplation of all sensible creation in its oneness through finding that all the *logoi* of sensi-

4 See also (Balthasar, 2003: 154 – 157).

ble things can be united in one divine *Logos*, which constitutes the principle of creation (Ibid.: 26).

Because the created *logoi* is originally and finally linked with the *Logos*-Christ, it follows that the ontological status of the whole creation is Christologically based. Therefore, the doctrine of *logoi* is not merely a doctrine of metaphysical principle in a cosmological sense, but it is also a multidimensional doctrine bearing on the whole divine economy of creation and redemption (Tollefsen 2008: 66 – 67). In the teachings of Maximus the Confessor, the cosmic *Logos* is incarnated in a threefold presence: historical person, Jesus; scripture; and also in the whole reality (Ibid.). "The incarnation thus gave expression to the cosmic importance of Christ, for through the differentiation of things and their *logoi*, in which Christ the *Logos* is present, one can contemplate their unity in the one *Logos* of God and through them ascend with the incarnate Christ to the Father" (Nesteruk 2003: 27). Likewise, the uncreated and created, the spiritual and the material, the sensible and the nonsensible, are united and bound into the truth and the grace of God who leads the whole of creation to find its ultimate fulfillment through human contemplation and practice. This Orthodox idea of the cosmic liturgy provides the re-enchantment of the world without committing to the charge of pantheism. The Orthodox theology upholds the doctrine of "difference in unity" in which the mystery of God and the world are maintained even though they constitute a kind of sacramental reality.

6.1.3 The Confucian Cosmogony

Generally speaking, western dualistic conceptuality is not found in the Chinese holistic and organic world view; instead, the poles of transcendence and immanence integrate within each other to construct a more dynamic and developmental cosmic whole. The genuine Chinese cosmogony is that of an organismic process, meaning that all of the parts of the entire cosmos belong to one organic whole and that they all interact as participants in one spontaneously self-generating life process (Tu 1989). According to TU Weiming, continuity, wholeness and dynamism are the three characters of the Chinese vision of the cosmos. The reality is regarded as a huge continuum in which nothing is outside of it. In rejecting dualistic thinking, nature is perceived under holistic thinking, and the whole reality is not static in a sense that vitality and dynamism always perform in a process-oriented way. In Neo-Confucianism, the dynamic ordering pattern (*li*) and the vital energies (*qi*) emanate from the ultimate Great (*taiji*) which performs as the basic structure and function of the cosmos and it penetrates into the vital energy. Therefore, the ultimate principle of the universe is the ultimate One and it

differentiates itself into the diverse structures and patterns in order to form different beings. In this context, the transcendent principle and the immanent forms are not dualistic but functions as a polar interaction. This philosophy of *qi* becomes the focus of Zhang Zai's philosophy. *Qi* functions as the cosmic force to unite everything in the universe, and it is embodied into the human mind to embrace the pluralist and diverse conditions in everything in an integral whole (Kim 2015).

Nature is a relational whole in which human life and the rhythms of nature that sustain life in both its biological needs and socio-cultural expressions operate together. Everything in nature is interdependent, interrelated, dynamic and transformational. Nature, therefore, is inherently valuable and morally good. Value lies in the ongoing transformation and productivity of nature. TU Weiming asserted that Confucian ontology is regarded as the continuity of being in which all modalities of being are organically connected (Tu 1989: 70). Spiritual and material realms are co-related under the vital force. All beings, whether living or non-living, consist of this vital force. Without the concept of a creator God and the Christian idea of creation out of nothing, Confucian thought emphasizes a spontaneously self-generating life process within which all beings, human and non-human, are integral parts of an organic continuum (Ibid.). Under this way of thinking, humans and nature share the same cosmic creative force, so that a kind of kinship relationship develops between them.

Although nature has inherent value and embodies the normative standard for all things, it is not judged from an anthropocentric perspective. In Confucianism, value is embodied within nature and lies in the ongoing transformation and productivity of nature. In this context, Confucians do not view hierarchy as leading inevitably to domination. Rather, they see that value rests in each thing, but not equally in each thing in an individual way. A Confucian vision of reality asserts that everything has its appropriate role and location. The use of nature for human ends must recognize the intrinsic value of each element of nature, but also its value in relation to the larger context of the environment. Each entity is considered not simply equal to every other; rather, each interrelated part of nature has a particular value according to its nature and function (Tucker 2001: 131). Hierarchy, for Confucianism, is seen as a necessary way for each being to fulfill its function. Thus, no individual has an exclusive privileged status. The processes of nature and its ongoing logic of transformation is the standard form that takes priority.

Human actualization in cultural and ethical transformation is always embodied in the transformation process within the dynamic of nature. The great triad of Confucianism – heaven, earth and humans – signifies this understanding that only humans can attain their full humanity in relationship to both heav-

en and earth. This becomes an ontological-ethical foundation for a cosmological ethical system of relationality applicable to spheres of family, society, politics, and nature. Nature functions in this world view as great parents to humans, providing sustenance, nurturing, intelligibility and guidance. In return, nature requires human respect and care. Human realization is achieved by fulfilling this role of filial children to beneficent parents who have sustained life for humans. Humans participate in the vast processes of nature by cultivating themselves in relation to nature's seasons and transformations.

6.2 Cosmic Anthropology: Microcosms, Mediator and the Great Man

6.2.1 Human Being as Microcosms: Tillich

For Tillich, human beings are not merely one of the creatures among other living creatures. In a Heideggerian sense, only human beings can be aware of the structure of the being. The uniqueness of the human being is not based on supremacy among all living beings; nor is the human being to be regarded as *animal rationale* in an Aristotelian sense. For Tillich, the idea, *human*, means that the one is aware of finitude and potential infinity (Tillich 1951: 258). His doctrine of *Imago Dei* points out that, in human beings, the ontological elements are complete and are united on a creature basis, on one hand, and, on the other hand, are united with God as the creative ground (Ibid.: 259). The above double ontological structures constitute, first, the human being as the mediator between the divine and all other beings. Tillich adopted a classical notion that the human being is the *microcosm*[5] because all dimensions – inorganic, organic, psychic, spiritual and historical – are all present and actualized in the human being (Ibid.: 260). Second, the ontological structure of the human being is analogous to the divine *Logos* that means the *ground of being mandates the telos of a human being*. Based on this anthropological understanding, the fulfillment of the created purposiveness of creation is dependent on the actualization of human finite freedom. No other beings are constructed and required to fulfill the above mandate. We would say that the role of the human being is as a co-creator (Philip Hefner's

5 The concept, microcosms, originally comes from Greek antiquity and can be traced back to pre-Socratic times, and was later adopted and enriched by Greek Orthodox fathers. Later on, it can be found in Renaissance philosophy and German philosophy as well.

phrase);[6] "God is primarily and essentially creative; man is secondarily and existentially creative." (Tillich 1951: 256)

In volume three of Tillich's *Systematic Theology*, his anthropology is well constructed within the whole being of the universe. Against the metaphor of "levels", Tillich preferred the imagery of "dimensions" to describe the different intersecting of all kinds of *zoe*, rather than *bio*-sphere only. The choice reflects the dislocation of the hierarchical matrix and centering on the blurring and mixing of the organic flow of different dimensions of life. All dimensions – inorganic, organic, psychic, spiritual and historical – cross their boundaries without losing their own identities. The multi-dimensionality of life "describes the difference of the realms of being in such a way that there cannot be mutual interference; depth does not interfere with breadth, since all dimensions meet in the same point. They cross without disturbing each other; there is no conflict between dimensions ... these conflicts are not denied, but they are not derived from the hierarchy of levels; they are the consequences of the ambiguity of all life processes" (Tillich 1963: 15). The interpenetration and fusion within poly- and trans- dimensionality constitutes an interactive, dynamic and vitalist vision of the realities. The basic idea of Tillich's dynamic vision of all life forms is that all dimensions are real but not always in actual status. Therefore, for Tillich, when someone encounters someone/ something, it means that the one who encounters is the mixture of all dimensions, but some dimensions are in a potential stage, and some are in an actual stage. Even in the so-called inorganic realm, all other dimensions are potentially present. "In this sense one speaks of the vegetable realm or the animal realm or the historical realm. In all of them, all dimensions are potentially present, and some of them are actualized" (Ibid.: 16). For Tillich, the interplay of potentiality and actuality insists that there is not any metaphysical and transcendental core in any realms or dimensions. This non-essentialist approach of Tillich's idea allows the ontological blurring of spirituality, humanity, animality and materiality.

The above multi-dimensionality of all species presupposes a certain kind of evolutionary understanding. Tillich emphasized that the condition of the actualization of one dimension is that other previous dimensions have been actualized. Therefore, "the dimension of spirit would remain potential without the actualization of the organic". The continuum within different dimensions expresses that there is no possibility of a clear-cut mechanism to allocate human "exceptionalism". Therefore, although Tillich maintained that the human being is onto-

6 See (Hefner 1993).

logically the highest being, he did not commit to an anthropocentric understanding.

6.2.2 Man as Mediator of the Cosmos: Orthodox Anthropology

According to Lars Thunberg, the idea of a human being as a microcosm can be traced back to Nemesius of Emessa.[7] Actually, the tradition of "human being as microcosm" has a long history deeply rooted in the Orthodox tradition. This divine task of being human is based on God's creation plan in which the human being is located in an intermediary position in order to carry out the act through which all the created beings can gather together. That is the reason why a human being is the one combined with two oppositions; it implies that the vocation of being human should function as an image of the whole cosmos (Thunberg 1985: 73). St. Symeon the New Theologian, based on the Scripture and the anthropology of the Orthodox tradition, emphasized that all levels of existence belonging to the various forms in the created world are to be found in human beings. The physiology of a human being has a direct relationship to Orthodox cosmology (Keselopoulos 2001: 42). First, the whole universe is ontologically connected with the created structure of the human being meaning that the completeness of the human manifests in a unified psychosomatic whole in which matter and spirit are formed together. This formulates the role of humanity as the bridge and point of contact for the whole of creation (Ibid.: 45). Second, the image of God in humans does not mean that the human being is the master of other beings, but that human beings are called to preserve and to fulfill the right orientation of the dynamism within the whole creation. The human being is placed in the world as the priest standing between the world and God (Ibid.).

St. Maximus the Confessor insisted that the human being is regarded as a microcosm (small universe) and the world as *makranthropos* (a man enlarged). This double and parallel constitution is mutually connected and united. The analogy between the world and the human should be transformed into a unity. To be human being as mediator is attributed the task of unification of the universe (Thunberg 1985: 74). For Maximus the Confessor, the incarnation of Christ is not the secondary measure caused by the fall, but in fact God wills Himself to be incarnated as a real man in whom the perfection and fulfill-

7 Man as microcosm in Nemesius is interpreted as seeing the external universe reflected in man as in a mirror, and also emphasizes that all tensions created by the oppositive and dualistic entities are reconciled in man. See (Thunberg 1995: 136).

ment of the full task of mediation is anticipated (Ibid.). According to Lars Thunberg, for Maximus the Confessor, Christology is the key to open the linkage between anthropology and cosmology (Nichols 1993: 158 – 195). His Christological anthropology and cosmology locates humans as the center of the created universe and also does justice to the cosmic implications of Christ's position and work of reconciliation (Thunberg 1995: 142). It is well known that, in the Orthodox tradition, incarnation and deification forms a mutually hermeneutical circle. For Maximus the Confessor, the human being as macrocosm, who unites in herself/himself all that is differentiated without the expense of its integrity. The work of unification and mediation is the result of the human relationship with God in the doctrine of creation, and its eschatological fulfillment and actualization are interpreted as the union with God (deification), which is ultimately grounded, by the *Logos*-incarnated (Incarnation).[8] Therefore, it is no problem for Maximus the Confessor to talk about the divinization of the human being in a sense that "He remains wholly man in soul and body in nature, and becomes wholly God in body and soul by grace and by the unparalleled divine radiance of blessed glory".[9]

Thus, according to Orthodox tradition, each human being should be regarded as the mediator and priest of creation. According to John Zizioulas, the traditional Christian idea of stewardship is problematic in the following sense: Even though the idea of steward emphasizes the responsible role of human beings towards creation, it also implies a managerial approach to nature (Zizioulas 2013: 164). A utilitarian approach would be assumed in this model which perceives the creation as an object to be managed, arranged and distributed by human beings. Also, stewardship implies a conservation attitude towards nature. (Ibid.). It is an unrealistic and futile attitude to speak of sheer conservation of the environment. In contrast, the human being as priest of creation insists that the human role is neither passive nor managerial. The nature of humanity is related to nature not functionally, as the idea of stewardship would suggest, but ontologically and sacramentally. In the case of stewardship, our attitude towards nature is determined by ethics and morality. However, in the case of priesthood, in destroying nature we simply cease to be human. The consequences of ecological sin is not moral but *existential* (Ibid.: 169). Also, the idea of priest of creation provides ecology with a cultural dimension in which material nature is transformed into an artistic product to be loved and embraced. Ecology is not preservation

8 For the excellent study on the concept of deification in the Orthodox tradition, see (Russell 2004). For the study on Maximus the Confessor, see, pp.262 – 295.

9 Quoted by (Vishnevskaya 2006).

but development. The model of priest is more suggestive and fruitful to assert human intervention towards nature.

6.2.3 Great Man in Confucianism

Human beings are not treated as the masters of the universe in Confucianism, because all beings in the world are included within the cosmic moral order. As Chang Tsai (Zhang Zai, 1020 – 1077)'s *Western Inscription* noted,[10] this cosmic moral order constitutes the basic ontological structural relationship between humans and other beings. Using the metaphor of kinship order, all beings in the world are arranged in an orderly relational structure. Humans are the sons / daughters of Heaven and Earth, and other non-human beings are regarded as our companions. It seems that, in Confucianism, "human beings are organically connected with rocks, trees and animals" (Tu 1989: 113). In this sense, we can state that it is no problem for Confucianism to agree with the anti-anthropocentric approach of environmental ethics, that human and non-human beings should each have intrinsic value, because they are equal in the sense that all are subject to the transformative influence of Heaven and Earth.

However, Confucianism rejects certain kinds of eco-egalitarianism, which assume that an equal moral status is shared by human beings and other non-human beings. In the *Doctrine of the Mean*, Heaven decrees human nature on the assumption that humankind receives, at least in potential, this mandate of Heaven in its highest excellence. Therefore, among the creatures in the cosmos, human beings are assumed to be the most sentient being, and the mandate that comes from Heaven establishes the ideal moral process and ideal personality as grounded in sincerity (*Cheng*, 誠).[11] In the *Doctrine of the Mean*, the word "sincerity" is not only regarded as a human moral quality, being trustworthy to other people and oneself, but is also treated as an ethical ontological substance of Heaven and Earth. "Sincerity is a way of Heaven. To think how to be sincere is

10 "Heaven is my father and earth is my mother, and even such a small creature as I find an intimate place in their midst. Therefore that which fills the universe I regard as my body and that which directs the universe I consider as my nature. All people are my brothers and sisters, and all things are my companions" (Chan 1963: 497).

11 "Only those who are absolutely sincere can fully develop their nature. If they can fully develop their nature, they can then fully develop the nature of others. If they can fully develop the nature of others, they can then fully develop the nature of things. If they can fully develop the nature of things, they can then assist in the transforming and nourishing process of Heaven and Earth, they can thus form a trinity with Heaven and Earth" (Chan 1963: 108).

the way of man" (Chan 1963: 7). To be sincere is identical with developing and cultivating the potentiality of others. The Confucian ideal moral person is a person who can fully actualize the inner goodness mandated by Heaven, and then also cultivate others' inner goodness in order to fulfill the ultimate self-cultivating ends in union with Heaven and Earth.

Based on the unity of human beings and non-human beings, Confucianism finds no difficulty in asserting the intrinsic value of all beings. However, under the above analysis, "Heaven-Human-Earth" consists of the organic and holistic worldview in which human beings should play a unique role: transformation of the moral potentiality of other beings in the world. In this sense, the Confucian tradition insists that the centrality of the human being in the cosmos is by virtue of cultivating and transforming the other. The unity of "Heaven-Human-Earth" is best illustrated in Wang Yangming (1472–1529)'s *Inquiry on the Great Learning*.[12] In the text, Wang emphasized that the Confucian "Great Man" does not mean super-human, but a person who transforms and cultivates her/himself to be an authentic person who, ontologically united with transcendent Heaven and immanent Earth on the one hand, and constituting a unifying body with other species on the other, is full of passion and compassion towards other beings that are also regarded as the creation of the Heaven and Earth. The concept of unity with other beings in a body upholds the intrinsic value of other beings; however, this does not mean that Confucianism will agree with eco-egalitarianism, which insists that all beings have equal value with others. The idea of the "degree of love" will insist that, in Confucianism, though non-human be-

12 "The great man regards Heaven and Earth and the myriad things as one body. He regards the world as one family and the country as one person ... That the great man can regarded Heaven, Earth and the myriad things as one body is not because he deliberately wants to do so, but because it is natural to the humane nature of his mind that he do so. Forming one body with Heaven, Earth and the myriad things is not only true of the great man. Even the mind of the small man is no different. Only he himself makes it small. Therefore when he sees a child about to fall into a well, he cannot help a feeling of alarm and commiseration. This shows that his humanity (*jen*) forms one body with the child. It may be objected that the child belongs to the same species. Again, when he observes the pitiful cries and frightened appearance of birds and animals about to be slaughtered, he cannot help feeling an "inability to bear" their suffering. This shows that his humanity forms one body with birds and animals. It may be objected that birds and animals are sentient beings as he is. But when he sees plants broken and destroyed, he cannot help ... feeling ... pity. This shows that his humanity forms one body with plants. It may be said that plants are living things as he is. Yet, even when he sees tiles and stones shattered and crushed, he cannot help ... feeling ... regret. This means that even the mind of the small man necessarily has the humanity that forms one body with all. Such a mind is rooted in his Heaven-endowed nature, and is naturally intelligent, clear and not beclouded. For this reason it is called 'clear character'" (Chan 1963: 659–660).

ings are the objects of moral compassion, the human social order has ontological and moral priority over the animal world and the natural world.[13]

In a certain sense, the concept of human as microcosm is found in Confucianism. This is expressed most succinctly in the metaphor of humans as forming a triad with Heaven and earth. This is not intended simply to describe a vague mystical unity with the "all". Rather, the Confucians situate humans within concentric circles of embeddedness. The individual is never viewed in isolation, but is seen as part of these interlocking circles, which touch each other. The family is at the center and the circles move outward toward friends and the larger human community; they connect to the political order, and inevitably unite with the cosmos itself. This is exactly the Confucian anthropocosmic world view.

6.3 Environmental Ethics in Dialogue

Recently, several studies have attempted to articulate the linkage between Orthodox traditions and ecology.[14] The sacramental cosmology presented by Orthodox tradition views the world not as an entity for human manipulation and domination, but as an icon or a sacrament embodied within, symbolizing the divine on the one hand, and creation, regarded as a *gift* offered by God on the other. Therefore, the role of the universe is twofold: one is the mirror of the divine glory; the other is the object of thanks-giving towards God (Theokritoff 2009). Nature as a whole is regarded as a symbolic system that is full of dynamic diversity in unity under the *logoi* created by God. As a symbol, nature participates and points to the divine. It does not commit to the idolatry of nature. Nature never identifies itself with the divine. However, through the richness and diversity of nature, we can see the glory and the presence of God. Following that line, Tillich's idea of the presence of Holy Spirit is embodied universally within the multi-dimensional unity of life; the pan-sacramentality provides the room for Tillich to embrace the idea of the cosmic liturgy of Orthodox traditions. Also, in Confu-

13 For the question of how Confucianism' views animals, see Keith Ka-fu, Chan & Stephen Palmquist, "A Confucian-Kantian Response to Environmental Eco-Centrism on Animal Equality," *Journal of Chinese Philosophy*, volume 43, issue 3–4, 2016 (forthcoming).

14 Fr Bartholomew I (1940-) is well known as the Green Patriarch. He is undoubtedly an important figure of Orthodox tradition in dealing with the ecological problem. See (Bartholomew I. 2003). Recently, some environmentalists have started to be aware of the ecological contribution of the Orthodox tradition, and to cooperate with Orthodox theologians to explore ecological significance. For their contributions see (Foltz and Chryssavgis 2013), and (Chryssavgis and Goldsmith 2014).

cianism, the dynamic and unifying vision of the universe constitutes the principle of "unity in difference" in which all the diverse realities share the "one fundamental principle". Confucian ethics encourages us to expand our human heart to love the other beings in the world.

Concerning anthropology, Orthodox traditions locate the human being as the mediator between God and the world. Comparing the stewardship of human beings with environmental thinking, the priest/ mediator of the creation emphasized in Orthodox traditions highlights the religious role of human beings in treating the world as an offering gift to the Creator instead of adopting a "manager" metaphor in the concept of "stewardship" which tends to relocate the subject-object relationship. For Orthodox traditions, an ecological problem is treated as a *spiritual* problem in the modern world. It implies that the authentic human role among other creatures has been distorted and abused. Following this line, Tillich also highlighted the human being as the "highest" being in the ontological sense, though this does not imply that s/he is the perfect one. Based on the universal fall of humanity and nature, the ambiguous character of all beings results in suffering with an alienated existential condition. For Tillich, the human as macrocosm represents the ethical and religious tasks that human should fulfill.

For Tillich, under the impact of Spiritual Presence, the divine love, *agape*, is manifested. The *agape* manifests its power through the ontological structure of all beings, to bind all beings into a unified whole. Because the ontological structure of love is the reunion of the separated, the Spiritual *agape* transforms the human *eros* to embrace the universe. Compared with the Orthodox traditions and Confucianism, the love-quality of human beings is also manifested in the role of humans as the companions of other beings in the world. Human beings and other beings are fragile and share the suffering of the world. In order to love and to be loved, the Orthodox tradition emphasizes the beauty of the cosmos, which is viewed by the transformed spirituality. That is why the ecological richness contained in the Orthodox theology is heavily found in Christian asceticism in which the greatest love for the beauty of creation is mentioned and human beings are purified by God's grace to "see" (*theoria*) the extraordinary depths of the universe (*theosis*) (Foltz 2013a).

7 Conclusion

Paul Tillich had lamented in one of his latest sermons, "Man and Earth," of the imminent danger of a universal and total catastrophe in his generation. Although Tillich never mentioned the phrase "environmental crisis" in this sermon, and even in his lifetime, it is surprising that the content was not dated and still powerfully addresses our ecological catastrophe. For him, first, in facing the problem of the survival of civilized humankind, the fundamental question is how to reconceive the relationship between humans and the earth. "It may well be that we are living in such a moment, and that man's relation to the earth and the universe will ... become the point of primary concern for sensitive and thoughtful people." (Tillich 1963d: 68 – 69) Tillich was fully aware of the emergence of the alienated relationship between humans and the planet in which the ecological crisis would become our global and spiritual problem. In facing the threat of universal catastrophe, Tillich emphasized, our reaction is either longing for the security of our daily life, or exaggerating the confidence through the technical conquest of all our dimensions of life. Actually, these two reactions are not contradictory but deeply and profoundly rooted in the existential situation of human being in the world. Second, in order to break through the paradoxical situation of the greatness and smallness of humans on the planet, Tillich asserted, "Man is rooted in the same Ground in which the universe with all its galaxies is rooted." (Ibid.: 72) This theological and religious dimension affirms the secular environmental discourses concerning the complex relationship of humans and nature, and also packages the ecological consideration with ultimate concern. Last, in the end of the sermon, Tillich pointed out, "the question of man and his earth ... cannot be answered without an awareness of the eternal presence." (Ibid.: 77) Originally, in Tillich's mind, "spiritual presence" and "eternal now" are coinciding. Eternal presence symbolizes the divine spiritual power of healing and fulfillment, of love and blessings. Tillich ended his sermon with the pneumatological-eschatological hope and faithful encouragement with his words, "only the eternal can give us the certainty that the earth, and, with it, mankind, has not existed in vain, even should history comes to an end tomorrow." (Ibid.: 77 – 78)

This study reconstructs Tillich's ecological thinking through emphasizing his pneumatological-eschatological perspective which was profoundly contained in volume three of his *Systematic Theology*. It concludes that, first, the role of pneumatology in Tillich's entire theological system is highly significant. The tension between universality and particularity of divine revelation is maintained by the matrix of pneumatology in which the center and the periphery of the theological

https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110612752-008

circle, the relationship between Christianity and other religions, the conflict between incarnational and adoptional Christologies and the transcendence and immanence of God and the world, are repackaged through pneumatology. As this book shows, pneumatology is not merely one of Tillich's theological doctrine, but he actually attempted to reconsider all his theological issues through the lens of the idea of Spirit. Second, Tillich's pneumatology is multi-dimensional in character. The Holy Spirit is correlated with poly- and multi-faceted levels of numerous forms of life in our world. This cosmic and universal aspect of pneumatology makes a strong critique of the subjectivist understanding of the divine Spirit and the human spirit, and we can trace this dimension of pneumatology to Catholic, Orthodox and radical reformer traditions on one hand, and also to his German idealist-philosophical heritages, on the other. This study also argues that different dimensions of life-forms (inorganic, organic, spiritual and historical) are capable of symbolizing the divine; they are all potentially the bearer of divine manifestations in which the boundary of different forms of life blurr, and the interdisciplinary character of pneumatology with the natural sciences should be mentioned. Third, this study points out the internal tension of Tillich's idea of multi-dimensional and hierarchical metaphors in describing the numerous levels of reality. Human beings, as Tillich asserted, are microcosms which indicates the highest beings as such. Therefore, this cosmic anthropology emphasizes the distinctiveness of the human center and holds the idea of the reciprocity of the human person and nature. Following, it seems that, as this study argues, the eco-centricism and anthropocentricism are not in contradiction. Rather, if all beings in the world have inherently different degrees of the power of being, it implies that different functionalities of individuals are classified and leveled in an integrated whole within the universe. Individuals are unique in their definitive character, and this character is relative to the context in the sense that neither holism nor individualism is Tillich's entire position. Moreover, Tillich's idea of theonomous technology is demonstrated within the pneumatological-eschatological perspective in which the divine-demonic and ambiguous character of the modern technological apparatus are explained, and this scientific-technological mindset is grounded in the nominalist philosophical-theological in the medieval ages. Tillich adopted a realist approach towards the problem of scientific-technological power in particular, and the philosophical-theological attitude towards the nature. Tillich is neither optimistic nor pessimistic. His realistic attitudes towards the fate of nature and human beings bring him to escape a naive romantic nature-fantasy, and he always expresses the tragic character of nature which is manifested in our scientific-technical framework dominating our world. In the essay, "The Effect of Space Exploration on Man's Condition and Stature," (1964) Tillich expressed his worry for the radicalization of demy-

thologizing and materialization of our motherly earth, and the meaning-loss of our scientific "forwardism" which radicalizes the contrast between the horizontal and vertical dimensions of human orientation. (Tillich 1966: 45 – 46) However, his German idealistic and Lutheran background provides him a picture of intimate relationship between humanity and nature in which both parties share the same destiny. Tillich combines the objective-philosophical perspectives and compassionate whole-hearted attitudes together towards nature. Last, this study tries to demonstrate the potential of religious dialogue of Tillich's ecological pneumatology with Orthodox environmental theology and Confucian ecological thinking. All three parties reject the idea of equality of the intrinsic value of all beings as bio-centricism asserts, and emphasize that nature is a relational whole in which human life and the rhythms of nature that sustain life in both its biological needs and socio-cultural expressions operate together. Everything in nature is interdependent, interrelated, dynamic and transformational. Nature, therefore, is inherently valuable and morally good. Value lies in the ongoing transformation and productivity of nature. Human beings as the center of the universe share all the ontological power of the universe, and all powers of the universe are manifested in human beings. The existential ambiguity of human creativity is profoundly expressed in Tillich's pneumatology that the human being is the fulfillment and the destroyer of the universe. This ambiguous mixture points to the quest for pneumatological healing and divine redemption.

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https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110612752-011